WORKING WITH THE BANGSAMORO GOVERNMENT

A Guide for Fresh Graduates and Job Seekers

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BANGSAMORO GOVERNMENT

BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION IN MUSLIM MINDANAO

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About This Guidebook

Why This Guidebook Exists

This guidebook was written for people **outside** government who want to get **inside**.

Other BARMM guidebooks – on Complete Staff Work, supervision, bill drafting, budget briefing – are written for people already inside the Bangsamoro government. Those guidebooks assume you know what a memorandum looks like, what "CSW" means, and how the approval chain works. They coach you as a peer.

This guidebook assumes none of that.

This guidebook exists because the Bangsamoro government needs you – and you deserve a clear, honest guide to help you decide whether to join, how to apply, and how to succeed once you are inside.

The Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao has **50,467 authorized positions** across 15 ministries and 13 executive offices (as reported in BDP Chapter 5 on Governance, November 2022). Thousands remain vacant. The region has the largest land area in the Philippines, the youngest population, and the widest development gaps. It needs engineers, teachers, nurses, planners, budget analysts, lawyers, IT specialists, social workers, and administrative professionals.

It needs **you**.

Who This Guidebook Is For

Primary Audience: Fresh Graduates

You have completed college but have not yet been employed, or you are in your first job search. You have academic knowledge – a thesis, a capstone project, leadership experience in student organizations – but zero government experience. You may not know what "BTA" stands for, what a **plantilla position** is, or how the **Comparative Assessment** works.

This guidebook will teach you all of that.

Secondary Audience: Experienced Professionals

You have worked in the private sector, NGOs, international organizations, or other government agencies, and you want to **join or transfer** to the Bangsamoro government. You have work experience but may not know BARMM-specific systems – the Bangsamoro Civil Service Code (BAA 17), the Bangsamoro Administrative Code (BAA 13), or the 12 Pillars of Moral Governance.

This guidebook will bridge that gap.

How to Use This Guidebook

This guidebook is organized into four parts. You can read it cover to cover, or you can go directly to the part that matches where you are in your journey.

Part I: Understanding the Bangsamoro Government (Chapters 1-6)

Read this first. Before you apply, understand what you are joining. These six chapters give you the foundation: why the government needs you, the Bangsamoro story, how the government is organized, your employment framework under BAA 17, the Bangsamoro Development Plan, and the four career tracks you can choose from.

If you are a fresh graduate with no government background, Part I is essential. Do not skip it.

Part II: Getting the Job (Chapters 7-9)

Read this when you are ready to apply. These three chapters are the most practical in the guidebook. Chapter 7 tells you where to find job openings. Chapter 8 walks you through the application process step by step. Chapter 9 prepares you for the interview and assessment. A fresh graduate should be able to read Part II, follow the steps, and submit a competitive application without outside help.

Part III: Succeeding in Government (Chapters 10-16)

Read this when you get the job. These seven chapters prepare you for your first day and beyond. You will learn Complete Staff Work (the methodology every government worker uses), the competencies that determine your career trajectory, how to work with your su-

pervisor, how to write government documents, the employee lifecycle from onboarding to promotion, career growth and development pathways, and the ethical foundations of Bangsamoro public service.

Part IV: Reference (Chapter 17, Glossary, and Appendices)

Use this anytime. Chapter 17 answers the 33 most frequently asked questions – from "Do I need Civil Service eligibility?" to "I am not Muslim – can I still work in BARMM government?" The Glossary defines every acronym, legal term, and institutional term used in this guidebook. The Appendices provide detachable tools: checklists, worksheets, templates, and quick reference cards you can use throughout your career.

Conventions Used in This Guidebook

Throughout this guidebook, you will encounter the following:

- **Bold terms** indicate key vocabulary you should learn. Most are defined in the Glossary.
- **Tables and checklists** are designed for practical use. Print them, fill them in, and bring them to your interviews.
- **"Actionable Tool" sections** at the end of each chapter provide worksheets, self-assessments, and reference cards you can detach and use.
- **Cross-references** (e.g., "See Chapter 8, Section 8.3") point you to related content elsewhere in this guidebook.
- **Legal citations** (e.g., BAA 17, RA 6713) refer to specific laws. You do not need to read these laws before starting – the guidebook explains what you need to know.
- **Islamic terms** (e.g., *amanah*, *shura*) are governance values rooted in Islamic tradition. Each is defined where it first appears and in the Glossary. These values apply to all staff regardless of personal faith.

Acknowledgments

This guidebook would not exist without the Bangsamoro public servants – career staff, legislative officers, program managers, and frontline workers – who build the systems, write the memos, deliver the services, and keep the government running every day. Their work during the transition period is the foundation upon which the permanent Bangsamoro government will stand.

Gratitude is due to the members and staff of the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament for their contribution to the institutional knowledge reflected in this guidebook; to the Civil Service Commission for the competency frameworks and qualification standards that structure government careers; and to the Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority for the development data and planning frameworks that give government work its direction.

This guidebook is dedicated to the fresh graduates of the Bangsamoro – and to every Filipino professional who sees in the Bangsamoro autonomous region not just a job, but a calling.

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About the Author

Saidamen "Sayeed" R. Mambayao has worked in governance, legislation, and cooperative development across the Bangsamoro region for over a decade.

Before the establishment of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region, he served as a Consultant of the Cooperative Development Authority under the former Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao, where he led programs on cooperative development, Islamic finance, and executive leadership. He also served as Secretariat Head and Program Director of the Bangsamoro Executives and Leaders League (BELL), Inc., and held leadership roles in the ARMM Islamic Finance Sub-Cluster and the Bangsamoro Coalition on Social Enterprise.

When the Bangsamoro Transition Authority was established in 2019, he led the development and implementation of two BARMM flagship programs: the Access to Higher and Modern Education (AHME) Scholarship Program under the Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education, and the Engaging the SK, Empowering the Youth (ESKEY) Program under the Ministry of the Interior and Local Government. He later served as Chief of Staff at the Office of a Member of Parliament, where he assisted on legislative portfolios covering women, youth, children, persons with disabilities, cooperatives, social enterprises, and halal industries. He drafted and reviewed legislative measures on scholarships, cultural heritage preservation, assistance to Other Bangsamoro Communities, and cooperative and social enterprise development. He also served as OIC-Legislative Affairs at the Office of MP Sittie Fahanie S. Uy-Oyod.

He is the Founder of MoroTech and MoroAcademy, social enterprises empowering Bangsamoro organizations and communities through knowledge and technology, and the Founding Chairperson of the Bangsamoro Scholars Association. He also founded the SEED Initiative, a consultancy and training firm focused on cooperative and social enterprise development. He is an Active Citizen and graduate of the British Council's CSO-SEED Business and Investment Readiness Program.

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Why the Bangsamoro Government Needs You

The Bangsamoro government has 50,467 authorized positions[1] — and it needs more. It governs the largest land area in the Philippines, serves one of the youngest populations in the country, and faces the widest development gaps of any region. If you want to build something from the ground up, this is the last frontier.

This chapter is not about history or organizational charts. Those come later. This chapter is about a simple question: **Why should a fresh graduate or job seeker choose the Bangsamoro government?**

The answer is in the numbers, in the staffing gaps, and in the kind of work you will do here that you cannot do anywhere else.

1.1 The Development Gap — In Numbers

The gap between where BARMM is today and where the **2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan (BDP) 2023-2028** says it should be is the reason you are needed. These numbers are not abstract. Each one represents communities waiting for services, families without clean water, children leaving school too early.

Indicator	BARMM (Current)	National Average	BDP Target (2028)
Poverty incidence	29.80% (2021)	~16%	20-25%
Functional literacy rate	71.6%	91.6%	Near national
Dropout rate (G1-G6)	8.36%	3.76%	Below national
WASH access (safe water)	Lowest in PH	—	Universal
Maternal mortality rate	73.83 per 100,000 live births (2020)	70.66 per 100,000	Below national

Indicator	BARMM (Current)	National Average	BDP Target (2028)
GRDP contribution to national	1.4%	—	Proportional
Underemployment rate	9.0% (2020)	—	4-7%

Sources: All indicators from the 2nd BDP 2023-2028, Chapter 4.[2] Staffing data from Chapter 5.[1]

Look at these numbers together. BARMM's functional literacy rate trails the national average by **20 percentage points**. The dropout rate is more than double the national figure. Safe water access ranks **17th out of 17 regions** — dead last. Maternal mortality sits above the national average. And despite having the largest land area in the country, BARMM contributes only **1.4% to national GDP** — the lowest of any region.

Education

The scale of the education gap is staggering. Out of 2,590 barangays (BDP 2023-2028 figure; excludes adjustments from Sulu's exclusion from BARMM per SC ruling), **104 remain unserved or underserved** — meaning children in those communities have no nearby school or an incomplete school. Only **7% of 1,679 madrasahs** (Islamic schools) are accredited. There are not enough teachers for Grades 1 through 12. The completion rate from Grade 1 to Grade 6 sits at **63.98%** — the lowest in the Philippines.[3]

What this means for you: if you have a degree in education, curriculum development, or any social science, the **Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education (MBHTE)** needs you. The gap is not just about buildings. It is about people — teachers, planners, curriculum developers, and education administrators.

Health

BARMM has the highest rates of **stunting, wasting, and underweight children** in the Philippines. There are not enough doctors, nurses, or midwives to serve the population. Psychosocial and mental health services barely exist at the community level. Provincial and district hospitals operate below capacity — not because of low demand, but because of insufficient personnel and equipment.

The maternal mortality rate sits at **73.83 per 100,000 live births** (2020) — above the national average of 70.66.[6] Behind that number are mothers in island barangays of Tawi-Tawi and Basilan who give birth without a skilled attendant. Behind it are health stations that have buildings but no midwife assigned.

What this means for you: if you have a degree in nursing, midwifery, public health, nutrition, or any allied health field, the **Ministry of Health (MOH)** needs you — at provincial hospitals, district health offices, and community health stations across all five provinces and Cotabato City.

Infrastructure

Basic water and sanitation access ranks last nationally across all indicators. BARMM's **WASH (water, sanitation, and hygiene)** situation is the worst in the country — ranked 17th out of 17 regions. Roads in island provinces remain underdeveloped. Connectivity between mainland BARMM (Lanao del Sur, Maguindanao del Norte, Maguindanao del Sur) and island provinces (Basilan, Tawi-Tawi) depends on sea routes and limited air service.

The infrastructure backlog is not just about convenience. A road that washes out during rainy season means children cannot reach school. A water system that breaks means families drink unsafe water. A seaport that cannot handle cargo means food prices in island municipalities are double the mainland rate.

The **Ministry of Public Works (MPW)** and the **Ministry of Transportation and Communications (MOTC)** need engineers, project managers, construction inspectors, and infrastructure planners. If you have a degree in civil engineering, architecture, geodetic engineering, or project management, the infrastructure gap is where your skills translate directly into community impact.

Economy

Here is the paradox: BARMM is the **number one producer of seaweed** (48.42% national share) and **cassava** (41.70% national share).[7] It has vast agricultural land, marine resources, a strategic position in the BIMP-EAGA (Brunei-Indonesia-Malaysia-Philippines East ASEAN Growth Area) corridor, and a young labor force. Yet its contribution to national GDP is the lowest of any region at **1.4%**.

The gap is not in resources. It is in people — the market analysts, the agricultural economists, the trade specialists, the investment officers, the tourism planners who can turn raw resources into economic value. The **Ministry of Trade, Investments, and Tourism**

(MTIT), the **Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries, and Agrarian Reform (MAFAR)**, and the **Bangsamoro Board of Investments (BBOI)** all need professionals who can help close this gap.

Social Welfare

The **Ministry of Social Services and Development (MSSD)** manages social protection programs for the most vulnerable communities — persons with disabilities, solo parents, displaced families, senior citizens, and children in need of special protection. BARMM's poverty incidence at 29.80% means nearly one in three families lives below the poverty line. MSSD implements livelihood programs, humanitarian assistance, and social welfare services across the region, but its staff-to-beneficiary ratio remains stretched thin.

If you have a degree in social work, community development, psychology, or any social science, MSSD offers a career path where your work directly reaches the most underserved communities in the Philippines.

1.2 The Staffing Reality

The numbers tell the staffing story clearly:

- **50,467 authorized positions** across 15 ministries and 13 executive offices[1]
- **35,812 positions filled** — meaning **14,655 positions remain vacant**[1]
- **600,000+ job applications** received through the Bangsamoro Job Portal[1] — but many applicants lack required qualifications or eligibility
- **15 line ministries** need staff across all functional areas: policy, planning, budget, administration, IT, legal, and technical
- **10 attached agencies** under the Office of the Chief Minister (BPDA, BBOI, BIO, BICTO, OSC, OOBC, BPA, DAB, BDI, CSEA) — many are newly created and still building teams
- **4 commissions** (BWC, BYC, BSC, BCPCH) need specialized staff in gender, youth, sports, and cultural heritage
- **116 municipalities and 2,590 barangays** (BDP 2023-2028 figures; exclude adjustments from Sulu's exclusion from BARMM per SC ruling) need frontline service delivery workers

The gap between 600,000+ applicants and 14,655 vacancies is misleading. Many applicants lack **Civil Service eligibility**, do not meet **qualification standards**, or apply for positions that do not match their credentials. The government does not need just warm bodies. It needs **qualified, eligible, motivated people** who understand the mission.

What does "qualified" mean in practice? Chapter 4 covers this in detail, but the short version: for professional positions (SG 11 and above), you typically need a **bachelor's degree** and **Career Service Professional eligibility** (obtained by passing the CSC exam or through equivalent eligibility for licensed professionals). For some technical positions, you need a degree in a specific field — engineering for MPW, agriculture for MAFAR, nursing for MOH.

The eligibility requirement alone eliminates many applicants. If you have a college degree and CSC eligibility (or a professional license that grants equivalent eligibility), you are already ahead of most of the 600,000+ applicants. If you do not yet have eligibility, Chapter 4 explains how to get it.

The Coterminous and COS Reality

Not all government positions are permanent. A significant number of staff in BARMM work under **coterminous appointments** (tied to the appointing authority's term) or **Contracts of Service (COS)**. These arrangements offer less job security but provide a way into the system. Many permanent employees started as COS workers, proved their competence, and were later appointed to plantilla positions when vacancies opened.

Understanding this landscape prepares you for realistic expectations. You may not land a permanent position on your first try. But getting into the system — even through COS or a temporary appointment — gives you insider knowledge, professional networks, and demonstrated experience that strengthens future applications.

Where Staff Are Needed Most Urgently

Office/Ministry	Why	Example Positions
MBHTE (Education)	Lowest literacy, dropout, and completion rates nationally	Teachers, curriculum developers, education planners
MOH (Health)	Maternal mortality above national average, highest stunting rates	Nurses, midwives, health program officers, nutritionists
MAFAR (Agriculture)		

Office/Ministry	Why	Example Positions
	Largest land area, food security gaps, 110,513 ha of undistributed land[16]	Agricultural technicians, agrarian reform officers
BPDA (Planning)	Coordinates the entire BDP — needs analysts and M&E staff	Development planners, statisticians, M&E officers
MFBM (Finance)	Manages PHP 80B+ annual block grant[17] — needs financial controls	Budget analysts, accountants, procurement officers
MPW (Public Works)	Infrastructure backlog across 5 provinces + Cotabato City	Engineers, project managers, construction inspectors
Parliament Secretariat	Supports 77 MPs across all committees	Legislative staff officers, political affairs officers, media officers

This table is your starting map. Find the office whose mission matches your degree and your motivation. That is where you begin.

The Demand for Generalists

The table above highlights technical roles, but the government also needs **generalists** — people with degrees in public administration, political science, management, communications, information technology, or the liberal arts. Every ministry needs administrative officers, planning staff, IT support, records managers, and communications personnel. If your degree is not technical, you are not shut out. You simply enter through a different door: the administrative, planning, or communications track within any ministry or office.

Generalists are especially valued in the **Parliament Secretariat** (where legislative staff officers analyze policy across all subject areas), at **BPDA** (where planners coordinate across ministries), and in the **commissions** (BWC, BYC, BSC, BCPCH), where small teams handle diverse functions.

1.3 What Makes BARMM Different from Any Other Government Job

Working for the Bangsamoro government is not the same as working for a national government agency or a regional field office. Five things set it apart.

Autonomous Governance

BARMM is the **only region in the Philippines** with its own parliament, its own civil service code (BAA 17),[8] its own administrative code (BAA 13),[9] its own budget system (BAA 84),[10] and its own education code (BAA 18).[11] You are not joining a field office that follows Manila's instructions. You are joining a government that makes its own laws.

> "The Bangsamoro Autonomous Region is an integral, indivisible, and inseparable part of the territory of the Republic of the Philippines."[12] — Republic Act 11054, Article IV, Section 1

This means your work has direct legislative backing from the **Bangsamoro Parliament** — not just administrative orders from a department secretary in Manila.

Moral Governance

Every government claims to value ethics. What makes BARMM different is that its ethical framework is not borrowed from a generic good governance manual. It is rooted in the Bangsamoro people's own values — informed by Islamic principles, shaped by centuries of governance tradition, and codified as official policy.

The **12 Pillars of Moral Governance**[4] are the ethical foundation of everything BARMM does. They are not aspirational slogans on a wall poster. They are cited in performance evaluations, referenced in legislation, and expected in daily conduct. The 12 pillars are:

1. **Integrity** — avoid conflicts of interest
2. **Accountability** — be open about decisions and actions
3. **Transparency and Honesty** — declare private interests, resolve conflicts protecting the public
4. **Sense of Patriotism** — invest in the Bangsamoro's reputation
5. **Striving for Excellence** — deliver the highest quality
6. **Cultural Understanding and Tolerance** — appreciate diversity within the Bangsamoro

7. **Unwavering Loyalty to God** — governance guided by devotion
8. **Justice** — serve without prejudice
9. **Inclusivity** — foster environments free from discrimination
10. **Objectivity** — make merit-based decisions
11. **Dialogue and Meaningful Engagement** — seek community opinion
12. **Balance Between Practical Life and Moral Side** — never deviate from the ethical dimension

If you come from the private sector, this will feel unfamiliar. Government work anywhere has ethical standards, but BARMM's moral governance framework is explicit, faith-informed, and culturally grounded in ways that are unique in Philippine governance.

Parliamentary System

BARMM is the **only region in the Philippines with a parliamentary system**. The Chief Minister leads the executive. The Parliament legislates and exercises oversight. This means legislative staff and executive staff work differently here than anywhere else in Philippine government. If you join the Parliament, you will draft bills, prepare legislative briefers, and support committee hearings. If you join a ministry, you will implement laws that the Parliament enacts. The two branches work in closer coordination than in a presidential system.

The Peace Process

You are not joining a regular bureaucracy. You are implementing the **Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB)**[20] — a peace agreement that ended decades of armed conflict. Every program you run, every policy you draft, every barangay you serve is a **peace dividend**. The government's legitimacy rests not just on elections or appointments, but on delivering the promises made in that agreement.

Cultural Diversity

BARMM is home to **13 ethnolinguistic groups**: Meranaw, Maguindanaon, Tausug, Sama, Yakan, Iranun, Kalibugan, Palawanon, Molbog, Jama Mapun, Badjao, Sangil, and Teduray. There are also settler communities, Other Bangsamoro Communities, and indigenous peoples. You will work with colleagues and communities whose languages, customs, and perspectives differ from yours — sometimes dramatically.

Cultural sensitivity is not optional. It is a job requirement. A program that works in Maguindanao may fail in Tawi-Tawi because the community dynamics are different. A communication style that is respected in Lanao del Sur may be perceived differently in Basilan. Understanding these differences — or at least being humble enough to ask about them before assuming — is a core competency in BARMM government work.

The government institutionalizes this commitment to diversity through specific offices: the **Office for Settler Communities (OSC)**, the **Office for Other Bangsamoro Communities (OOBC)**, and the **Ministry of Indigenous Peoples' Affairs (MIPA)**. These offices exist because the Bangsamoro government recognizes that "Bangsamoro" is not a monolithic identity — it is a diverse community of communities, and governance must reflect that diversity.

1.4 What "Founder" Means

In a mature government, you inherit systems. Manuals are written. Templates exist. Precedents guide you. In BARMM, you build the systems yourself. The Bangsamoro government is barely seven years old. Here is what "founder" looks like in practice:

You may be the first. Your position may have existed on paper for years but never been filled. Your job description may be a paragraph, not a manual. You will define the role as you fill it.

You are the systems designer. Many offices do not yet have Manuals of Procedure (MOPs). You may be asked to create the filing system, the tracking sheet, the approval workflow, the template that everyone after you will use.

You set the standard. Your output quality becomes the benchmark. If you write excellent memos, your successors will follow your format. If you write poor ones, they will too. The first person to do something defines how it gets done.

You are the bridge. The BTA is transitional — appointed by the President. The first elected Bangsamoro government is coming. The systems you build during transition become the inheritance of that elected government. Your filing system, your tracking tool, your template — those survive you.

A real example: When the Bangsamoro Parliament began operations in 2019, there were no committee staffing templates, no standard legislative briefer format, no standardized bill-drafting manual. Staff who joined early created these tools from scratch — and those templates are still in use today. That is what "founder" means.

This is not unique to the Parliament. When MAFAR began implementing agrarian reform programs, staff had to design the application forms, the beneficiary screening criteria, and the distribution tracking systems. When BPDA launched the first Bangsamoro Development Plan, planners had to create the monitoring framework, the data collection templates, and the coordination mechanisms from scratch. Every ministry has a version of this story.

The founder advantage is real: if you join now and build well, you shape the institution. But the founder burden is also real: if you need someone to tell you what to do step by step, you will struggle. Government work in BARMM rewards initiative, resourcefulness, and a willingness to figure things out.

What "Founder" Does NOT Mean

Being a founder does not mean you work alone or without guidance. You will have supervisors, colleagues, and institutional frameworks. BAA 13[18] defines your office's mandate. BAA 17[19] defines your employment terms. The BDP defines your targets. What is missing — and what you will help create — are the **operational details**: the workflows, the templates, the checklists, the standard operating procedures that turn mandates into daily practice.

It also does not mean that everything is broken. BARMM inherited some functioning systems from ARMM. Many national government processes (procurement, auditing, financial reporting) apply in BARMM. The challenge is adapting national systems to autonomous governance and building new systems where none existed.

1.5 The 12-Point Priority Agenda — Where You Fit

The **Enhanced 12-Point Priority Agenda**[5] is the Chief Minister's implementation framework within the BDP. Each priority maps to ministries and offices that need staff. Use this table to find where your skills and interests align.

#	Priority	Focus	Offices Needing Staff
1	**Bureaucracy**	Strengthen regional bureaucracy	All MOAs — HR, admin, planning
2	**Priority Codes**	Enact priority codes (5 enacted: Administrative BAA 13, Civil Service	Parliament (legislative staff for

#	Priority	Focus	Offices Needing Staff
		BAA 17, Education BAA 18, Electoral BAA 35,[14] Local Governance BAA 49;[15] remaining: Revenue, Investment)	drafting), Legal offices
3	**Revenue Generation**	Increase revenue and economic advantages	MFBM, BBOI, MTIT
4	**Social Services**	Education, health, social welfare	MBHTE, MOH, MSSD
5	**Infrastructure**	Strategic infrastructure development	MPW, MOTC
6	**Economic Development**	Inclusive economic growth	MTIT, MAFAR, MOLE
7	**Environment**	Natural resources protection	MENRE
8	**Disaster Resilience**	Community resilience	MILG, BRDRRMO
9	**Peace and Normalization**	Peace agreement provisions	OCM, MPOS
10	**Marawi Rehabilitation**	Marawi City recovery	Task Force Bangon Marawi, MHSD
11	**Peace and Security**	Sustain peace, justice, security	MPOS, BHRC
12	**Cultural Heritage**	Preserve Bangsamoro culture	BCPCH, MIPA

Notice how every priority connects to specific offices. If you care about education, Priority 4 leads you to MBHTE. If you care about the environment, Priority 7 leads you to MENRE. If you care about Marawi's recovery, Priority 10 leads you to MHSD and Task Force Bangon Marawi. Your passion has an address in this government.

How to Use This Table

Start with the column that matches your motivation. If you wake up thinking about food security, start at Priority 6 (Economic Development) and look at MAFAR. If you wake up thinking about cultural preservation, start at Priority 12 and look at BCPCH and MIPA. Then move to Chapter 3, where you will learn the detailed organizational structure of each office, and Chapter 7, where you will learn how to find actual job openings in those offices.

The 12-Point Priority Agenda is also a useful interview tool. When an interviewer asks, "Why do you want to work here?" being able to say, "Your ministry supports Priority 4 of the Enhanced 12-Point Priority Agenda, and I want to contribute to closing the education gap" demonstrates that you understand the government's strategic framework — not just the job listing.

1.7 The Youth Advantage

BARMM has one of the youngest populations in the Philippines. The **youth bulge** — a disproportionately large share of the population between ages 15 and 35 — is both a development challenge and an opportunity.

The challenge: Young people need jobs, education, and social services. If the government fails to provide these, the youth bulge becomes a source of instability rather than growth.

The opportunity: A young population means a growing workforce, fresh perspectives, and energy for institution-building. The Bangsamoro government needs young professionals who understand digital tools, data analysis, social media, and modern management practices — skills that older bureaucracies often lack.

As a fresh graduate, you bring exactly what this young government needs for its young population. You are not a liability because of your lack of experience. You are an asset because of your proximity to the communities, technologies, and ideas that the government must reach.

The **Bangsamoro Youth Commission (BYC)**, created by BAA 10,[13] exists specifically to advance youth development and participation. But every ministry needs young staff — not just the BYC. Your age is not a disadvantage here. It is a strategic fit.

1.8 The Geographic Opportunity

BARMM is not Cotabato City. The seat of government is in the mainland, but the region spans a vast and diverse territory:

- **Lanao del Sur** — 39 municipalities surrounding Lake Lanao, including Marawi City
- **Maguindanao del Norte and del Sur** — the agricultural heartland, home to the Bangsamoro Government Center
- **Basilan** — an island province south of Zamboanga, with agriculture-based communities
- **Tawi-Tawi** — the southernmost province of the Philippines, gateway to Southeast Asian neighbors
- **Cotabato City** — the commercial hub and seat of government
- **8 SGA municipalities** — the newest municipalities, still establishing basic governance structures

Each location offers different work environments. Cotabato City has the most developed infrastructure and the highest concentration of government offices. Island provinces offer fewer amenities but more direct community impact. The SGA municipalities are literally being built from scratch — if you want the purest founder experience, that is where to find it.

Your willingness to work outside Cotabato City — especially in island provinces or SGA municipalities — dramatically increases your chances of getting hired. Many applicants prefer the comfort of the mainland. Offices in Basilan, Tawi-Tawi, and remote Lanao del Sur municipalities struggle to attract qualified staff. Supply and demand work in your favor if you are willing to go where the need is greatest.

1.6 Actionable Tool: “Is Government Work Right for Me?” Self-Assessment

Before you invest weeks preparing applications, take 10 minutes to check your fit. This is not a test — there are no right or wrong answers. It helps you understand whether Bangsamoro government work matches your current motivations, tolerance for ambiguity, and career expectations.

Instructions: Rate each statement from 1 (Strongly Disagree) to 5 (Strongly Agree). Be honest.

#	Statement	Score (1-5)
1	I care about the Bangsamoro people's aspirations for self-governance and development — this is not just any job for me.	___
2	I am willing to work in areas outside Metro Manila or my hometown, including island provinces and conflict-affected communities.	___
3	I can work in a diverse environment with colleagues from different ethnolinguistic groups, religious backgrounds, and political perspectives.	___
4	I am comfortable with ambiguity — I can function even when there is no manual, no template, and no precedent.	___
5	I can accept that government salaries are lower than private sector for the same level of education and skill.	___
6	I am willing to learn government writing (memos, briefers, policy papers) even though it is very different from academic writing.	___
7	I can handle bureaucratic processes (approvals, endorsements, transmittals, compliance requirements) without frustration.	___
8	I am interested in policy, governance, public administration, or	___

#	Statement	Score (1-5)
	community development — not just any available job.	
9	I understand that working in BARMM means implementing a peace agreement — and I take that responsibility seriously.	___
10	I am willing to start at an entry-level position (SG 11-15, approximately PHP 27,000-38,000/month) and build my career over years.	___
11	I can respect Islamic governance principles (moral governance, amanah, shura) even if my own background is different.	___
12	I am willing to develop new competencies on the job — Complete Staff Work, policy analysis, stakeholder engagement — through training and practice.	___

Scoring Guide

48-60 — Strong fit. You have the mindset and motivation for Bangsamoro public service. Read on — the rest of this guidebook will show you how to get there.

36-47 — Good potential. Some areas need reflection. Read Chapters 2 through 5 to build your understanding of the Bangsamoro context before applying. Pay attention to the areas where you scored below 3 — those are your growth edges.

24-35 — Mixed signals. Government work may not be what you expect. Read the entire Part I before deciding. The "Day-in-the-Life" profiles in Chapter 6 will give you a realistic picture of what government work actually looks like.

12-23 — Consider other paths. Government work — especially in BARMM — requires a level of commitment, adaptability, and willingness to accept trade-offs that may not match your current preferences. That is OK. Not every contribution to the Bangsamoro happens inside the government. The private sector, civil society, and development organizations also need talented people.

How to Use Your Score

Your total score is less telling than your **pattern of low scores**. If you scored 5 on most items but 1 on "I can accept government salaries," that is a specific, solvable concern — you may decide the trade-off is worth it, or you may not. If you scored 2 or below on items 1, 8, and 9 (mission, interest in governance, and understanding of the peace process), the issue is motivation, not capability. No amount of preparation fixes a misaligned motivation.

Keep your self-assessment results. You will revisit them in Chapter 6 when you choose your career track, and in Chapter 8 when you prepare for interviews.

A Note About Item 5: Government Salaries

The salary question deserves honest discussion. A fresh graduate entering at **SG 11** earns approximately **PHP 27,000 per month** in base pay. With allowances (COLA, PERA) and bonuses (mid-year, year-end, cash gift), the annualized compensation is better than the base number suggests. But it is still lower than what many private sector employers offer for graduates with the same degree.

The trade-offs are real: **security of tenure** (you cannot be fired without due process), **retirement benefits through GSIS** (which accumulate over decades), **leave credits that monetize upon retirement**, and **the non-monetary value of public service**. Some people find these trade-offs worthwhile. Others do not. There is no shame in either answer.

What you should not do is accept a government job resenting the salary. Resentment erodes performance, and poor performance in a founding government has consequences that outlast your tenure. If salary is a dealbreaker, the private sector, NGOs, and international development organizations operating in BARMM offer alternative paths to contribute — often at higher pay.

A Note About Item 4: Comfort with Ambiguity

This item deserves emphasis because it separates people who thrive in BARMM from people who struggle. In a mature bureaucracy — the Department of Finance in Manila, for example — every process has a manual, every form has a template, every question has a precedent. In BARMM, you will regularly face situations where no manual exists, no template has been created, and no one has done what you are about to do before.

If that prospect excites you — if you see it as a chance to create something — you will do well. If it terrifies you — if you need step-by-step instructions to function — BARMM government work will be frustrating. Neither reaction is wrong. But knowing your reaction before you apply saves time.

What Comes Next

Now you know the gap, the staffing reality, and what makes this government different. You have a self-assessment score that tells you how well your motivations align with the demands of Bangsamoro public service. You have a table showing where staff are needed most urgently. You have a framework — the 12-Point Priority Agenda — that connects your interests to specific offices.

The next chapter tells you how this government came to exist — the Bangsamoro story from struggle to self-governance. That history is not decoration. It shapes every policy, every institution, and every interaction you will have as a government worker. Colleagues will reference the peace process in casual conversation. Community members will connect their expectations to promises made during negotiations. Decision-makers will frame policy choices in terms of the BOL's vision.

Understanding that history is not optional. It is the foundation on which everything else in this guidebook builds.

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1. Staffing statistics (50,467 authorized positions, 35,812 filled, 600,000+ applications) as reported in the 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 5 (data as of November 2022). These figures predate Sulu's exclusion from BARMM and may not reflect current staffing counts. ↩↩↩↩↩
2. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4. ↩
3. Education data from MBHTE reports as cited in the 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4. ↩

4. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 5. ↩
5. *Id.* ↩
6. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4, citing MOH data (2020). ↩
7. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 3, citing PSA data. ↩
8. BAA No. 17, Bangsamoro Civil Service Code (enacted Feb. 2021). ↩
9. BAA No. 13, Bangsamoro Administrative Code (enacted Oct. 2020). ↩
10. BAA No. 84, Bangsamoro Budget System Act (enacted 2025). ↩
11. BAA No. 18, Bangsamoro Education Code (enacted May 2021). ↩
12. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 1, art. IV. ↩
13. BAA No. 10, creating the Bangsamoro Youth Commission. ↩
14. BAA No. 35, Bangsamoro Electoral Code. ↩
15. BAA No. 49, Bangsamoro Local Governance Code. ↩
16. MAFAR/DAR data as cited in the 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 3. ↩
17. The annual block grant under Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 22, art. XII, which provides that the Bangsamoro government shall receive an annual block grant from the national government. ↩
18. BAA No. 13, *supra* note 9. ↩
19. BAA No. 17, *supra* note 8. ↩
20. Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro, signed Mar. 27, 2014. ↩

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The Bangsamoro Story: From Struggle to Self-Governance

You are joining a government that was born from a peace agreement. That history shapes everything — every institution, every policy, every relationship between the government and its people. You do not need to become a historian, but you do need to understand why the Bangsamoro government exists, what it replaced, and what it promises.

This chapter gives you that foundation. It covers the story in three acts: the centuries-long struggle for self-determination, the peace process that led to the Bangsamoro Organic Law, and the transition period you are entering.

2.1 The Bangsamoro Struggle — A Brief, Necessary History

Before the Colonizers

Long before Spain arrived in the Philippines, the Bangsamoro homeland was organized into **independent sultanates and political systems**. These were not tribal chieftaincies. They were structured governments with written laws, diplomatic relations, and trade networks that stretched across Southeast Asia.

The major political entities included:

- **Sultanate of Sulu** — established in 1457, the oldest Islamic institution in the Philippines. It maintained trade and diplomatic ties with Borneo, China, and the Malay world.
- **Sultanate of Maguindanao** — a powerful sultanate that controlled much of Mindanao and maintained its own legal and administrative systems.
- **Sultanate of Buayan** — a sister sultanate of Maguindanao.
- **Sultanate of Kabuntalan** — a confederation in the Cotabato region.
- **Royal House of Ranao** — the *Pat a Pangampong* (Four Lake Kingdoms) of Lanao, centered around Lake Lanao.
- **Iranun Confederation** — a maritime power known for naval strength.

These sultanates governed through **Islamic legal traditions (Shari'ah)**, maintained independent political systems, conducted trade with Southeast Asian neighbors, and preserved distinct cultural identities. This is the foundation of the Bangsamoro identity: a people who governed themselves, practiced their faith, and defended their homeland for centuries before the Philippine state existed.

Colonial Resistance: 300+ Years

Spain arrived in the Philippines in 1521 and spent over 300 years trying to conquer the Bangsamoro. They called the Muslim inhabitants "Moros" — from their experience fighting the "Moors" in the Iberian Peninsula. The term was meant as a slur. The Bangsamoro reclaimed it as a badge of resistance.

The key fact: The Bangsamoro were **never fully conquered by Spain**. Despite aggressive military campaigns and anti-Muslim policies, the sultanates maintained effective self-governance throughout the colonial period. This is not a minor footnote. It is the historical basis for the Bangsamoro claim to self-determination — they were independent before colonization and never surrendered that independence by force.

The American Period and Forced Integration

When Spain ceded the Philippines to the United States in 1898 through the Treaty of Paris, Mindanao was administered separately as the **"Moro Province."** The Americans recognized that the Bangsamoro were distinct from the rest of the Philippines.

But in 1935, the Bangsamoro homeland was integrated into the Philippine Commonwealth under the new Constitution — over what the Bangsamoro Organic Law itself describes as the **"vehement resistance of the Bangsamoro."**[1] This forced integration is the root of the modern conflict. The Bangsamoro did not consent to becoming part of the Philippine state on the terms that were imposed.

Post-Independence: The Modern Struggle

After Philippine independence in 1946, the Bangsamoro struggle for self-determination continued through three channels:

- **Political advocacy** — legal and democratic efforts to secure autonomy
- **Armed resistance movements** — the Moro National Liberation Front (MNLF, founded 1969) and later the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF, founded 1977)
- **Peace negotiations** — decades of talks between the Philippine government and Bangsamoro fronts

These three channels — politics, arms, and negotiation — ran in parallel for decades. The government you are joining is the product of the third channel: peace negotiations that succeeded.

What This History Means for You

You may think: "I am applying for a budget analyst position — why do I need to know about sultanates and colonial resistance?" Because the Bangsamoro identity is not academic. Your colleagues carry it. The communities you serve remember it. The government's foundational documents reference it.

When the BOL's preamble speaks of the "Bangsamoro people" as a people with a "distinct historical and cultural identity," it is drawing on these centuries. When the 12 Pillars of Moral Governance include "Sense of Patriotism" and "Cultural Understanding," they are not borrowing abstract values — they are codifying what the Bangsamoro have practiced for generations.

You do not need to become a scholar of Bangsamoro history. But you need to know enough to respect it, understand references to it, and avoid the common mistake of treating the Bangsamoro struggle as mere insurgency. It was, and remains, a movement for self-determination rooted in a pre-colonial political identity.

2.2 Why ARMM Failed

Before BARMM, there was ARMM — the **Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao**, created in 1989 through Republic Act 6734 (later amended by RA 9054). ARMM was later expanded through RA 9054 following the 1996 Final Peace Agreement between the Philippine government and the MNLF.

ARMM lasted 30 years (1989-2019). It failed.[2] Understanding why it failed helps you understand why BARMM was designed differently.

Limited autonomy. ARMM followed a **unitary system** — the regional governor and departments were essentially extensions of the national government. The region had minimal control over its own budget, legislation, or institutional design.

Weak fiscal powers. ARMM did not have genuine fiscal autonomy. Its budget depended almost entirely on national government allocations, with limited ability to generate its own revenue.

Governance problems. ARMM's 25 regional departments were often poorly staffed, poorly managed, and plagued by patronage. Accountability mechanisms were weak.

Institutional design. ARMM replicated the national government's presidential structure at the regional level. The regional governor held executive power. There was no parliament. Legislative functions were limited.

The Bangsamoro Organic Law was designed to fix every one of these failures. Where ARMM had a governor, BARMM has a **Chief Minister accountable to Parliament**. Where ARMM had departments, BARMM has **15 line ministries** with clear mandates under BAA 13.[3] Where ARMM had limited fiscal powers, BARMM has a **constitutionally guaranteed block grant** equal to 5% of net national internal revenue, plus the power to create its own revenue sources.[4]

Why This Matters for You

When you join BARMM, you will hear people say "we are not ARMM." This is not a throwaway line. It is a statement of institutional identity. The entire organizational design of BARMM — the parliamentary system, the civil service code, the ministry structure, the moral governance framework — was built to prevent the failures of ARMM from repeating.

Understanding ARMM's shortcomings helps you appreciate why certain BARMM systems work the way they do. The **merit and fitness principle** in BAA 17 exists because ARMM's hiring was notoriously patronage-driven.[5] The **SPMS performance management system** exists because ARMM had weak accountability mechanisms. The **parliamentary oversight function** exists because ARMM's executive branch operated with insufficient checks.

You are joining a government that was designed as a corrective. That design is intentional and well-documented. When you encounter a process that seems cumbersome — a multi-step approval chain, a qualification standard that seems demanding, a reporting requirement that takes time — ask yourself: "What problem was this designed to solve?" The answer is usually in ARMM's history.

2.3 The Peace Process: From Conflict to Agreement

The Framework Agreement on the Bangsamoro (2012)

In 2012, the Government of the Philippines (GPH) and the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF) signed the **Framework Agreement on the Bangsamoro (FAB)**.[6] This agreement established the framework for a new autonomous entity to replace ARMM. It was signed

under the Aquino III administration and represented a breakthrough after years of negotiations — and setbacks, including the failed Memorandum of Agreement on Ancestral Domain (MOA-AD) in 2008.

The Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (2014)

Two years later, the GPH and MILF signed the **Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB)** — the comprehensive peace agreement that became the blueprint for the BOL.[7] The CAB has four annexes, and each one shapes the government you are joining:

Annex on Transitional Arrangements and Modalities — This annex created the transition mechanism from ARMM to BARMM. It established the **Bangsamoro Transition Authority (BTA)** as the interim government. The BTA you may work under today exists because of this annex.

Annex on Revenue Generation and Wealth-Sharing — This annex established the block grant mechanism, natural resource sharing arrangements, and the Bangsamoro government's tax powers. When you work with the budget, you are implementing provisions from this annex.

Annex on Power-Sharing — This annex defines which powers belong to the national government (reserved), which belong exclusively to the Bangsamoro government, and which are shared (concurrent). Understanding this annex helps you know what BARMM can and cannot do.

Annex on Normalization — This annex covers the decommissioning of MILF forces, socioeconomic development programs for former combatants, and transitional justice and reconciliation. This is the annex that makes BARMM different from any other government job — you are implementing a peace agreement.

Why This History Matters for Your Work

You may wonder: why does a fresh graduate applying for a budget analyst position need to know about the CAB? Because the CAB is not ancient history. It is the **legal and political foundation** of the government you are joining.

When your office prepares its annual budget proposal, the block grant formula comes from the CAB's wealth-sharing annex. When your ministry coordinates with a national government agency, the power-sharing annex determines who has jurisdiction. When your MP files a bill, the bill's constitutional basis often traces back to the powers enumerated in the CAB and codified in the BOL.

Colleagues, supervisors, and community members will reference the peace process casually — "that's a CAB commitment," "this is part of normalization," "the BDP targets flow from the peace agreement." If you do not know what they mean, you will be lost. If you do, you will understand not just what you are doing, but why.

2.4 The Bangsamoro Organic Law (Republic Act 11054)

What the BOL Is

The **Bangsamoro Organic Law** is Republic Act 11054, signed by President Rodrigo Duterte on July 27, 2018, and ratified through a plebiscite in January-February 2019.[8] It replaced RA 6734 (as amended by RA 9054), which created the ARMM.[9]

The BOL is the foundational law of the Bangsamoro government. Everything — every ministry, every commission, every budget allocation, every BAA that the Parliament enacts — derives its authority from the BOL. Think of the BOL as the Bangsamoro's constitution within the Philippine Constitution.

What the BOL Established

The BOL created an **autonomous government with real powers** — not a symbolic autonomy, but a government with its own parliament, its own civil service, its own budget, and its own legal system. Here are the key provisions, organized by article:

Article	Subject	What You Need to Know
I	Name and Purpose	Establishes the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
II	Bangsamoro Identity	Defines who the Bangsamoro are — a people with a distinct identity
III	Territory	Defines the geographic scope (5 provinces + Cotabato City + SGA)[10]
IV	General Principles	Guiding principles of governance
V	Powers of Government	

Article	Subject	What You Need to Know
		55 enumerated areas of competence (Section 2)[11]
VI	Intergovernmental Relations	How BARMM coordinates with the national government
VII	Bangsamoro Government	The Parliament, Chief Minister, and Cabinet
VIII	Wali	Ceremonial head — moral and cultural authority
IX	Basic Rights	Rights of all people in BARMM
X	Justice System	Shari'ah courts and the justice system
XI	National Defense and Security	Defense, public order and safety, coast guard services
XII	Fiscal Autonomy	Block grant (Sec. 15-16), revenue powers, 75% tax share (Sec. 10)
XIII	Regional Economy and Patrimony	Social justice, economic system, natural resources, cooperatives
XIV	Rehabilitation and Development	Special Development Fund (Sec. 2): PHP 5B/year for 10 years
XV	Plebiscite	Ratification process for the Organic Law
XVI	BTA / Transition	The BTA and the transition period
XVII	Amendments	Process for amending the Organic Law
XVIII	Final Provisions	Separability, repealing clause, effectivity

The 2019 Plebiscite: The People Chose This

The BOL did not take effect automatically. It was submitted to the people through a **plebiscite** held in two stages: January 21 and February 6, 2019. The residents of the affected areas voted on whether to be part of the new Bangsamoro region.

The results:

- The former ARMM provinces voted overwhelmingly in favor
- **Cotabato City** voted to join BARMM
- **63 barangays** in North Cotabato (from Carmen, Kabacan, Midsayap, Pigkawayan, and Pikit) voted to join — these became the **Special Geographic Area (SGA)**[12]
- **Isabela City** (Basilan) voted **not** to join — it remains outside BARMM
- **Sulu** voted against the BOL in the plebiscite — rejecting it by 54.3% — and the Supreme Court later confirmed that Sulu could not be part of BARMM because the province voted against it[13]

This plebiscite matters because it gives the Bangsamoro government **democratic legitimacy**. The people chose this government. When you serve in BARMM, you serve a government that the people voted for.

Territory: Five Provinces and More

The Bangsamoro territory today consists of:

- **Lanao del Sur** — capital: Marawi City. Home to Lake Lanao, the Royal House of Ranao heritage, and the ongoing Marawi rehabilitation.
- **Maguindanao del Norte** — split from the former Maguindanao province via RA 11550, ratified in 2022.[14]
- **Maguindanao del Sur** — the other half of the former Maguindanao. Home to the Bangsamoro Government Center.
- **Basilan** — an island province south of Zamboanga. Capital: Lamitan City. Isabela City is not part of BARMM.
- **Tawi-Tawi** — the southernmost province of the Philippines. Capital: Bongao. Known as the seaweed capital.
- **Cotabato City** — the commercial hub and current administrative center. Joined BARMM by plebiscite. (Note: BAA 37 designates Parang, Maguindanao del Norte as the permanent seat of government.)
- **Special Geographic Area (SGA)** — 63 barangays in North Cotabato that voted to join. These have been organized into **8 new municipalities** (Pahamuddin,

Kadayangan, Nabalawag, Tugunan, Malidegao, Ligawasan, Kapalawan, and Old Kaabakan) through BAAs 41-48.[15]

Sulu is not part of BARMM. In the case of *Province of Sulu v. Medialdea* (G.R. Nos. 242255, 243246, 243693), the Supreme Court ruled on September 9, 2024 (finalized November 26, 2024) that Sulu could not be part of BARMM because the province voted against the BOL — rejecting it by 54.3%.[16] This violated Article X, Section 18 of the Constitution, which provides that only areas voting favorably in the plebiscite can join an autonomous region.[17] Executive Order 91 (July 30, 2025) realigned Sulu under Region IX.[18]

The SC ruling applied the **doctrine of operative fact** — meaning that actions taken during the period when Sulu was considered part of BARMM (including BTA appointments of members from Sulu) remain valid. The ruling did not invalidate those prior acts.

2.5 Key BOL Provisions Every Government Worker Should Know

You do not need to memorize the entire BOL. But you need to know these provisions well enough to recognize them when they come up in your work.

Article V, Section 2 — The 55 Enumerated Powers

This is the most operationally significant section of the BOL. Section 2 of Article V lists **55 areas of competence** — from (a) administration of justice to (ccc) water supply. These are the subjects over which the Bangsamoro government has authority. They include:

- Administrative organization
- Creation of sources of revenue
- Ancestral domain and natural resources management
- Social services
- Education
- Environmental protection
- Labor and employment
- Disaster risk reduction
- Culture and language preservation
- Cooperatives

- Public works
- Tourism

When you draft a policy, prepare a budget proposal, or write a legislative briefer, your first question should always be: **"Does BARMM have competence over this subject?"** The answer is in Article V, Section 2.

> "The Bangsamoro Government shall exercise its authority over the following matters... (n) Creation of sources of revenues." — Republic Act 11054, Article V, Section 2(n)

Article XII — Fiscal Autonomy

This article gives BARMM genuine financial independence:

- **Annual Block Grant** (Art. XII, Sec. 15-16) — equal to 5% of the net national internal revenue of the BIR and Bureau of Customs[19]
- **Special Development Fund** (Art. XIV, Sec. 2) — PHP 5 billion per year for 10 years (PHP 50 billion total)[20]
- **Revenue generation** — power to create own revenue sources (taxes, fees, charges)
- **75% tax share** (Art. XII, Sec. 10) — of national taxes collected within BARMM[21]

When you see budget discussions, block grant allocations, or fiscal reports, these provisions are the legal basis.

Article VII — The Bangsamoro Government

This article establishes the parliamentary system:

- **Bangsamoro Parliament** — the legislative body, with **80 Members of Parliament** under the BOL (Art. VII, Sec. 6)[22]
- **Chief Minister** — head of government, elected by Parliament from among its members
- **Cabinet** — ministers appointed by the Chief Minister with Parliament consent
- **Wali** — the ceremonial head, representing the moral and cultural authority of the Bangsamoro people

Currently, 77 MPs are sworn in (as of March 2025).[23] The Parliament is led by the Speaker, supported by the Secretary General and the Secretariat.

Article X — The Shari'ah Justice System

BARMM has its own justice system for matters governed by Islamic law:

- **Shari'ah courts** with jurisdiction over personal law (marriage, divorce, inheritance, custody), property relations among Muslims, and cases involving Muslims within BARMM
- **District and Circuit Shari'ah Courts**
- **Shari'ah High Court** as the highest Shari'ah court in BARMM

This is unique to BARMM. No other region in the Philippines has its own Shari'ah court system. If your work touches family law, personal status, inheritance, or community disputes among Muslims, you will encounter this system.

Article IX — Basic Rights

This article guarantees rights for all people in BARMM — not just Muslims, not just Bangsamoro, but everyone. Key provisions include:

- Right to life, liberty, and property
- Freedom of religion, expression, and assembly
- Right to education (Section 16) — integrated system of quality education
- Right to culture and identity (Section 24) — preserve and promote Bangsamoro culture
- Women's rights and protection from violence
- Indigenous peoples' rights
- Right to adequate social services

Section 24 — the cultural preservation mandate — is especially significant. It is the legal basis for many programs you may work on, from cultural heritage preservation to mother tongue-based education.

Article VI — Intergovernmental Relations

Because BARMM is autonomous but still part of the Philippines, it must coordinate with the national government. Article VI establishes mechanisms for this coordination — including the Intergovernmental Relations Body (IGRB), which resolves issues between the Bangsamoro and national governments.

Why this matters for you: If you work in any ministry, you will encounter situations where BARMM's authority overlaps with a national agency. MAFAR coordinates with the Department of Agriculture. MOH coordinates with the Department of Health. MBHTE coordinates with the Department of Education. Article VI defines the rules for these interactions. The power-sharing arrangement specifies which powers are **exclusive** to the Bangsamoro, which are **reserved** to the national government, and which are **concurrent** (shared).

When you are unsure whether your office has jurisdiction over a matter, Article V (enumerated powers) and Article VI (intergovernmental relations) are where you look first.

2.6 The Transition Period — Where You Are Entering

What "Transition" Means

The BTA — Bangsamoro Transition Authority — is the **interim government**. It holds both legislative and executive powers. Its members are appointed by the President, not elected. The BTA was originally supposed to serve until 2022, but the transition has been extended:

- **RA 11593** (2021) — extended the BTA mandate, resetting elections to 2025[24]
- **RA 12064** (2024) — further extended the transition to 2028[25]

The current BTA (appointed by President Marcos under RA 12064) has been in place since March 2025. Regular elections for the Bangsamoro Parliament are scheduled for 2028.

Three BTA Compositions

The BTA has been reconstituted three times:

1. **First BTA** (February 2019 - September 2022) — appointed by President Duterte
2. **Second BTA** (September 2022 - February 2025) — reconstituted by President Marcos under RA 11593
3. **Current BTA** (March 2025 - present) — appointed by President Marcos under RA 12064

Each reconstitution brought new members but maintained institutional continuity. Bills filed during one BTA composition were not archived — they continued to be deliberated by the succeeding composition without refiling.[26]

Why Transition Creates Opportunity

The transition period is both urgent and opportunity-rich for new staff:

Urgency. The government must build institutions, enact priority codes, deliver services, and prepare for elections — all within a defined timeline. There is more work than there are people to do it.

Opportunity. Because the government is still forming, entry-level staff can have outsized impact. You are not joining a 100-year-old bureaucracy with rigid hierarchies and filled positions. You are joining a government that is still deciding how to organize itself.

Priority codes. The BTA is tasked with enacting seven priority codes during the transition. As of 2026, five have been enacted:

Code	BAA	Status
Bangsamoro Administrative Code	BAA 13 (October 2020)	Enacted
Bangsamoro Civil Service Code	BAA 17 (February 2021)	Enacted
Bangsamoro Education Code	BAA 18 (May 2021)[27]	Enacted
Bangsamoro Electoral Code	BAA 35 (2023)[28]	Enacted
Bangsamoro Revenue Code	—	Pending
Bangsamoro Investment Code	—	Pending
Bangsamoro Local Governance Code	BAA 49[29]	Enacted

Each code creates new institutions, new positions, and new functions — which means new staff are needed to implement them.

The Shift from Appointed to Elected

The most significant event ahead is the **transition from an appointed BTA to an elected Bangsamoro Parliament**. When elections happen, the government will change from a transitional body to a permanent one. Coterminous staff (those whose appointments are tied to the appointing authority) may be affected. Permanent staff (those with plantilla positions and security of tenure) will continue.

This is why Chapter 4 covers appointment types in detail. Understanding whether your position is permanent, coterminous, or contractual determines how the transition affects you.

2.7 Actionable Tool: BOL Quick Reference Card

Keep this reference card accessible. These are the 10 BOL provisions you will encounter most frequently in your work.

#	Provision	Article/Section	What It Means for Your Work
1	**Enumerated Powers**	Art. V, Sec. 2	Check this list to confirm BARMM has authority over your subject area
2	**Annual Block Grant**	Art. XII, Sec. 15-16	The primary funding source — 5% of net national internal revenue
3	**Special Development Fund**	Art. XIV, Sec. 2	PHP 5B/year for 10 years — funds development projects
4	**Parliament composition**	Art. VII, Sec. 6	80 MPs — the body that enacts BAAs and approves budgets
5	**Chief Minister**	Art. VII, Sec. 7	Head of government — elected by Parliament from among its members
6	**Cultural preservation**	Art. IX, Sec. 24	Legal mandate for all cultural heritage programs
7	**Right to education**	Art. IX, Sec. 16	Integrated system of quality education

#	Provision	Article/Section	What It Means for Your Work
			— basis for MBHTE programs
8	**Shari'ah courts**	Art. X	Jurisdiction over personal law among Muslims
9	**Territory definition**	Art. III, Sec. 2	5 provinces + Cotabato City + SGA (Sulu excluded per SC ruling)
10	**Transition**	Art. XVI	BTA as interim government, extended to 2028 via RA 12064

How to use this card: When someone references a BOL provision — in a meeting, a memo, or a policy discussion — find it on this card first. If you need the full text, read the relevant article in RA 11054. The full BOL is publicly available through the BARMM Official Gazette and Congress's official website.

Common BOL Misconceptions

As a newcomer, you may encounter these misunderstandings. Knowing the correct answers helps you avoid repeating them:

"BARMM is a separate country." No. BARMM is an autonomous region within the Republic of the Philippines. The BOL explicitly states that "The Bangsamoro Autonomous Region is an integral, indivisible, and inseparable part of the territory of the Republic of the Philippines."[30]

"BARMM can do anything — it has full autonomy." Not quite. BARMM has 55 enumerated powers (Art. V, Sec. 2), but powers not granted to BARMM remain with the national government (Art. V, Sec. 1 — the residual clause).[31] Defense, foreign affairs, coinage, and customs are examples of powers that remain national.

"Sulu is part of BARMM." No longer. The Supreme Court ruled in *Province of Sulu v. Medialdea* (finalized November 2024) that Sulu is excluded because the province voted against the BOL.[32] Sulu was realigned under Region IX via EO 91 (July 2025).

"The BTA is the permanent government." No. The BTA is a transitional body. Its members are appointed by the President. The permanent Bangsamoro government will be established through elections, currently scheduled for 2028.

"Only Muslims can work in BARMM." Absolutely not. The BOL guarantees rights for all people in BARMM regardless of religion (Art. IX). The government employs people of all faiths. The moral governance framework is inspired by Islamic principles but applies to all staff — and respecting it does not require converting to Islam.

What Comes Next

You now know the story — the struggle, the peace process, the BOL, and the transition. The next chapter shows you how the government is actually organized: who reports to whom, what each ministry does, and how to find your place in the structure. That chapter is built on **BAA 13, the Bangsamoro Administrative Code** — the law that turns the BOL's vision into an organizational blueprint.

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1. Rep. Act No. 11054, preamble. ↩
2. Rep. Act No. 6734, sec. 1; Rep. Act No. 9054, sec. 1. *See also* 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 1 (documenting ARMM's institutional failures). ↩
3. BAA No. 13, tit. V (establishing the 15 line ministries of the Bangsamoro Government). ↩
4. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. XII, secs. 15-16 (block grant); *id.* art. XII, sec. 10 (75% tax share). ↩
5. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code), tit. II (merit and fitness principle). ↩
6. Framework Agreement on the Bangsamoro (FAB), signed Oct. 15, 2012, Malacanan Palace, Manila. ↩
7. Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB), signed Mar. 27, 2014, Malacanan Palace, Manila. ↩
8. Rep. Act No. 11054 (signed July 27, 2018; ratified Jan. 21 and Feb. 6, 2019 plebiscite). ↩
9. Rep. Act No. 6734 (creating the ARMM); Rep. Act No. 9054 (expanding the ARMM following the 1996 Final Peace Agreement). ↩
10. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. III, sec. 2. ↩
11. *Id.* art. V, sec. 2. ↩
12. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. III, sec. 2(c), (f); 2019 plebiscite results (COMELEC). ↩
13. *Province of Sulu v. Medialdea*, G.R. Nos. 242255, 243246, 243693 (Sept. 9, 2024). ↩

14. Rep. Act No. 11550 (dividing the Province of Maguindanao into Maguindanao del Norte and Maguindanao del Sur; ratified Sept. 17, 2022 plebiscite). ↩
15. BAA Nos. 41-48 (creating the municipalities of Pahamuddin, Kadayangan, Nabalawag, Old Kaabakan, Kapalawan, Malidegao, Tugunan, and Ligawasan in the SGA). ↩
16. *Province of Sulu v. Medialdea*, G.R. Nos. 242255, 243246, 243693 (Sept. 9, 2024; finalized Nov. 26, 2024). ↩
17. Const. art. X, sec. 18. ↩
18. Exec. Order No. 91 (July 30, 2025) (realigning Sulu under Region IX). ↩
19. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. XII, secs. 15-16. ↩
20. *Id.* art. XIV, sec. 2. ↩
21. *Id.* art. XII, sec. 10. ↩
22. *Id.* art. VII, sec. 6. ↩
23. BARMM Official Gazette, "77 BTA Members Sworn In" (Mar. 15, 2025). ↩
24. Rep. Act No. 11593 (2021) (extending the BTA transition period and resetting elections to 2025). ↩
25. Rep. Act No. 12064 (2024) (further extending the BTA transition period to 2028). ↩
26. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. XVI (transition provisions); BTA Parliament practice on legislative continuity. ↩
27. BAA No. 18 (Bangsamoro Education Code, enacted May 2021). ↩
28. BAA No. 35 (Bangsamoro Electoral Code, enacted 2023). ↩
29. BAA No. 49 (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code). ↩
30. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. IV, sec. 1. ↩
31. *Id.* art. V, secs. 1-2. ↩
32. *Province of Sulu v. Medialdea*, *supra* note 16. ↩

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How the Government Is Organized

BAA 13 is the blueprint. Learn it the way an architect learns a floor plan — not to memorize every room, but to know where everything is, how the spaces connect, and where you fit.

Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 13 — the Bangsamoro Administrative Code — defines the structure, powers, and functions of every ministry, office, and agency in the Bangsamoro government.[1] Before you apply for any position, you need to know what the government looks like from the inside. This chapter gives you that map.

3.1 The Three Branches at a Glance

The Bangsamoro government operates under a **parliamentary system** — the only one in the Philippines.[2] Unlike the national government's separation of executive and legislative branches, the Bangsamoro system integrates them. Here is the high-level structure:

Branch	Head	Function
Parliament (BTA)	Speaker	Enacts laws (BAAs), approves budgets, conducts oversight
Executive (Cabinet)	Chief Minister	Implements laws, manages ministries, delivers services
Wali	Wali	Ceremonial head, represents moral and cultural authority

The **Chief Minister** is both head of government and a Member of Parliament. The **Cabinet ministers** are appointed by the Chief Minister with Parliament's consent.[3] This means the executive is drawn from and accountable to the legislature — a fundamental difference from the presidential system used nationally and in LGUs.

What does this mean for you? If you join the Parliament, your work supports lawmaking and oversight. If you join a ministry, your work implements the laws that Parliament enacts. The two tracks are distinct but tightly connected. A legislative briefer you draft in Parliament may shape a program that a ministry implements. A field report you write in a ministry may prompt a parliamentary inquiry.

3.2 The Parliament

Composition

The BOL (Article VII, Section 6) provides for **80 Members of Parliament**.[4] During the transition, MPs are appointed by the President.[5] Currently, **77 MPs are sworn in** (as of March 2025).[6]

The Parliament is led by: - **The Speaker** — presiding officer who directs parliamentary proceedings - **The Deputy Speaker(s)** — assist the Speaker - **The Secretary General** — the chief administrative officer of the Parliament, who heads the Secretariat[7]

Committees

Parliament work is organized through **committees**. Each committee has jurisdiction over specific subject areas — education, health, agriculture, finance, local government, and so on. Committees are where most legislative work happens: hearings, bill deliberations, report preparation.

There are two types: - **Statutory (Standing) Committees** — permanent committees organized by subject area (e.g., Committee on Agriculture, Committee on Education, Committee on Finance) - **Parliamentary (Procedural) Committees** — handle internal parliament operations (e.g., Rules, Accounts, Ethics)

The Secretariat

The **Parliament Secretariat** is the administrative and support structure that enables MPs to do their work. It is headed by the Secretary General and staffed by professional civil servants. The Secretariat includes several key offices:

If you want to work in Parliament, these are the offices you would join:

- **Legislative Services** — supports the legislative process, including bill drafting, committee support, and legislative research

- **Parliamentary Operations** — manages plenary sessions, committee hearings, scheduling, and records
- **Administrative Services** — handles human resources, finance, procurement, and general administration for the Parliament

Parliamentary Staff Roles

Three staff roles appear throughout Parliament work. Understanding them helps you decide which one matches your skills:

Legislative Staff Officer (LSO) — The analytical backbone. LSOs research issues, draft bills, prepare legislative briefers, write committee reports, and provide policy analysis. If you enjoy reading, writing, and research, this is your role. Entry level: SG 11.

Political Affairs Officer (PAO) — The constituency link. PAOs handle constituent concerns, coordinate with LGUs and communities, and manage the MP's field activities. If you enjoy community engagement and stakeholder relations, this is your role.

Public Information and Media Affairs Officer (PIMAO) — The communications specialist. PIMAOs manage the MP's public communications, social media, press releases, and media relations. If you have skills in communications, journalism, or digital media, this is your role.

Each MP typically has a small team that includes one or more of each role. The committee itself may also have dedicated LSOs assigned by the Secretariat.

3.3 The Chief Minister and Cabinet

The Chief Minister

The **Chief Minister** is the head of government. Under the BOL (Article VII, Section 31), the Chief Minister is elected by the Parliament from among its members by a majority vote.[8] The Chief Minister exercises executive power, appoints Cabinet ministers, and directs the overall operations of the Bangsamoro government.[9]

The Office of the Chief Minister (OCM)

The OCM is the executive staff and administrative office of the Chief Minister. It is separate from the line ministries. The OCM houses:

Executive Offices: - Office of the Senior Minister - Office of the Chief of Staff - Cabinet Secretariat - Bangsamoro Attorney General's Office (BAGO)

Bangsamoro Management Support System (BMSS): - Technical Management Service (TMS) - Administrative Management Service (AMS) - Finance Management Service (FMS) - Intelligence and Security Service (ISS) - Procurement Service (PS) - Clinic - Bangsamoro Satellite Coordinating Offices - Bangsamoro Liaison Office in Metro Manila - Bangsamoro Library and Archives

Three Councils under the OCM: 1. Bangsamoro Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council (DRRMC) 2. Bangsamoro Economic and Development Council (BEDC) 3. Bangsamoro Regional Peace and Order Council (BRPOC)

If you want to work in strategic coordination, policy advice, or executive operations, the OCM offices are where that work happens. Positions here tend to be closer to decision-making but also more politically sensitive.

3.4 The 15 Line Ministries

Line ministries are where most government employees work. Each ministry has a specific mandate defined in BAA 13,[10] and many have enabling BAAs that flesh out their powers and functions. Here is the complete list:

1. Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries, and Agrarian Reform (MAFAR)

Mandate: Agricultural development, fisheries management, and agrarian reform across BARMM.

Why it matters: BARMM has the largest agricultural land area in the Philippines. It is the top producer of seaweed (48.42% national share) and cassava (41.70%). There are 110,513 hectares of undistributed agricultural land under CARP (per MAFAR/DAR data as cited in BDP 2023-2028).[11] MAFAR needs agricultural technicians, agrarian reform officers, fisheries specialists, and program managers.

2. Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education (MBHTE)

Mandate: Comprehensive education system — from basic education through higher education and technical-vocational training.

Enabling BAA: BAA 18 (Bangsamoro Education Code)[12]

Why it matters: BARMM has the lowest literacy rates, highest dropout rates, and lowest completion rates in the Philippines.[13] MBHTE needs teachers, curriculum developers, education planners, and administrative staff at every level.

3. Ministry of Environment, Natural Resources, and Energy (MENRE)

Mandate: Environmental protection, natural resource management, and energy development.

Why it matters: BARMM's territory includes Lake Lanao (the second largest lake in the Philippines), the Mindanao River Basin, the Sulu-Celebes Sea marine ecosystem, and multiple watersheds. Environmental management directly affects communities dependent on fishing, farming, and water resources.

4. Ministry of Finance, and Budget and Management (MFBM)

Mandate: Fiscal management — revenue collection, budget preparation, expenditure management, and financial accountability.

Enabling BAA: BAA 84 (Bangsamoro Budget System Act)[14]

Why it matters: MFBM manages the annual block grant (5% of net national internal revenue — exceeding PHP 80 billion).[15] It needs budget analysts, accountants, procurement officers, and financial management specialists. Every peso the government spends passes through MFBM's systems.

5. Ministry of Health (MOH)

Mandate: Health service delivery across the region.

Why it matters: Maternal mortality above the national average. Highest stunting, wasting, and underweight rates in the Philippines.[16] Insufficient health professionals at all levels — from provincial hospitals to barangay health stations. MOH needs nurses, midwives, doctors, nutritionists, and health program officers.

6. Ministry of Human Settlements and Development (MHSD)

Mandate: Housing, shelter programs, and human settlements planning.

Why it matters: Displacement from conflict (especially the 2017 Marawi siege), natural disasters, and the ongoing need for social housing in urban and rural areas. MHSD works on resettlement, housing programs, and community development.

7. Ministry of Indigenous Peoples' Affairs (MIPA)

Mandate: Protection and promotion of the rights, culture, and welfare of indigenous peoples within BARMM.

Enabling BAA: BAA 64[17]

Why it matters: BARMM is home to indigenous peoples including the Teduray, Lambangian, and Dulangan Manobo, among others.[18] MIPA ensures that development programs respect indigenous rights, ancestral domains, and cultural traditions.

8. Ministry of the Interior and Local Government (MILG)

Mandate: Coordination with and supervision of local government units (LGUs) — provinces, cities, municipalities, and barangays.

Enabling BAA: BAA 49 (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code)[19]

Why it matters: MILG oversees 116 municipalities and 2,590 barangays (BDP 2023-2028 figures; exclude adjustments from Sulu's exclusion from BARMM per SC ruling).[20] It assesses LGU functionality, coordinates disaster response through BRDRRMO (an attached agency), and supports local governance capacity building. If you want to work at the intersection of regional and local government, MILG is where that happens.

9. Ministry of Labor and Employment (MOLE)

Mandate: Employment promotion, labor standards, and workers' welfare.

Enabling BAA: BAA 82 (Bangsamoro Labor Code)[21]

Why it matters: With underemployment at 9% and a growing working-age population, MOLE manages employment programs, labor dispute resolution, and overseas worker protection (coordinated with BAA 19 on overseas Bangsamoro workers).[22]

10. Ministry of Public Order and Safety (MPOS)

Mandate: Public order, law enforcement coordination, and community safety.

Why it matters: BARMM's peace and security situation directly affects development. MPOS coordinates with national law enforcement agencies (PNP, NAPOLCOM) and supports the normalization process under the CAB.

11. Ministry of Public Works (MPW)

Mandate: Infrastructure development — roads, bridges, buildings, water systems, and public facilities.

Why it matters: Infrastructure backlog across all five provinces and Cotabato City. Island provinces (Basilan, Tawi-Tawi) face connectivity challenges. MPW needs engineers, project managers, construction inspectors, and infrastructure planners.

12. Ministry of Science and Technology (MOST)

Mandate: Science, technology, and innovation for regional development.

Why it matters: Technology adoption, research and development, and digital infrastructure are growing priorities. MOST supports innovation in agriculture, health, education, and governance.

13. Ministry of Social Services and Development (MSSD)

Mandate: Social welfare programs, social protection, and community development.

Why it matters: MSSD runs livelihood programs, humanitarian assistance, and social protection services for the most vulnerable communities. It coordinates with DSWD on national social protection programs being devolved to BARMM.

14. Ministry of Trade, Investments, and Tourism (MTIT)

Mandate: Trade promotion, investment facilitation, and tourism development.

Attached agencies: Bangsamoro Economic Zone Authority (BEZA), Bangsamoro Halal Board

Why it matters: BARMM's economic potential — in agriculture, halal industry, marine resources, and cultural tourism — remains largely untapped. MTIT and its attached agencies drive economic development strategy.

15. Ministry of Transportation and Communications (MOTC)

Mandate: Transportation networks and communications infrastructure.

Why it matters: Connectivity between mainland and island provinces is a persistent challenge. Flight routes, seaport development, road networks, and digital connectivity all fall under MOTC.

3.5 Attached Agencies and Offices Under the OCM

Beyond the 15 line ministries, **10 agencies** are attached to the Office of the Chief Minister.[23] These agencies have specialized mandates:

Agency	Acronym	Focus
Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority	BPDA	Development planning, M&E, BDP coordination
Bangsamoro Board of Investments	BBOI	Investment promotion and facilitation
Bangsamoro Information Office	BIO	Government communications and public information
Bangsamoro ICT Office	BICTO	Information and communications technology
Office for Settler Communities	OSC	Welfare of settler communities in BARMM
Office for Other Bangsamoro Communities	OOBC	Bangsamoro communities outside BARMM territory
Bangsamoro Pilgrimage Authority	BPA	Hajj and Umrah coordination
Development Academy of the Bangsamoro	DAB	Capacity building and training
Bangsamoro Darul-Ifta'	BDI	Islamic jurisprudence and religious guidance
Cooperatives and Social Enterprise Authority	CSEA	Cooperative development and social enterprises

BPDA deserves special mention. It coordinates the entire Bangsamoro Development Plan — the government's roadmap. If you are interested in strategic planning, data analysis, monitoring and evaluation, or development research, BPDA is where that work concentrates.

3.6 Commissions and Independent Bodies

Bangsamoro Commissions (Attached to OCM)

Four commissions address specific sectors. Each was created by a specific BAA:[24]

Commission	Acronym	Enabling BAA	Focus
Bangsamoro Women Commission	BWC	BAA 8[25]	Gender equality, women's empowerment
Bangsamoro Youth Commission	BYC	BAA 10[26]	Youth development, participation
Bangsamoro Sports Commission	BSC	BAA 12[27]	Sports development
Bangsamoro Commission for the Preservation of Cultural Heritage	BCPCH	BAA 13, Title XVI[28]	Cultural heritage preservation

Independent Bodies

Two bodies operate independently from the executive:

Body	Acronym	Enabling BAA	Function
Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission	BHRC	BAA 4[29]	Human rights monitoring and protection
Bangsamoro Internal Auditing Body	BIAB	BAA 13, Title XVII[30]	Internal audit and accountability

If you are passionate about human rights, gender, youth, sports, or cultural heritage, these commissions and bodies offer focused career paths. They are smaller than ministries, which means fewer positions but also more direct involvement in your area of interest.

3.7 Local Government Units

BARMM's territory is organized into local government units at four levels:

Level	Count	Key Officials
Provinces	5 (Lanao del Sur, Maguindanao del Norte, Maguindanao del Sur, Basilan, Tawi-Tawi)	Governor, Vice-Governor, Provincial Board Members
Cities	Cotabato City + Lamitan City + Marawi City	Mayor, Vice-Mayor, City Council Members
Municipalities	116 (including 8 SGA municipalities)[31]	Mayor, Vice-Mayor, Municipal Council Members
Barangays	2,590[31]	Barangay Captain, Barangay Council

The **8 SGA municipalities** (Pahamuddin, Kadayangan, Nabalawag, Tugunan, Malidegao, Ligawasan, Kapalawan, and Old Kaabakan) were created by BAAs 41-48.[32] These are the newest municipalities in BARMM — the 63 barangays in North Cotabato that voted to join during the 2019 plebiscite.

LGU governance in BARMM operates under **BAA 49 (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code)**,[33] which defines the structure, powers, and responsibilities of local governments within the autonomous region. BAA 49 differs from the national Local Government Code (RA 7160) in ways specific to the Bangsamoro context — including recognition of indigenous governance structures and the integration of moral governance principles.[34]

LGU Functionality Assessment

MILG assesses all LGUs based on **seven elements of functionality**:

1. Presence of government center with facilities
2. Working elected and appointed mandatory officials
3. Functional local special bodies
4. Functional local legislative body
5. Approved mandated plans and budget
6. Availability of basic services
7. Sound fiscal management

As of 2021, **59% of 70 assessed LGUs** were compliant — up from 50% in 2020.[35] Island provinces register lower compliance due to geographic challenges. If you join an LGU, you will likely work on improving one or more of these elements.

3.8 How to Read BAA 13

BAA 13 is a long law. You do not need to read it cover to cover. But you do need to know how to navigate it. Here is the structure:

Book I — General provisions, principles, and the Bangsamoro government structure **Book II** — The Parliament (composition, powers, procedures) **Book III** — The Chief Minister and the Executive (OCM, Cabinet, executive functions) **Book IV** — Line Ministries (mandate, powers, organizational structure for each of the 15 ministries) **Book V** — Other offices, agencies, and commissions

For your purposes, the most useful sections are in **Book IV** — where you will find the mandate section, the powers section, and the organizational structure section for the specific ministry or office you want to join. Each ministry's entry in BAA 13 tells you:

- **Mandate** — what the ministry exists to do
- **Powers and functions** — what it is authorized to do
- **Organizational structure** — how it is internally organized (bureaus, services, divisions)

When you research a target office before applying, BAA 13 is your primary source. When an interviewer asks, "What do you know about this ministry?" your answer should draw from what BAA 13 says about its mandate and powers.

3.9 The Full Organizational Map

Here is the complete organizational structure at a glance:

Category	Count	Examples
Parliament (BTA)	1 body, 77 MPs	Speaker, Deputy Speaker, Secretary General, Secretariat
Office of the Chief Minister	1 executive office	Senior Minister, Chief of Staff, Cabinet Secretariat, BAGO
BMSS (Management Support)	9 support units	TMS, AMS, FMS, ISS, Procurement, Clinic, Liaison Office

Category	Count	Examples
OCM Councils	3	DRRMC, BEDC, BRPOC
OCM Attached Agencies	10	BPDA, BBOI, BIO, BICTO, OSC, OOBC, BPA, DAB, BDI, CSEA
Line Ministries	15	MAFAR, MBHTE, MENRE, MFBM, MOH, MHSD, MIPA, MILG, MOLE, MPOS, MPW, MOST, MSSD, MTIT, MOTC
Ministry-Attached Agencies	3	BEZA, Bangsamoro Halal Board (under MTIT), BRDRRMO (under MILG)
Commissions	4	BWC, BYC, BSC, BCPCH
Independent Bodies	2	BHRC, BIAB
Wali	1 office	Ceremonial head
LGUs	5 provinces, 3 cities, 116 municipalities, 2,590 barangays[31]	Elected local officials

Total executive units (OCM + 15 ministries): 16.[39]

3.10 Intergovernmental Relations: BARMM and the National Government

Because BARMM is autonomous but still part of the Philippines, coordination with the national government is constant. The BOL (Article VI) establishes several mechanisms:[36]

Mechanism	Purpose	Status
IGRB (Intergovernmental Relations Body)	Resolve intergovernmental issues	Operational
PCBPF (Philippine Congress-Bangsamoro Parliament Forum)	Legislative coordination	Convened November 2022

Mechanism	Purpose	Status
BSDB (Bangsamoro Sustainable Development Board)	Sustainable development coordination	Established via BAA 31[37]
Joint Normalization Committee	Peace agreement implementation	Operational

If you work in any ministry that coordinates with a national counterpart (MAFAR with DA, MOH with DOH, MBHTE with DepEd, MFBM with DBM), you will encounter these inter-governmental mechanisms. Understanding that BARMM has **exclusive powers, shared powers, and residual powers** (those not granted to BARMM remain with the national government) helps you navigate jurisdictional questions.[38]

3.11 Actionable Tool: "Know Your Target Office" Worksheet

Before you apply to any office, fill out this worksheet. It takes 30 minutes of research and demonstrates preparation in interviews. Use BAA 13 and the ministry's website or Facebook page as your sources.

Question	Your Research
Office name and acronym:	___
Created/established by:	BAA 13 and/or specific BAA (e.g., BAA 18 for MBHTE)
Mandate (from BAA 13):	One sentence — what does this office exist to do?
Key powers (from BAA 13):	List 3-5 specific powers or functions
Current leadership:	Minister/Director/Head name and title
Number of staff (if available):	From the office's website or annual report
Key programs or outputs:	What does this office produce or deliver? List 3-5
BDP alignment:	Which of the 6 BDP goals does this office serve?

Question	Your Research
12-Point Priority Agenda alignment:	Which priority does this office support?
Position I am targeting:	Specific position title and salary grade
Why I want to join this office:	2-3 sentences connecting your skills/ motivation to the office's mandate

How to use this worksheet: Bring it to your interview preparation (Chapter 9). When an interviewer asks, "Why this office?" your answer comes from the last row. When they ask, "What do you know about our mandate?" your answer comes from the third row. This worksheet is your cheat sheet — except it is not cheating, because the information is public and the effort to find it proves your seriousness.

What Comes Next

You now know the structure — Parliament, ministries, agencies, commissions, LGUs. The next chapter covers the rules that govern your employment: **BAA 17, the Bangsamoro Civil Service Code**.[40] That law determines how you get hired, how you get evaluated, how you get promoted, and how you can be disciplined. It is the employee handbook for the entire Bangsamoro government.

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1. BAA No. 13 (Bangsamoro Administrative Code), enacted October 2020. Defines the organizational structure, powers, and functions of the Bangsamoro government. ↩
2. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 4, art. VII. The BOL establishes a parliamentary form of government for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region. ↩
3. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 4, art. VII ("The Chief Minister shall nominate two (2) Deputy Chief Ministers … and appoint the members of the Cabinet, majority of whom shall come from the Parliament."). ↩
4. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 6, art. VII ("The Parliament shall be composed of eighty (80) members, unless otherwise increased by the Congress of the Philippines."). ↩
5. *Id.*, sec. 4, art. XVI (BTA composition; members appointed by the President). ↩
6. BARMM swearing-in records, March 15, 2025. *See* BOL, *supra* note 4 (providing for 80 members; 77 currently seated). ↩
7. BAA No. 13, Book II (Parliament structure, including the Secretariat headed by the Secretary General). ↩

8. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 31, art. VII ("On the first day of session following the election of the members of the Parliament, the Parliament shall elect the Chief Minister by a majority vote of all its members."). ↩
9. *Id.*, sec. 32, art. VII (powers, duties, and functions of the Chief Minister). ↩
10. BAA No. 13, Book IV (mandates, powers, and organizational structures of the 15 line ministries). ↩
11. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028 (BDP), Chapter 8: Accelerating Economic Growth and Expanding Economic Opportunities, citing MAFAR/DAR data. ↩
12. BAA No. 18 (Bangsamoro Education Code), enacted May 2021. ↩
13. BDP 2023-2028, Chapter 6: Enhancing Social Development, citing PSA and DepEd data on education indicators. ↩
14. BAA No. 84 (Bangsamoro Budget System Act). ↩
15. Rep. Act No. 11054, secs. 15-16, art. XII (annual block grant equal to 5% of the net national internal revenue of the BIR and BoC). The PHP 80 billion figure is based on FY 2025 appropriations. ↩
16. BDP 2023-2028, Chapter 6: Enhancing Social Development, citing DOH and FNRI data on health indicators. ↩
17. BAA No. 64 (recognizing, developing, and protecting the rights of indigenous peoples in BARMM; strengthening MIPA). ↩
18. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 8, art. VII (listing Teduray, Lambangian, Dulangan Manobo, B'laan, and Higaonon as non-Moro indigenous peoples within BARMM). ↩
19. BAA No. 49 (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code). ↩
20. BDP 2023-2028, Chapter 5: Improving and Strengthening Governance, citing MILG data. Municipality and barangay counts exclude adjustments from Sulu's exclusion per *Province of Sulu v. Medialdea*, G.R. Nos. 242255, 243246, 243693 (S.C., Sept. 9, 2024; finalized Nov. 26, 2024). ↩
21. BAA No. 82 (Bangsamoro Labor Code). ↩
22. BAA No. 19 (policies for overseas Bangsamoro employment and worker protection). Underemployment data from BDP 2023-2028, Chapter 8. ↩
23. BAA No. 13, Book V (other offices, agencies, and commissions attached to the OCM). *See also supra* note 10. ↩
24. BAA No. 13, Title XVI (Bangsamoro Commissions, attached to OCM). ↩
25. BAA No. 8 (creating the Bangsamoro Women Commission). ↩
26. BAA No. 10 (creating the Bangsamoro Youth Commission). ↩
27. BAA No. 12 (creating the Bangsamoro Sports Commission). ↩
28. *Id.*, Title XVI. BCPCH is established under BAA No. 13 without a separate enabling BAA. ↩
29. BAA No. 4 (operationalizing the Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission). ↩
30. BAA No. 13, Title XVII. BIAB is established under BAA No. 13 without a separate enabling BAA. ↩
31. BDP 2023-2028, Chapter 5, citing MILG data. Figures exclude adjustments from Sulu's exclusion. *See supra* note 20. ↩↩↩
32. BAA Nos. 41-48 (creating the municipalities of Pahamuddin, Kadayangan, Nabalawag, Old Kaabakan, Kapalawan, Malidegao, Tugunan, and Ligawasan, respectively). ↩
33. BAA No. 49, *supra* note 19. ↩

34. Rep. Act No. 7160 (Local Government Code of 1991). BAA No. 49 adapts national LGU governance provisions to the Bangsamoro context, including recognition of indigenous governance structures. ↩
35. BDP 2023-2028, Chapter 5, citing MILG LGU functionality assessment data (59% of 70 assessed LGUs compliant in 2021, up from 50% in 2020). ↩
36. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. VI (Intergovernmental Relations), secs. 2-8 (establishing the IGRB, PCBPF, BSDB, and other coordination bodies). ↩
37. BAA No. 31 (creating the Bangsamoro Sustainable Development Board). *See also* Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 8, art. VI (BOL mandate for BSDB). ↩
38. Rep. Act No. 11054, secs. 1-3, art. V (powers of the Bangsamoro government: enumerated powers, implied and incidental powers, and the residual clause). ↩
39. BAA No. 13. Count derived from the organizational structure: 1 OCM + 15 line ministries = 16 executive units. *See supra* notes 1 and 10. ↩
40. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code), enacted February 2021. ↩

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Your Employment Framework

BAA 17 governs your hiring, your evaluation, your promotion, and your dismissal. It is the Bangsamoro Civil Service Code — the employment framework for every government worker in BARMM. If the BOL is the constitution and BAA 13 is the organizational chart, BAA 17 is the employee handbook.

This chapter explains what BAA 17 covers, how it affects you from day one, and what systems you will encounter throughout your career. Read it before you apply. Read it again after you are hired.

4.1 What BAA 17 Covers

The **Bangsamoro Civil Service Code (BAA 17)**, enacted in February 2021, establishes the complete employment framework for BARMM government workers.[1] It covers:

- **Recruitment and appointment** — how positions are filled
- **Qualification standards** — what you need to qualify
- **Types of appointments** — permanent, temporary, coterminous, contractual, casual
- **Performance management** — how your work is measured
- **Rewards and recognition** — how good performance is acknowledged
- **Discipline** — what happens when rules are broken
- **Leave benefits** — your time-off entitlements
- **Code of conduct** — the ethical standards you must follow
- **Separation from service** — how employment ends

BAA 17 does not exist in isolation. It works alongside **national Civil Service Commission (CSC) rules**, which still apply to BARMM in areas not specifically covered by BAA 17. The relationship is straightforward: where BAA 17 provides its own rules, those rules apply. Where BAA 17 is silent, national CSC rules fill the gap.

4.2 The Merit and Fitness Principle

The foundation of BAA 17 — and of the Philippine civil service generally — is the **merit and fitness principle**. This means:

- Positions are filled based on **qualifications, competence, and competitive selection** — not on political connections, family ties, or personal loyalty
- All applicants who meet the qualification standards have an equal opportunity to be considered
- Selection is conducted by a **Human Resource Merit Promotion and Selection Board (HRMPSB)** — a multi-member panel that evaluates candidates

> "Appointments in the civil service shall be made only according to merit and fitness, to be determined as far as practicable by competitive examination." — Philippine Constitution, Article IX-B, Section 2(2)[2]

What this means in practice: When a position opens, it is posted publicly. Applicants submit credentials. The HRMPSB evaluates all qualified applicants against the same criteria. The most qualified applicant is recommended for appointment. The appointing authority (Minister, Secretary General, or other authorized official) makes the final appointment based on the HRMPSB recommendation.

Does this system work perfectly? No. Patronage pressures exist in any government, and BARMM is no exception. But the legal framework is designed to resist patronage. Understanding the merit-based process protects you — both as an applicant (you know what you are entitled to) and as a future government worker (you know what standards to uphold).

4.3 Types of Appointments

Not all government jobs are the same. The type of appointment determines your job security, benefits, and career trajectory. Understanding these distinctions is critical before you accept any position.

Permanent (Plantilla)

What it is: A permanent appointment to a position that is included in the approved staffing pattern (the "plantilla") of the office. This is the gold standard of government employment.

What you get: - **Security of tenure** — you cannot be removed except for cause and with due process - **Full benefits** — GSIS, PhilHealth, Pag-IBIG, leave credits, retirement benefits - **Promotion eligibility** — you can be promoted to higher positions through the merit-based process - **Step increments** — automatic salary increases based on length of service and performance

What you need: - Meet all **qualification standards** for the position (education, experience, training, eligibility) - **Civil Service eligibility** — either Professional or Sub-Professional, depending on the position level - Pass the HRMPSB evaluation process

How it works: Permanent positions are the ones listed on the government's plantilla — the authorized staffing pattern approved by the Department of Budget and Management (DBM) or MFBM. Each position has a **salary grade (SG)**, a **position title**, and a set of **qualification standards** (QS).

Temporary

What it is: An appointment to a position for a specified period, usually when the appointing authority cannot find a qualified applicant who meets all requirements — particularly CSC eligibility.

What you get: - Benefits similar to permanent — but **no security of tenure** - The appointment expires after the specified period (typically 12 months) and may or may not be renewed - You can be replaced at any time if a fully qualified applicant becomes available

When it happens: A ministry has a vacant SG 15 position. No eligible applicant applies. An applicant with the right degree and experience but no CSC eligibility is available. The ministry can issue a temporary appointment. If that person later passes the CSC exam, the appointment can be converted to permanent.

Key warning: Temporary appointments do not carry security of tenure. If you are offered a temporary appointment, prioritize passing the **Civil Service exam** so your appointment can be converted.

Coterminous

What it is: An appointment that is tied to the appointing authority's term. When the appointing authority leaves office, your appointment ends.

What you get: - Benefits during the term of appointment - **No security of tenure** — your appointment automatically expires when the appointing authority's term ends

Who gets it: Staff directly serving officials with fixed terms — confidential staff, executive assistants, and special project staff. In BARMM, this is especially relevant during the **BTA transition**. If your appointment is coterminous with a BTA member's term, your position ends when the BTA's mandate expires or is reconstituted.

Key warning: If you are offered a coterminous position, understand that your employment is tied to someone else's tenure. When the BTA transitions to an elected government, coterminous positions may not survive. Ask explicitly: "Is this position coterminous or plantilla?"

Contractual (Contract of Service / Job Order)

What it is: Employment under a Contract of Service (COS) or Job Order (JO). These are not regular government appointments — they are service contracts.

Contract of Service (COS): - A contract for a specific deliverable or project - Duration: usually 6 months to 1 year, renewable - You receive compensation but are **not considered a government employee** in the traditional sense - Limited benefits — no GSIS, no security of tenure, no leave credits (though some offices provide these voluntarily)

Job Order (JO): - The most basic form of government engagement - Task-based, short-term (usually less than 6 months) - Minimal benefits - No employer-employee relationship in the legal sense

The reality: Many fresh graduates enter government through COS or JO engagements. These are not ideal — the benefits are limited and the security is low. But they offer a way to gain **government experience**, build your network, and position yourself for a permanent appointment when one opens. Think of COS/JO as the entry point, not the destination.

Casual

What it is: Employment for seasonal or intermittent work. Less common in BARMM's central offices, more common in LGUs and project-based programs.

Summary Table: Appointment Types

Type	Security of Tenure	Full Benefits	Promotion Eligible	Duration
Permanent	Yes	Yes	Yes	Until retirement or separation

Type	Security of Tenure	Full Benefits	Promotion Eligible	Duration
Temporary	No	Partial	Limited	Up to 12 months, renewable
Coterminous	No	Partial	Limited	Tied to appointing authority's term
COS	No	Minimal	No	Contract period (6-12 months)
Job Order	No	Minimal	No	Task-based (< 6 months)
Casual	No	Partial	No	Seasonal/ intermittent

The bottom line: Aim for a **permanent appointment**. If you start as COS or temporary, make it your goal to convert. The two things you need: meet the **qualification standards** and obtain **CSC eligibility**.

4.4 Qualification Standards

Every position in the government has a set of **qualification standards (QS)** — the minimum requirements you must meet to be considered. QS have four components:

Education

The degree or level of education required. Examples: - **SG 6-9 (clerical/sub-professional):** High school diploma or vocational course - **SG 11-15 (professional/entry):** Bachelor's degree (sometimes in a specific field — e.g., BS Agriculture for MAFAR technical positions) - **SG 18-22 (supervisory/specialist):** Bachelor's degree + graduate study, or a master's degree - **SG 24+ (managerial):** Master's degree or higher

Experience

The number of years of relevant work experience required. Entry-level professional positions (SG 11) typically require **none**. Mid-level positions (SG 18) may require **2-4 years of relevant experience**. Senior positions (SG 24+) may require **4-8 years**.

What counts as "relevant": Experience in the function area of the position. If you are applying for a Planning Officer III position, relevant experience means work in planning, research, data analysis, or M&E — whether in government, NGOs, or the private sector.

Training

Hours of relevant training completed. Expressed in hours: - Entry-level (SG 11-15): Often **none required** or 4 hours - Mid-level (SG 18-22): **16-40 hours** of relevant training - Senior (SG 24+): **40-120 hours** of relevant training

Training includes seminars, workshops, short courses, and certificate programs. Keep records of all training you attend — you will need them for every promotion throughout your career.

Eligibility

Civil Service eligibility — the gateway requirement. The CSC administers exams that grant eligibility:

- **Career Service Professional (CSP)** — required for SG 11+ professional positions. Obtained by passing the Career Service Professional exam administered by the CSC, or through equivalent eligibility (RA 1080 for licensed professionals, PD 907 for college honor graduates, etc.)[3]
- **Career Service Sub-Professional (CSSP)** — for SG 1-10 sub-professional positions

Key point: If you are a licensed professional (CPA, nurse, engineer, teacher, lawyer), your professional license may serve as your CS eligibility. This is called **RA 1080 eligibility** — bar and board exam passers are automatically granted civil service eligibility.[4] College honor graduates (*cum laude* and above) receive eligibility through **PD 907**.[5] Check with the CSC which licenses and honors qualify.

If you are not yet eligible: You can still apply for temporary appointments (the office can hire you temporarily while you prepare for the CS exam). But your career advancement will be blocked until you obtain eligibility. Take the exam seriously.

How BARMM QS Relate to National CSC Standards

BAA 17 allows BARMM to create its own qualification standards within the CSC framework. This means: - **CSC eligibility remains the national standard** — you still need to pass the CSC exam - **BARMM can add requirements** relevant to the autonomous region (e.g., knowledge of Bangsamoro governance, cultural competency, language skills for specific positions) - **BARMM cannot lower standards below CSC minimums** — the floor is national, but the ceiling can be higher

4.5 Performance Management

Once you are hired, your work is measured through the **Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS)**.[6] This system connects individual performance to organizational goals, all the way up to the BDP.

The SPMS Cascade

The system works top-down:

1. **BDP goals and targets** — the government's overall objectives
2. **Office Performance Commitment and Review (OPCR)** — each office sets annual targets aligned with BDP goals
3. **Individual Performance Commitment and Review (IPCR)** — each employee sets personal targets aligned with the OPCR

Your IPCR is your performance contract. At the beginning of each rating period, you and your supervisor agree on: - **Performance targets** — specific, measurable outputs you will deliver - **Success indicators** — how achievement is measured - **Timeline** — when deliverables are due

The Rating Cycle

Phase	When	What Happens
Target-setting	January (or start of rating period)	You and your supervisor set IPCR targets
Mid-year review	June-July	Progress check — are you on track? Adjust if needed
Year-end evaluation	December-January	

Phase	When	What Happens
		Final assessment of performance against targets
Rating	After year-end evaluation	You receive a numerical rating (1-5 scale)

Performance Ratings

Rating	Description	Consequence
5 — Outstanding	Exceeded all targets with exceptional quality	Eligible for Performance-Based Bonus (PBB) and awards
4 — Very Satisfactory	Met all targets, some exceeded	Eligible for PBB
3 — Satisfactory	Met most targets at acceptable quality	Standard — meets expectations
2 — Unsatisfactory	Failed to meet several targets	Performance improvement plan required
1 — Poor	Failed to meet most or all targets	Subject to administrative action

What you need to know as a new employee: Your first rating period matters. It establishes your reputation and sets the baseline for your career. Take target-setting seriously — make sure your IPCR targets are **specific, measurable, and achievable**. Do not agree to vague targets ("improve office operations") that cannot be measured. Push for clear deliverables ("process 50 applications per quarter with 95% accuracy").

BDP Alignment in Your IPCR

Every IPCR should reference how your work contributes to BDP goals. This is not bureaucratic box-checking — it is how the government connects individual effort to regional development. When you set your targets, ask: "Which BDP goal does this support?" Document the link.

For example: - A budget analyst at MFBM → BDP Goal 1 (Stable, Just, and Accountable Government) - A teacher at MBHTE → BDP Goal 4 (Inclusive, Responsive, and Quality Social Services) - A project officer at MPW → BDP Goal 6 (Strategic, Adequate, and Climate-Resilient Infrastructure)

4.6 Rewards and Recognition

Good performance is recognized through several mechanisms:

Performance-Based Bonus (PBB)

The PBB is an annual bonus given to government employees and offices that meet their performance targets. Eligibility depends on both your individual IPCR rating (at least Satisfactory) and your office's OPCR rating. If your office performs poorly as a whole, even individual high performers may not receive the PBB.

Step Increment

A **step increment** is a salary increase within your salary grade. Each SG has 8 steps. You advance one step every **3 years of satisfactory service** (length of service increment) or for **outstanding performance** (merit increment).[7] Step increments are automatic — but you must have at least a Satisfactory rating.

Loyalty Award

After **10 years of continuous government service**, you are eligible for a Loyalty Award. Subsequent awards come at 5-year intervals (15, 20, 25 years, etc.). The award includes a cash bonus.[8]

PRAISE

The **Program on Awards and Incentives for Service Excellence (PRAISE)** is the government's formal recognition program. Each office nominates outstanding employees for awards — Employee of the Month, Employee of the Quarter, Employee of the Year, and special citations.

4.7 Discipline

BAA 17 and the national **2017 Rules on Administrative Cases in the Civil Service (RACCS)** govern disciplinary matters.[9] As a government employee, you are subject to administrative discipline for violations of the Code of Conduct and other rules.

Grounds for Disciplinary Action

Grounds for administrative cases include, among others: - **Dishonesty** — lying, falsifying documents, misrepresenting facts - **Neglect of duty** — failing to perform assigned tasks - **Misconduct** — improper behavior in office - **Habitual absenteeism or tardiness** — chronic attendance problems - **Inefficiency and incompetence** — persistent inability to perform duties - **Conduct prejudicial to the best interest of the service** — behavior that damages the government's reputation

Due Process

No government employee can be disciplined without due process. This means: - **Written notice** — you receive a formal complaint specifying the charges - **Opportunity to respond** — you have the right to answer the charges in writing - **Investigation** — a fact-finding process determines what happened - **Decision** — a written decision based on evidence, with explanation - **Appeal** — you can appeal the decision to a higher authority or the CSC

Penalties

Penalties are graduated based on the offense and whether it is a first, second, or third occurrence:

Severity	Examples	Penalty Range
Light offenses	Discourtesy, improper attire, minor delay in reports	Reprimand → 1-30 days suspension
Less grave offenses	Simple neglect, simple misconduct	1-6 months suspension → dismissal (on 2nd offense)
Grave offenses	Dishonesty, grave misconduct, falsification	6 months suspension → dismissal (even on 1st offense)

Key advice: The most common disciplinary issues for new employees are **attendance-related** — tardiness, unauthorized absences, failure to follow timekeeping rules. These seem minor but accumulate quickly. Follow the attendance rules from day one.

4.8 Leave Benefits

Government employment comes with leave benefits that are generally better than private sector standards:

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Key Rules
Vacation Leave (VL)	15 days per year	Earned monthly (1.25 days/month). Can be accumulated. Requires advance filing.
Sick Leave (SL)	15 days per year	Earned monthly (1.25 days/month). Can be accumulated. Requires medical certificate for 5+ consecutive days.
Maternity Leave	105 days (RA 11210)[10]	For female employees who give birth. Paid.
Paternity Leave	7 days (RA 8187)[11]	For married male employees whose legitimate spouse gives birth.
Solo Parent Leave	7 days (RA 8972)[12]	For qualified solo parents.
Study Leave	Up to 6 months	For employees pursuing studies relevant to their work. With pay, if approved.
Special Leave for Women	2 months (RA 9710)[13]	For gynecological surgery. Paid.
Forced/Mandatory Leave	5 days per year	You must take at least 5 days of VL annually. Non-negotiable.

What you need to know: Leave credits accumulate. Unused VL and SL carry over to the next year. When you retire or separate from service, your accumulated leave credits are **monetized** — paid out as terminal leave pay. This can amount to a significant sum after decades of service. Start accumulating from your first month.

4.9 Government Systems and Compliance

From your first week, you will encounter several systems and requirements. None of these are optional.

SPMS — Strategic Performance Management System

Already covered in Section 4.5. Your IPCR is the central document — it defines your targets, measures your output, and determines your rating.

SALN — Statement of Assets, Liabilities, and Net Worth

Every government employee must file a **SALN** annually. This is a **constitutional requirement** (Article XI, Section 17 of the Philippine Constitution).[14] You declare all your assets (property, bank accounts, investments), liabilities (loans, debts), and net worth.

The SALN is not a tax return — it is a transparency tool. It allows the government and the public to monitor whether your wealth is proportional to your legitimate income. Failure to file or filing a false SALN is a ground for administrative and criminal liability.

First-time tip: File your SALN honestly and on time. The biggest mistake new employees make is forgetting to file or treating it as unimportant. It is one of the most legally consequential documents you will sign.

Attendance and Timekeeping

Government offices follow prescribed working hours. Timekeeping is typically done through biometric systems or daily time records (DTRs). The standard work schedule is **8:00 AM to 5:00 PM, Monday to Friday**, though some offices have flexible work arrangements.

Tardiness and absences are tracked and can result in disciplinary action. The rules are strict: habitual tardiness (reporting late 10 or more times in a month) and habitual absenteeism (unauthorized absences for 3 or more days in a month or at least 5 consecutive days) are grounds for administrative cases.

ARTA Compliance — Citizen's Charter

Under the **Anti-Red Tape Act (ARTA)**, originally enacted as RA 9485 (2007) and strengthened by RA 11032 (2018),[15] every government office must maintain a **Citizen's Charter** — a document listing all services the office provides, the steps to access each service, the processing time, and the responsible person. If your office delivers services to the public, you may be involved in maintaining and implementing this charter.

Government Benefits Enrollment

Upon appointment, you will be enrolled in three mandatory benefit systems:

- **GSIS (Government Service Insurance System)** — your retirement, insurance, and loan provider
- **PhilHealth** — health insurance
- **Pag-IBIG (HDMF)** — housing and savings fund

Monthly contributions are deducted from your salary. These are not optional — they are mandatory for all government employees. In exchange, you get retirement benefits, loan access, health coverage, and housing fund accumulation.

4.10 The Code of Conduct

Two layers of ethical standards govern your behavior as a BARMM government worker:

RA 6713 — Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees[16]

This is the national standard. It requires all government employees to: - Act with professionalism, justness, and sincerity - Be accountable to the people - Respond to public needs promptly and adequately - Disclose conflicts of interest - Avoid using office resources for personal gain - Maintain a simple and modest lifestyle

Moral Governance Overlay

On top of RA 6713, BARMM applies the **12 Pillars of Moral Governance** (covered in Chapter 1). This adds a faith-informed, culturally grounded ethical dimension that is unique to the Bangsamoro government. In practice, this means:

- **Integrity and amanah (trust)** — you are a trustee of public resources, not an owner

- **Accountability and shura (consultation)** — decisions are made through consultation, not unilateral authority
- **Justice and adl** — fairness in all dealings, regardless of personal relationships

You do not need to be Muslim to serve in BARMM. But you do need to understand and respect these governance principles. They will come up in orientation, in performance discussions, and in the day-to-day culture of the workplace.

4.11 The CSC and BARMM

The relationship between the **Civil Service Commission (CSC)** and the Bangsamoro government can be confusing. Here is the short version:

The CSC is a national constitutional body. It has jurisdiction over all civil service matters in the Philippines, including BARMM.[21]

BAA 17 creates a Bangsamoro civil service system within the CSC framework. This means: - **CSC eligibility exams** are still the standard — you take the same exam as any other government applicant in the Philippines - **CSC rules on appointments, promotions, and discipline** apply unless BAA 17 provides otherwise - **BARMM has its own HRMPSB** — the merit selection board that evaluates applicants within BARMM - **BARMM can set additional qualification standards** beyond the CSC minimums, tailored to the needs of the autonomous region

The practical takeaway: Take the CSC exam. Without it, your career options are limited. The exam is offered multiple times per year in testing centers across Mindanao. Study for it the way you would study for a board exam — it covers vocabulary, grammar, mathematics, and general information about Philippine government and the Constitution.

4.12 Other Key Civil Service Issuances

Several CSC issuances affect your daily work. You do not need to memorize them, but you should know they exist:

Issuance	Subject	What It Means for You
CSC MC No. 14, s. 2018[17]	Omnibus Rules on Appointments	The detailed rules governing how appointments are made — posting, evaluation, attestation

Issuance	Subject	What It Means for You
2017 RACCS (CSC Res. No. 1701077)[18]	Rules on Administrative Cases in the Civil Service	The disciplinary framework — complaints, investigation, penalties, appeals
OP MC No. 72, s. 2019 and OP MC No. 2, s. 2022[19]	Complete Staff Work (CSW)	The standard for professional staff work — your memos, briefers, and recommendations must be complete, accurate, and actionable
Various EOs	Government working hours, flexible work	Rules on work schedules, telecommuting, and flexible work arrangements

Complete Staff Work (CSW) deserves special attention. CSW is the principle that every document you submit to a decision-maker must be so thorough and well-prepared that the decision-maker only needs to approve or disapprove — no further research, no missing data, no incomplete analysis. CSW is the professional standard that separates competent government workers from mediocre ones. Chapters 11-14 of this guidebook will teach you how to do it.

4.13 Salary and Compensation

Government salaries follow the **Salary Standardization Law (SSL)**, which assigns salary amounts to each Salary Grade (SG 1-33).[20] All government employees at the same SG receive the same base pay, regardless of where they work.

Entry-Level Salary Ranges (SSL Step 1, approximate)

Salary Grade	Monthly Base Pay (approx.)	Typical Entry Positions
SG 6	~PHP 18,000	Administrative Aide VI (clerical)
SG 9	~PHP 22,000	Administrative Assistant III
SG 11	~PHP 27,000	Professional entry — LSO I, Admin Officer I, Project Dev't Officer I

Salary Grade	Monthly Base Pay (approx.)	Typical Entry Positions
SG 13	~PHP 30,000	LSO II, Admin Officer III, DMO II
SG 15	~PHP 38,000	LSO III, Senior Staff positions

Beyond Base Pay

Your actual take-home pay is higher than the base salary. Additional compensation includes: - **COLA (Cost of Living Allowance)** — PHP 2,000/month - **PERA (Personnel Economic Relief Allowance)** — PHP 2,000/month - **Clothing/Uniform Allowance** — PHP 6,000/year - **Mid-Year Bonus** — equivalent to 1 month salary (May) - **Year-End Bonus** — equivalent to 1 month salary (November) - **Cash Gift** — PHP 5,000 (November) - **Performance-Based Bonus** — variable, based on office and individual performance rating

An honest comparison: A fresh graduate at SG 11 earns approximately PHP 27,000/month base pay. With allowances and bonuses, the annualized compensation is higher. But in the private sector — especially in Manila — a comparable graduate might earn PHP 25,000-40,000/month with faster salary progression. The trade-off is job security, benefits (GSIS retirement), and the non-monetary value of public service. Make this trade-off consciously.

4.14 Your First 90 Days: What to Expect

Here is what typically happens during your first three months as a new government employee in BARMM:

Week 1: Orientation and Onboarding - Report to your office. Meet your supervisor and colleagues. - Complete enrollment forms for GSIS, PhilHealth, and Pag-IBIG. - Receive your office's organizational chart, Citizen's Charter, and any orientation materials. - Get access to your workspace, email, and any office systems. - Some offices conduct formal orientation programs. Others simply assign you a desk and a task. Be ready for either.

Week 2-4: Learning the Systems - Begin learning office processes, filing systems, and reporting requirements. - Draft your first IPCR targets with your supervisor's guidance. - Start building relationships with colleagues — especially those who have been in the office longest. - Observe how memos, letters, and reports are formatted. Every office has unwritten format standards. - File your SALN if required upon assumption of duty.

Month 2: Building Competence - You should be handling routine tasks independently by now — processing documents, drafting correspondence, maintaining records. - Attend any available training — orientation on SPMS, CSW, ARTA compliance, or technical skills relevant to your office. - Ask questions. Lots of them. There is no penalty for asking; there is a penalty for guessing wrong.

Month 3: Contributing Productively - You should be producing work that contributes to your IPCR targets. - Your supervisor should have a clear picture of your strengths and development areas. - Start thinking about your career trajectory — what skills do you need to develop? What training should you pursue?

The unwritten rule: In BARMM government offices, the culture tends to be relationship-oriented. Making an effort to get to know your colleagues — their names, their roles, their working styles — is not socializing. It is essential to getting your work done. You will need their cooperation, their institutional knowledge, and their willingness to help you navigate a young bureaucracy that does not always have written procedures for everything.

What Comes Next

You now understand the employment framework — appointments, qualifications, performance management, benefits, and discipline. The next chapter covers the **Bangsamoro Development Plan (BDP)** — the government's strategic roadmap. Every program, every budget allocation, and every performance target flows from the BDP. Knowing it helps you connect your daily work to the larger purpose of Bangsamoro self-governance.

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1. BAA No. 17 (2021). Bangsamoro Civil Service Code. Enacted February 2021 by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority. ↩
2. Const. art. IX-B, sec. 2(2). "Appointments in the civil service shall be made only according to merit and fitness to be determined, as far as practicable, and, except to positions which are policy-determining, primarily confidential, or highly technical, by competitive examination." ↩
3. Rep. Act No. 1080, as amended. Declares bar and board examinations as civil service examinations, granting automatic eligibility to passers. Pres. Decree No. 907. Grants civil service eligibility to college honor graduates (*cum laude* and above). ↩
4. Rep. Act No. 1080, sec. 1. ↩

5. Pres. Decree No. 907 (1976). Granting Civil Service Eligibility to College Honor Graduates. ↩
6. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 6, s. 2012. Guidelines in the Establishment and Implementation of Agency Strategic Performance Management System. ↩
7. BAA No. 17, in relation to the Salary Standardization Law. Step increments are granted after every three (3) years of continuous satisfactory service (length of service increment) or for meritorious performance (one step for Outstanding rating). ↩
8. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 6, s. 2002. Revised Policies on the Grant of Loyalty Award. Initial award after 10 years of continuous and satisfactory government service; subsequent awards at 5-year intervals. ↩
9. 2017 Rules on Administrative Cases in the Civil Service (2017 RACCS), CSC Resolution No. 1701077, promulgated July 3, 2017. ↩
10. Rep. Act No. 11210 (2019). 105-Day Expanded Maternity Leave Law. ↩
11. Rep. Act No. 8187 (1996). Paternity Leave Act. Grants seven (7) working days of paternity leave with full pay for the first four (4) deliveries of the legitimate spouse. ↩
12. Rep. Act No. 8972 (2000). Solo Parents' Welfare Act. Grants seven (7) working days of parental leave per year, as amended by Rep. Act No. 11861 (Expanded Solo Parents Welfare Act). ↩
13. Rep. Act No. 9710 (2009). Magna Carta of Women, sec. 18. Special leave benefit of up to two (2) months with full pay for female employees who undergo surgery due to gynecological disorders. ↩
14. Const. art. XI, sec. 17. "A public officer or employee shall, upon assumption of office and as often thereafter as may be required by law, submit a declaration under oath of his assets, liabilities, and net worth." ↩
15. Rep. Act No. 9485 (2007). Anti-Red Tape Act, as strengthened by Rep. Act No. 11032 (2018), Ease of Doing Business and Efficient Government Service Delivery Act. ↩
16. Rep. Act No. 6713 (1989). Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees. ↩
17. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018. 2017 Omnibus Rules on Appointments and Other Human Resource Actions, Revised July 2018. ↩
18. *See* note 9. ↩
19. Office of the President, Memorandum Circular No. 72, s. 2019, Strengthening the Standards of Complete Staff Work; Office of the President, Memorandum Circular No. 2, s. 2022, Mandating Strict Compliance with the Requirement of a Strengthened Complete Staff Work. Note: These are Office of the President issuances, not CSC memorandum circulars. ↩
20. Rep. Act No. 11466 (2020). Salary Standardization Law V (SSL V), providing for the fifth tranche of salary adjustments for government employees. Salary figures cited are approximate. ↩
21. Const. art. IX-B, sec. 1. The Civil Service Commission is established as the central personnel agency of the Government, with jurisdiction over all branches, subdivisions, instrumentalities, and agencies, including government-owned or controlled corporations with original charters. ↩

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Chapter 5: The Bangsamoro Development Plan — What You're Working Toward

Every memo you write, every briefer you draft, every program you implement serves one plan. Know it.

If you have ever wondered why the Bangsamoro government exists, the answer is in the **2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan (BDP) 2023-2028**.[1] This document is the government's roadmap. It tells every ministry, every office, every staff member what BARMM is trying to achieve and how it plans to get there. When you join the government, your daily work connects to this plan. Your performance targets trace back to it. Your budget proposals must justify spending against it. The BDP is not a shelf document. It is the operating system.

This chapter gives you the essentials. You do not need to memorize all 14 chapters. But you do need to understand the goals, the strategies, the targets, and the ethical framework. When an interviewer asks "What do you know about the BDP?" you should be able to answer with substance.

5.1 What the BDP Is

The **2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan** covers the period **2023 to 2028**.[2] It is the successor to the 1st BDP (2020-2022), which guided BARMM through its initial years of institution-building. The **Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority (BPDA)** led the formulation of the plan in coordination with all 15 ministries, attached agencies, and development partners.[3]

The BDP is organized into **14 chapters** covering governance, economy, peace and security, social services, culture, infrastructure, and cross-cutting concerns.[4] It is publicly available through the BPDA website and the BARMM Official Gazette.

Why the BDP matters to you personally:

- Every **ministry and office** aligns its Annual Work and Financial Plan to the BDP

- Every **Individual Performance Commitment and Review (IPCR)** should reference BDP alignment
- Every **policy recommendation** you write should cite the relevant BDP chapter
- Every **budget proposal** must justify spending against BDP targets
- During **job interviews**, knowledge of the BDP demonstrates strategic awareness that most applicants lack

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5.2 The Overall Goal

The BDP's overall goal is:

> **An empowered, cohesive, and progressive Bangsamoro.**[5]

Each word carries specific meaning:[6]

Term	What It Means
Empowered	Improved capacity of communities through enhanced access to quality basic social services and widened economic opportunities via institution building and service delivery
Cohesive	Improved relationships between stakeholders evidenced in reduced violent conflict and forged partnerships in governance and development
Progressive	Sustained ability to optimize existing and potential resources addressing community development needs and realizing economic and human potential

When someone says "empowered Bangsamoro," they are not using a slogan. They are referencing a measurable outcome: communities that have access to quality services and economic opportunity because the government built the institutions to deliver them.

5.3 The Vision and Mission

The Vision

> "A Bangsamoro that is united, enlightened, self-governing, peaceful, just, morally upright, and progressive."[7]

This vision is long-term. It extends beyond the 2028 plan period. Key elements like peace, unity, and justice remain relevant as desired states the Bangsamoro people continue to work toward.

The Mission

> "Guided by moral governance and in pursuit of genuine and meaningful autonomy, the Bangsamoro government ensures the necessary conditions for enduring peace and sustained socioeconomic development suitable to the systems of life, needs, and aspirations of its people by providing services to communities, ensuring multi-stakeholder participation, and facilitating appropriate partnership."[8]

Two phrases in the mission statement deserve your attention:

- **"Systems of life"** – this means development that fits the Bangsamoro people's way of living, not development imposed from outside
- **"Multi-stakeholder participation"** – the government does not work alone. It partners with communities, civil society, the private sector, and development partners

5.4 The Six Development Goals

These six goals define what BARMM is working toward. Every office in the government contributes to at least one of them.[9]

Goal 1: Stable, Just, and Accountable Government

What it means:

- **Stable** – the government continues to function during emergencies, elections, or changes in power. Ministries deliver services even during shocks.
- **Just** – the government is the primary agent of economic and social justice. Leaders exercise power to advance the public interest, not personal gain.
- **Accountable** – institutions, leaders, and staff are held responsible for how they use government resources and powers. Accountability frameworks and systems are in place.

Which offices work on this: All ministries (governance is everyone's job), plus MFBM (fiscal accountability), the Bangsamoro Internal Auditing Body (BIAB),[24] and the Office of the Chief Minister (OCM).

What your work might look like: Preparing compliance reports, developing standard operating procedures, processing financial documents with proper documentation, supporting performance evaluations.

Goal 2: Equitable, Competitive, and Robust Economy

What it means:

- **Equitable** – economic gains benefit all, with special consideration for the poor and marginalized. Key inequality indicators (Gini coefficient, poverty gap) improve.
- **Competitive** – BARMM enjoys comparative advantage in selected commodities (seaweed, cassava, rubber, palm oil) with optimized local and international market linkages.[25]
- **Robust** – sustained growth over six years with a diversified, stabilized economy that creates quality jobs.

Which offices work on this: MTIT (trade and tourism), MAFAR (agriculture and fisheries), MOLE (labor and employment), BBOI (investment promotion), MOST (science and technology).

What your work might look like: Analyzing trade data, supporting cooperative registration, drafting investment incentive policies, coordinating livelihood programs, processing business permits.

Goal 3: Peaceful, Safe, and Resilient Bangsamoro Communities

What it means:

- Achieve lasting peace through ensuring security and intensifying peace-building efforts
- Create safe communities by protecting Bangsamoro people
- Build resilient communities that can withstand natural calamities and human-induced disasters

Which offices work on this: MPOS (public order and safety), MILG (interior and local government), the Bangsamoro Regional Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Office (BRDRRMO), OCM peace and normalization units.

What your work might look like: Supporting peace and order councils, preparing disaster preparedness plans, coordinating with local governments on community safety, processing normalization program documents.

Goal 4: Inclusive, Responsive, and Quality Social Services

What it means:

- Social services are **inclusive** – available to all sectors regardless of tribe, religion, or political affiliation
- Services are **responsive** – they address the actual needs of communities, not just what the government decides to provide
- Services are **quality** – they meet standards that improve lives

Which offices work on this: MBHTE (education), MOH (health), MSSD (social services), MHSD (human settlements), MOLE (employment services).

What your work might look like: Tracking school enrollment and dropout rates, processing beneficiary lists for social protection programs, coordinating health service delivery in municipalities, supporting scholarship program administration.

Goal 5: Rich and Diverse Bangsamoro Culture and Identity Preserved and Recognized

What it means:

- The Bangsamoro exercises its powers to maintain and promote its rich, diverse culture and identity

- Mandated under Section 24, Article IX of the BOL[10] – cultural preservation is not optional. It is a constitutional responsibility.
- The BOL recognizes that Bangsamoro identity is the primary cause of the Bangsamoro struggle. Preserving it is inseparable from the peace process.

Which offices work on this: BCPCH (cultural heritage preservation), MIPA (indigenous peoples' affairs), MBHTE (cultural education), the Office of the Wali (moral and cultural authority).

What your work might look like: Documenting cultural heritage sites, supporting indigenous peoples' rights programs, developing culturally responsive curricula, coordinating cultural events and festivals.

Goal 6: Strategic, Adequate, and Climate-Resilient Infrastructure

What it means:

- **Strategic** – infrastructure that has broad-based, inclusive effects on industries and communities (not bridges to nowhere)
- **Adequate** – infrastructure that meets the demands of communities and industries (not token projects)
- **Climate-resilient** – infrastructure that withstands calamities induced by climate change

Which offices work on this: MPW (public works), MOTC (transportation and communications), MENRE (environment and natural resources), MHSD (human settlements).

What your work might look like: Processing infrastructure project proposals, monitoring construction progress, preparing environmental compliance documents, coordinating road network plans with LGUs.

5.5 The Eight Development Strategies

The six goals tell you **what** BARMM wants to achieve. The eight strategies tell you **how**.[11]

1. **Improve and strengthen governance mechanisms** for a stable, just, and accountable Bangsamoro government
2. **Create an enabling environment** towards an equitable, competitive, and robust economy

3. **Harness technology and innovations** to increase socioeconomic opportunities and improve government services
4. **Improve ecological integrity and resilience** of communities and ensure a healthy and clean environment
5. **Enhance and strengthen peace, public order, safety, and security** and uphold human rights for inclusive, peaceful, progressive, and sustainable development
6. **Ensure inclusive and equitable access** to quality services for social justice and human capital development
7. **Mainstream Bangsamoro cultural diversity**, beliefs, heritage, and identity
8. **Scale up functional, strategic, climate-resilient, and quality infrastructure** to support sustainable socioeconomic development

Notice how the strategies map to the goals:

Strategy	Primary Goal Served
Strategy 1 (Governance)	Goal 1 (Stable government)
Strategy 2 (Economy)	Goal 2 (Robust economy)
Strategy 3 (Technology)	Goals 1, 2, 4 (cross-cutting)
Strategy 4 (Environment)	Goal 3 (Resilient communities)
Strategy 5 (Peace and security)	Goal 3 (Peaceful communities)
Strategy 6 (Social services)	Goal 4 (Quality services)
Strategy 7 (Culture)	Goal 5 (Culture preserved)
Strategy 8 (Infrastructure)	Goal 6 (Climate-resilient infrastructure)

Strategy 3 – **harnessing technology and innovations** – is cross-cutting. It applies to governance (digital government services), economy (technology-enabled agriculture and trade), and social services (e-learning, telemedicine). This means every office, not just MOST, has a role in technology adoption.

5.6 The Twelve Pillars of Moral Governance

The BDP is not only about economic targets and infrastructure. It is grounded in an ethical framework called the **Twelve Pillars of Moral Governance**.[12] These pillars are the centerpiece of BARMM's leadership and governance for 2023-2028. They are cited in performance evaluations, referenced in legislation, and expected in daily conduct.

1. **Integrity** – Avoid conflicts of interest in executing official duties. Those in positions of public trust should not bind themselves in any manner, whether financially or otherwise.
2. **Accountability** – Be open and transparent about decisions and actions. Document decisions and limit information only when the larger public interest clearly requires it.
3. **Transparency and Honesty** – Declare private interests related to public duties. Resolve conflicts in a way that protects the public interest. All public transactions should be made public.
4. **Sense of Patriotism** – Invest in the reputation and integrity of the Bangsamoro. Protect the community's achievements, history, and way of life.
5. **Striving for Excellence** – Uphold the legitimacy of all actions. Deliver the highest quality in everything, prioritizing process over results for the good of all.
6. **Cultural Understanding and Tolerance** – Gain better understanding of socioeconomic differences between societies. Appreciate the variety within the Bangsamoro.
7. **Unwavering Loyalty to God** – Strict adherence to rules and regulations as a result of devotion to God. This pillar reflects the Islamic foundation of Bangsamoro governance.
8. **Justice** – Serve the public without prejudice. Equity should triumph without regard for oneself, family, companions, or political alliances.
9. **Inclusivity** – Foster welcoming environments free from discrimination based on religion, ethnicity, or culture. Appreciate the region's identity-building and cultural characteristics.
10. **Objectivity** – Make merit-based decisions in public business, including appointments, contracts, and awards. Decide solely in the public interest.
11. **Dialogue and Meaningful Engagement** – Consult the community. Engage in meaningful dialogue to identify needs and achieve positive change.

12. **Balance Between Practical Life and Moral Side** – Balance practical and ethical values in carrying out government duties. Never deviate from the moral aspect of public service.

What the pillars mean for you as a new employee:

These are not decorative values. When your supervisor evaluates your performance, they may reference these pillars. When the HRMPSB interviews you, they may ask what moral governance means to you. When you face an ethical dilemma at work – a colleague asks you to backdate a document, a politician pressures you to approve an unqualified applicant, a contractor offers you a "gift" – these pillars are your guide.

The most practical pillar for daily work is **Pillar 10: Objectivity**. It says decisions must be merit-based. This applies to everything from hiring (the HRMPSB process) to procurement (competitive bidding) to budget allocation (BDP alignment). When in doubt, ask: "Is this decision based on merit and public interest?"

5.7 Macroeconomic Targets

The BDP sets measurable targets for the Bangsamoro economy. These numbers appear in budget proposals, program evaluations, and policy briefs. You should know the key ones.[13]

Indicator	Baseline	End-of-Plan Target (2028)
GRDP Annual Average Growth Rate	7.5% (2020-2021)	8-9% for six years
GRDP Per Capita Growth Rate	6.4% (2020-2021)	6-9%
Industry/Services Real Growth	Industry 7.9%, Services 6.6%	10-12% (double-digit)
Gross Capital Formation (% of GRDP)	16.91% (2021)	18-20% by 2028
Inflation Rate	2.40% (2021)	2-4%
Unemployment Rate	3.80% (2021)	3-5%
Underemployment Rate	9.0% (2020)	4-7%

Indicator	Baseline	End-of-Plan Target (2028)
Poverty Incidence	29.80% (2021)	20-25% by 2028

Source: 2nd BDP, Chapter 4, Table 4.1 (PSA Reports)[14]

Key assumptions behind these targets:

- No sustained large-scale armed conflict in the plan period
- Significant progress in peace and normalization
- Continued recovery from the pandemic
- Government expenditure as an economic stimulus ("pump-priming")
- Passage of priority codes (Revenue Code, Investment Code) to create a predictable investment climate

What these numbers mean for your work:

If you work in **MAFAR**, your programs contribute to GRDP growth through agricultural productivity. If you work in **MOLE**, your employment programs help maintain the unemployment rate within target. If you work in **MSSD**, your social protection programs reduce poverty incidence. If you work in **BPDA**, you monitor all these indicators and report progress. Every ministry's work connects to at least one macroeconomic target.

5.8 What the 1st BDP Achieved

The 1st BDP (2020-2022) set six macroeconomic targets. Five were achieved:[15]

Target	Result
GRDP Growth Rate	7.5% – **Achieved**
Population Growth	3.26% – **Achieved**
Labor Force Participation	60% – **Exceeded** (target was 46-50%)
Unemployment	7.60% – **Not Met** (target was 3%)
Inflation	2.40% – **Achieved**
Poverty Incidence (families)	29.80% – **Exceeded** (target was 49.6%)

The poverty reduction from 54.20% (2018) to 29.80% (2021) was the most significant achievement – a **24.4 percentage point reduction** in three years.[16] However, unemployment remained above target, and the COVID-19 pandemic disrupted economic activity.

The 2nd BDP builds on these gains while addressing persistent challenges: underemployment, infrastructure gaps, education quality, and health service access.

5.9 Vertical Alignment – How the BDP Connects to National and International Plans

The BDP does not exist in isolation. It aligns vertically with higher-level plans:

- **National**: Philippine Development Plan 2023-2028 and Ambisyon Natin 2040[17]
- **Regional**: Mindanao Development Agenda[26]
- **International**: United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)[27]
- **BARMM-specific**: Enhanced 12-Point Priority Agenda[18]

This alignment matters because BARMM receives an **Annual Block Grant** from the national government (equal to 5% of net national internal revenue)[19] and a **Special Development Fund** (PHP 5 billion per year).[20] The national government expects BARMM's spending to align with national priorities. Development partners (UNDP, World Bank, JICA, USAID) align their support with the SDGs. When you write a project proposal, showing alignment with both the BDP and the SDGs strengthens your case.

5.10 The Enhanced 12-Point Priority Agenda

The **Enhanced 12-Point Priority Agenda** is the Chief Minister's implementation framework within the BDP.[21] It translates the BDP's broad goals into specific priorities for the transition period.

Priority	Focus	Key Offices
1. Bureaucracy	Strengthen the regional bureaucracy	All MOAs
2. Priority Codes	Enact the 7 priority codes	Parliament, Legal offices

Priority	Focus	Key Offices
3. Revenue Generation	Increase revenue and economic advantages	MFBM, BBOI, MTIT
4. Social Services	Education, health, social welfare	MBHTE, MOH, MSSD
5. Infrastructure	Strategic infrastructure development	MPW, MOTC
6. Economic Development	Inclusive economic growth	MTIT, MAFAR, MOLE
7. Environment	Natural resources protection	MENRE
8. Disaster Resilience	Community resilience	MILG, BRDRRMO
9. Peace and Normalization	Peace agreement provisions	OCM, MPOS
10. Marawi Rehabilitation	Marawi City recovery	Task Force Bangon Marawi, MHSD
11. Peace and Security	Sustain peace, justice, security	MPOS, BHRC
12. Cultural Heritage	Preserve Bangsamoro culture	BCPCH, MIPA

When you research a prospective office, identify which of the 12 priorities it supports. This gives you a concrete answer when an interviewer asks: "How does this office's work connect to the Chief Minister's agenda?"

5.11 How to Connect YOUR Work to the BDP

Here is the chain of connection:

```
BDP Goal → Development Strategy → Ministry/Office Mandate → Office Work Plan
→ Your IPCR
```

Example 1 – Education Staff at MBHTE: - **BDP Goal 4**: Inclusive, responsive, and quality social services - **Strategy 6**: Ensure inclusive and equitable access to quality services - **MBHTE Mandate** (BAA 13):[22] Comprehensive education system - **Office Work Plan**: Increase school enrollment in underserved barangays - **Your IPCR Target**: Process 200 AHME scholarship applications per quarter

Example 2 – Legislative Staff at Parliament: - **BDP Goal 1**: Stable, just, and accountable government - **Strategy 1**: Improve and strengthen governance mechanisms - **Parliament Mandate** (BOL Art. VII):[23] Legislate for the Bangsamoro - **Committee Work Plan**: Draft and deliberate priority codes - **Your IPCR Target**: Prepare 4 legislative briefers per quarter on referred bills

Example 3 – Planning Staff at BPDA: - **BDP Goal 1**: Stable, just, and accountable government (cross-cutting) - **Strategy 1**: Improve and strengthen governance mechanisms - **BPDA Mandate**: Coordinate BDP implementation, monitor progress - **Office Work Plan**: Conduct mid-term review of BDP performance - **Your IPCR Target**: Collect and consolidate progress reports from 4 assigned ministries per quarter

How to use BDP alignment in your application:

In your cover letter, write one sentence connecting your target office's work to a specific BDP goal. In your interview, when asked "Why this office?" reference the BDP. This demonstrates strategic awareness that separates you from applicants who have not read the plan.

5.12 Where to Read the Full BDP

The complete BDP has **14 chapters**. Here are the ones most relevant to your job search:

Chapter	Content	Why You Need It
Chapter 1	BARMM extended transition and 1st BDP review	Understand the context and what BARMM has achieved so far
Chapter 3	Bangsamoro spatial strategy	Know the functional roles of provinces and geographic areas
Chapter 4	Development framework	

Chapter	Content	Why You Need It
		The goals, strategies, and targets (this chapter covers it)
Chapter 5	Governance	If you are targeting Parliament, OCM, or any governance office
Chapter 6	Economy	If you are targeting MTIT, MAFAR, MOLE, BBOI
Chapter 7	Peace and security	If you are targeting MPOS or peace-related offices
Chapter 8	Social services	If you are targeting MBHTE, MOH, or MSSD
Chapter 9	Culture	If you are targeting BCPCH or MIPA
Chapter 10	Infrastructure	If you are targeting MPW or MOTC

Where to find it:

- BPDA website (official digital copy)
- BARMM Official Gazette
- Ask the BPDA office directly – they distribute printed and digital copies

Practical tip: You do not need to read all 14 chapters before applying. Read **Chapter 4** (development framework – the chapter you just learned) and the **chapter relevant to your target office**. That gives you enough to be the most informed applicant in any interview panel.

5.13 Actionable Tool: "Connect Your Work to BDP" Worksheet

Complete this worksheet for your target office. It demonstrates strategic awareness in your cover letter and interview.

BDP Goal	Actions My Target Office Takes	How My Skills Contribute
Goal 1: Stable, just, and accountable government	___	___
Goal 2: Equitable, competitive, and robust economy	___	___
Goal 3: Peaceful, safe, and resilient communities	___	___
Goal 4: Inclusive, responsive, and quality social services	___	___
Goal 5: Culture and identity preserved	___	___
Goal 6: Strategic, climate-resilient infrastructure	___	___

Instructions:

1. Identify your target office (from Chapter 3 or Chapter 6)
2. For each BDP goal, list 2-3 specific actions that office takes to advance it. If the goal is not directly relevant to the office, write "N/A" – no office serves all six goals equally.
3. In the third column, write how your education, skills, or experience can contribute to those actions
4. Use this worksheet when writing your cover letter (Chapter 8) and preparing for your interview (Chapter 9)

Example – Target Office: MSSD

BDP Goal	Actions MSSD Takes	How My Skills Contribute
Goal 1	Submits compliance reports, maintains performance management system	My public administration degree covers government accountability systems
Goal 4	Administers BANGON livelihood program, processes humanitarian	My thesis on community development in Maguindanao gives me

BDP Goal	Actions MSSD Takes	How My Skills Contribute
	assistance, runs feeding programs	direct knowledge of beneficiary communities
Goal 5	Supports cultural activities for settler communities and IP groups	My volunteer work with OOBC exposed me to multicultural community engagement

Key Takeaways

- The **2nd BDP (2023-2028)** is the government's roadmap. All offices align to it.
- The overall goal is an **empowered, cohesive, and progressive Bangsamoro**.
- Know the **6 development goals** – they define what your work contributes to.
- Know the **8 development strategies** – they define how goals become action.
- The **12 Pillars of Moral Governance** are not aspirational. They are the ethical standard you will be held to.
- The **macroeconomic targets** (GRDP 8-9%, poverty 20-25%, unemployment 3-5%) are the numbers your work is measured against.
- Connect your work to the BDP in your cover letter and interview. It separates informed applicants from uninformed ones.

In the next chapter, you will choose your career track: Parliament, Ministry, Office/Agency, or LGU. Each serves the BDP differently – and each offers a different kind of working life.

1. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028 (Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority, 2023). ↩
2. *Id.*, ch. 1, p. 1. ↩
3. *Id.*, ch. 1, pp. 1-2. ↩

4. *Id.*, Table of Contents. ↩
5. *Id.*, ch. 4, p. 70. ↩
6. *Id.* ↩
7. *Id.*, ch. 4, p. 69. ↩
8. *Id.* ↩
9. *Id.*, ch. 4, pp. 70-71. ↩
10. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 24, art. IX. ↩
11. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4, pp. 71-72. ↩
12. *Id.*, ch. 5, pp. 86-88. ↩
13. *Id.*, ch. 4, p. 75. ↩
14. *Id.*, ch. 4, Table 4.1. ↩
15. *Id.*, ch. 1, Table 1.1. ↩
16. *Id.*, ch. 1; Philippine Statistics Authority, Official Poverty Statistics, Full Year 2018 and 2021. ↩
17. Philippine Development Plan 2023-2028 (National Economic and Development Authority, 2023); Ambisyon Natin 2040 (NEDA, 2016). ↩
18. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4, p. 73. ↩
19. Rep. Act No. 11054, secs. 15-16, art. XII. ↩
20. *Id.*, sec. 2, art. XIV. ↩
21. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4, p. 73. ↩
22. BAA No. 13, Book IV, Title I (Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education). ↩
23. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. VII. ↩
24. BAA No. 13, Book V, Title XVII, ch. 2 (Bangsamoro Internal Auditing Body). ↩
25. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 6 (Economy). ↩
26. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4, p. 74. ↩
27. United Nations, Transforming Our World: The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development (2015). ↩

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Chapter 6: Choosing Your Path — Parliament vs. Ministry vs. Office vs. LGU

BARMM has four career tracks. Each leads somewhere different. Choose wisely.

Before you start applying, you need to answer a fundamental question: **Where in the Bangsamoro government do you want to work?** This is not a small decision. The track you choose determines what you do every day, the skills you develop, the people you work with, and how far your career can go.

BARMM government has four distinct career tracks. Each serves the Bangsamoro Development Plan differently. Each attracts a different kind of person. This chapter gives you an honest look at all four so you can choose with your eyes open.

6.1 The Four Tracks – Overview

Track	What You Do Daily	Key Competencies	Entry Positions	Career Ceiling
Parliament[1]	Draft bills, write briefers, prepare speeches, support committees	Investigation, policy analysis, legal competence, Complete Staff Work	Legislative Staff Officer I (SG 11)	SLSO I, Legislative Chief, Director
Ministry	Implement programs, deliver services, manage budgets, write policy	Technical expertise, project management, budget analysis	SG 6-15 (clerical SG 6-9, professional SG 11-15)	Staff, Division Chief, Director, Undersecretary
Office/Agency	Focused mandate	Stakeholder engagement,	Project Officer /	Staff, Section Head,

Track	What You Do Daily	Key Competencies	Entry Positions	Career Ceiling
	(youth, women, planning, economic development)	program design, M&E	Specialist (SG 11-15)	Executive Director
LGU	Frontline service delivery, community engagement, local governance	Community relations, compliance, operations	Municipal Staff (SG 8-11)	Staff, Department Head, Administrator

Each track has different rhythms, different outputs, and different measures of success. The following sections show you what a real day looks like in each one.

6.2 Day-in-the-Life: Parliament Track

You are a Legislative Staff Officer II (SG 13) assigned to an MP who chairs the Committee on Agriculture, Fisheries, and Agrarian Reform.

7:30 AM – You arrive at the Parliament building in Cotabato City. You check your email and the committee's shared folder for new referrals from the Secretary General's office. Overnight, a new bill has been referred to your committee: "An Act Establishing the Bangsamoro Fisheries Code."

8:00 AM – Your MP asks you to prepare a legislative briefer on the bill before Thursday's committee hearing. You read the bill's explanatory note, cross-reference it against BOL Article V, Section 2 (enumerated powers – fisheries falls under BARMM competence),[2] and check whether any existing BAA already covers the subject.

9:30 AM – You attend the weekly staff meeting with the MP's team: two PAOs (Political Affairs Officers) who handle constituency concerns, one PIMAO (Public Information and Media Affairs Officer) who manages the MP's communications, and you (the LSO handling legislative work). The MP assigns priorities for the week.

10:30 AM – Research phase. You pull data from MAFAR's fisheries reports, review the national Fisheries Code (RA 8550 as amended by RA 10654)[3], and call the committee secretary to confirm hearing logistics.

1:00 PM – You draft the legislative briefer: background, key provisions, constitutional and BOL basis, comparison with national law, fiscal impact estimate, stakeholder positions, and recommended committee actions. This is Complete Staff Work. The briefer must be so thorough that your MP only needs to read it, agree or disagree, and walk into the hearing prepared.

3:00 PM – Your MP reviews your draft and asks you to add a section on how the bill affects small fisherfolk in Tawi-Tawi and Basilan. You revise.

4:30 PM – A PAO brings in a constituent complaint about delayed agrarian reform in Maguindanao. You help draft a letter to MAFAR requesting a status update. This is constituent service, which Parliament staff handle alongside legislation.

5:00 PM – You finalize the briefer, run it through the quality checklist, and submit through the transmittal chain.

What this day tells you: Parliament work is cerebral. You read, write, analyze, and research. You are the intellectual engine behind the MP's legislative work. You rarely interact with communities directly (that is the PAO's role). Your output is documents: briefers, committee reports, bill drafts, speeches, policy papers.

6.3 Day-in-the-Life: Ministry Track

You are an Administrative Officer III (SG 14) at the Ministry of Social Services and Development (MSSD), assigned to the Social Protection Division.

7:30 AM – You arrive at the MSSD regional office. Your first task: review the weekly disbursement report for the BANGON (sustainable livelihood) program. Three municipalities in Maguindanao have not submitted their liquidation reports. Without those reports, the next tranche cannot be released.

8:30 AM – Team meeting with your Division Chief and six colleagues. The division is preparing for the mid-year OPCR review. Your Division Chief asks each staff member to report progress against IPCR targets. You report: 45 of 80 BANGON beneficiaries in your assigned municipalities have received starter kits. You are behind schedule because of LGU coordination delays in two island barangays in Tawi-Tawi.

10:00 AM – You draft a memorandum to MILG requesting coordination support for the Tawi-Tawi barangays. This is a routine inter-ministry memo: To, From, Date, Subject, body explaining the situation, specific action requested, deadline.

11:00 AM – A field report comes in from a municipal social worker: a family displaced by flooding in Lanao del Sur needs humanitarian assistance. You process the emergency request – checking eligibility, preparing the voucher, getting supervisor approval.

1:00 PM – You participate in a video call with a DSWD national office counterpart about the Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps) transition to MSSD. Intergovernmental coordination is common – BARMM handles its own social services, but some national programs are still being devolved.

2:30 PM – You work on a project proposal for a feeding program expansion in Basilan. This requires BDP alignment (Goal 4: Inclusive, Responsive, and Quality Social Services), budget justification under BAA 84,[4] and endorsement from the provincial government.

4:00 PM – You update the beneficiary tracking database. Data management is unglamorous but critical. The Commission on Audit will audit these records.

What this day tells you: Ministry work is operational. You implement programs, manage budgets, coordinate with LGUs, process paperwork, and track results. You see the direct impact of your work on communities. But you also spend significant time on compliance, reporting, and coordination.

6.4 Day-in-the-Life: Office/Agency Track

You are a Development Management Officer II (SG 13) at the Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority (BPDA).

8:00 AM – You review the latest regional poverty statistics from PSA. BARMM poverty incidence dropped from 54.20% (2018) to 29.80% (2021) – a 24.4 percentage point reduction.[10] You draft a data request to PSA-BARMM to verify whether this trend is holding.

9:00 AM – Your section chief assigns you to support the BDP mid-term review. You are responsible for collecting progress reports from four ministries (MBHTE, MOH, MSSD, MIPA) against BDP Goal 4 targets. This means preparing data collection templates, scheduling interviews with ministry focal persons, and consolidating findings.

10:30 AM – A development partner (UNDP) requests a meeting to discuss alignment of their governance support program with BDP priorities. You prepare talking points for your Executive Director, pulling relevant BDP targets and BARMM performance data.

1:00 PM – You attend an inter-agency planning workshop for the Annual Investment Program. Representatives from eight ministries present their priority projects. Your role: ensure each proposed project aligns with BDP goals and the 12-point priority agenda. You flag a PHP 200M infrastructure proposal that lacks BDP alignment documentation.

3:00 PM – You work on a policy brief analyzing BARMM's macroeconomic performance against BDP targets: GRDP growth at 7.5% (target: 8-9%), capital formation at 16.91% (target: 18-20%). You recommend specific interventions.

What this day tells you: Office/agency work is strategic. You plan, analyze, coordinate, and monitor. You interact with many ministries but belong to none. Your output is plans, frameworks, assessments, and policy recommendations. You see the big picture but may feel distant from frontline implementation.

6.5 Day-in-the-Life: LGU Track

You are a Municipal Planning and Development Coordinator designate (SG 11) in a 4th-class municipality in Lanao del Sur with a population of 18,000.

7:00 AM – You arrive at the municipal hall. The mayor asks you to prepare the Comprehensive Development Plan (CDP) update. This is a BAA 49 (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code) requirement.[5] The municipality's current CDP expired last year.

8:00 AM – You attend a barangay assembly in one of 15 barangays. Community members raise concerns: the road to the school is impassable during rain, the barangay health station has no midwife, and the water system broke three months ago. You take notes. These feed into the CDP.

10:00 AM – Back at the municipal hall, you process a request from MILG for the municipality's Statement of Receipts and Expenditures. The municipal accountant needs your help formatting the report.

11:00 AM – A provincial government representative arrives to discuss compliance with the 7 Elements of LGU Functionality (assessed by MILG). Your municipality is non-compliant on Element 5 (approved mandated plans) because the CDP is expired. This is your problem to solve.

1:00 PM – You draft a project proposal for a Level II water system for three barangays, to be submitted to MPW for funding. You need engineering specs (which you will request from MPW's provincial office), a site survey (which requires travel to remote barangays), and barangay council resolutions of endorsement (which requires coordinating with three barangay captains).

3:00 PM – A walk-in citizen asks about a land title issue. This is not your job – it belongs to the Municipal Assessor. But you help direct the citizen because you are the most accessible staff member in the building.

What this day tells you: LGU work is frontline. You are closest to the people. You do everything: planning, compliance, coordination, community engagement, even tasks outside your job description. Resources are thin, staff are few, and you are often the most educated person in the building. The work is grounding but demanding.

6.6 Salary Grade Progression by Track

Level	Parliament	Ministry	Office/Agency	LGU
Entry (SG 11)	Legislative Staff Officer I (~PHP 27,000/mo)	Administrative Aide VI / Staff Assistant (~PHP 27,000/mo)	Project Development Officer I (~PHP 27,000/mo)	Municipal Staff / Aide (~PHP 27,000/mo)
Junior (SG 13-15)	Legislative Staff Officer II-III (~PHP 30,000-38,000/mo)	Administrative Officer III / Analyst (~PHP 30,000-38,000/mo)	Development Management Officer II (~PHP 30,000-38,000/mo)	Municipal Planning Coordinator (~PHP 30,000-38,000/mo)
Mid-level (SG 18-20)	Senior Legislative Staff Officer I (~PHP 46,000-55,000/mo)	Senior Specialist / Section Chief (~PHP 46,000-55,000/mo)	Senior Development Officer (~PHP 46,000-55,000/mo)	Dept Head / Administrator (~PHP 46,000-55,000/mo)
Senior (SG 22-24)	Legislative Chief / Division Chief (~PHP	Division Chief / Assistant Director (~PHP	Division Chief (~PHP 65,000-85,000/mo)	– (LGU ceiling typically SG 22)

Level	Parliament	Ministry	Office/Agency	LGU
	65,000-85,000 /mo)	65,000-85,000 /mo)		
Executive (SG 25-28)	Director (~PHP 95,000-130,000/mo)	Director / Undersecretary (~PHP 95,000-130,000/mo)	Executive Director (~PHP 95,000-130,000/mo)	–
Leadership (SG 29-31)	Secretary General (~PHP 145,000+/mo)	Minister (~PHP 145,000+/mo)	–	Governor / Mayor (elected)

Important notes on salary:

- Figures are approximate based on the Salary Standardization Law (SSL) Step 1[6]
- Actual take-home is higher with COLA (Cost of Living Allowance), PERA (Personnel Economic Relief Allowance), and other allowances
- Government salaries are standardized. An SG 11 in Parliament earns the same base pay as an SG 11 in an LGU.
- Government compensation includes benefits the private sector often does not: GSIS retirement,[7] PhilHealth, Pag-IBIG, generous leave credits, Performance-Based Bonus, and security of tenure (for permanent appointments)

6.7 Decision Flowchart – Which Track Is Right for You?

Answer these questions in order:

Question 1: Do you enjoy reading, writing, and research more than fieldwork and community engagement? - Yes – Parliament or Office/Agency - No – Ministry or LGU

Question 2: Do you want to write laws and policies, or implement programs and services? - Write laws – **Parliament** - Implement programs – **Ministry** - Plan and coordinate – **Office/Agency** - Deliver directly to people – **LGU**

Question 3: Are you comfortable working in Cotabato City, or do you want to work in a province or municipality? - Cotabato City – Parliament, Ministry HQ, Office/Agency - Province – Ministry field office, LGU - Municipality or barangay – LGU

Question 4: Do you have a specialized degree (law, engineering, agriculture, health, education, finance)? - Yes – Ministry matching your specialization, or Parliament (for law graduates) - No (general degree: public administration, political science, management) – Parliament, Office/Agency, or any Ministry administrative track

Question 5: Do you want your career ceiling to be Director/Undersecretary level, or are you OK with Department Head level? - Director or higher – Parliament, Ministry, or Office/Agency (SG 25-28 positions exist) - Department Head is fine – LGU (ceiling is typically SG 22, but you can transfer to a ministry later)

Question 6: How do you feel about working in a small team with limited resources? - I prefer larger organizations with more structure – Ministry or Parliament - I thrive in lean environments where I wear many hats – Office/Agency or LGU

6.8 Position Titles and Salary Grades – Real Examples

Parliament Positions (Bangsamoro Parliament Secretariat)

Position	Salary Grade	Role
Legislative Staff Officer I	SG 11	Entry-level committee staff
Legislative Staff Officer II	SG 13	Experienced committee staff
Legislative Staff Officer III	SG 15	Senior committee staff
Senior Legislative Staff Officer I	SG 18	Lead analyst for a committee
Supervising Legislative Staff Officer I	SG 22	Supervises committee staff team
Legislative Chief	SG 24	Heads a legislative division
Director III	SG 27	Heads a department within the Secretariat

Ministry Positions (Typical Staffing Pattern)

Position	Salary Grade	Role
Administrative Aide VI	SG 6	Clerical support
Administrative Assistant III	SG 9	Records, filing, data entry
Administrative Officer III	SG 14	Budget, procurement, HR processing
Planning Officer III	SG 18	Program planning and M&E
Division Chief	SG 24	Leads a functional division
Director III	SG 27	Leads a bureau or service
Undersecretary	SG 30	Assists the Minister

LGU Positions (Under BAA 49 / Bangsamoro Local Governance Code)[8]

Position	Salary Grade	Notes
Municipal Planning and Development Coordinator	SG 22-24	Depends on municipality class
Municipal Budget Officer	SG 22-24	Depends on municipality class
Municipal Accountant	SG 22-24	Depends on municipality class
Municipal Health Officer	SG 23-24	Requires medical degree
Municipal Administrator	SG 24-25	SG 25 for 1st-2nd class; SG 24 for 3rd-4th class

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6.9 Switching Tracks

You are not locked into your first choice. BARMM government employees move between tracks through several mechanisms:[9]

Transfer – Moving from one MOA to another. Requires a vacancy in the receiving office, meeting the qualification standards, and release from the current office. Timeline: 1-3 months. You keep your salary grade.

Detailing – Temporary assignment to another office (30-90 days, extendable). Good for exploring a different track before committing. No change in salary or appointment status.

Secondment – Extended assignment to another government entity (6 months to 1 year). Common for inter-agency projects. You remain employed by your original office.

Reapplication – Resigning from one position and applying to another through the regular competitive process. Most permanent, but you lose seniority.

Promotion to a different track – If a higher-SG position opens in a different track and you meet the qualification standards, you can apply through the regular HRMPSB process.

Common Switching Patterns

- **LGU to Ministry**: After 2-3 years of frontline experience, apply to the ministry that supervises your sector (e.g., Municipal Health Officer to MOH regional office)
- **Ministry to Parliament**: After building technical expertise, move to a committee that covers your sector (e.g., MBHTE staff to the Committee on Education)
- **Office/Agency to Ministry**: After developing planning skills at BPDA, move to a ministry's planning division
- **Parliament to Office/Agency**: After building policy analysis skills, move to BPDA or a commission

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6.10 The Generalist vs. Specialist Question

	Generalist	Specialist
What it means	Broad skills across multiple functions (admin, budget, planning, coordination)	Deep expertise in one domain (health policy, agricultural economics, legislative drafting, environmental law)
Best tracks	LGU (you do everything), Office/Agency	Parliament (legislative drafting), Ministry (technical division)

	Generalist	Specialist
Career advantage	Flexibility – you can fill any role	Depth – you become the go-to expert and are harder to replace
Career risk	You may lack the depth required for senior technical positions	You may be pigeonholed and miss broader leadership opportunities
Fresh graduate advice	Start generalist if you do not know your specialization yet	Start specialist if your degree is technical (law, engineering, health, agriculture)

The practical reality: Most fresh graduates start as generalists by default. You take whatever position is available and learn along the way. That is fine. What matters is that you are intentional about building expertise over time. After 2-3 years, you should be able to say: "I specialize in budget analysis" or "I specialize in legislative research" or "I specialize in community-based disaster risk reduction." That clarity makes you promotable.

6.11 Understanding Parliament Staff Roles

If you are considering the Parliament track, you should know the three distinct staff roles. Each serves the Member of Parliament differently.

Legislative Staff Officer (LSO)

What you do: Research, analysis, and document production. You draft bills, prepare legislative briefers, write committee reports, conduct policy analysis, and support committee hearings with substantive content.

Key competencies: Investigation and research, policy analysis, legal and legislative competence, drafting quality, Complete Staff Work.

Who thrives here: People who love reading laws, analyzing policy options, writing structured documents, and working independently on complex research questions.

Typical daily output: Legislative briefers, bill comparison matrices, committee reports, policy papers, speech drafts with substantive policy content.

Political Affairs Officer (PAO)

What you do: Stakeholder engagement, constituency service, and representation. You handle constituent concerns, coordinate with LGUs and communities, manage the MP's schedule of public engagements, and facilitate dialogue between the MP and various stakeholders.

Key competencies: Stakeholder engagement, representation, advocacy, monitoring and evaluation, community relations.

Who thrives here: People who enjoy face-to-face engagement, relationship building, community immersion, and managing multiple competing requests from constituents.

Typical daily output: Constituent response letters, meeting reports, stakeholder position summaries, coordination memos with LGUs and ministries.

Public Information and Media Affairs Officer (PIMAO)

What you do: Communications, documentation, and media management. You manage the MP's social media presence, write press releases, document committee hearings and plenary sessions, handle media inquiries, and produce print and digital content.

Key competencies: Strategic communications, documentation, social media management, print and digital media production, media handling.

Who thrives here: People with skills in writing for public audiences, photography, videography, graphic design, and social media content creation.

Typical daily output: Social media posts, press releases, photo/video documentation of sessions and events, media briefing notes.

How the Three Roles Work Together

In a typical MP's office, the LSO provides the intellectual substance, the PAO manages the constituency relationships, and the PIMAO communicates the MP's work to the public. All three roles require Complete Staff Work, but the nature of the work differs significantly.

Fresh graduate guidance: If you are a law, political science, or public administration graduate, the LSO track is your natural entry. If you are a communications, journalism, or multimedia graduate, the PIMAO track fits. If you are a community development, social work, or public affairs graduate, the PAO track suits you.

6.12 Matching Your Degree to a Track

Your degree does not lock you into one track, but it gives you a natural advantage in certain positions.

Degree	Natural Track	Specific Offices
Law / Legal Management	Parliament (LSO), Ministry (Legal)	Parliament committees, BAGO,[11] any office's legal unit
Public Administration / Political Science	Parliament, Office/Agency	Parliament, BPDA, any MOA admin division
Social Work / Community Development	Ministry (MSSD), LGU	MSSD, MILG, municipal social welfare
Education	Ministry (MBHTE)	MBHTE schools, education planning
Nursing / Public Health	Ministry (MOH)	MOH, provincial/municipal health offices
Agriculture / Fisheries	Ministry (MAFAR), LGU	MAFAR, municipal agriculture offices
Accounting / Finance	Ministry (MFBM), any MOA	MFBM, any office's finance unit
Engineering (Civil/Electrical)	Ministry (MPW)	MPW, infrastructure project offices
IT / Computer Science	Office/Agency (BICTO),[12] any MOA	BICTO, any office's IT unit
Communications / Journalism	Parliament (PIMAO), Office	BIO, Parliament PIMAO, any office's comms unit
Environmental Science	Ministry (MENRE)	MENRE, BRDRRMO
Economics / Statistics	Office/Agency (BPDA), Ministry	BPDA, MFBM, MTIT

If your degree is not listed: Most general degrees (management, liberal arts, humanities) qualify you for administrative positions across all four tracks. Your degree gets you in the door; your performance determines your career.

6.13 Actionable Tool: "Career Track Decision Worksheet"

Complete this worksheet before applying. It takes 15 minutes and saves you months of being in the wrong track.

Question	Your Answer	Track Implication
My degree is: ___		Technical degree = Ministry specialist track
I enjoy reading/writing/ research: Yes / Somewhat / No		Yes = Parliament or Office/ Agency
I want to work directly with communities: Yes / Somewhat / No		Yes = LGU or Ministry field office
I want to work in Cotabato City: Yes / No / Either		Yes = Parliament, Ministry HQ, Office/Agency
My preferred salary entry point: SG 8-11 / SG 11-15		SG 8-11 = LGU; SG 11-15 = Parliament, Ministry, Office/ Agency
I want to write laws and policies: Yes / No		Yes = Parliament
I want to manage programs and budgets: Yes / No		Yes = Ministry
I want to plan and coordinate across agencies: Yes / No		Yes = Office/Agency (BPDA, BEDC)
I want to be closest to people served: Yes / No		Yes = LGU
My top 2 tracks (based on above):	1. ___ 2. ___	Research these tracks in Chapters 3 and 4

After completing this worksheet: Look up your top two tracks in Chapter 3 (government structure) to identify specific offices. Then check Chapter 7 (job openings) for current vacancies in those offices.

Key Takeaways

- BARMM has **four career tracks**: Parliament, Ministry, Office/Agency, and LGU. Each offers a different working life.
- **Parliament** is for people who love reading, writing, and policy analysis
- **Ministry** is for people who want to implement programs and see direct community impact
- **Office/Agency** is for people who want to plan, coordinate, and see the big picture
- **LGU** is for people who want to be closest to the communities they serve
- Salary grades are **standardized** – an SG 11 earns the same base pay in any track
- You can **switch tracks** later through transfer, detailing, secondment, or reapplication
- **Choose intentionally**, but do not agonize. Your first position is an entry point, not a life sentence.

Now that you know which track fits you, Part II begins. The next three chapters are the most practical in this guidebook: how to find job openings, how to apply, and how to ace the interview.

1. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. VII (establishing the Bangsamoro Parliament). ↩
2. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 2, art. V (enumerated powers of the Bangsamoro government). ↩
3. Rep. Act No. 8550 (Philippine Fisheries Code of 1998), as amended by Rep. Act No. 10654 (2015). ↩
4. BAA No. 84 (Bangsamoro Budget System Act). ↩
5. BAA No. 49 (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code). ↩
6. Rep. Act No. 11466 (Salary Standardization Law V), sec. 7 (Salary Grade Table). ↩
7. Rep. Act No. 8291 (Government Service Insurance System Act of 1997). ↩
8. BAA No. 49, Title V (Local Government Officers and Employees). ↩

9. BAA No. 17, secs. 27-30 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code – transfer, detail, secondment, and reassignment). ↩
10. Philippine Statistics Authority, Official Poverty Statistics, Full Year 2018 and 2021; 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 1, Table 1.1. ↩
11. BAA No. 5 (creating the Bangsamoro Attorney General's Office). ↩
12. BAA No. 13, Book V, Title XIV (Bangsamoro Information and Communications Technology Office). ↩

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Chapter 7: Finding Job Openings

Government jobs are posted publicly – but not always where you would expect. Here is where to look and how to search smart.

You have decided you want to work in the Bangsamoro government. You know the structure (Chapter 3), the employment framework (Chapter 4), the development plan (Chapter 5), and which track fits you (Chapter 6). Now you need to find an actual job opening.

This chapter shows you every channel – formal and informal – where BARMM positions are posted. It also covers alternative entry points for fresh graduates who do not yet have civil service eligibility. By the end, you will have a system for tracking openings so nothing slips through.

Part II: Getting the Job

Chapters 7, 8, and 9 are the most practical chapters in this guidebook. A fresh graduate should be able to read all three, follow the steps, and submit a competitive application without outside help.

7.1 The Formal Channels

These are the places where positions are **legally required** to be posted. If a vacancy is not posted through at least one of these channels, the appointment may be challenged.

CSC Job Portal (csc.gov.ph/career)

The **Civil Service Commission Job Portal** is the national government's official job board. It is your most reliable source for BARMM positions.

How to use it:

1. Go to **csc.gov.ph/career** (not "CSC KIOSK" – that is a different system)
2. Create a free account using your email address
3. Complete your profile – this allows you to set job alerts
4. Filter by **Region: BARMM** (or Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao)
5. Filter further by salary grade, location, or position title if desired
6. Set up **email alerts** so you receive notifications when new BARMM positions are posted

What you will find:

- Position title, salary grade, and monthly salary
- Office or ministry posting the vacancy
- Qualification standards: education, experience, training, and eligibility requirements
- Posting date and closing date (minimum 10 calendar days)[1]
- Application instructions and contact information

Practical tip: Check the portal at least twice a week. Some positions are posted for exactly 10 days (the minimum), so checking weekly may cause you to miss the deadline.

BARMM Official Gazette

BAA 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code)[2] requires that all vacancies be published in the BARMM Official Gazette. This is the legal publication channel.

How to navigate it:

- Visit the BARMM Official Gazette website or the BARMM government portal
- Look for the "Vacancies" or "Career Opportunities" section
- Check the gazette regularly – new issues are published periodically
- Note both the **posting date** and the **closing date** on each announcement

What makes the Gazette different from the CSC portal: The Gazette is the official legal publication. If there is any discrepancy between what you see on the CSC portal and what the Gazette says, the Gazette version is authoritative.

Bangsamoro Parliament Website

Legislative staff positions – the Parliament track described in Chapter 6 – are posted through the Parliament's own channels.

What to look for:

- Secretariat positions (administrative, finance, records, IT)
- Committee support staff (LSO, PAO, PIMAO positions)
- Project-based positions tied to specific legislative activities

Where to find it: Check the official Bangsamoro Parliament website and its official social media pages.

Individual MOA Websites and Facebook Pages

Most ministries and offices maintain their own websites and Facebook pages. Many post vacancies on these platforms **before** the gazette announcement appears.

Offices to monitor:

- Your target ministry or office's official Facebook page
- BPDA (which coordinates across all offices)
- MBHTE (largest ministry by staffing – frequent vacancies)
- MOH (health worker positions posted regularly)
- MPW (engineering and project management positions)
- Parliament Secretariat social media

Practical tip: Follow the official Facebook pages of your top three target offices. Turn on notifications. Ministry HR offices often post vacancies on Facebook the same day they submit them to the CSC portal, giving you a few extra days to prepare your application.

CSC Posting Requirements

Under CSC rules, all vacancies must be posted for a **minimum of 10 calendar days**.[3] This applies to both internal posting (within the office) and external posting (on the CSC portal). The 10-day clock starts from the date of posting, not the date you see it.

What this means for you:

- You have at least 10 days from posting to submit your application
- Some offices post for longer (15-30 days), especially for hard-to-fill positions[4]
- If you see a posting with only 2-3 days remaining, move fast. Prepare your documents today and submit tomorrow.

7.2 The Informal Channels

The formal channels are where jobs are officially posted. But the reality is that most people first **hear** about openings through informal channels. Understanding this is not about gaming the system. It is about being realistic.

Networking

Attending BARMM events, university alumni gatherings, and professional association meetings puts you in contact with people who work in the government. They know which offices are hiring, which positions are about to be posted, and what the office is actually looking for.

Where to network:

- University alumni associations (especially MSU, Notre Dame, Cotabato Foundation College of Science and Technology, Mindanao State University system campuses)
- Professional associations relevant to your field (education, health, agriculture, law)
- BARMM-sponsored conferences, forums, and consultations (often open to the public)
- Development partner events (UNDP, JICA, World Bank activities in BARMM)

How to network effectively:

- Introduce yourself and state your interest in government service clearly
- Ask questions about the office's work, not about vacancies directly
- Follow up with a thank-you message and maintain the connection
- Share relevant articles or resources – be useful, not transactional

Faculty Referrals

Your professors may know ministry contacts, especially in education, agriculture, health, and public administration. Faculty members who have served as consultants, resource persons, or advisers to BARMM offices can provide introductions.

How to approach your professors:

- Be specific: "I am interested in applying to MBHTE's Planning Division. Do you know anyone I could talk to about what the work involves?"
- Offer to share your PDS or resume so they can forward it if appropriate

- Do not ask them to "get you in." Ask them to introduce you so you can learn about the office.

Social Media Monitoring

Several Facebook groups and pages regularly share BARMM job postings:

- Official ministry and office Facebook pages (mentioned above)
- BARMM-related job posting groups
- Civil service exam review and career groups
- Bangsamoro professional networks

Practical tip: Create a separate email folder or social media bookmark for job postings. When you see a posting, save it immediately with the closing date. Do not rely on seeing it again in your news feed.

Walk-In Inquiries

Visiting HR offices directly with your PDS and cover letter is a legitimate strategy in BARMM. Many offices are actively looking for qualified applicants and appreciate proactive candidates.

How to do a walk-in:

1. Dress in business formal (the same attire you would wear to an interview)
2. Bring a printed copy of your complete application package (see Chapter 8)
3. Ask to speak with someone in the HR unit or the HRMPSB secretariat
4. Introduce yourself: "I am interested in serving in this office. Are there current or upcoming vacancies I could apply for?"
5. If there are no current openings, ask if you can leave your PDS on file for future reference
6. Get the name and contact information of the person you spoke with

The ethics of networking: There is an important line between **legitimate networking** (learning about opportunities, building professional relationships, demonstrating interest) and **patronage** (using political connections to bypass the merit process). BAA 17's merit and fitness principle applies regardless of how you learned about the opening.[5] A referral can get your application noticed, but only your qualifications can get you hired through the HRMPSB process.[6]

7.3 Alternative Entry Points

If you are a fresh graduate without civil service eligibility or significant work experience, you may not yet qualify for regular plantilla positions. That does not mean you cannot start working in government. These alternative entry points let you build experience while you prepare for permanent employment.

Contract of Service (COS)

What it is: A project-based employment arrangement.[7] You are hired for a specific project or function, typically for 6-12 months, renewable depending on funding and performance.

Requirements: - No CSC eligibility required - Relevant educational background (bachelor's degree for professional positions) - Specific skills matching the project needs

What you get: - Monthly compensation (varies, often equivalent to SG 11-15 rates) - Valuable government experience that counts toward future applications - Exposure to government systems, processes, and culture

What you do not get: - Security of tenure - GSIS retirement benefits - Leave credits (in most cases) - Automatic conversion to permanent appointment

Why it matters: COS experience listed on your PDS demonstrates that you can function in a government office. When you later apply for a permanent position, this experience fills the "relevant work experience" gap that fresh graduates normally face.

Job Order (JO)

What it is: A task-based arrangement.[8] You are paid on an hourly, daily, or task basis for specific deliverables. Common for administrative support, IT work, event coordination, and data encoding.

Requirements: - No CSC eligibility required - Specific skills matching the task

What you get: - Compensation for completed work - First exposure to how government offices operate - References for future applications

What you do not get: - Benefits of any kind - Employer-employee relationship (you are technically a service provider) - Long-term commitment from the office

When to consider JO: If you have no other way to enter government and need immediate income while preparing for the CSC exam. JO work is short-term by design. Treat it as a stepping stone, not a career.

Consultant / Resource Person

What it is: A professional engagement for specialized expertise. You are hired to deliver a specific output – a study, a training program, a technical report, a system design – within a defined period.

Requirements: - Specialized expertise (this is not an entry-level option for most fresh graduates) - Relevant academic credentials or professional certifications - However, fresh graduates with strong thesis work or unique technical skills (data analysis, GIS, web development, graphic design) may qualify for short-term consultancy engagements

Practical tip: If your thesis produced original research relevant to BARMM (education data, health surveys, agricultural assessments, governance analysis), approach the relevant ministry and offer your findings. This can lead to short-term consultancy work.

Internship and On-the-Job Training (OJT)

What it is: Most government agencies accept interns and OJT students from partner universities. While this is typically arranged through your university, some offices accept walk-in intern applications.

How to apply: 1. Check with your university's OJT coordinator for existing MOAs with BARMM offices 2. If no MOA exists, write directly to the HR unit of your target office requesting intern placement 3. Specify the dates, duration, and skills you want to develop 4. Be prepared to work without compensation (some offices provide allowances, most do not)

How internship converts to employment:

Internship does not guarantee a job. But it gives you three things that other applicants lack: - **Familiarity** with the office's systems, people, and culture - **References** from supervisors who have seen your work - **Documentation** of specific tasks you performed (critical for your PDS)

Scholarship-to-Employment Pipelines

Several BARMM scholarship programs include **return service obligations** – meaning scholars commit to working in BARMM government after graduation. If you are still in school or recently graduated under one of these programs, you may have a direct employment pathway.

AHME (Access to Higher and Modern Education Scholarship Program)

- Administered by **MBHTE** (Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education)[9]

- BARMM's flagship scholarship program
- Covers tuition and other educational expenses
- Includes a **return service obligation** to BARMM government
- Scholars are expected to serve in BARMM institutions after completing their degrees

BASE/BASE-MERIT (Bangsamoro Assistance for Science Education)

- Administered by **MOST** (Ministry of Science and Technology)[10]
- Focused on **STEM fields** (science, technology, engineering, mathematics)
- Includes a **return service commitment** to BARMM government
- Designed to build the region's science and technology workforce

CHED/BARMM Scholarship Programs

- Check with BPDA and MBHTE for current pipelines
- Some programs are coordinated with the Commission on Higher Education
- Return service terms vary by program

If you are a scholar with a return service obligation: Contact your scholarship program administrator to ask about placement procedures. Some programs have dedicated placement units that match scholars with offices.

7.4 For Fresh Graduates: Your Search Strategy

Finding a government job is not a one-time effort. It is a campaign. Here is how to run it effectively.

Start Early

Begin searching **3-6 months before graduation**. Government hiring timelines are long (2-4 months from posting to appointment). If you start looking after graduation, you may wait 6-8 months before you start working.

Target COS/JO First

If you do not yet have CSC eligibility, target **COS and JO positions** first. These build experience while you prepare for the CSC Professional or Sub-Professional exam. Many successful government employees entered through COS before converting to permanent positions.

Apply to Multiple Positions

Do not apply to one position and wait for a response before applying to others. The government hiring process is slow. Apply to **multiple positions simultaneously** across different offices. This increases your chances and gives you options.

Be Strategic About Location

If you are flexible about location, your options expand significantly. Offices in Cotabato City receive the most applications. Field offices in provincial capitals and municipalities receive fewer applications, meaning less competition for positions.

Track Everything

Use a systematic tracking method. A simple spreadsheet works:

Position Title	Office	SG	Posting Date	Closing Date	Documents Submitted	Status	Follow-Up Date	Notes
LSO I	Parliament - Committee on Education	11	Mar 15, 2026	Mar 25, 2026	Complete - Mar 20	Submitted	Apr 20	Via CSC portal
Admin Officer III	MSSD - Social Protection Div	14	Mar 18, 2026	Mar 28, 2026	Preparing	–	–	Need NBI clearance

Position Title	Office	SG	Posting Date	Closing Date	Documents Submitted	Status	Follow-Up Date	Notes
COS - Project Officer	BPDA - Planning Division	–	Mar 20, 2026	Apr 3, 2026	Complete - Mar 25	Submitted	Apr 25	Walk-in submission

The Weekly Routine

Build job searching into your weekly schedule:

- **Monday**: Check CSC Job Portal and BARMM Gazette for new postings
- **Wednesday**: Check Facebook pages of your target offices
- **Friday**: Follow up on pending applications (if past 30 days since submission) and update your tracker

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7.5 Understanding What You See in a Job Posting

Government job postings follow a standard format. Here is how to read one:

Sample Posting (Annotated)

```
REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES
BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION IN MUSLIM MINDANAO
MINISTRY OF SOCIAL SERVICES AND DEVELOPMENT

PUBLICATION OF VACANT POSITIONS

Position Title:     Administrative Officer III        ← What you'll be calle
d
Plantilla Item No:  MSSD-AO3-15-2026                 ← Unique identifier
Salary Grade:       14                                 ← Determines your
pay (~PHP 33,000/mo)
Monthly Salary:     PHP 33,843.00                      ← Before deductions
Place of Assignment: Social Protection Division, MSSD  ← Where you'll sit

QUALIFICATION STANDARDS:
Education:          Bachelor's degree relevant to the job ← Your degree
must match
Experience:         1 year of relevant experience         ← COS/JO/voluntee
r counts
Training:           4 hours of relevant training          ← Seminars, webin
ars count
Eligibility:        CS Professional / 2nd Level Eligible   ← You need this

Posting Date:       March 15, 2026
Closing Date:       March 25, 2026                        ← Hard deadline

Interested applicants may submit their application to the
MSSD Human Resource Management Office, 2nd Floor, MSSD Building,
Cotabato City. For inquiries, contact [phone/email].
```

Key Things to Check

Do you meet ALL four qualification standards? - **Education**: Does your degree match? “Relevant to the job” means the HR office has discretion, but your degree should reasonably connect to the position’s functions. - **Experience**: “1 year of relevant experience” means paid or unpaid work related to the position. COS, JO, OJT, and volunteer work count if documented. - **Training**: “4 hours” means any seminar, webinar, or workshop relevant to the position. Check your certificates. - **Eligibility**: “CS Professional” or “2nd Level Eligible” means you need to have passed the Career Service Professional exam, or hold a board/bar certificate (RA 1080 automatic eligibility for CPAs, engineers, lawyers, etc.)[11]

If you meet 3 of 4: Apply anyway, but be transparent about the gap. Some offices will consider you if the position is hard to fill. However, for permanent appointments, all four QS must be met.

7.6 Actionable Tool: "Job Search Tracker"

Print this template or create it as a spreadsheet. Update it every time you find a new posting or take action on an existing application.

#	Position Title	Office/Ministry	SG	Monthly Salary	Posting Date	Closing Date	QS Met? (E/Ex/T/El)	Documents Ready?	Date Submitted	Submission Method	Status	Follow-Up Date	Notes
1							/ / /	Y/N		Portal/Walk-in/Email			
2							/ / /	Y/N					
3							/ / /						

#	Position Title	Office/Ministry	SG	Monthly Salary	Posting Date	Closing Date	QS Met? (E/Ex/T/El)	Documents Ready?	Date Submitted	Submission Method	Status	Follow-Up Date	Notes
								Y/N					
4							/ / /	Y/N					
5							/ / /	Y/N					

Column guide: - **QS Met**: E = Education, Ex = Experience, T = Training, El = Eligibility. Mark each with a checkmark or X. - **Documents Ready**: All 12 items from the Chapter 8 application package checklist - **Status**: Preparing / Submitted / Screening / Interview Scheduled / Interviewed / Awaiting Results / Appointed / Regret Letter - **Follow-Up Date**: 30 days after submission (polite follow-up is professional)

Key Takeaways

- **Formal channels**: CSC Job Portal (csc.gov.ph/career), BARMM Official Gazette, Parliament website, and individual MOA websites and Facebook pages
- **Informal channels**: Networking, faculty referrals, social media monitoring, and walk-in inquiries are legitimate and effective
- **Alternative entry points** for fresh graduates: COS, JO, consultancy, internship, and scholarship-to-employment pipelines (AHME, BASE/BASE-MERIT)

- **Start searching 3-6 months before graduation** and apply to multiple positions simultaneously
- **Track everything** in a spreadsheet. Check postings at least twice a week.
- The CSC portal requires a minimum **10-day posting period**. Move fast when you see a posting with only a few days remaining.
- **Networking is not patronage**. Learning about opportunities through professional relationships is legitimate. Getting hired through the HRMPSB process based on merit is required.

You know where to look. The next chapter tells you exactly how to apply – every document, every step, every scoring criterion.

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1. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018 (Revised Rules on the Publication and Posting of Vacant Positions), sec. 4. ↩
2. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code), sec. 26 (Publication of Vacancies). ↩
3. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018, *supra* note 1, sec. 4. ↩
4. *Id.*, sec. 5 (extended posting periods for hard-to-fill positions). ↩
5. BAA No. 17, *supra* note 2, sec. 3 (Merit and Fitness Principle). ↩
6. *Id.*, secs. 27-30 (Qualification Standards and Merit Promotion and Selection Board). ↩
7. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 2, s. 2017 (Guidelines on Contracts of Service and Job Orders in Government), sec. 3. ↩
8. *Id.*, sec. 4. ↩
9. BAA No. 13, Book IV, Title I (Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education); MBHTE Administrative Order establishing the AHME Program. ↩
10. BAA No. 13, Book IV, Title XII (Ministry of Science and Technology). ↩
11. Rep. Act No. 1080, sec. 1 (granting automatic civil service eligibility to board and bar examination passers). *See also* Chapter 8, sec. 8.2 of this guidebook for the full list of RA 1080 professions. ↩

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Chapter 8: The Application Process

Getting hired in BARMM government is a structured process with specific steps and scoring criteria. No guessing. Here is exactly what happens.

This chapter walks you through every step of the application process, from checking qualification standards to submitting your complete application package. If you follow this chapter carefully, your application will be complete, compliant, and competitive. Most applicants are eliminated not because they lack qualifications, but because they submit incomplete or poorly prepared applications.

8.1 The Application Process – Step by Step

Here is the full process from finding a vacancy to receiving your appointment:

```
Step 1 → Find the vacancy posting (Chapter 7)
Step 2 → Check if you meet the Qualification Standards (QS)
Step 3 → Prepare your application package
Step 4 → Submit before the deadline
Step 5 → Wait for the HRMPSB to screen your application
Step 6 → Receive notice of interview/exam (if shortlisted)
Step 7 → Attend interview and assessment (Chapter 9)
Step 8 → Wait for the Comparative Assessment results
Step 9 → Receive appointment or regret letter
```

Total timeline: Expect **2-4 months** from posting to appointment. Some offices move faster, others slower. Do not panic if you do not hear back for several weeks.

The rest of this chapter covers Steps 2-6 in detail. Step 7 (the interview) is covered entirely in Chapter 9.

8.2 Understanding Qualification Standards (QS)

Every government position has four qualification requirements.[1] You must meet all four for a permanent appointment. Understanding these requirements prevents you from wasting time on positions you do not qualify for – and helps you identify where your strengths lie.

The Four Requirements

Requirement	What It Means	Example (Admin Officer III, SG 14)
Education	The academic degree required	Bachelor's degree relevant to the job
Experience	Years and type of prior work	1 year of relevant experience
Training	Hours of relevant professional development	4 hours of relevant training
Eligibility	Civil service or professional license	Career Service Professional / 2nd Level Eligible

Where to Find Qualification Standards

- **The vacancy posting itself** (always lists the QS)
- **CSC Qualification Standards Manual**[2] (the master reference for all government positions)
- **The HR office** of the posting agency (they can clarify any questions about the QS)

For Fresh Graduates – Your Sweet Spot

Most entry-level positions (**SG 11-15**) require: - A bachelor's degree (you have this or are about to have it) - **Minimal experience** (0-1 year – this is where COS/JO/volunteer work fills the gap) - **Minimal training** (4-8 hours – a single webinar or seminar satisfies this) - CSC eligibility (Professional or Sub-Professional)

This means your **primary barrier** is usually eligibility. If you do not yet have CSC eligibility, prioritize getting it.

How to Get CSC Eligibility

Career Service Professional (CSP) Exam: - Administered by the Civil Service Commission - Pen-and-paper exam covering vocabulary, grammar, reading comprehension, analogy, logic, numerical reasoning, and general information[13] - Passing score: 80% - Schedule: CSC announces exam dates periodically (usually 2-3 times per year) - Register at the nearest CSC Regional/Field Office - This gives you **2nd Level Eligibility**[3] – required for professional positions (SG 11 and above)

Career Service Sub-Professional (CSSP) Exam: - Same administration as CSP but covers slightly different content - Passing score: 80% - Gives you **1st Level Eligibility** – required for sub-professional positions (SG 10 and below)

RA 1080 (Automatic Eligibility for Board/Bar Passers):[4]

If you have passed a professional board exam or the Bar exam, you are **automatically eligible** for government positions. No need to take the CSC exam separately.

License	Eligibility Level	Example Positions
Bar (lawyer)	2nd Level + practicing attorney	Legal Officer, Attorney, Legislative Staff Officer
CPA (accountant)	2nd Level	Accountant, Budget Officer, Financial Analyst
REE/RME (engineer)	2nd Level	Engineer, Project Manager, Infrastructure Specialist
RN (nurse)	2nd Level	Nurse, Health Program Officer
LPT (licensed teacher)	2nd Level	Teacher, Education Program Specialist
Other PRC-regulated professions	2nd Level	Varies by profession

The Board/Bar passer advantage: RA 1080[5] eligibility is scored the same as CSP eligibility in the Comparative Assessment. However, a specialized license (e.g., CPA applying for an accountant position) demonstrates a higher level of qualification than generic CSP eligibility.

8.3 Your Application Package – Complete Checklist

This is the complete list of documents you need to submit. Missing even one document can delay or disqualify your application. Prepare everything **before** you start applying, so you can submit quickly when you find a suitable posting.

Document 1: Application Letter / Cover Letter

Your cover letter is your first impression. It introduces you, states the position you are applying for, and explains why you want to serve in BARMM government.

What to include: - The **specific position** and **plantilla item number** you are applying for - **Why you want to serve in BARMM** – connect your motivation to the BDP, the peace process, or the office's specific mandate - Your **relevant qualifications** – education, thesis topic, skills that match the position - A closing sentence requesting consideration

What NOT to include: - Salary expectations (government salaries are standardized) - Personal problems or financial difficulties - Desperation ("I need this job because...") - Flattery that is not grounded in facts

For fresh graduates: Lead with your thesis, capstone project, or academic achievements – not your lack of experience. "My thesis on community-based disaster risk management in Lanao del Sur gave me direct research experience in the communities MSSD serves" is stronger than "Although I have no work experience, I am eager to learn."

Sample cover letter structure:

```
[Date]

[Name and Title of HRMPSB Chair or Head of Office]
[Office Name]
[Address]

Dear [Sir/Ma'am or specific name]:

[Paragraph 1 - State the position]
I am writing to apply for the position of Administrative Officer III
(Plantilla Item No. MSSD-AO3-15-2026) posted on the CSC Job Portal on
March 15, 2026.

[Paragraph 2 - Why BARMM/this office]
I want to serve in the Ministry of Social Services and Development because
its mandate directly supports BDP Goal 4: inclusive, responsive, and quality
social services. My degree in Social Work from [university] and my thesis on
livelihood interventions in conflict-affected communities in Maguindanao
prepared me to contribute to MSSD's social protection programs.

[Paragraph 3 - Qualifications summary]
I graduated [honors if applicable] with a Bachelor of Science in Social
Work.
I completed a 600-hour OJT at [organization], where I assisted in
beneficiary
validation for a livelihood program serving 120 families. I have passed the
Career Service Professional examination (Rating: [score], [date]).

[Paragraph 4 - Closing]
I have enclosed my complete application package as indicated in the vacancy
posting. I am available for interview at your convenience. Thank you for
considering my application.

Respectfully,

[Signature]
[Full Name]
[Contact Number]
[Email Address]
```

Document 2: Personal Data Sheet (CS Form 212, Revised 2017)

The **Personal Data Sheet (PDS)** is the government's standard CV format.[6] It replaces the private sector resume. Every government applicant must submit one. It is four pages long.

Where to get it: Download CS Form 212 (Revised 2017) from the CSC website (csc.gov.ph).[7] Use only the official form. Do not create your own format.

Critical fields fresh graduates often miss:

Work Experience Section: - If you have no paid work experience, leave this section **blank**. Do not fabricate entries. - COS and JO work **should** be listed here if documented (you had a contract or work order) - OJT counts if it was part of your academic program and you have a certificate

Training Section: - Include ALL relevant seminars, workshops, and webinars – even university-sponsored ones - Online courses (Coursera, edX, LinkedIn Learning) count if you have a certificate - CSC-sponsored webinars count - Format: title of training, provider, date, number of hours

Voluntary Work or Involvement in Civic/Non-Government Organizations: - **This is where fresh graduates build their profile.** Include: - Student organization roles (president, secretary, treasurer, committee chair) - Volunteer work (community outreach, disaster response, barangay programs) - Church/mosque youth programs - CSO/NGO volunteer activities - Tutoring, mentoring, community teaching

Civil Service Eligibility: - If you have RA 1080 (board/bar passer), enter it here. Many fresh graduates forget. - Enter: type of eligibility, rating, date of examination, place of examination, license number (if applicable)

Common PDS mistakes that lead to disqualification: 1. Unsigned pages (every page must be signed) 2. Missing passport-size photo (required on page 1) 3. Inconsistent dates (check that your dates match your TOR and certificates) 4. Blank Civil Service Eligibility section when you have RA 1080 5. Using an outdated form (must be Revised 2017 version) 6. Not filling in the "declaration" section at the end (questions about administrative cases, criminal charges, etc. – answer honestly)

Document 3: Work Experience Sheet (CS Form 212 Attachment)

Required **only** if you have prior employment. This form provides details for each position listed in your PDS Work Experience section. If you are a fresh graduate with no work history, you may skip this.

Document 4: Transcript of Records (TOR)

- Must be a **certified true copy** from your university (not a photocopy)
- Request it from your Registrar's Office

- If you have not yet graduated, submit a certification of units earned and expected graduation date

Document 5: Diploma

- **Certified true copy** from your university
- If not yet graduated, a certification from the Dean's Office will suffice

Document 6: CSC Eligibility Proof

- **Certificate of Eligibility** (from CSC – for CSP/CSSP passers)
- **PRC Board Certificate** or **PRC ID** (for board passers)
- **Bar Certificate** (for lawyers)
- Request authenticated copies if your originals are with another office

Document 7: Training Certificates

- Certificates for all seminars, workshops, conferences, and online courses listed in your PDS
- Organize chronologically (most recent first)
- Include the number of hours if printed on the certificate

Document 8: NBI Clearance

- Must be **current** (not expired)
- Apply at the nearest NBI office or satellite
- Processing time: 1-5 business days (plan ahead)

Document 9: Barangay Clearance

- From your **current place of residence**
- Available at your barangay hall
- Usually same-day processing

Document 10: Community Tax Certificate (Cedula)

- **Current year** (CTC for the year of application)
- Available at your municipal/city hall
- Small fee (based on income)

Document 11: Photos

- **2×2** and **passport-size photos**
- White background
- Recent (within the last 6 months)
- Formal attire
- Bring extra copies (some offices require multiple sets)

Document 12: Birth Certificate (PSA-Authenticated)

- Issued by the Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA)
- Required for appointment processing (not always required at application stage, but have it ready)
- Order online through PSAHelpline.ph or visit a PSA outlet/Serbilis center

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8.4 The Comparative Assessment – How You Are Scored

After the HR office screens your application and confirms you meet the qualification standards, your application goes to the **Human Resource Merit Promotion and Selection Board (HRMPSB)**.[8] The HRMPSB evaluates you using the **Comparative Assessment** – a scoring system that ranks all qualified applicants.[9]

The Scoring Breakdown

Criteria	Weight	What Is Evaluated	Fresh Graduate Impact
Education	25%	Degree relevance, honors, graduate units	Your strongest area – maximize it
Experience	25%	Years and relevance of work experience	Your weakest area – COS/JO/volunteer work helps
Training	15%	Relevant seminars, workshops, certifications	Build this NOW – attend free government webinars

Criteria	Weight	What Is Evaluated	Fresh Graduate Impact
Eligibility	10%	Type and level of CS eligibility	Pass the CSP exam or use RA 1080
Interview	25%	CBI performance, fit assessment	Prepare thoroughly – this is where you recover points (Chapter 9)

These weights are prescribed by CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018.[10]

The Math for Fresh Graduates

Look at the weights carefully:

- **Education (25%)**: You will likely score **high** here. Your degree is recent, relevant, and possibly includes honors or relevant coursework.
- **Experience (25%)**: You will likely score **low** here. This is your weakest area. But COS, JO, OJT, volunteer work, and student organization leadership all count as relevant experience if documented properly.
- **Training (15%)**: This is a **swing factor**. Every webinar, seminar, and workshop you attend adds points. Attend free government webinars (CSC, BPDA, ministry-sponsored events) starting now.
- **Eligibility (10%)**: Binary – you either have it or you do not. Pass the CSP exam or use RA 1080.
- **Interview (25%)**: This is your **biggest swing factor**. A strong interview can compensate for limited experience. Chapter 9 is dedicated entirely to interview preparation.

The bottom line: Education (25%) + Interview (25%) + Eligibility (10%) = **60%** of your total score that you can maximize as a fresh graduate. Even with low Experience scores, a well-prepared fresh graduate can be competitive.

How to Build Experience Without a Job

You do not need formal employment to build relevant experience. These activities count on your PDS if documented properly:

- **OJT / Internship** – your university-required on-the-job training

- **Volunteer work in LGUs** – assisting barangay offices, joining disaster response teams
- **Mosque or church community programs** – organizing youth activities, community outreach
- **CSO project assistance** – working with NGOs or civic organizations on community projects
- **Student organization leadership** – planning events, managing budgets, coordinating teams
- **Thesis fieldwork** – if your research involved community engagement, data collection, or stakeholder interviews

Critical requirement: You must have **documentation** for any experience you list. A certificate, letter of completion, or signed endorsement from the organization. Undocumented experience cannot be scored.

8.5 Posting and Timeline

Understanding the timeline helps you plan and manage expectations.

Stage	Typical Duration
Vacancy posted (minimum)	10 calendar days[11]
Screening by HRMPSB	2-4 weeks after posting closes
Interview scheduling	1-2 weeks after screening
Interview and assessment	1 day (your part)
HRMPSB deliberation and ranking	1-2 weeks after interviews
Appointment decision	1-4 weeks after ranking
Total from posting to appointment	**2-4 months (typical)**

Can you follow up? Yes. After **30 days** from submission, a polite inquiry to the HR office is professional, not pushy.

Sample follow-up:

> "Good morning, Ma'am/Sir. I am [Name], and I submitted my application for [Position Title, Plantilla Item No.] on [date]. I am writing to respectfully inquire about the status of the screening process. Thank you for your time."

Keep it short. One follow-up is enough. If you do not receive a response, wait for the official notification.

8.6 Common Application Mistakes (and How to Avoid Them)

These are the mistakes that eliminate otherwise qualified applicants. Every one of them is avoidable.

Mistake 1: Submitting After the Deadline

Government is strict about deadlines. Even one day late means disqualification. If the closing date is March 25, your application must be received by end of business on March 25 – not March 26.

How to avoid it: Submit at least 2-3 days before the deadline. This also gives you a buffer if documents need corrections.

Mistake 2: Incomplete PDS

Unsigned pages, missing photos, blank required fields, and outdated form versions are the most common reasons applications are returned.

How to avoid it: Use the "Before You Submit" checklist at the end of this chapter. Have someone else review your PDS before submission.

Mistake 3: No Cover Letter

Some offices require it, some do not. Always include one. It takes 30 minutes to write and shows professionalism.

How to avoid it: Prepare a template cover letter that you customize for each application. Change the position title, office name, and the paragraph explaining why you want to serve in that specific office.

Mistake 4: Applying for Positions Above Your Qualification Standard

A position at SG 24 typically requires 4 years of supervisory experience, 24 hours of management training, and a master's degree. A fresh graduate applying for this will not be considered.

How to avoid it: Check the QS carefully before applying. Target SG 11-15 for your first position.

Mistake 5: Sending Generic Applications

A cover letter that says "I want to serve in BARMM government" without mentioning the specific office's mandate tells the HRMPSB you did not bother to research.

How to avoid it: Tailor your cover letter to each office using its mandate from BAA 13.[12] Reference the relevant BDP goal. Mention a specific program or output that interests you.

Mistake 6: Not Keeping Copies

You will need copies of everything you submitted if you are called for an interview or asked for verification.

How to avoid it: Photocopy or scan every document before submission. Keep a digital folder organized by application.

8.7 Special Situations

Applying from Outside BARMM

You do not need to be a resident of BARMM to apply. Government positions are open to all Filipino citizens who meet the qualification standards. However:

- Some positions may have a preference for candidates from BARMM provinces (check the posting)
- You will need to relocate if appointed (factor this into your decision)
- Your barangay clearance should be from your current place of residence, wherever that is

Applying While Currently Employed in Government

If you are already a government employee (national or BARMM) and want to transfer:

- You need a **release** from your current office
- The receiving office will coordinate with your current HR
- You retain your salary grade (no demotion)
- This is a transfer, not a new appointment – different paperwork

Applying with a Temporary Appointment

If you currently hold a temporary appointment (you met all QS except eligibility), you can apply for permanent positions once you pass the CSC exam. Your temporary appointment counts as relevant experience.

8.8 Actionable Tool: "Application Package Checklist"

Use this checklist for every application. Check off each item before submission.

Documents Checklist

#	Document	Ready?	Notes
1	Application / Cover letter (tailored to this office)	☐	
2	Personal Data Sheet (CS Form 212, Revised 2017) – all pages signed	☐	
3	Work Experience Sheet (if applicable)	☐	
4	Transcript of Records (certified true copy)	☐	
5	Diploma (certified true copy)	☐	

#	Document	Ready?	Notes
6	CSC Eligibility proof (Certificate/PRC/Bar)	☐	
7	Training certificates (all listed in PDS)	☐	
8	NBI Clearance (current)	☐	
9	Barangay Clearance (current)	☐	
10	Community Tax Certificate / Cedula (current year)	☐	
11	2×2 and passport-size photos (white background, recent)	☐	
12	Birth Certificate (PSA-authenticated)	☐	

Before You Submit – Final Review

Check	Done?
All PDS pages are signed	☐
PDS photo is attached	☐
All dates in PDS match supporting documents	☐
Cover letter mentions the specific position and plantilla item number	☐
Cover letter mentions the office's mandate or a relevant BDP goal	☐
All training certificates listed in PDS are included in the package	☐
NBI Clearance is not expired	☐

Check	Done?
Cedula is for the current year	☐
I have kept a photocopy/scan of everything	☐
I am submitting before the closing date	☐

Key Takeaways

- The application process has **9 steps** from finding a vacancy to receiving an appointment. Expect **2-4 months** total.
- Every position has **4 qualification standards**: Education, Experience, Training, Eligibility. You must meet all four for a permanent appointment.
- Your **application package** has **12 documents**. Prepare them all before you start applying so you can submit quickly.
- The **Comparative Assessment** scores you on 5 criteria: Education (25%), Experience (25%), Training (15%), Eligibility (10%), Interview (25%).
- Fresh graduates can maximize **Education + Interview + Eligibility = 60%** of the total score. Invest heavily in interview preparation.
- The **HRMPSB** (Human Resource Merit Promotion and Selection Board) conducts the screening, interview, and ranking. They follow a standardized process.
- **CS Form 212 (PDS, Revised 2017)** is the government's standard CV. Use only the official form.
- **Avoid the six common mistakes**: late submission, incomplete PDS, no cover letter, overreaching on QS, generic applications, and not keeping copies.

Your application is in. The next chapter prepares you for the most important 25% of your score: the interview.

1. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code), sec. 27 (Qualification Standards). ↩
2. CSC Resolution No. 1700656, promulgating the Revised Qualification Standards Manual (2017). ↩
3. Exec. Order No. 292 (Administrative Code of 1987), Book V, Title I, Subtitle A, ch. 5 (Career Service Eligibility); BAA No. 17, sec. 22. ↩
4. Rep. Act No. 1080, sec. 1 (granting automatic civil service eligibility to board and bar examination passers). ↩
5. *Id.* ↩
6. CSC Resolution No. 1700656 (prescribing CS Form 212, Revised 2017). ↩
7. *Id.* ↩
8. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 3, s. 2001 (Revised Policies on Merit Promotion Plan), as amended; BAA No. 17, sec. 30. ↩
9. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018 (Comparative Assessment criteria and weights). ↩
10. *Id.*, sec. 7 (Comparative Assessment Scoring Matrix). ↩
11. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018, *supra* note 9, sec. 4 (Publication and Posting Requirements). ↩
12. BAA No. 13 (Bangsamoro Administrative Code), Book IV (Ministry Mandates). ↩
13. Exec. Order No. 292, *supra* note 3, Book V, Title I, Subtitle A, ch. 5, sec. 27 (scope and coverage of Career Service examinations); CSC Resolution No. 1700103 (Career Service Examination Policies). ↩

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Chapter 9: The Interview and Assessment

The interview is 25% of your score. For a fresh graduate with limited experience, it might be the difference between getting hired and getting a regret letter. Prepare like it matters – because it does.

You submitted your application. The HRMPSB screened it and found that you meet the qualification standards. Now they want to meet you. This chapter covers everything you need to know about the government interview: the format, the questions, the scoring, the preparation, and the follow-up. If you prepare using this chapter, you will walk into the panel more prepared than most applicants – including those with more experience than you.

9.1 What to Expect: The Interview Format

Government interviews are structured. They are not casual conversations. Here is what you will encounter:

Panel interview: Typically **3-5 members** of the HRMPSB.[1] The panel usually includes: - The HR head or HR officer - A division chief or supervisor from the hiring unit - A subject matter expert - An employee representative - Sometimes an external resource person

Duration: 20-45 minutes depending on the position level. Entry-level interviews (SG 11-15) are usually 20-30 minutes.

Format: Competency-Based Interview (CBI)[2] – structured questions designed to assess specific competencies from the position description. This is not a freestyle Q&A. Each question targets a specific competency. Each panelist scores independently.

Scoring: Each panelist uses a **standardized rubric**. They rate your answers on a scale (typically 1-5) for each competency assessed. Your interview score is the averaged total.

Recording: Some offices record interviews. You may be asked to sign a consent form before the interview begins. This is standard procedure for documentation purposes.

9.2 Competency-Based Interviews (CBI) – The STAR Method

Every CBI question asks you to describe a **past situation** where you demonstrated a specific competency. The panel is not interested in what you would hypothetically do. They want to know what you **actually did**.

The standard framework for answering is **STAR**:[3]

Element	What It Is	How to Answer
S – Situation	Set the scene. Where? When? What was happening?	Be specific. "During my thesis research on agricultural cooperatives in Maguindanao in April 2025..."
T – Task	What was your specific role or responsibility?	Clarify YOUR role, not the team's. "I was responsible for conducting interviews with 30 cooperative leaders across 5 municipalities..."
A – Action	What did YOU specifically do?	Use "I" not "we." "I designed a bilingual questionnaire in Filipino and Maguindanaon, coordinated with barangay captains for introductions, and scheduled interviews over three weeks..."
R – Result	What happened? Quantify if possible.	Show the outcome. "We completed all 30 interviews on schedule. The thesis earned a grade of 1.25, and the cooperative federation adopted two of our recommendations."

STAR Rules

- **Be specific.** "I helped with a project" tells the panel nothing. "I managed the logistics for a youth summit with 200 participants from 5 provinces" tells them everything.
- **Use "I" not "we."** The panel is assessing you, not your team. Even in team projects, clarify what you personally contributed.

- **Quantify results.** Numbers make your answers credible. “30 interviews,” “200 participants,” “3-week timeline,” “grade of 1.25” are all stronger than vague descriptions.
- **Keep it under 2 minutes.** A good STAR answer is 90-120 seconds. Longer answers lose the panel’s attention.

Where Fresh Graduates Find STAR Stories

You do not need work experience to have STAR stories. Your “situations” come from:

- **Thesis or capstone research** – research design, data collection, stakeholder engagement, writing under deadline
- **Student organization leadership** – planning events, managing budgets, coordinating teams, resolving conflicts
- **Volunteer work and community service** – disaster response, barangay programs, community outreach
- **Part-time jobs, OJT, or internships** – real work experience even if short-term
- **Family responsibilities** – managing a household IS project management. Coordinating family events IS logistics.
- **Personal challenges overcome** – resilience, problem-solving, adapting to difficult circumstances

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9.3 Common Interview Questions for BARMM Positions

Governance Awareness Questions

Expect these in **every** BARMM interview. They test whether you understand the government you are joining.

“What do you know about the Bangsamoro Organic Law?”

How to prepare: Review Chapter 2. Know that RA 11054[4] established BARMM, was ratified by plebiscite in 2019, gives the Bangsamoro government 55 enumerated powers, creates a parliamentary system, and provides fiscal autonomy through the Annual Block Grant and Special Development Fund.[5] You do not need to recite sections. Demonstrate understanding.

“Can you name the 6 goals of the Bangsamoro Development Plan?”

How to prepare: Review Chapter 5. List them:[16] 1. Stable, just, and accountable government 2. Equitable, competitive, and robust economy 3. Peaceful, safe, and resilient Bangsamoro communities 4. Inclusive, responsive, and quality social services 5. Rich and diverse Bangsamoro culture and identity preserved and recognized 6. Strategic, adequate, and climate-resilient infrastructure

Then connect one goal to the office you are applying to. "Since I am applying to MSSD, I am most drawn to Goal 4. MSSD's social protection programs directly advance inclusive and quality social services."

"What is the mandate of [this office] under BAA 13?"

How to prepare: Before every interview, look up the office's mandate in BAA 13 (the Bangsamoro Administrative Code).[6] You studied this in Chapter 3. State the mandate in your own words, not word-for-word recitation.

"What does moral governance mean to you?"

How to prepare: Review the 12 Pillars of Moral Governance from Chapter 5.[7] Choose 2-3 pillars that resonate with you and explain why. Connect them to how you would conduct yourself in the position.

"How does BARMM differ from ARMM? Why did ARMM fail?"

How to prepare: ARMM (Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao) had limited powers and was widely seen as ineffective. BARMM has a parliamentary system, enumerated powers over 55 areas,[8] its own civil service code,[9] fiscal autonomy,[10] and was created through a peace agreement (the Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro, signed March 27, 2014).[15] The key difference is genuine autonomy with real powers, not just a name change.

Competency Questions (STAR Format)

These questions assess your core competencies. Prepare a STAR story for each.

Critical Thinking: "Tell me about a time you had to analyze a complex problem and propose a solution." - Thesis research, data analysis, case studies, organizational problem-solving

Cultural Competence: "Describe a situation where you worked with people from different backgrounds." - Group projects with diverse classmates, volunteer work in multicultural communities, student exchange, community immersion

Results Orientation: "Give an example of when you had to meet a tight deadline with limited resources." - Academic deadlines, event planning with a small budget, thesis submission, OJT deliverables

Openness to Feedback: "Tell me about a time you received negative feedback. How did you respond?" - Thesis defense revisions, supervisor corrections during OJT, constructive criticism from org advisers

Initiative and Project Management: "Describe a project you led from start to finish." - Student organization events, community projects, research from proposal to defense, family or community occasions you organized

BARMM-Specific Questions

These questions are unique to BARMM. They test your motivation and cultural fit.

"Why do you want to work in BARMM government specifically?"

This is your most important answer. Do not say "I need a job" or "Government work has benefits." Connect your motivation to: - The peace process and what BARMM represents - Specific development challenges you want to help address - Personal connection to the Bangsamoro community (if applicable) - The opportunity to build systems in a new government

"How would you handle working with colleagues from different ethnolinguistic groups?"

BARMM has 13 ethnolinguistic groups.[11] Acknowledge the diversity. Share an experience working with people different from you. Show respect, openness, and willingness to learn.

"What role does Islamic governance play in public service?"

Answer respectfully regardless of your faith. The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance[12] are rooted in Islamic principles (amanah/trustworthiness, adl/justice, shura/consultation) but apply to all government workers. Focus on values: integrity, accountability, service orientation.

"What contribution can you make to the Bangsamoro transition?"

This is a vision question. Speak about the specific skills you bring, the work you want to do, and how you see yourself contributing to building institutions that will serve the first elected Bangsamoro government.

9.4 For Fresh Graduates: Compensating for Limited Experience

The panel knows you are a fresh graduate. They do not expect 5 years of government experience. They expect potential, preparation, and authenticity. Here is how to stand out.

Lead with Preparation

The single most powerful thing you can say in an interview:

> "I may not have government experience, but I have studied your office's mandate under BAA 13, read the relevant BDP chapter, and prepared a draft [output relevant to the position] to show what I can contribute."

Most applicants – even experienced ones – have not read the BOL, BAA 13, or the BDP. If you have, you are already ahead.

Reframe Academic Work as Professional Competence

Your academic experience is real experience. Frame it as such:

Academic Experience	How to Frame It
Thesis research	"I conducted primary research involving interviews with 30 stakeholders across 5 municipalities"
Student org presidency	"I led a team of 15 officers, managed an annual budget of PHP 50,000, and organized 8 events"
Volunteer work	"I coordinated a disaster response program that distributed relief goods to 200 families"
OJT / Internship	"I completed 600 hours of on-the-job training at [organization], where I [specific deliverable]"
Group thesis	"I managed the data collection and analysis components for a team of 4 researchers"

Show Learning Speed

Fresh graduates win interviews by demonstrating that they learn fast:

> "In my OJT at [organization], I was given a beneficiary tracking database with no instructions. Within two weeks, I had learned the system, identified three data entry errors, and proposed a validation checklist that the office adopted."

The panel takes away: this person can be productive quickly without hand-holding.

Demonstrate BOL/BDP Knowledge

When you reference the BOL or BDP naturally in your answers, the panel notices. For example:

> "I am drawn to this position because MSSD's work on social protection directly supports BDP Goal 4. I read in the BDP Chapter 8 that BARMM has the highest stunting rates in the Philippines. I want to be part of the team addressing that."

Bring a Portfolio

A physical folder with your best academic output is unusual and impressive. Include: - Thesis or capstone abstract (1-2 pages) - A sample research paper or policy brief - Event documentation from student organization activities - Any certificates of recognition

You do not need to hand it over unless asked. Having it signals preparation.

9.5 Written Exams and Skills Tests

Some positions require additional assessments beyond the panel interview.

What to Expect

- **Analytical writing test**: Write a memo, policy brief, or essay on a given topic (common for planning and policy positions)
- **Multiple choice exam**: General knowledge, government policies, position-specific content

- **Practical exercise**: Draft a sample document relevant to the position (e.g., a legislative briefer for LSO positions, a project proposal for planning positions)
- **Technical exam**: Subject matter test for specialized positions (health, agriculture, education, finance, engineering)

How to Prepare

- **Review the office's recent outputs.** If you are applying to a Parliament committee, read its published committee reports. If you are applying to MSSD, review its published program guidelines.
- **Study the relevant BAA.** The written exam may ask about provisions of BAA 13, BAA 17, or the BAA specific to the office.
- **Practice government writing.** Government writing is different from academic writing. It is shorter, more direct, action-oriented, and follows specific formats (memo, briefer, endorsement). Review the memo format in Chapter 13 if this guidebook's later chapters are available, or ask the HR office what format the office uses.
- **For technical positions:** Review your professional subject matter. An Agricultural Technician position will test agricultural knowledge. A Nurse position will test clinical knowledge.

9.6 Cultural Appropriateness

How you present yourself matters. These guidelines help you make the right impression.

Dress Code

Business formal. The interview is a professional setting.

- **For men**: Long-sleeved polo or barong tagalog, slacks (not jeans), closed shoes (not sandals). A necktie is optional but appropriate.
- **For women**: Modest business attire. Consider that many BARMM offices observe Islamic dress norms. Avoid sleeveless tops. Wear knee-length or longer skirts/slacks. A headscarf is not required unless you choose to wear one, but dress modestly.

Greetings

"Assalamu Alaikum" (peace be upon you) is the standard greeting in BARMM offices. It is appropriate regardless of your faith. The standard response is **"Wa Alaikum Assalam"** (and upon you, peace).

If you are unsure, **"Good morning"** or **"Good afternoon"** is always acceptable.

Addressing Panelists

- **"Sir"** or **"Ma'am"** is always safe
- Use professional titles when known: **"Director," "Attorney," "Engineer," "Doctor"**
- For Members of Parliament: **"Honorable"** (e.g., "Honorable Member" or "Your Honor")
- When in doubt, "Sir/Ma'am" works

Demeanor

- **Respectful confidence.** You are not begging for a job. You are presenting your qualifications.
- **Look panelists in the eye** when speaking. This signals sincerity.
- **Do not interrupt.** Wait for the panelist to finish the question completely before answering.
- **"Thank you for the question"** before answering buys you 3-5 seconds of thinking time. Use it.
- **Sit upright** but not stiffly. Lean slightly forward to show engagement.
- **Speak clearly.** If you tend to speak quickly, slow down.

Punctuality

Arrive 30 minutes early. Use the extra time to review your notes, observe the office environment, and compose yourself. Being late is disqualifying in most offices. If unforeseen circumstances delay you, call the contact number on the interview notice immediately.

Phone

Silent mode, not vibrate. Do not check your phone during the interview. If it rings, ignore it. Checking your phone tells the panel that something else is more important than this interview.

9.7 After the Interview – What Happens Next

Understanding the post-interview process helps you manage expectations and plan your next steps.

Step 1: HRMPSB Deliberation

After all candidates have been interviewed, the panel consolidates individual scores into a **Comparative Assessment ranking**. Each candidate receives a total score based on the five criteria:

- Education (25%)
- Experience (25%)
- Training (15%)
- Eligibility (10%)
- Interview (25%)

Step 2: Shortlist Submission

The HRMPSB submits the **top 3-5 candidates** to the appointing authority. The appointing authority is typically: - The **Minister** (for ministry positions) - The **Secretary General** (for Parliament Secretariat positions) - The **Executive Director** (for office/agency positions) - The **Mayor** or **Governor** (for LGU positions)

Step 3: Appointing Authority Decision

The appointing authority makes the final selection. They may or may not follow the HRMPSB ranking. The appointing authority has discretion, but the appointment must be justified and documented.

Step 4: Appointment Letter

If selected, you receive an **appointment letter** specifying: - Position title and plantilla item number - Salary grade and monthly salary - Effectivity date (when you start) - Type of appointment (permanent, temporary, coterminous) - Reporting instructions

Step 5: Oath of Office

Before you begin work, you take an **oath of office**. This is usually administered by the appointing authority or an authorized officer. The oath commits you to faithfully discharge your duties and uphold the Constitution and the Bangsamoro Organic Law.

Step 6: Pre-Employment Requirements

After appointment but before starting work, you typically need to: - Complete pre-employment medical examination - Open a government bank account (for salary disbursement) - Register with GSIS, PhilHealth, and Pag-IBIG (if not yet registered) - Submit additional documentary requirements as specified by the HR office

Timeline

Expect **2-8 weeks** from interview to appointment. Some offices move quickly (2-3 weeks). Others take longer due to administrative processes. This is normal.

If Not Selected

You will receive a **regret letter**. This is not a failure. Consider the following:

- **You may request feedback** from the HRMPSB. Ask what competencies to develop. Frame it as professional development, not a complaint.
- **Apply again.** Most successful government workers were not hired on their first attempt. Each interview is practice for the next one.
- **Update your tracker.** Note what went well and what you would do differently. Use this to prepare for your next opportunity.
- **Build your weak areas.** If the feedback points to experience gaps, look for COS or volunteer opportunities. If it points to training gaps, attend seminars. If it points to interview performance, practice with a friend using the mock interview tool at the end of this chapter.

9.8 The Appointment Types You May Receive

Understanding what each appointment type means helps you make informed decisions if you receive an offer.

Type	What It Means	Security of Tenure	Benefits
Permanent[13]	You met all qualification standards. You hold a plantilla position.	Full tenure – you can only be removed through a formal administrative process	Full: GSIS, PhilHealth, Pag-IBIG, leave credits, PBB, step increments
Temporary[14]	You met all QS except eligibility. Given up to 2 years to pass the CSC exam.	Limited – appointment expires if you do not obtain eligibility within the period	Full benefits while appointed
Coterminous[17]	Your appointment is tied to the appointing authority's term (common in political staff positions)	Ends when the appointing authority leaves office	Full benefits while appointed
COS[18]	Contract of Service – project-based, no plantilla position	None – contract can be terminated at the end of the period	Limited – typically no GSIS or leave credits
JO	Job Order – task-based, no employer-employee relationship	None	None

For fresh graduates: A **permanent appointment** is the gold standard. A **temporary appointment** is excellent – you have up to 2 years to pass the CSC exam while enjoying full benefits and building experience. COS is a strong stepping stone if plantilla positions are not yet available.

9.9 Actionable Tool: "Interview Preparation Worksheet"

Complete this worksheet before every interview. It organizes your preparation and gives you confidence walking into the panel.

Section 1: My STAR Stories

Prepare at least one STAR story for each competency category. Write them out in advance and practice saying them aloud.

Story 1: Thinking (Critical/Analytical) | Element | Your Answer | |—|—| | Situation | | | Task | | | Action | | | Result | |

Story 2: Communication (Written or Oral) | Element | Your Answer | |—|—| | Situation | | | Task | | | Action | | | Result | |

Story 3: Collaboration (Teamwork/Coordination) | Element | Your Answer | |—|—| | Situation | | | Task | | | Action | | | Result | |

Story 4: Values (Integrity/Service Orientation) | Element | Your Answer | |—|—| | Situation | | | Task | | | Action | | | Result | |

Story 5: Bangsamoro-Specific (Cultural Competence/BOL/BDP Awareness) | Element | Your Answer | |—|—| | Situation | | | Task | | | Action | | | Result | |

Section 2: Office Research Checklist

Complete this research before every interview. Walking in with this knowledge separates you from other candidates.

Item	Your Research
Office mandate (from BAA 13)	
Minister / Director / Head of Office (name and title)	
Relevant BDP Goal(s)	
Relevant BDP Chapter	
Current programs or projects	
Recent news or achievements	
How this position contributes to the office's mandate	

Section 3: Mock Interview Practice

Practice these 10 questions with a friend, classmate, or family member. Have your practice partner score you on clarity, confidence, and substance (1-5 each).

#	Question	Clarity (1-5)	Confidence (1-5)	Substance (1-5)
1	What do you know about the Bangsamoro Organic Law?			
2	Can you name the 6 goals of the BDP?			
3	What is the mandate of this office under BAA 13?			
4	Why do you want to work in BARMM government specifically?			
5	Tell me about a time you analyzed a complex problem. (STAR)			
6	Describe working with people from different backgrounds. (STAR)			
7	Give an example of meeting a tight deadline. (STAR)			

#	Question	Clarity (1-5)	Confidence (1-5)	Substance (1-5)
8	How did you respond to negative feedback? (STAR)			
9	What does moral governance mean to you?			
10	What contribution can you make to the Bangsamoro transition?			

Scoring guide: - **13-15 per question**: Strong. You are ready. - **10-12 per question**: Good, but refine your answers. Be more specific or add numbers. - **Below 10**: Practice more. Write out your answers and rehearse until you can deliver them naturally.

Key Takeaways

- The interview is a **Competency-Based Interview (CBI)** with a panel of 3-5 HRMPSB members. It is worth **25% of your total score**.
- Use the **STAR method** (Situation, Task, Action, Result) for every competency question. Be specific. Use "I" not "we." Quantify results.
- Expect three types of questions: **governance awareness** (BOL, BDP, BAA 13, moral governance), **competency questions** (STAR format), and **BARMM-specific questions** (motivation, cultural fit, transition contribution).
- **Fresh graduates compensate** for limited experience through preparation (read the BOL, BDP, BAA 13), reframing academic work as professional competence, and demonstrating learning speed.
- **Cultural appropriateness** matters: dress in business formal, greet with "Assalamu Alaikum" or "Good morning," address panelists respectfully, arrive 30 minutes early, keep your phone silent.

- After the interview: the HRMPSB ranks candidates, submits the top 3-5 to the appointing authority, and the authority makes the final decision. Expect **2-8 weeks** from interview to appointment.
- **If not selected**: request feedback, build your weak areas, and apply again. Most successful government workers were not hired on their first attempt.
- Complete the **Interview Preparation Worksheet** before every interview. It is 30 minutes of preparation that can determine the outcome.

You now have everything you need to find a position, apply competitively, and ace the interview. Part III of this guidebook prepares you for what comes after: succeeding once you are inside.

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1. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 3, s. 2001 (Revised Policies on Merit Promotion Plan), sec. 5 (Composition of the HRMPSB). ↩
2. *Id.*, sec. 7; CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018, sec. 7 (Competency-Based Interview as component of Comparative Assessment). ↩
3. The STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result) method is the standard behavioral interview framework adopted by the CSC for competency-based assessments. *See* CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018. ↩
4. Rep. Act No. 11054 (Bangsamoro Organic Law). ↩
5. *Id.*, art. XII, secs. 15-16 (Annual Block Grant); art. XIV, sec. 2 (Special Development Fund). ↩
6. BAA No. 13 (Bangsamoro Administrative Code), Book IV (Ministry Mandates). ↩
7. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 5, pp. 86-88. ↩
8. Rep. Act No. 11054, *supra* note 4, sec. 2, art. V (Enumerated Powers). ↩
9. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code). ↩
10. Rep. Act No. 11054, *supra* note 4, art. XII (Fiscal Autonomy). ↩
11. Rep. Act No. 11054, *supra* note 4, sec. 1, art. II (Bangsamoro Identity); 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 11, pp. 250-252 (enumerating the 13 Bangsamoro ethnolinguistic groups: Maranao, Maguindanaon, Tausug, Sama, Yakan, Iranun, Jama Mapun, Kalibugan, Sangil, Molbog, Palawani, Kalagan, and Badjao). ↩
12. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 5, pp. 86-88. ↩
13. BAA No. 17, sec. 33 (Permanent Appointments); Exec. Order No. 292, Book V, Title I, Subtitle A, ch. 5, sec. 27. ↩

14. BAA No. 17, sec. 34 (Temporary Appointments). ↩
15. Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB), signed March 27, 2014, between the Government of the Republic of the Philippines and the Moro Islamic Liberation Front. ↩
16. 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4, pp. 69-75 (Six Development Goals). ↩
17. BAA No. 17, *supra* note 9, sec. 35 (Coterminous Appointments). ↩
18. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 2, s. 2017 (Guidelines on Contracts of Service and Job Orders in Government), sec. 3. ↩

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Chapter 10: How Work Gets Done: Complete Staff Work

Every assignment you receive in government follows a process. That process has a name: **Complete Staff Work (CSW)**. Learn it now, because it will shape every document you write, every recommendation you make, and every problem you solve for the rest of your government career.

What Complete Staff Work Means

Complete Staff Work is a doctrine, not just a concept.[1] It means that when you give your supervisor a document, that document should be so thorough, so well-researched, and so clearly written that your supervisor only needs to do one thing: **approve or disapprove**.

Your supervisor should not need to: - Ask you for missing information - Rewrite your sentences - Check your legal citations - Call you back to explain what you meant - Fix your formatting

If your supervisor has to do any of those things, your staff work is **not complete**.

Think of it this way. A doctor does not hand a patient a half-finished diagnosis and say, “Can you look up the rest?” A mechanic does not return a car with three wheels attached and say, “I ran out of time.” **Your CSW output is your professional product.** It should be finished, accurate, and ready for decision.

> **The CSW Standard**: The decision-maker should only need to approve or disapprove. Everything else is your job.

The ADDRESS IT Process

In the Bangsamoro government, CSW follows a 7-step process called **ADDRESS IT**.[2] This is the methodology used across BARMM — in the Parliament, in ministries, in offices, and in local government units.

ADDRESS IT is a mnemonic. Each letter (or pair of letters) represents one step:

Step	Letter(s)	Action
Step 1	**A**	**Analyze** the Context[3]
Step 2	**DD**	**Define** and **Deliberate** the Problem or Need[4]
Step 3	**R**	**Research** Needed Information[5]
Step 4	**E**	**Explore** Options[6]
Step 5	**SS**	**Submit** Proposal or Report[7]
Step 6	(SS cont.)	**Sustain** Efforts to Implement the Solution[8]
Step 7	**IT**	**Iterate** and Improve the Solution[9]

The process is **cyclical**.[20] Step 7 can loop back to Step 1 when circumstances change or new problems emerge. Government work is never truly "done" — policies evolve, communities grow, and new challenges appear.

Let us walk through each step as if you have just received your first assignment.

Step 1: Analyze the Context

Your supervisor says: *"I need a report on why our feeding program in Basilan is behind schedule."*

Before you start writing, **stop and analyze**. This step lays the foundation for everything that follows.

What to do in Step 1

Understand the assignment. What exactly does your supervisor want? A report? A recommendation? A memo for the Minister? Clarify ambiguities now — not after you have written 10 pages in the wrong direction.

Assess your office's function. How does this assignment connect to your office's mandate under **BAA 13**[10] (the Bangsamoro Administrative Code)? If you work for the Ministry of Social Services and Development (MSSD), the feeding program falls squarely within your mandate. If you work for the Ministry of Finance, and Budget and Management (MFBM), your angle might be the budget utilization rate instead.

Identify stakeholders. Who is affected by this feeding program? The beneficiaries (children and families in Basilan), the implementing LGUs, the municipal social workers, the provincial government, development partners who co-funded the program. List them. You will need their perspectives later.

Examine internal and external factors. Internally: does your office have enough staff to monitor the program? Is the budget released on time? Externally: are there access issues in Basilan's island municipalities? Are there security concerns? Is it typhoon season?

Review relevant laws and policies. What BAA or memorandum order governs the feeding program? What national laws apply (RA 11037,[11] the Masustansyang Pagkain para sa Batang Pilipino Act)? What are the BDP targets for child nutrition (Goal 4: Inclusive, Responsive, and Quality Social Services)?[12]

Gather preliminary data. Pull whatever information is readily available — last quarter's monitoring report, the program's approved work plan, disbursement records.

Why this step matters

Skipping contextual analysis is the most common mistake new staff make. You rush to write the report without understanding the full picture. The result: a document that addresses symptoms instead of causes, ignores key stakeholders, or recommends actions outside your office's mandate.

> **Fresh graduate tip**: When your supervisor gives you an assignment, do not immediately start typing. Spend the first 30 minutes reading, asking questions, and mapping the landscape. Those 30 minutes will save you hours of rework.

Step 2: Define and Deliberate the Problem or Need

Now that you understand the context, **define the problem clearly**. This sounds simple. It is not.

What to do in Step 2

Articulate the problem. Write it in one sentence. Not "The feeding program has issues" but "The Basilan feeding program has reached only 38% of its FY 2026 target beneficiaries as of March 2026, primarily due to delayed fund release and insufficient municipal social workers in 3 island municipalities."

Identify root causes. Use the **"5 Whys" method**[21]: 1. Why is the program behind? *Because only 38% of beneficiaries have been served.* 2. Why only 38%? *Because 3 island municipalities have not started implementation.* 3. Why haven't they started? *Because the funds were released 2 months late.* 4. Why were funds late? *Because the municipality did not submit liquidation reports for the previous tranche.* 5. Why didn't they submit? *Because they have no trained staff to prepare the reports.*

The root cause is not "the program is slow." The root cause is **capacity and compliance gaps at the municipal level**.

Engage stakeholders. Talk to the municipal social workers, the provincial coordinator, the budget officer. Their perspectives will reveal things that data alone cannot show. In the Bangsamoro context, this deliberation reflects the Islamic principle of **shura** — collective consultation before decision-making.[13]

Establish scope. Define what your CSW covers and what it does not. You are analyzing the Basilan feeding program delays, not redesigning the entire national feeding strategy.

Set SMART objectives.[22] Your CSW should aim for something specific: *"Identify the root causes of implementation delays in 3 Basilan municipalities and recommend corrective actions achievable within Q3 FY 2026."*

Why this step matters

A poorly defined problem leads to a poorly designed solution. If you define the problem as "the program is slow," your recommendation might be "speed it up" — which tells your supervisor nothing useful. If you define it as a capacity gap, your recommendation can be specific: deploy a technical assistance team, conduct liquidation report training, or adjust the disbursement schedule.

Step 3: Research Needed Information

With your problem defined, **gather the evidence**. This step separates CSW from guesswork.

What to do in Step 3

Develop a research plan. What information do you need? Where will you find it? How long will it take? A simple research plan prevents you from drowning in data or running out of time.

Identify sources. For a BARMM staff member, your sources include: - **Government data**: MSSD monitoring reports, MFBM disbursement records, PSA statistics - **Legal references**: BAAs, national laws, memorandum circulars,[14] executive orders - **BDP targets**: The relevant chapter of the 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028[15] - **Stakeholder input**: Interviews with municipal staff, field reports from social workers - **Best practices**: How other BARMM provinces or national programs handle similar challenges

Evaluate source credibility.[23] Not all data is equal. An official MSSD report is more reliable than an unverified social media post. A PSA-validated statistic is more credible than an estimate from a single barangay captain.

Synthesize findings. Do not just collect data — analyze it. Look for patterns, contradictions, and gaps. If three municipalities report the same problem (no trained staff), that is a systemic issue, not an isolated case.

Document everything. Keep a record of every source you consulted, every person you interviewed, every document you reviewed. Your supervisor may ask, "Where did you get this number?" You should be able to answer immediately.

Why this step matters

CSW built on insufficient or unreliable data will fail. Your supervisor and the decision-maker above them will lose trust in your work if your facts are wrong. In government, **credibility is your most valuable asset**. Once lost, it takes years to rebuild.

Step 4: Explore Options

You have the context, the problem definition, and the evidence. Now **generate solutions** — more than one.

What to do in Step 4

Generate multiple options.[24] Never present only one solution. Decision-makers need choices. For the Basilan feeding program, your options might be:

Option	Description	Cost	Timeline	Risk
Option A	Deploy MSSD technical assistance team to 3 municipalities for 2 weeks	PHP 150,000 (travel, per diem)	1 month	Low — uses existing staff
Option B	Conduct online liquidation training for all Basilan municipal social workers	PHP 50,000 (platform, materials)	2 weeks	Medium — internet connectivity issues
Option C	Transfer implementation to provincial government with MSSD oversight	PHP 0 additional	2 months (transition)	High — capacity at provincial level unverified

Evaluate each option against clear criteria: - **Feasibility**: Can you actually do this with available resources? - **Effectiveness**: Will it solve the root cause? - **Efficiency**: Does it use resources wisely? - **Sustainability**: Will the fix last, or will the problem recur? - **Alignment**: Does it support BDP goals and your office mandate?[25]

Conduct cost-benefit analysis.[26] Option B costs the least but may not work due to connectivity. Option A costs more but directly addresses the capacity gap. Option C costs nothing upfront but risks further delays.

Recommend the best option. Based on your analysis, recommend one option and explain why. Provide your reasoning clearly so the decision-maker can follow your logic.

Why this step matters

Presenting a single option forces the decision-maker into a yes-or-no choice. Presenting multiple options with analysis demonstrates **thoroughness** and **respect for the decision-maker's authority**. It also protects you — if the decision-maker disagrees with your top recommendation, they can choose an alternative without sending you back to start over.

Step 5: Submit the Proposal or Report

This is where your staff work becomes a **physical document** that moves through the approval chain.

What to do in Step 5

Structure your document.[27] A typical CSW output follows this structure: 1. **Executive Summary** — 1-2 paragraphs capturing the problem, recommendation, and expected benefit 2. **Background and Context** — why this issue matters 3. **Problem Statement** — what you found in Step 2 4. **Research Findings** — what the evidence shows (Step 3) 5. **Options Explored** — the alternatives and your analysis (Step 4) 6. **Recommended Solution** — your recommendation with supporting rationale 7. **Implementation Plan** — specific actions, timelines, responsible persons, resources needed 8. **Conclusion and Call to Action** — what you need the decision-maker to do

Write clearly.[28] Government writing is direct, structured, and action-oriented. Short sentences. Numbered paragraphs. Bold key terms. No jargon without definition. (See Chapter 13 for detailed writing guidance.)

Review and proofread.[29] Check every fact, every citation, every number. Run the quality checklist: Is it accurate? Is it complete? Is it properly formatted? Are all attachments included?

Get supervisor clearance. Before your document reaches the decision-maker, your immediate supervisor must review and endorse it. This is not optional — it is part of the CSW process.[16] Your supervisor's endorsement signals: *"I have reviewed this work and I am satisfied with its quality."*

Submit through proper channels. Attach a **transmittal memorandum**[17] (see Chapter 13) and route it through the established approval chain. Do not skip levels. Do not hand it directly to the Minister if it should go through your Division Chief first.

The transmittal chain

Your CSW follows this path:

```
Your desk → Supervisor review → Supervisor endorsement →
Division Chief (if applicable) → Director → Decision-maker
```

At each level, the reviewer may: - **Approve and forward** — your work passes - **Return with comments** — revise and resubmit - **Reject** — start over (rare if you followed Steps 1-4 properly)

Why this step matters

Even excellent analysis fails if it is poorly written, badly formatted, or submitted through the wrong channel. The decision-maker may receive dozens of documents each day. Yours must be **clear enough to read in 10 minutes** and **complete enough to act on immediately**.

Step 6: Sustain Efforts to Implement the Solution

Your CSW does not end when the decision-maker approves it. Now you **implement**.

What to do in Step 6

Mobilize resources. If your recommendation was approved, coordinate with the relevant offices to secure the budget, personnel, and logistics needed.

Develop action plans.[30] Break the approved solution into specific tasks with deadlines and responsible persons. Share the action plan with everyone involved.

Monitor progress. Track whether implementation is on schedule. Use simple tools — a checklist, a shared spreadsheet, or a tracking memo. Report progress to your supervisor regularly.

Engage stakeholders. Keep everyone informed — the implementing units, the beneficiaries, the partner offices. In the Bangsamoro context, this includes **community engagement** in the local language and through culturally appropriate channels.

Provide support. If the implementing team encounters obstacles, help remove them. CSW is not “submit and forget.” Your ownership continues until the solution is working.

Why this step matters

Approved solutions that are never implemented are the most common waste in government. The filing cabinets of every ministry contain brilliant recommendations that never became action. **Sustained follow-through is what separates effective staff from paper-pushers.**

Step 7: Iterate and Improve the Solution

Government work is never finished. After implementation, you **evaluate and improve**.

What to do in Step 7

Monitor and evaluate.[31] Is the solution working? Are the KPIs being met? In the feeding program example: after deploying the technical assistance team, did the 3 municipalities start implementing? Did beneficiary numbers increase?

Collect feedback. Ask the municipal social workers: Was the training useful? What challenges remain? Ask the beneficiaries: Are you receiving the feeding supplies on time?

Identify improvements. Based on the data and feedback, identify what can be done better. Maybe the training needs a follow-up session. Maybe the disbursement schedule needs further adjustment.

Document lessons learned.[32] Write a brief after-action review. What worked? What did not? What would you do differently? This becomes institutional knowledge — the next person who handles a similar issue will benefit from your experience.

Restart if necessary. If monitoring reveals that the problem has fundamentally changed — perhaps a new policy directive changes the feeding program's design — go back to Step 1 and start a new CSW cycle.

Why this step matters

Without iteration, the same problems recur. Lessons from one project never inform the next. The organization fails to learn and improve. **The best government workers are not those who produce one perfect document. They are those who continuously improve their work over time.**

CSW Types You Will Encounter

Not all CSW looks the same. Here are the most common types you will produce in BARMM:[33]

CSW Type	Purpose	Where used	Key feature
Legislative Briefer[18]	Prepares a legislator for a committee hearing or plenary session	Parliament	Comprehensive bill analysis with recommendation
Budget Briefer	Analyzes a budget proposal for decision-makers	MFBM, Parliament Committee on Appropriations	Financial data, fiscal impact, BDP alignment
Policy Recommendation	Proposes a policy change with evidence and analysis	Any MOA	Options analysis, cost-benefit, implementation plan
Project Proposal	Requests approval and funding for a new project	Any MOA	Work plan, budget, timeline, expected outcomes
Legal Opinion	Provides legal analysis on a question or issue	Legal divisions, Parliament	Legal basis, jurisprudence, interpretation
General CSW	Covers any other staff work product (reports, assessments, reviews)	Any office	Depends on the assignment

As a new staff member, you will most likely start with **general CSW** — responding to specific assignments from your supervisor. As you gain experience, you may be asked to produce briefers, policy recommendations, or project proposals.

What "Completed" Actually Means

Here is a checklist to verify that your staff work is truly complete before you submit it:[34]

Check	Question	Yes/No
Accuracy	Are all facts, figures, and citations verified?	
Completeness	Does the document cover everything the assignment requires?	
Clarity	Can the decision-maker understand it without calling you for explanation?	
Structure	Does it follow the standard format for this type of CSW?	
Legal basis	Are relevant laws, BAAs, and policies cited correctly?	
BDP alignment	Does the recommendation connect to a BDP goal or priority?	
Attachments	Are all supporting documents included and properly labeled?	
Formatting	Is it properly formatted (margins, fonts, page numbers, headers)?	
Proofreading	Is it free of spelling, grammar, and typographical errors?	
Transmittal	Does it have a transmittal memorandum with the correct action phrase?	
Supervisor clearance	Has your supervisor reviewed and endorsed it?	

If you answered “No” to any of these, your work is not yet complete. Go back and fix it before submitting.

ADDRESS IT in Practice: A Quick Example

Here is how ADDRESS IT applies to a common first assignment — preparing a memorandum requesting approval of a training schedule.[35]

Step	What you do	Time
1. Analyze	Read the training policy, check the budget, identify participants, confirm venue availability	1 hour
2. Define	"The office needs to conduct mandatory CSW training for 25 new staff by Q2 FY 2026 per OP MC 72-2019"[19]	30 minutes
3. Research	Check available trainers, review past training schedules, confirm per diem rates, verify CSC requirements	2 hours
4. Explore	Option A: 3-day face-to-face in Cotabato City. Option B: 5-day blended (online + 2-day face-to-face). Option C: Self-paced online only.	1 hour
5. Submit	Write the memo with your recommendation (Option B — balances cost and effectiveness), attach the proposed schedule, budget estimate, and participant list. Route through your supervisor.	2 hours
6. Sustain	After approval, coordinate logistics, send invitations, prepare materials, monitor attendance	Ongoing
7. Iterate	After the training, collect feedback, assess learning	Post-training

Step	What you do	Time
	outcomes, adjust the next cycle	

Total time for Steps 1-5: approximately one working day. That is reasonable for a routine CSW assignment. Complex assignments (legislative briefers, policy recommendations) may take days or weeks.

The CSW Quick Reference Card

Keep this card at your desk until ADDRESS IT becomes second nature:[36]

Step	Action	Key Question
A	Analyze Context	*What is the situation? Who is involved? What laws apply?*
DD	Define and Deliberate	*What exactly is the problem? What are the root causes?*
R	Research	*What does the evidence say? What have others done?*
E	Explore Options	*What are the possible solutions? Which is best and why?*
SS	Submit Proposal or Report	*Is my document complete and decision-ready?*
(SS)	Sustain Implementation	*Is implementation on track? Are stakeholders engaged?*
IT	Iterate and Improve	*Is the solution working? What can be done better?*

Key Takeaways

- **CSW is a doctrine.** Your output should be so complete that the decision-maker only needs to approve or disapprove.
- **ADDRESS IT is your process.**[37] Seven steps, cyclical, applicable to every assignment from a simple memo to a complex policy recommendation.
- **Start with analysis, not writing.** The most common mistake is jumping to Step 5 (Submit) without doing Steps 1-4.
- **Document everything.** Your research, your sources, your reasoning. Government decisions must be traceable and defensible.
- **Get supervisor clearance.** No CSW output goes to the decision-maker without passing through your supervisor first.
- **Follow through.** Submission is not the end. Implementation (Step 6) and improvement (Step 7) are where your work creates real impact.

Your degree got you through the door. Your ability to produce complete staff work will determine how far you go.

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1. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 1. ↩
2. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2. ↩
3. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2, sec. 1 (Analyze the Context). ↩
4. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2, sec. 2 (Define and Deliberate). ↩
5. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2, sec. 3 (Research). ↩
6. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2, sec. 4 (Explore Options). ↩
7. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2, sec. 5 (Submit and Sustain). ↩
8. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2, sec. 6 (Sustain Implementation). ↩

9. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2, sec. 7 (Iterate and Improve). ↩
10. BAA No. 13, the Bangsamoro Administrative Code, establishing the organizational structure and mandates of BARMM ministries and offices. ↩
11. Rep. Act No. 11037, the Masustansyang Pagkain para sa Batang Pilipino Act (2018). ↩
12. Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority, *2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028*, Goal 4 (Inclusive, Responsive, and Quality Social Services). ↩
13. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 5, art. III (recognizing Islamic principles in Bangsamoro governance). ↩
14. Memorandum circulars from various oversight agencies (CSC, COA, DBM) prescribe government-wide standards for personnel, training, and administrative procedures applicable to BARMM under Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 11, art. XVI. ↩
15. Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority, *2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028*. ↩
16. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 3 (CSW Quality Standards and Review Process). ↩
17. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (CSW Document Formats). ↩
18. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 5 (CSW Types: Legislative Briefer, Budget Briefer, Policy Recommendation). ↩
19. Office of the President, Memorandum Circular No. 72, s. 2019 (directing all government agencies to adopt Complete Staff Work standards); *see also* OP Memorandum Circular No. 2, s. 2022 (reiterating CSW compliance). ↩
20. *Id.* at ch. 2 (describing the cyclical nature of the ADDRESS IT process — Step 7 loops back to Step 1 when circumstances change). ↩
21. The "5 Whys" is a root cause analysis technique developed by Sakichi Toyoda; *see* Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 2, sec. 2.3 (Identify Root Causes). ↩
22. SMART objectives (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound); *see* Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 2, sec. 2.5 (Establish Scope and Objectives). ↩
23. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 2, sec. 3.2 (Identify Relevant Information Sources — assessing credibility, reliability, and relevance of each source). ↩
24. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 2, sec. 4.2 (Generate Options — encouraging creative thinking and exploring a wide range of possibilities). ↩
25. Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority, *2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028*, Development Strategy No. 1 (Improve and Strengthen Governance Mechanisms); *see also* BAA No. 13, establishing office mandates. ↩
26. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 2, sec. 4.5 (Perform Cost-Benefit Analysis). ↩
27. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 2, sec. 5.1 (Develop the Proposal or Report Structure). ↩
28. *Id.* at ch. 4 (CSW Document Formats and Government Writing Standards). ↩
29. *Id.* at ch. 3 (CSW Quality Standards and Review Process — self-review, peer review, and supervisor review stages). ↩
30. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 2, sec. 6.3 (Develop Action Plans with steps, responsibilities, and timelines). ↩

31. *Id.* at ch. 2, sec. 7.1 (Monitor and Evaluate — establishing clear metrics and KPIs to measure success). ↩
32. *Id.* at ch. 2, sec. 7.6 (Document Lessons Learned — sharing insights to promote knowledge sharing). ↩
33. *Id.* at ch. 5 (CSW Types: Legislative Briefer, Budget Briefer, Policy Recommendation, Project Proposal, Legal Opinion). ↩
34. *Id.* at ch. 3 (CSW Quality Standards and Review Process — completeness checklist). ↩
35. *Id.* at ch. 2 (ADDRESS IT applied example); Office of the President, Memorandum Circular No. 72, s. 2019, *supra* note 19. ↩
36. *Id.* at ch. 2 (ADDRESS IT Quick Reference). ↩
37. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 1-2 (defining CSW as a doctrine and ADDRESS IT as the 7-step cyclical methodology). ↩

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Chapter 11: Competencies of a Bangsamoro Government Worker

Your degree got you in the door. Your competencies determine how far you go.

You may not have work experience yet. That is fine. You already have many of the competencies this chapter describes — from school, from community work, from life. This chapter helps you **name** them, **develop** them, and **show** them in interviews and on the job.

What Competencies Are

The Civil Service Commission (CSC) defines competencies as **knowledge, skills, and abilities (KSAs) demonstrated through observable behaviors**.[1] That last part matters. A competency is not something you claim to have. It is something people can **see you do**.

- **Knowledge** is what you know (facts, laws, theories, procedures)
- **Skills** are what you can do (write a memo, analyze data, facilitate a meeting)
- **Abilities** are your capacity to perform (critical thinking, leadership, adaptability)

In BARMM government, competencies fall into five categories. The first four are standard across government. The fifth is unique to the Bangsamoro.

Category	What it covers	Why it matters
Thinking Skills	Critical, creative, systems, and strategic thinking	Every CSW assignment starts with analysis
Communication Skills	Written and oral communication	Your output is judged by how well you write and speak
Collaboration Skills	Teamwork, coordination, stakeholder engagement	Government is never solo work
Values-Based Competencies	Integrity, professionalism, accountability, service	The foundation of public trust

Category	What it covers	Why it matters
Bangsamoro Competencies	BOL literacy, cultural competence, moral governance, CSW, peace process awareness	What makes BARMM different from every other employer[2]

Each category builds on the others. Strong thinking without communication produces analysis no one reads. Strong communication without values produces persuasive documents that mislead. All five categories together produce a **competent Bangsamoro government worker**.

11.1 Thinking Skills

Thinking skills are the foundation of all analytical government work. Every time your supervisor hands you an assignment, they are asking you to **think before you act**.

Critical Thinking[26]

What it is. Examining issues from multiple angles, questioning assumptions, distinguishing evidence from opinion, and drawing logical conclusions.

In government. Every CSW assignment requires you to analyze before you recommend. When your supervisor asks, "Why is the feeding program behind schedule?" — critical thinking is what keeps you from answering with the first explanation that comes to mind. Instead, you examine the data, question the obvious narrative, and identify the actual root cause.

What it looks like at different levels:

Level	Behavior
Entry	Presents information clearly; identifies key issues; draws logical conclusions
Intermediate	Analyzes complex issues and root causes; synthesizes information from multiple sources
Advanced	

Level	Behavior
	Conducts comprehensive research on multifaceted issues; develops innovative solutions; builds analytical capacity in others

How fresh graduates demonstrate it. Your thesis research required you to formulate a research question, review literature, analyze data, and defend your conclusions before a panel. That **is** critical thinking. So is debating in class, evaluating case studies, or questioning a professor's assumption during a lecture.

Creative Thinking[27]

What it is. Generating novel ideas, approaches, and solutions. Challenging conventional thinking. Proposing alternatives that others have not considered.

In government. BARMM is building systems from scratch. Many offices do not have established procedures, standard templates, or proven workflows. When your supervisor says, "We need a better way to track beneficiary complaints," creative thinking is what helps you design a solution that does not exist yet — perhaps a simple shared spreadsheet, a community feedback hotline, or a text-based reporting system for areas with limited internet.

How fresh graduates demonstrate it. Student organizations run on creative thinking. You planned events with no budget, designed recruitment campaigns with no marketing team, and found solutions to problems your advisers had never seen. That counts.

Systems Thinking[28]

What it is. Understanding how parts connect to form a whole. Seeing that your output affects another office's input, which affects a community's outcome.

In government. A budget decision at MFBM affects whether MSSD can release funds, which affects whether a municipal social worker can distribute feeding supplies, which affects whether a child in Basilan eats today. Systems thinking helps you see these connections — and avoid actions that solve one problem while creating another.

This is not just about your office. BARMM has 15 ministries, 13 executive offices, 5 provinces, 116 municipalities, and 2,590 barangays[29] (BDP 2023-2028 figures; exclude adjustments from Sulu's exclusion from BARMM per SC ruling).[30] Every policy, every program, and every budget line connects to something else. A government worker who sees only their own desk will miss the bigger picture.

How fresh graduates demonstrate it. If you have ever organized a multi-day event and coordinated logistics, food, speakers, transportation, and volunteers simultaneously — you practiced systems thinking. If you have ever noticed that one failed component (a delayed speaker, a broken projector) cascaded into other problems — you understood systems.

Strategic Thinking

What it is. Seeing the big picture and planning toward it. Connecting your daily tasks to long-term goals. Anticipating consequences before they happen.

In government. Strategic thinking means connecting your memo to a BDP goal,[3] your project proposal to the 12-point priority agenda, and your IPCR targets to your office's mandate under BAA 13.[4] It means asking: "If we implement this recommendation, what happens next year? In five years?"

What it looks like:

Level	Behavior
Entry	Understands organizational goals; aligns work with office mandate
Intermediate	Connects work to BDP priorities and BOL mandates; anticipates second-order effects
Advanced	Shapes organizational strategy; integrates cross-cutting concerns (gender, indigenous peoples, peace); drives long-term institutional reform

How fresh graduates demonstrate it. If you have ever planned a student organization's activities for an entire semester — setting priorities, allocating limited funds, sequencing events so each built on the last — you practiced strategic thinking. If you have ever decided to take specific elective courses because they aligned with your career goal, that was strategic thinking too.

11.2 Communication Skills

In government, **writing is working**. Your supervisor judges your competence primarily through your written output. A staff member who writes well is trusted with bigger assignments. A staff member who writes poorly will spend their career doing data entry.

Written Communication[31]

What it is. Clear, concise, structured writing that enables the reader to understand and act.

In government. You will produce memos, briefers, policy recommendations, reports, transmittal memoranda, endorsements, minutes, letters, and emails. Every day. (Chapter 13 teaches you the specific formats.)

Government writing is NOT academic writing:

Academic writing	Government writing
Long sentences, complex syntax	Short sentences, simple structure
Passive voice ("It was determined that...")	Active voice ("The committee determined...")
Builds to a conclusion at the end	States the conclusion FIRST, then supports it
Demonstrates the writer's knowledge	Enables the reader's decision
Hedging ("It appears that there may be...")	Direct ("There is a shortage of...")

Common mistakes fresh graduates make: - Writing 300-word paragraphs when 50 words would suffice - Using "the undersigned" instead of "I" (the CSC has discouraged this)[5] - Burying the main point in paragraph four instead of paragraph one - Using academic citations (APA format) instead of inline references - Forgetting to state what action they want the reader to take

How fresh graduates demonstrate it. Your thesis, term papers, and reports show writing ability. But recognize that you will need to **unlearn** some academic writing habits. Government writing is shorter, more direct, and always action-oriented.

Oral Communication[32]

What it is. Presenting ideas clearly, adapting to different audiences, listening actively, and speaking with appropriate confidence.

In government. You will brief your supervisor, present to committees, facilitate stakeholder consultations, speak in meetings, and engage communities. The contexts range from formal (committee hearings, budget defense) to informal (supervisor check-ins, team discussions) to public (community consultations, press interactions).

The multilingual dimension. BARMM operates in Filipino, English, and Arabic.[6] Community engagement often requires regional languages — Meranaw, Maguindanaon, Tausug, Sama, Yakan, and others. If you speak any of these, it is a professional asset. If you do not, learn basic greetings and respectful phrases in the language of your assigned community.

How fresh graduates demonstrate it. Class presentations, thesis defense, debate competitions, student journalism, peer tutoring, event hosting — all of these developed your oral communication skills. In your interview, you demonstrate this competency in real time.

11.3 Collaboration and Teamwork Skills

Government is never solo work. Every output involves multiple people, offices, and stakeholders. The ability to work effectively with others is not optional — it is essential.

Working in Teams[33]

What it is. Contributing to group goals, respecting diverse viewpoints, sharing information willingly, and supporting colleagues.

In government. Your CSW output will pass through multiple reviewers. Your project will involve colleagues from different divisions. Your program will require coordination with other ministries. You cannot succeed alone.

What it looks like:

Level	Behavior
Entry	Works cooperatively with colleagues; shares information willingly; respects diverse viewpoints
Intermediate	Coordinates across offices and ministries; resolves team conflicts; facilitates inter-agency cooperation

Level	Behavior
Advanced	Builds and leads cross-functional teams; establishes inter-entity partnerships; creates collaborative frameworks

Cross-Functional Coordination[34]

What it is. Working with people outside your office — other MOAs, Parliament committees, LGUs, national agencies, and development partners.

In government. A feeding program involves MSSD (implementation), MFBM (budget release), MILG (LGU coordination), MOH (nutrition standards), and the LGU (service delivery). No single office can do it alone. Cross-functional coordination is how things actually get done.

Stakeholder Engagement[35]

What it is. Consulting communities, civil society organizations (CSOs), the private sector, and academe. Gathering input, building consensus, and maintaining relationships.

In BARMM. Stakeholder engagement means working across **13 ethnolinguistic groups**[36] with different languages, customs, and perspectives. A community consultation in Tausug-speaking Tawi-Tawi requires different approaches than one in Meranaw-speaking Lanao del Sur. Cultural sensitivity is not a bonus skill — it is a core competency.

Shura (Consultation)[37]

What it is. The Islamic principle of collective decision-making. In Arabic, *shura* means consultation.

In BARMM. Shura is not just a value — it is a governance practice. Major decisions are made through consultation, not unilateral directives. Committee hearings, stakeholder forums, community assemblies, and inter-agency coordination meetings are all expressions of shura. As a government worker, you participate in this practice every time you consult before deciding.

How fresh graduates demonstrate collaboration. Group projects, student organization leadership, volunteer work, community service, sports teams, family responsibilities that required coordination — all of these show teamwork capacity. In your interview, describe a specific team achievement and your role in it using the STAR method.

11.4 Values-Based Competencies

Technical competence without values is dangerous. A government worker who can write excellent memos but lacks integrity produces polished documents that mislead decision-makers. Values are the foundation of public trust.

Integrity and Ethics

What it is. Honesty, transparency, and compliance with laws and organizational policies. In BARMM: **amanah** (trustworthiness) — a core Islamic value and one of the 12 Pillars of Moral Governance.[7]

In government. Every document you produce is a public record. Every recommendation you make affects real people. Every budget you process uses public funds. Integrity means: - Reporting facts accurately, even when they are unfavorable - Declaring conflicts of interest - Not using your position for personal benefit - Following procurement rules even when shortcuts are tempting - Maintaining confidentiality on sensitive matters

What the ACSCCRaPATFEE framework says:[8]

Level	Behavior
Entry	Acts honestly; follows ethical guidelines; declares conflicts of interest; maintains confidentiality
Intermediate	Navigates ethical dilemmas; ensures compliance with BOL and BAAs; promotes transparency
Advanced	Shapes ethical frameworks for the organization; leads anti-corruption initiatives; serves as moral compass

Professionalism and Service Orientation[38]

What it is. Putting the public first. Showing up on time. Meeting deadlines. Treating colleagues and constituents with respect. Maintaining composure under pressure.

In BARMM. You serve the Bangsamoro people — including marginalized communities, conflict-affected families, indigenous peoples, and underserved barangays. Professionalism means treating the barangay captain from a remote island municipality with the same respect you give the Minister.

Results Orientation

What it is. Delivering outputs on time and to standard. Setting goals and meeting them. Not just working hard, but working toward measurable outcomes.

In government. Your work is measured through the **Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS)**.[9] Your Individual Performance Commitment and Review (IPCR) sets specific targets. At year-end, you are rated on a 5-point scale: Poor, Unsatisfactory, Satisfactory, Very Satisfactory, Outstanding. Your rating affects your Performance-Based Bonus, promotion ranking, and career trajectory.

Accountability[39]

What it is. Taking responsibility for your work — both successes and failures. In BARMM: **adl** (justice) and transparency in governance.[40]

In government. When your CSW contains an error, own it. When your project falls behind schedule, report it honestly. When your supervisor asks why a deadline was missed, explain the cause and propose a solution — do not make excuses or blame others.

How fresh graduates demonstrate values. Values are shown through behavior, not statements. Returning extra change. Citing sources instead of plagiarizing. Completing your share of a group project even when others slack off. Admitting when you are wrong. These behaviors, from your everyday life, are evidence of the values government demands.

11.5 The Bangsamoro Dimension

These competencies are **not in the CSC Competency Dictionary**.[10] They are unique to BARMM — a recognition that working in the Bangsamoro government requires knowledge and sensitivities that no other Philippine government employer demands.

BOL Literacy[41]

What it is. Understanding Republic Act 11054,[11] the Bangsamoro Organic Law — the law that created the autonomous government you are joining.

Why it matters. Every decision you make, every policy you recommend, and every program you implement operates within the BOL's framework. If you do not know what BARMM can and cannot do under the BOL, you will propose actions outside your government's competence — embarrassing yourself and your office.

What you should know: - **Article III** — Territory[12] (5 provinces, Cotabato City, 63 barangays in North Cotabato as SGA municipalities; Sulu excluded per Supreme Court ruling, now Region IX)[42] - **Article V, Section 2** — The 55 areas of competence[13] (what BARMM can do that other regions cannot) - **Article VII** — The Bangsamoro Government structure, including the Parliament[14] - **Article X** — The Shari'ah justice system[15] - **Article XII** — Fiscal autonomy (block grant, revenue powers)[16]

Bangsamoro Cultural Competence[43]

What it is. Awareness of the Bangsamoro people's diversity, history, and identity. Understanding that "Bangsamoro" encompasses 13 ethnolinguistic groups[17] — Meranaw, Maguindanaon, Tausug, Sama, Yakan, Iranun, Kalibugan, Palawanon, Molbog, Jama Mapun, Badjao, Sangil, and Teduray — plus settler communities, Other Bangsamoro Communities, and indigenous peoples.

Why it matters. You will work with colleagues and communities whose languages, customs, food, clothing, kinship systems, and conflict resolution practices differ from yours. Cultural competence is not about knowing every tradition. It is about **approaching differences with respect and curiosity rather than judgment**.

Practical examples: - Learning basic greetings in the language of your assigned community - Understanding that time, hierarchy, and hospitality operate differently across groups - Respecting Islamic practices (prayer times, halal food, Ramadan observance) without being asked - Recognizing that "the Bangsamoro story" is not a single story — it is many stories from many peoples

Complete Staff Work (ADDRESS IT)

What it is. The CSW methodology described in Chapter 10. ADDRESS IT is not just a process — it is a competency. Your ability to produce complete, accurate, decision-ready staff work is the single most important functional skill in BARMM government.

Why it is listed as a Bangsamoro competency. While CSW exists in concept across Philippine government, the ADDRESS IT framework is specific to BARMM.[18] It was designed for this government's context — autonomous governance, transitional period, system-building, peace agreement implementation. Knowing ADDRESS IT sets you apart from applicants who only know the generic CSC version.

Moral Governance Practice[44]

What it is. Living the **12 Pillars of Moral Governance**[19] — not just reciting them.

The 12 pillars are: integrity, accountability, transparency, patriotism, excellence, cultural understanding, loyalty to God, justice, inclusivity, objectivity, dialogue, and balance.[45]

Why it matters. These are not aspirational values on a poster. They are cited in performance evaluations, referenced in legislation, and expected in daily conduct. When you prepare a budget, **transparency** means making the numbers verifiable. When you engage a community, **dialogue** means genuinely listening. When you face pressure to cut corners, **integrity** means refusing.

Peace Process Awareness[46]

What it is. Understanding that your work implements the Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB)[20] — a peace agreement that ended decades of armed conflict.

Why it matters. BARMM is not just another government agency. It is the institutional expression of the Bangsamoro people's right to self-governance, won through negotiation after decades of war. Every program you run, every policy you draft, every barangay you serve delivers **peace dividends** to communities that have known conflict for generations.

What this means for your work. The feeding program you track in MSSD is not just nutrition data — it is a tangible benefit of peace for a family in a conflict-affected barangay. The bill you brief in Parliament is not just legislation — it is the exercise of self-governance that the CAB promised. When your work feels tedious, remember what it represents.

11.6 Functional Competencies by Track

Beyond the universal competencies above, each career track requires **specialized functional skills**. These are the competencies that make a legislative staff officer different from a municipal planner or a media affairs officer.

Parliament: Political Affairs Officers (PAOs) — 5 Competencies[21]

#	Competency	What it means in practice
1		

#	Competency	What it means in practice
	Stakeholder Engagement, Community Organizing, and Constituency Building	Managing the MP's relationship with constituents; organizing community dialogues; building political support for legislation
2	**Representation Skills**	Speaking on behalf of the MP at events; articulating the MP's positions; liaison with other offices
3	**Social Marketing, Advocacy, and Lobbying**	Building public support for the MP's legislative agenda; engaging CSOs and media; persuading colleagues
4	**Project, Program, and Events Management**	Organizing committee hearings, public consultations, and constituency events; managing logistics and budgets
5	**Monitoring, Reporting, and Evaluation**	Tracking the MP's legislative scorecard; reporting on committee progress; evaluating program impact

Parliament: Legislative Staff Officers (LSOs) — 5 Competencies[22]

#	Competency	What it means in practice
1	**Investigation and Research Skills**	Conducting legislative research; gathering evidence for committee hearings; reviewing proposed bills against existing law
2	**Policy Making, Analysis, and Evaluation**	Analyzing policy options; drafting policy papers; evaluating the impact of proposed and enacted legislation

#	Competency	What it means in practice
3	**Legal and Legislative Competence**	Understanding the BOL, BAAs, and national laws; drafting bills and resolutions; ensuring legal consistency
4	**Attention to Details and Quality**	Producing error-free briefers, committee reports, and bill drafts; cross-referencing legal citations; maintaining version control
5	**Oversight Skills**	Supporting the committee's oversight function; monitoring implementing agencies; preparing oversight reports

Parliament: Public Information and Media Affairs Officers (PIMAOs) — 5 Competencies[23]

#	Competency	What it means in practice
1	**Strategic Communications**	Developing the MP's communication strategy; crafting key messages; managing public perception
2	**Documentation and Editing Skills**	Photographing and recording events; editing video and written content; maintaining media archives
3	**Social Media Skills**	Managing the MP's official social media accounts; creating engaging content; monitoring online engagement
4	**Print and Digital Media Skills**	Writing press releases; designing infographics and publications; producing newsletters and digital content

#	Competency	What it means in practice
5	**Media Handling Skills**	Coordinating press conferences; preparing media kits; briefing the MP before media interviews; managing media relations

Ministry, Office/Agency, and LGU Tracks[47]

Track	Key functional competencies
Ministry (technical)	Program management, budget analysis, technical expertise in your sector (health, education, agriculture, etc.), regulatory compliance
Ministry (administrative)	Records management, procurement processing, HR administration, financial management, property and supply management
Office/Agency	Program design and evaluation, multi-stakeholder coordination, monitoring and evaluation (M&E), policy brief writing, data analysis
LGU	Community relations and engagement, frontline service delivery, local regulatory compliance, basic development planning, multi-tasking across functions

11.7 How Competencies Are Assessed

Your competencies are measured at every stage of your government career. Knowing how assessment works helps you prepare.[48]

Stage	Assessment Method	What is measured	Your preparation
Hiring	Competency-Based Interview (CBI)	Specific competencies from	Prepare 5 STAR stories covering

Stage	Assessment Method	What is measured	Your preparation
	using the STAR method	the position description	thinking, communication, collaboration, values, and Bangsamoro awareness
Probation (Months 1-6)	Supervisor observation against position description	Whether you can perform the job's core functions	Focus on producing quality CSW outputs and building relationships
Annual evaluation	SPMS/IPCR with competency ratings	Results (what you achieved) and behaviors (how you achieved them)	Track your outputs, document your achievements, connect your work to BDP goals
Promotion	Comparative Assessment with competency scoring[25]	Education (25%), Experience (25%), Training (15%), Eligibility (10%), Interview (25%)	Accumulate training hours, build a track record of rated outputs, prepare for another CBI
Training	Pre/post competency assessment	Whether training improved your competency level	Engage fully in training; apply new skills immediately on the job

The ACSCCRaPATFEE Framework

The 12 competencies of a CSW practitioner are organized using the **ACSCCRaPATFEE** mnemonic.[24] This framework maps each competency to specific steps in the ADDRESS IT process:

#	Competency	Mnemonic	Primary ADDRESS IT Steps
1	Analytical and Critical Thinking	**A**	Step 1 (Analyze), Step 3 (Research)
2	Creativity and Innovation	**C**	Step 4 (Explore Options)

#	Competency	Mnemonic	Primary ADDRESS IT Steps
3	Strategic Thinking	**S**	Step 1 (Analyze), Step 4 (Explore), Step 7 (Iterate)
4	Communication	**C**	Step 5 (Submit), Step 6 (Sustain)
5	Collaboration and Teamwork	**C**	Step 2 (Deliberate), Step 6 (Sustain)
6	Research and Analysis	**Ra**	Step 3 (Research)
7	Problem-Solving and Decision Making	**P**	Step 2 (Define), Step 4 (Explore)
8	Attention to Details and Quality	**A**	Step 5 (Submit)
9	Time and Attention Management	**T**	All steps (cross-cutting)
10	Flexibility and Adaptability	**F**	Step 7 (Iterate), Step 6 (Sustain)
11	Emotional Intelligence and Accountability	**E**	Step 2 (Deliberate), Step 6 (Sustain)
12	Ethics and Integrity	**E**	All steps (cross-cutting)

You do not need to memorize this table. But understand the principle: **every competency connects to a specific part of your work process.** If your supervisor identifies a weakness in your Step 3 (Research), the competency to develop is #6 (Research and Analysis). If your Step 5 outputs have frequent errors, focus on #8 (Attention to Details and Quality).

11.8 Self-Assessment: Where Do You Stand?

Before you apply for a government position — or during your first months on the job — use this self-assessment to identify your strengths and development areas.[49]

Instructions. Rate yourself honestly on each competency category. Use a 4-point scale:

- **4 = Strong** — I can demonstrate this consistently with evidence
- **3 = Adequate** — I can do this but need more practice
- **2 = Developing** — I have done this occasionally but it is not a strength
- **1 = Needs Development** — I have limited experience with this

Thinking Skills

Competency	Rating (1-4)	Evidence from your experience
Critical Thinking	___	*Example: "Analyzed 3 policy options in my thesis and recommended one based on evidence"*
Creative Thinking	___	
Systems Thinking	___	
Strategic Thinking	___	

Communication Skills

Competency	Rating (1-4)	Evidence from your experience
Written Communication	___	
Oral Communication	___	

Collaboration Skills

Competency	Rating (1-4)	Evidence from your experience
Teamwork	___	
Cross-Functional Coordination	___	
Stakeholder Engagement	___	

Values-Based Competencies

Competency	Rating (1-4)	Evidence from your experience
Integrity and Ethics	___	
Professionalism	___	
Results Orientation	___	
Accountability	___	

Bangsamoro Competencies

Competency	Rating (1-4)	Evidence from your experience
BOL Literacy	___	
Cultural Competence	___	
CSW / ADDRESS IT	___	
Moral Governance Practice	___	
Peace Process Awareness	___	

Interpreting Your Results

Categories where you scored 3-4. These are your strengths. Highlight them in your cover letter and prepare STAR stories around them for interviews. You can confidently say: "I have demonstrated [this competency] through [specific experience]."

Categories where you scored 1-2. These are your development areas. They do not disqualify you — they guide your preparation:

Development area	What to do BEFORE applying	What to do ON the job
Thinking skills	Practice case analysis; read policy documents; join a debate or critical thinking group	Ask your supervisor for feedback on your analysis; study how senior colleagues structure their CSW
Communication	Start writing — blog posts, reports, summaries. Practice presentations.	Volunteer to draft memos and minutes; ask colleagues to review your writing; study Chapter 13
Collaboration	Join group activities; volunteer for team-based projects; seek leadership roles in organizations	Proactively offer help to colleagues; participate actively in meetings; join inter-office working groups
Values	Reflect on ethical dilemmas you have faced; study the 12 Pillars of Moral Governance	Observe how senior colleagues handle ethical situations; hold yourself accountable daily
Bangsamoro	Read the BOL (RA 11054), the BDP 2023-2028, and key BAAs; study Bangsamoro history and culture	Attend office orientation sessions; ask colleagues about cultural practices; learn basic greetings in local languages

Training Resources to Build Your Competencies

Resource	What it offers	Access
CSC Learning Hub	Free online courses on government competencies, ethics, CSW	csc.gov.ph

Resource	What it offers	Access
BARMM Training Programs	Office-specific orientation, CSW training, technical courses	Through your HR office after hiring
Online Courses (Coursera, edX)	Policy analysis, public administration, data analysis, project management	Free audit options available
Volunteer Work	Real-world practice of collaboration, communication, stakeholder engagement	Local CSOs, LGUs, faith-based organizations
BOL and BDP Study	Self-study of key governance documents	Available at BARMM Official Gazette and BPDA website

Key Takeaways

- **Competencies are observable behaviors**, not self-declarations. You must be able to show, not just claim, your abilities.
- **Five categories** matter in BARMM: thinking, communication, collaboration, values, and Bangsamoro-specific competencies.
- **Systems Thinking** helps you see how your work connects to the larger government ecosystem. A budget memo is never just about numbers — it is about the services those numbers fund.
- **The Bangsamoro dimension is real.** BOL literacy, cultural competence, moral governance practice, and peace process awareness are not theoretical concepts. They shape daily work in every BARMM office.
- **Functional competencies differ by track.** Parliament staff (PAOs, LSOs, PIMAOs) need different specialized skills than ministry technical staff, agency planners, or LGU frontline workers.
- **Assessment is continuous.** From hiring (CBI) through probation, annual evaluation (SPMS/IPCR), promotion, and training — your competencies are measured at every stage.

- **Start where you are.** Use the self-assessment to identify gaps. Develop your weak areas before applying and continue developing on the job. No one starts as an expert. The best government workers are those who **keep growing**.

Your degree proved you can learn. Your competencies prove you can **contribute**.

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1. Civil Service Commission, *Competency-Based Framework* and *CSC Competency Dictionary* (defining KSAs as the basis for government personnel assessment). ↩
2. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 6 (Bangsamoro-Specific Competencies). ↩
3. Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority, *2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028*. ↩
4. BAA No. 13, the Bangsamoro Administrative Code (defining ministry and office mandates). ↩
5. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 12, s. 2005 (discouraging the use of "the undersigned" in official correspondence). ↩
6. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 3, art. IX (official languages of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region). ↩
7. The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance, adopted by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority as foundational values for BARMM public service; *amanah* (trustworthiness) is one of the 12 pillars. *See also* Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 2, art. IX (right to just, fair, and accountable governance). ↩
8. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 6 (ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency Framework). ↩
9. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 06, s. 2012 (establishing the Strategic Performance Management System for government agencies). ↩
10. Civil Service Commission, *CSC Competency Dictionary* (the standard competency reference for Philippine government; Bangsamoro-specific competencies are unique to BARMM). ↩
11. Rep. Act No. 11054, the Bangsamoro Organic Law (2018). ↩
12. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. III (Territory of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region). ↩
13. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 2, art. V (Powers of the Bangsamoro Government — exclusive and concurrent competencies). ↩
14. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. VII (Bangsamoro Government structure, Parliament, Chief Minister, Cabinet). ↩
15. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. X (Shari'ah Justice System and Shari'ah Courts). ↩
16. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. XII (Fiscal Autonomy, block grant, taxing powers, revenue sharing). ↩
17. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 1, art. II (Definition of Bangsamoro People, listing ethnolinguistic groups). ↩
18. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2 (ADDRESS IT Methodology). ↩

19. The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance are a governance framework adopted by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority as foundational values for BARMM public service. ↩
20. Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB), signed March 27, 2014, between the Government of the Republic of the Philippines and the Moro Islamic Liberation Front. ↩
21. BTA Parliament, *Staff Competency Framework for Political Affairs Officers* (defining 5 core competencies for PAO positions). ↩
22. BTA Parliament, *Staff Competency Framework for Legislative Staff Officers* (defining 5 core competencies for LSO positions). ↩
23. BTA Parliament, *Staff Competency Framework for Public Information and Media Affairs Officers* (defining 5 core competencies for PIMAO positions). ↩
24. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 6 (ACSCCRaPATFEE: 12 Competencies of a CSW Practitioner). ↩
25. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018 (Revised Rules on the Comparative Assessment of candidates for promotion). ↩
26. Mambayao, *supra* note 2, at ch. 6 (ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency #1: Analytical and Critical Thinking — maps to ADDRESS IT Steps 1 and 3). ↩
27. *Id.* (ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency #2: Creativity and Innovation — maps to ADDRESS IT Step 4). ↩
28. *Id.* (ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency #3: Strategic Thinking — maps to ADDRESS IT Steps 1, 4, and 7). ↩
29. Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority, *2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028*, ch. 5 (Improving and Strengthening Governance — organizational structure data). ↩
30. *Province of Sulu v. Medialdea*, G.R. Nos. 242255, 243246, 243693 (Sept. 9, 2024; finalized Nov. 26, 2024) (excluding Sulu from BARMM territory); Executive Order No. 91, s. 2025 (realigning Sulu under Region IX). ↩
31. Mambayao, *supra* note 2, at ch. 6 (ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency #4: Communication — maps to ADDRESS IT Steps 5 and 6). ↩
32. *Id.* (oral communication indicators and multilingual dimension in BARMM). ↩
33. *Id.* (ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency #5: Collaboration and Teamwork — maps to ADDRESS IT Steps 2 and 6). ↩
34. BAA No. 13, the Bangsamoro Administrative Code (defining inter-ministry coordination responsibilities and organizational relationships). ↩
35. Mambayao, *supra* note 2, at ch. 6 (Collaboration indicators — stakeholder engagement across BARMM's ethnolinguistic groups). ↩
36. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 1, art. II, *supra* note 17. ↩
37. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 5, art. III (recognizing Islamic governance principles, including *shura*, in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region). ↩
38. Mambayao, *supra* note 2, at ch. 6 (Values-Based Competencies — service orientation and professionalism indicators). ↩
39. *Id.* (ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency #11: Emotional Intelligence and Accountability). ↩
40. The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance, *supra* note 19, Pillar No. 8 (Justice — serving without prejudice or self-interest). ↩
41. Mambayao, *supra* note 2, at ch. 6 (Bangsamoro-Specific Competencies: BOL Literacy). ↩
42. *Province of Sulu v. Medialdea*, *supra* note 30; *see also* Executive Order No. 91, s. 2025. ↩

43. Mambayao, *supra* note 2, at ch. 6 (Bangsamoro-Specific Competencies: Cultural Competence). ↩
44. *Id.* (Bangsamoro-Specific Competencies: Moral Governance Practice). ↩
45. The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance, *supra* note 19 (enumeration verified against Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 5). ↩
46. Mambayao, *supra* note 2, at ch. 6 (Bangsamoro-Specific Competencies: Peace Process Awareness). ↩
47. Functional competencies for Ministry, Office/Agency, and LGU tracks are adapted from CSC position descriptions and BAA No. 13 organizational mandates. ↩
48. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 06, s. 2012, *supra* note 9 (SPMS as the government-wide performance assessment system); *see also* CSC MC No. 14, s. 2018, *supra* note 25 (Comparative Assessment for promotion). ↩
49. Mambayao, *supra* note 2, at ch. 6 (Self-Assessment Tool for CSW Competencies). ↩

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Chapter 12: Working with Your Supervisor

Your supervisor's job is to develop you. Your job is to make that possible.

This chapter is written from **your perspective** — the staff member. Your supervisor has their own guidebook (the Supervision Guidebook)[1] that teaches them how to manage, coach, and evaluate you. This chapter teaches you what to expect from them, what they expect from you, and how to build the kind of working relationship that advances your career.

What Your Supervisor Expects From You

Before you worry about whether your supervisor is fair, competent, or easy to work with, understand what **every supervisor expects** from their staff. These expectations are universal — they apply whether you work in Parliament, a ministry, an office, or an LGU.

1. Come Prepared[15]

When your supervisor calls a meeting, a check-in, or a review — **arrive ready**. That means: - Know the status of your assignments - Bring your notes, your data, and your questions - Have a brief summary ready: *"Here is where I am, here is what I need, here is what is blocking me."* - Do not wait for your supervisor to ask you what is happening. Tell them.

What this looks like in practice. Your supervisor schedules a 30-minute check-in for Monday morning. Before you walk in, review your pending assignments, note which ones are on track and which are behind, prepare your questions, and have a list of decisions you need from them. That 30-minute meeting will be productive. Without preparation, it becomes 30 minutes of your supervisor pulling information from you one question at a time.

2. Receive Feedback Without Defensiveness

Your supervisor will give you feedback — both positive and corrective. The corrective feedback is not a personal attack. It is **professional development**. Your ability to receive it gracefully is itself a competency (Emotional Intelligence and Accountability — ACSCCRaPATFEE #11).[2]

The SBI model from your end. Your supervisor may use the **Situation-Behavior-Impact (SBI)** model to give you feedback.[3] Here is what it sounds like and how to respond:

Your supervisor says	What they mean	How to respond
"In yesterday's committee hearing **[Situation]**, you did not present the options analysis **[Behavior]**, which meant the committee could not make a decision **[Impact]**."	Your incomplete briefer caused a real problem.	"Thank you for pointing that out. I should have included the options analysis. I will make sure the next briefer has the full analysis section before I submit it."
"During last week's staff meeting **[S]**, you volunteered to help the Basilan team with their data **[B]**, and that allowed them to meet their deadline **[I]**."	Your proactive collaboration made a real difference.	"Thank you. I noticed they were struggling and thought I could help. I am glad it worked out."

What NOT to do when receiving feedback: - Do not argue or get defensive ("But that is not what I meant...") - Do not blame others ("The data was not available because Finance did not send it...") - Do not shut down or go silent - Do not dismiss it ("It was not a big deal anyway...")

What TO do: - Listen fully before responding - Acknowledge the feedback ("I understand") - Ask clarifying questions if needed ("Can you help me understand what the options analysis should have included?") - Commit to specific improvement ("Next time, I will complete the options analysis and have you review it before the hearing") - Follow through — and let your supervisor see the change

3. Take Ownership of Your Development[16]

Your supervisor will coach you, train you, and provide opportunities. But **they cannot develop you against your will**. You must be an active participant in your own growth.

What ownership looks like: - Asking your supervisor: *"What should I be learning in my first 6 months?"* - Requesting training opportunities before they are offered - Seeking feedback proactively: *"How was my last memo? What can I improve?"* - Studying on your own — reading the BOL, reviewing BAAs, learning the office's systems - Watching how senior colleagues work and learning from their approach

What it does NOT look like: - Waiting to be told what to learn - Attending training only when forced - Never asking for feedback - Repeating the same mistakes because you never sought to understand why

4. Produce CSW That Does Not Need Rework[17]

This is the practical test. Your supervisor measures your competence primarily through your written output. If every memo you submit comes back with red marks, your supervisor's confidence in you decreases. If your work is consistently clean, complete, and well-structured, their confidence grows — and so do your assignments.

The standard (from Chapter 10): Your supervisor should only need to approve or disapprove. If they have to rewrite your sentences, check your citations, fill in missing data, or fix your formatting — your staff work is not complete.

The Check-In Rhythm

Your supervisor should conduct regular **check-ins** — at least monthly, often more frequently during your first year. Check-ins are structured conversations, not casual chats. They follow a **4-step protocol**.[4]

The 4-Step Check-In Protocol (From Your Perspective)

Step 1: Discuss Roles and Responsibilities

Your supervisor shares the office's direction, clarifies expectations, and connects your work to the bigger picture. **Your role:** listen actively, ask questions, make sure you understand what is expected. If something is unclear, this is the time to clarify — not three weeks later when a deadline is missed.

What to ask: - "Has anything changed in our priorities since our last check-in?" - "Are there new assignments I should know about?" - "How does my current project connect to the office's OPCR targets?"

Step 2: Review Goals and Assignments

You and your supervisor review your current workload against your goals (IPCR targets, assignment deadlines, project milestones). **Your role:** come prepared with a status update for every active assignment. Be honest about what is behind schedule and why.

What to bring: - A list of your active assignments with status (on track / behind / completed) - Specific questions about priorities ("I have three deadlines this week — which is most urgent?") - Updates on completed work ("I submitted the feeding program memo last Tuesday — have you had a chance to review it?")

Step 3: Evaluate Progress and Provide Coaching

Your supervisor assesses how you are doing — not just what you are producing, but how you are producing it. They may use the **SBI model** to give feedback (see above). They may also provide positive feedback to reinforce what you are doing well.

Your role: receive feedback openly. Ask follow-up questions. If your supervisor says your analysis was strong but your formatting needs work, write it down and fix it. If they praise your initiative, keep doing it.

What to ask: - "What is one thing I could do differently to improve my output?" - "Are there specific skills I should be developing right now?" - "Can you show me an example of what a strong [memo / briefer / report] looks like in our office?"

Step 4: Determine Next Steps

Agree on what you will do before the next check-in. Your supervisor may assign new tasks, set development goals, or ask you to follow up on specific items. **Your role:** write down the agreed actions. Do them. Report back at the next check-in.

What to confirm: - "So my priorities for the next two weeks are [X, Y, Z] — is that correct?" - "I will complete the policy recommendation by Friday and submit it through you for review." - "Can we schedule the next check-in for [date]?"

How You Are Being Assessed: The PPR Framework

Your supervisor uses the **Performance-Potential-Readiness (PPR)** framework to assess where you stand.[5] Understanding this framework helps you see your career from your supervisor's perspective — and take action accordingly.

Step 1: Performance (Your Current Role)

Your supervisor evaluates how well you are performing **right now** — in the position you currently hold. Performance includes both **results** (what you achieve) and **behaviors** (how you achieve them).

- **Results**: Are you meeting your IPCR targets? Are your CSW outputs complete and on time? Are your projects progressing?
- **Behaviors**: Are you collaborative? Professional? Responsive to feedback? Reliable?

A staff member who produces excellent briefers but is consistently late, combative in meetings, and unwilling to help colleagues is not performing well — because behaviors matter as much as results.

Step 2: Potential (Your Future Capacity)

If your performance is solid, your supervisor assesses your **potential** — your capacity to grow into a larger role. Indicators of high potential include:

- Ability to solve complex problems (not just routine ones)
- Persistence through setbacks (you do not give up when things get hard)
- Drive to take on challenging work (you volunteer for difficult assignments)
- Improvement based on feedback (you do not make the same mistake twice)

Important: Potential is assessed only when you are meeting or exceeding your current role's expectations.[18] If your performance is low, your supervisor focuses on closing the performance gap first — not on your future potential.

Step 3: Readiness (For a New Assignment)

Readiness means you already have the skills, knowledge, and abilities for a **specific new role or assignment**. This is assessed when there is a concrete opportunity — a promotion, a lateral move, a stretch assignment, a project leadership role.

The 4-Quadrant Coaching Guide

Based on your PPR assessment, your supervisor places you in one of four quadrants.[6] Each quadrant has a different coaching focus:

Quadrant	Performance	Potential	What your supervisor will do	What you should do
Low-Low	Low	Low	**CHANGE** — Revisit goals and expectations, emphasize ownership, coach for behavior change	Be honest about your challenges. Ask for clear expectations. Accept coaching without defensiveness. Work hard to improve results.
Low-High	Low	High	**CHANGE** — Clarify goals, show how your behavior affects outcomes, schedule frequent check-ins	You have potential, but you are not delivering yet. Focus on results. Show your supervisor that their investment in you is paying off.
High-Low	High	Low	**DEVELOP** — Explore your interests and aspirations, identify development opportunities, keep you engaged	You are doing well now but may plateau. Ask about stretch assignments. Express interest in growth areas. Volunteer for cross-functional projects.
High-High	High	High	**SUSTAIN, REINFORCE, RECOGNIZE** — Help you become a mentor,	Keep performing. Mentor junior colleagues. Take on leadership

Quadrant	Performance	Potential	What your supervisor will do	What you should do
			consider stretch assignments, prepare you for promotion	opportunities. Make your case for promotion through consistent excellence.

Where do you want to be? The High-High quadrant. You get there by delivering results, behaving professionally, learning continuously, and demonstrating potential through initiative.

Where most fresh graduates start. Realistically, most new staff begin in the Low-High quadrant[19] — you have potential (your education, your motivation), but you have not yet demonstrated results in government. Your supervisor knows this. Your job in the first 6-12 months is to move from Low-High to High-High by converting your potential into performance.

How to Receive Feedback

Feedback is your fastest path to improvement. Yet most people resist it. Understanding how feedback works in your office will help you respond constructively.

The SBI Model from the Receiving End

Your supervisor structures feedback using **Situation, Behavior, Impact**:[7]

Corrective feedback example:

> "In the committee hearing last Thursday **[Situation]**, you read directly from your briefer instead of presenting the key points conversationally **[Behavior]**. The MPs lost interest after 5 minutes and started checking their phones **[Impact]**."

Your response: 1. **Acknowledge.** "Thank you for telling me. I did not realize I was reading verbatim." 2. **Understand.** "Should I prepare bullet-point talking points instead of reading the full text?" 3. **Commit.** "For the next hearing, I will practice presenting from notes rather than the full document." 4. **Follow through.** At the next hearing, present from talking points. Your supervisor notices.

Positive feedback example:

> "In the inter-agency coordination meeting yesterday **[S]**, you volunteered to draft the joint action plan and completed it within 24 hours **[B]**. That allowed us to submit the plan to the Minister on time and positioned our office as the lead coordinator **[I]**."

Your response: 1. **Accept graciously.** "Thank you. I saw the urgency and wanted to help us meet the deadline." 2. **Learn from it.** This tells you that initiative, speed, and quality are valued. Keep doing it.

Five Feedback Traps to Avoid[20]

Trap	What it sounds like	Why it hurts you
Defensiveness	"But I did include the data — it was on page 7"	Your supervisor stops giving you feedback because it always becomes an argument
Deflection	"The real problem was that Finance did not send the numbers on time"	Your supervisor sees you as someone who does not take responsibility
Silence	[Says nothing, looks at the floor]	Your supervisor cannot tell if you understood or plan to change
Over-apologizing	"I am so sorry, I am so sorry, I will never do it again"	Emotional responses make supervisors uncomfortable giving future feedback
Immediate pushback	"That is not fair — I worked on this all weekend"	Effort is not the same as quality. Your supervisor is evaluating the output, not the hours

The right approach: Listen. Acknowledge. Ask for clarification. Commit to improvement. Demonstrate the change.

Your Performance Evaluation

Once a year, your supervisor conducts a formal **performance evaluation**. This follows the **6-step evaluation protocol**.[8] Understanding what your supervisor is doing at each step helps you prepare.

Step 1: Your Supervisor Gets Your Input

Your supervisor asks you to summarize your key accomplishments. Provide this in writing using the **Situation-Action-Result** format: - *Situation:* "The feeding program in Basilan was 62% behind target as of March." - *Action:* "I conducted root cause analysis, proposed a 3-option corrective plan, and coordinated the TA deployment to 3 municipalities." - *Result:* "The program reached 87% of target by year-end — a 25-percentage-point improvement."

Important: Your supervisor will NOT ask you to rate yourself (self-ratings create defensiveness).[21] They only want your accomplishments in narrative form.

Step 2: Your Supervisor Gets Input from Others

Your supervisor may ask colleagues, partners, or subordinates about your work. This is not about collecting gossip — it is a **multi-source feedback** process to get a complete picture.

What you can do: Build strong working relationships with colleagues so that when asked, they have positive and specific things to say about your collaboration.

Step 3: Your Supervisor Evaluates Results (the "What")

Your supervisor assesses what you accomplished against your IPCR targets. They look at: - **Context** — what circumstances affected your work (budget delays, staffing gaps, emergencies) - **Accomplishment** — what you actually delivered - **Impact** — what difference your work made

Step 4: Your Supervisor Evaluates Behaviors (the "How")

Results are not enough. Your supervisor evaluates **how** you achieved them. Did you collaborate or work in isolation? Did you meet deadlines or consistently miss them? Did you support team goals or only pursue your own assignments?

This is where the competencies from Chapter 11 matter. Your supervisor assesses you against the 5-10 most important competencies for your position.

Step 5: Your Supervisor Writes the Review

Your supervisor prepares a written evaluation with: - A **rating** for both results and behaviors (using the SPMS scale:[9] Poor through Outstanding) - A **narrative** explaining why each rating was given - **Development recommendations** for the coming year

Step 6: Your Supervisor Discusses the Evaluation with You

This is a face-to-face conversation. Your supervisor: - Summarizes the check-in discussions throughout the year - Shares the rating and narrative - Asks for your thoughts - Focuses on development for the next year

The golden rule of evaluations: If check-ins were done well throughout the year, **the evaluation should contain no surprises**.[22] Every piece of feedback in the evaluation should have been discussed at least once during a check-in.

How to Prepare for Your Evaluation

Preparation	What to do
Track your work all year[23]	Keep a running list of completed assignments, achievements, and impact data. Do not rely on memory in December.
Save your outputs	Keep copies of your best CSW products — briefers, memos, reports, project proposals. These are evidence.
Document BDP alignment	For each major output, note which BDP goal or priority agenda item it supports.
Note your training	Record every training, seminar, and workshop you attended, with dates and topics.
Prepare your accomplishments	Write 3-5 accomplishments in Situation-Action-Result format before the evaluation meeting.
Identify your development needs	Be honest about areas where you struggled and propose what training or support would help.

When Things Go Wrong

Not every supervisor-staff relationship works smoothly. Here is what to do when challenges arise.

Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

If your supervisor determines that your performance is consistently below standard, they may place you on a **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)**.[10] This is a formal, documented intervention — not a punishment.

What a PIP includes: - Specific performance gaps identified - Measurable improvement targets - Timeline for improvement (typically 30-90 days) - Support the supervisor will provide (coaching, training, resources) - Consequences if improvement is not achieved

What you should do if placed on a PIP: 1. **Take it seriously.** A PIP is a warning that your employment may be at risk. 2. **Understand the gaps clearly.** Ask your supervisor: "What specifically do I need to change?" 3. **Follow the plan.** Meet every milestone, attend every check-in, document your progress. 4. **Ask for help.** Use the coaching and training offered. Seek mentorship from senior colleagues. 5. **Do not take it personally.** A PIP means your supervisor still sees potential — otherwise they would move directly to disciplinary action.

Progressive Discipline

If performance does not improve or if you commit a workplace violation, the **2017 Rules on Administrative Cases in the Civil Service (2017 RACCS)**[11] governs the disciplinary process. The progression is:

Step	Action	Typical grounds
1	**Written warning**	Minor violations (tardiness, dress code, minor discourtesy)
2	**Reprimand**	Repeated minor violations or first moderate offense
3	**Suspension** (1-90 days)	Serious violations (gross negligence, insubordination, unauthorized absence)

Step	Action	Typical grounds
4	**Dismissal**	Grave offenses (dishonesty, corruption, grave misconduct, conviction of a crime involving moral turpitude)

Your rights under due process: - You must be informed of the charges in writing - You have the right to answer and present evidence - You have the right to a formal hearing if the offense is grave - You can appeal to the CSC or the appropriate body - You cannot be dismissed without due process — even if you are guilty

When the Problem Is Your Supervisor

Sometimes the challenge is not your performance but the supervisory relationship. If your supervisor is: - **Unclear about expectations** — request a written set of priorities - **Unavailable for check-ins** — propose a schedule and follow up in writing - **Giving inconsistent direction** — document instructions and confirm in email - **Hostile or abusive** — document incidents, report to HR, and know your rights under the 2017 RACCS[14] and RA 7877[12] (Anti-Sexual Harassment Act) or RA 11313[13] (Safe Spaces Act)

The professional response: Address issues through proper channels. Document everything. Seek guidance from HR or a trusted senior colleague. Do not escalate on social media, gossip with colleagues, or retaliate. Your professionalism in difficult situations demonstrates the values-based competencies from Chapter 11.

Building a Productive Relationship

The best supervisor-staff relationships are built on **mutual investment**.[24] Here is what that looks like:

Your supervisor's investment in you	Your investment in the relationship
Clarifies expectations regularly	Delivers on those expectations
Gives honest feedback using SBI	Receives feedback without defensiveness
Creates development opportunities	Takes ownership of your development

Your supervisor's investment in you	Your investment in the relationship
Advocates for your promotion when ready	Produces work that justifies advocacy
Protects you from unfair demands	Protects your supervisor from surprises
Coaches you through mistakes	Learns from mistakes and does not repeat them

The last point deserves emphasis. "Protects your supervisor from surprises" means: if something goes wrong with your assignment, tell your supervisor **before** they hear about it from someone else. If a deadline will be missed, flag it early. If a stakeholder complained, report it immediately. Supervisors can manage problems. They cannot manage problems they do not know about.

Key Takeaways

- **Come prepared** to every check-in. Your supervisor's time is limited. Make meetings productive by bringing status updates, questions, and proposed next steps.
- **Receive feedback as a gift**, not an attack. The SBI model (Situation, Behavior, Impact) structures feedback so it is specific and actionable. Your job is to listen, acknowledge, and improve.
- **Understand how you are being assessed.** The PPR framework (Performance, Potential, Readiness) places you in one of four quadrants. Your goal is to move to High-High through consistent results and professional behaviors.
- **The 4-step check-in protocol** structures your monthly conversations: roles and responsibilities, goals and assignments, progress and coaching, next steps.
- **The 6-step evaluation protocol** is your annual formal review. Prepare by tracking accomplishments all year using Situation-Action-Result format.
- **No surprises.** If check-ins are done well, nothing in your evaluation should be unexpected. If something surprises you, the check-in process broke down — raise this with your supervisor.
- **When things go wrong**, respond professionally. A PIP is a chance to improve, not a death sentence. Due process protects you. And if the problem is your supervisor, address it through proper channels with documentation.

- **Your supervisor cannot develop you against your will.**[25] Take ownership. Ask for feedback. Seek training. Study on your own. The staff members who grow fastest are those who **pursue development, not wait for it**.

---

1. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Supervision Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026). ↩
2. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 6 (ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency #11: Emotional Intelligence and Accountability). ↩
3. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Supervision Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 3 (SBI Feedback Model: Situation-Behavior-Impact). ↩
4. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Supervision Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 2 (The 4-Step Check-In Protocol). ↩
5. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Supervision Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (The PPR Framework: Performance-Potential-Readiness). ↩
6. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Supervision Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (4-Quadrant Coaching Guide based on PPR assessment). ↩
7. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Supervision Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 3 (SBI Feedback Model). ↩
8. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Supervision Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 5 (The 6-Step Evaluation Protocol). ↩
9. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 06, s. 2012 (Strategic Performance Management System rating scale: Poor, Unsatisfactory, Satisfactory, Very Satisfactory, Outstanding). ↩
10. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 06, s. 2012, sec. 12 (Performance Improvement Plan provisions under SPMS). ↩
11. CSC Resolution No. 1701077, s. 2017 (2017 Rules on Administrative Cases in the Civil Service, superseding the RRACCS). ↩
12. Rep. Act No. 7877, the Anti-Sexual Harassment Act of 1995. ↩
13. Rep. Act No. 11313, the Safe Spaces Act (Bawal Bastos Law) of 2019. ↩
14. CSC Resolution No. 1701077, s. 2017, *supra* note 11. ↩
15. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 2 (Supervisory Competency #6: Conducting Ongoing Check-Ins — preparation expectations for staff). ↩
16. *Id.* at ch. 4 (Coaching Process — Element 2: Motivation, connecting development to staff goals); Mambayao, *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 6 (ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency #10: Flexibility and Adaptability). ↩
17. Mambayao, *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 1 (the CSW standard: the decision-maker should only need to approve or disapprove). ↩

18. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 4 (PPR Framework — Step 2: Assess Potential only when performance meets or exceeds current role expectations). ↩
19. *Id.* (4-Quadrant Coaching Guide — Low-High quadrant: low performance, high potential, coaching focus on clarifying goals and establishing check-ins). ↩
20. *Id.* at ch. 3 (SBI Feedback Model — common feedback reception errors and constructive response behaviors). ↩
21. *Id.* at ch. 5 (6-Step Evaluation Protocol — Step 1: Get Employee Input using Situation-Action-Result format; self-ratings explicitly avoided). ↩
22. *Id.* (the "no surprises" principle — evaluations should reflect feedback already given during check-ins throughout the year). ↩
23. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 06, s. 2012, *supra* note 9 (SPMS requires documented performance evidence throughout the rating period). ↩
24. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 1 (Supervisory Competency Foundations — mutual investment between supervisor and staff). ↩
25. *Id.* at ch. 4 (Coaching Process — Element 1: Self-Awareness and Element 2: Motivation as prerequisites for development). ↩

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Chapter 13: Government Communication: Writing That Gets Read

In government, writing IS working. If you cannot write a proper memo, you cannot do the job.

Your supervisor will judge your competence primarily through your written output. A staff member who writes well is trusted with bigger assignments. A staff member who writes poorly will spend their career doing data entry. This chapter teaches you the formats, conventions, and habits that make government writing effective.

13.1 The Memorandum: The Workhorse of Government

The memorandum (memo) is the most common document you will produce.[1] Every request, report, recommendation, and notification moves through memos. You may write dozens in a single week. Learn this format first.

Standard Memo Structure

```
REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES
BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION IN MUSLIM MINDANAO
[MINISTRY/OFFICE NAME]
[Address]

MEMORANDUM

TO      : [Full name and title of recipient]
FROM    : [Full name and title of sender]
DATE    : [Date of memo]
SUBJECT : [Clear, specific subject]

---

1. [Purpose paragraph — why you are writing. State the action needed
upfront.]

2. [Background paragraph — context the reader needs.]

3. [Details paragraph — specifics, data, findings, attachments referenced.]

4. [Action paragraph — what you need the reader to do, by when.]

[Signature block]
[Name]
[Position]
```

Annotated Example

Here is a real-world example with annotations:

```
REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES
BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION IN MUSLIM MINDANAO
MINISTRY OF SOCIAL SERVICES AND DEVELOPMENT
Cotabato City

MEMORANDUM

TO      : HON. RAISSA H. JAJURIE
          Minister, MSSD
FROM    : AHMAD M. SANTOS
          Administrative Officer III, Social Protection Division
DATE    : 26 March 2026
SUBJECT : Request for Approval of BANGON Beneficiary List for
          Municipality of Paglat, Maguindanao del Sur

---

1. This is to request your approval of the attached BANGON beneficiary
   list for the Municipality of Paglat, Maguindanao del Sur, covering
   45 qualified beneficiaries for FY 2026 Batch 1.

2. Per MSSD Memorandum Order No. 2026-003, all BANGON beneficiary lists
   must be validated by the Municipal Social Welfare Office, endorsed
   by the Municipal Mayor, and approved by the Minister before
   disbursement.

3. The attached list has been validated against the following criteria:
   (a) residency in conflict-affected barangay, (b) income below
   poverty threshold, (c) no duplication with other livelihood programs.
   Supporting documents are attached as Annexes A-C.

4. In view of the above, approval of the attached beneficiary list is
   respectfully requested to enable disbursement before the end of
   Q1 FY 2026.

[Signature]
AHMAD M. SANTOS
Administrative Officer III
Social Protection Division
```

Key Rules for Fresh Graduates[14]

The SUBJECT line is the most important line. Your supervisor may receive 20 or more memos per day. A vague subject line ("Request") gets buried. A specific one ("Request for Approval of BANGON Beneficiary List for Municipality of Paglat, Maguindanao del Sur") gets read and acted on.

One memo = one subject.[6] Do not combine unrelated requests in a single memo. If you need to request budget approval AND report on a field visit, write two separate memos.

Number your paragraphs.[7] Government readers scan — they do not read every word. Numbered paragraphs allow them to reference specific points: *"See paragraph 3 of your memo dated 26 March 2026."* This also helps during discussions when your supervisor says, "I have a question about your third point."

State the action requested in BOTH the first paragraph AND the last paragraph. Decision-makers often read only the beginning and end. Your purpose should be clear whether they read the full memo or skim it.

Attach supporting documents rather than embedding lengthy data in the body. A memo with 10 pages of tables in the body is hard to read. A memo with 4 short paragraphs and 10 pages of tables in an annex is easy to read.

13.2 The Transmittal Memorandum

A transmittal memo accompanies a CSW output[2] — a briefer, policy recommendation, project proposal, or report — as it moves from your desk to the decision-maker. It is NOT the CSW itself. It is the **cover page** that says: *"Here is the work. Here is what I need you to do with it."*

Transmittal Memo Structure

```
MEMORANDUM

TO      : [Decision-maker]
FROM    : [You]
DATE    : [Date]
SUBJECT : Transmittal of [Name of Document] re: [Topic]

---

1. Transmitted herewith is the [Legislative Briefer / Policy
Recommendation /
   Project Proposal / Budget Analysis] on [topic], prepared pursuant to
   [assignment source — e.g., "your directive during the March 15, 2026
   staff meeting" or "Committee Resolution No. 2026-001"].

2. [1-2 sentence summary of the key finding or recommendation.]

3. [List of attachments and how they are organized.]

4. For your [approval / information / appropriate action].

[Signature block]
```

Annotated Example

```
MEMORANDUM

TO      : HON. MEMBER OF PARLIAMENT [Name]
          Chair, Committee on Agriculture, Fisheries, and Agrarian Reform
FROM    : [Your name]
          Legislative Staff Officer II
DATE    : 26 March 2026
SUBJECT : Transmittal of Legislative Briefer re: Proposed Bangsamoro
          Fisheries Code (BTA Bill No. 2026-0045)

---

1. Transmitted herewith is the Legislative Briefer on BTA Bill No.
2026-0045,
   "An Act Establishing the Bangsamoro Fisheries Code," prepared pursuant to
   your directive during the March 20, 2026 committee staff meeting.

2. The briefer recommends approval of the proposed bill with three amendment
s
   to align Section 12 with BOL Article V, Section 2, Item 14 (fisheries
   competence) and to harmonize penalty provisions with the national
   Fisheries Code (RA 8550 as amended by RA 10654).

3. The following documents are attached:
   (a) Legislative Briefer (10 pages)
   (b) Bill Comparison Matrix — Proposed vs. National Fisheries Code
   (c) Stakeholder Position Summary

4. For your review and appropriate action in preparation for the committee
   hearing scheduled on April 3, 2026.

[Signature]
[Name]
Legislative Staff Officer II
```

When to Use a Transmittal Memo vs. a Regular Memo[15]

Use a regular memo when...	Use a transmittal memo when...
Your memo IS the document (a request, report, or notification)	Your memo ACCOMPANIES a more substantive document

Use a regular memo when...	Use a transmittal memo when...
The body of the memo contains all the information the reader needs	The attachments are more important than the memo itself
No attachments, or attachments are supporting documents	The main deliverable is the attachment

Rule of thumb: If your memo has attachments that are more important than the memo itself, it is a transmittal.

13.3 The Endorsement Chain

Endorsements are how documents move between offices.[3] When Office A sends a document to Office B for action, and Office B forwards it to Office C, each forwarding is an **endorsement**. Understanding endorsements is essential because you will both **write** them and **receive** them.

How It Works

```
ORIGINAL MEMO: Municipality of Paglat --> MILG
(Requesting technical assistance for CDP update)

1st ENDORSEMENT: MILG --> BPDA
"Respectfully endorsed to the Bangsamoro Planning and Development
Authority for appropriate action. The Municipality of Paglat requests
technical assistance in preparing its Comprehensive Development Plan
update."
[Signed by MILG Director]

2nd ENDORSEMENT: BPDA Executive Director --> Planning Division
"Referred to the Planning Division for evaluation and recommendation."
[Signed by BPDA Executive Director]

3rd ENDORSEMENT: Planning Division --> BPDA Executive Director
"Respectfully returned with the recommendation that BPDA deploy a
planning team to Paglat municipality for a 5-day CDP workshop, with
an estimated cost of PHP 85,000 chargeable to the FY 2026 Technical
Assistance Fund."
[Signed by Division Chief]
```

Each endorsement adds a layer to the document's history.[16] By the time you receive a document with three endorsements, you can trace its entire journey — who originated it, who reviewed it, what they recommended, and what is expected of you.

Key Endorsement Phrases and What They Mean

These phrases are standard across Philippine government.[4] Each one signals a specific action expectation:

Phrase	What it means	Who uses it
"Respectfully endorsed for appropriate action"	"Please handle this — you have authority to decide"	Superior forwarding to subordinate office
"Respectfully endorsed for information"	"FYI only — no action needed from you"	Lateral or upward endorsement
"Respectfully endorsed for approval"	"I have reviewed this and recommend approval — please sign"	Subordinate forwarding to superior
"Respectfully endorsed for comment"	"Please review and give your input"	Any direction
"Respectfully returned with recommendation"	"I have done my review — here are my findings"	Subordinate returning to superior

Fresh graduate tip: When you receive a document with endorsements, **read all the endorsements**. They tell you the document's journey — who sent it, who reviewed it, what they said, and what is expected of you. Many new staff skip the endorsements and miss critical context.

13.4 Email in Government

Government email is formal correspondence — not casual communication.[17] Every email you send is potentially a **public record**. It can be subject to Freedom of Information (FOI) requests.[5] It can be subpoenaed in administrative or legal proceedings. Write every email as if it will be read by someone other than the recipient.

Email Template 1: Request Email

```
Subject: Request for FY 2026 BANGON Disbursement Data –
         Paglat, Maguindanao del Sur

Dear [Name / Sir / Ma'am],

Assalamu Alaikum.

I am writing to request the FY 2026 disbursement data for the BANGON
program in the Municipality of Paglat, Maguindanao del Sur. This data
is needed for the mid-year OPCR review of the Social Protection
Division, due on July 15, 2026.

Specifically, we need:
1. Total amount disbursed (January – June 2026)
2. Number of beneficiaries served per barangay
3. Liquidation status per tranche

May we request this data by [date — give at least 5 working days]?

Thank you and Wassalam.

[Your name]
[Your position]
[Your office]
[Contact number]
```

Email Template 2: Follow-Up Email

```
Subject: Follow-Up: Request for FY 2026 BANGON Disbursement Data
         (sent [original date])

Dear [Name],

Assalamu Alaikum.

I am following up on my email dated [date] requesting the FY 2026
BANGON disbursement data for Paglat, Maguindanao del Sur. We have
not yet received the requested information.

As the mid-year OPCR review deadline is July 15, 2026, may we kindly
request the data by [new deadline — give 3 working days]?

Please let me know if there are any issues with the request. I am
happy to coordinate with your staff directly if that would help.

Thank you and Wassalam.

[Signature block]
```

Email Template 3: Routing/Transmittal Email

```
Subject: FOR APPROPRIATE ACTION: Referral of Constituent Complaint –
         Water System, Brgy. Kalanganan, Marawi City

Dear [Recipient],

Assalamu Alaikum.

Please find attached the constituent complaint filed by [name],
Brgy. Captain of Kalanganan, Marawi City, regarding the non-functional
Level II water system in Sitio [name].

This was referred to our office by [source] on [date]. Per our office
mandate, this falls under your division's responsibility.

Recommended action: Site inspection and status assessment within
15 working days.

Please advise on next steps.

Thank you and Wassalam.

[Signature block]
```

Email Rules in Government

CC (Carbon Copy).[18] Copy those who need to know but do not need to act. **Always CC your immediate supervisor** on substantive emails. This prevents surprises and keeps your supervisor informed.

BCC (Blind Carbon Copy). Use sparingly. Appropriate only when sending to a large distribution list where recipients do not need to see each other's addresses.

Key response words and what they mean:

Word	Meaning	Action required
"Noted"	"I have read and acknowledged"	NO — it does NOT mean "approved"
"Approved"	"I agree — this is an official action"	YES — proceed with implementation
"For compliance"		YES — it is a directive

Word	Meaning	Action required
	"You MUST do what this email says"	

Response time. Acknowledge within 24 hours, even if you cannot fully respond yet. A quick reply — *"Received. I will provide the requested data by [date]"* — is professional. Silence is not.

Never use: - Informal language or text speak ("pls," "thx," "ASAP" is acceptable but borderline) - All caps (reads as shouting) - Unprofessional tone ("I already sent this three times...")

13.5 Meeting Minutes

Every government meeting should produce minutes.[19] As a new staff member, you will likely be assigned to take minutes. This is considered junior work — and it is also the **best way to learn what is happening in your office**. Embrace it.

Meeting Minutes Template

```
MINUTES OF THE MEETING

Meeting Title : [e.g., "Weekly Staff Meeting, Social Protection Division"]
Date and Time : [e.g., "26 March 2026, 9:00 AM - 10:30 AM"]
Venue         : [e.g., "MSSD Conference Room B, Cotabato City"
                 or "Via Google Meet"]
Presiding Officer : [e.g., "Division Chief Ahmad M. Santos"]

ATTENDEES:
1. [Name] — [Position]
2. [Name] — [Position]
3. [Name] — [Position]

ABSENT:
1. [Name] — [Reason if known]

---

AGENDA AND PROCEEDINGS:

I. Call to Order
   [Time called to order, by whom]

II. Approval of Previous Minutes
    [Status: approved / approved with corrections — specify corrections]

III. Matters Arising from Previous Minutes
     [Follow-up items from last meeting and their current status]

IV. [Agenda Item 1 — use a specific title, not "Item 1"]
    [Summary of discussion — key points, not verbatim]
    [Decision reached or action item assigned]

V. [Agenda Item 2]
   [Same format]

VI. Other Matters
    [Any items raised not on the original agenda]

VII. Schedule of Next Meeting
     [Date, time, venue]

---

ACTION ITEMS:

| # | Action Item | Person Responsible | Deadline | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
```

```
| 1 | [Specific action] | [Name] | [Date] | Pending |
| 2 | [Specific action] | [Name] | [Date] | Pending |
| 3 | [Specific action] | [Name] | [Date] | Pending |

Prepared by  : [Your name, position]
Noted by     : [Presiding officer, position]
Date prepared: [Date]
```

Meeting Minutes Rules[20]

Minutes are a RECORD, not a transcript. Capture decisions and action items, not every word spoken. If a 30-minute discussion ends with a decision to deploy a team to Basilan, write the decision — not the 30 minutes of debate.

Distribute within 48 hours. Minutes lose value quickly. If people forget what was discussed, the minutes arrived too late.

The action items table is the most important part. Many readers skip the proceedings and go straight to the action items. Every action item must have a specific responsible person and a specific deadline — not "the team" and not "soon."

Get the presiding officer to note/approve before distributing. This ensures accuracy and gives the minutes official status.

Keep a running file. Maintain a folder (physical or digital) of all meeting minutes in chronological order. You will need to reference previous minutes regularly — *"Per the March 12 staff meeting minutes, Item IV..."*

13.6 Official Letters

Letters are for **external correspondence**[21] — communicating with other government agencies, LGUs, development partners, CSOs, or the public. They are more formal than memos and follow a different format.

Standard Letter Format

```
[Date]

[Recipient's full name and title]
[Position]
[Office/Organization]
[Address]

Dear [Title and Last Name / Sir / Ma'am]:

Assalamu Alaikum.

[Body — same structure as memo: purpose, background, details, action]

[Complimentary close]

Respectfully,

[Signature]
[Name]
[Position]
[Office]
```

Key Differences Between Memos and Letters

Feature	Memo	Letter
Audience	Internal (within your office or MOA)	External (other agencies, LGUs, partners, public)
Header	TO / FROM / DATE / SUBJECT	Full address block with recipient details
Salutation	None (the TO line serves this purpose)	“Dear [Title and Name]:”
Tone	Direct and functional	Formal and courteous
Closing	Signature block only	“Respectfully,” or “Very truly yours,” + signature
When to use	Routine internal communication	When communicating outside your immediate organization

13.7 Action Phrases: The Five Phrases That Control What Happens

These five phrases determine what the recipient does with your document. Using the wrong one creates confusion, delays, or inaction. Master them.

Action Phrase	What it means	When to use it	Example
"For information"[8]	Read and note — no response or action needed	Sharing data, reports, or updates the recipient should know about but does not need to act on	"The attached FY 2025 Year-End Report is forwarded for your information."
"For appropriate action"	The recipient should decide what to do and act — you are NOT prescribing the action	Routing a complaint, referral, or request to the office responsible for handling it	"The attached constituent complaint is endorsed for your appropriate action."
"For approval"	You have done the work, you are recommending an action, and the decision-maker needs to sign off	Submitting a completed CSW (briefer, proposal, budget, beneficiary list) to a superior	"The attached project proposal is submitted for your approval."
"For comment"	You want the recipient's input before finalizing	Circulating a draft document for review	"The attached draft Administrative Order is forwarded for your comment."
"For compliance"	This is a directive — the recipient MUST do what is stated	Issuing instructions, citing regulations, or following up on unmet requirements	"Per CSC MC No. 14, s. 2018,[9] compliance with posting requirements is directed."

Additional Routing Phrases[22]

Phrase	What it means
"Respectfully submitted"	This is my original work — I created this document
"Respectfully transmitted"	I am forwarding someone else's document
"Respectfully endorsed"	I am routing this to you with my recommendation
"Respectfully returned"	I am sending this back to you with my findings

Common mistake:[10] Using "submitted" and "transmitted" interchangeably. They mean different things. Use "submitted" for work you produced. Use "transmitted" for work someone else produced that you are forwarding.

13.8 Government Writing Voice: Rules for Fresh Graduates

Government writing is NOT academic writing.[11] The transition from university to government requires you to **unlearn** several habits.[23]

Academic vs. Government Writing

Academic writing	Government writing
Long sentences, complex syntax	Short sentences, simple structure
Passive voice ("It was determined that...")	Active voice ("The committee determined...")
Hedging ("It appears that there may be...")	Direct ("There is a shortage of...")
Citations in footnotes	Citations inline or in attachments
Builds to a conclusion at the end	States the conclusion FIRST, then supports it
Demonstrates the writer's knowledge	Enables the reader's decision

The Golden Rule of Government Writing

Lead with the action. Your reader is busy. They receive dozens of documents daily. Tell them what you need in the first paragraph — not the fourth.

Before (academic habit)	After (government standard)
"In light of the recent developments in the implementation of the BANGON program, and considering the various challenges encountered by the implementing municipalities, particularly in terms of fund utilization and beneficiary validation, this memorandum seeks to..."	"This memorandum requests approval of the attached BANGON beneficiary list for Paglat, Maguindanao del Sur (45 beneficiaries, FY 2026 Batch 1)."

The "before" version takes 40 words to say nothing. The "after" version takes 25 words to say everything the reader needs.

Common Government Writing Mistakes

Mistake	Example	Correction
Using "the undersigned"	"The undersigned respectfully requests..."	"I respectfully request..." (the CSC has explicitly discouraged "the undersigned")[12]
Confusing "submitted" and "transmitted"	Using them interchangeably	"Submitted" = your original work. "Transmitted" = forwarding someone else's document.
Using "thru"	"Thru the Secretary General"	"Through the Secretary General" ("thru" is informal)
Unnecessary preambles	"In connection with the above-captioned subject matter and pursuant to..."	State the purpose directly in the first sentence
Acronyms without definition	"The HRMPSB reviewed the QS per CSC MC 14"[13]	Spell out on first use: "The Human Resource Merit Promotion and Selection Board (HRMPSB)..."
Run-on paragraphs	One paragraph covering 3 different topics	One paragraph per point. Number them.

Mistake	Example	Correction
Passive voice	"It is recommended that the proposal be approved"	"I recommend approving the proposal"
Burying the conclusion	Main recommendation appears in paragraph 6	Move the recommendation to paragraph 1

Voice Principles for BARMM Writing[24]

Be direct. Government readers want answers, not suspense.

Be specific. "Several municipalities" is vague. "Three municipalities in Basilan (Lamitan City, Tipo-Tipo, and Ungkaya Pukan)" is useful.

Be concise. If you can say it in 15 words, do not use 40.

Be structured. Number your paragraphs. Use headings in long documents. Include tables for comparative data. Bold key terms.

Be courteous but not flowery. "Respectfully" is appropriate. "I humbly beg your most esteemed consideration of this insignificant submission" is not.

13.9 Government Writing Quick Reference Card

Keep this at your desk until these conventions become habit.[25]

Side 1: Document Types Quick Reference

Document	Use when	Key element
Memo	Internal communication	Subject line + action requested
Transmittal	Forwarding a CSW output	"Transmitted herewith..." + attachment list
Endorsement	Routing between offices	"Respectfully endorsed..." + action phrase
Letter	External correspondence	Formal salutation and complimentary close

Document	Use when	Key element
Minutes	Recording meeting proceedings	Action items table with persons and deadlines
Email	Fast internal/external communication	Specific subject line + clear ask + professional tone

Side 2: Action Phrases Cheat Sheet

Write this	When you mean
"For your approval"	"Please sign this — I have done the work"
"For your information"	"FYI — no action needed"
"For appropriate action"	"Please handle this — it is your responsibility"
"For your comment"	"Please review and give feedback"
"For compliance"	"You must do this — it is a requirement"
"Respectfully submitted"	"This is my original work"
"Respectfully transmitted"	"I am forwarding someone else's work"
"Respectfully endorsed"	"I am routing this to you with my recommendation"
"Respectfully returned"	"I am sending this back with my findings"

Key Takeaways

- **The memo is your workhorse.** Learn the format cold: TO, FROM, DATE, SUBJECT, numbered paragraphs, action requested in paragraphs 1 and 4.
- **The transmittal memo is your CSW's cover page.** It accompanies your substantive work and tells the decision-maker what to do with it.
- **Endorsements trace a document's journey.** Read all endorsements to understand context. Write endorsements with the correct action phrase.

- **Government email is formal correspondence.** CC your supervisor. Acknowledge within 24 hours. Write as if it will be FOI'd.
- **Meeting minutes are your learning tool.** Capture decisions and action items, not verbatim transcripts. Distribute within 48 hours.
- **Five action phrases control everything.** "For information," "for appropriate action," "for approval," "for comment," and "for compliance" each trigger different responses. Use the right one.
- **Government writing leads with the action.** State what you need in paragraph 1. Support it in paragraphs 2-3. Restate it in your closing paragraph.
- **Unlearn academic habits.** Short sentences. Active voice. Specific numbers. No hedging. No preambles. The reader needs a decision, not a literature review.

Your writing is your professional identity.[26] In a government where most work is documented in writing, the quality of your memos, briefers, and reports is **the quality of your work**. Write well, and your career advances. Write poorly, and it stalls. Start practicing now.

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1. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (CSW Document Formats: Memorandum Structure). ↩
2. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (Transmittal Memorandum Format and Conventions). ↩
3. Philippine government endorsement conventions as practiced across national and sub-national agencies; see also BAA No. 13, Book V (Administrative Procedures in BARMM). ↩
4. These action phrases follow standard Philippine government correspondence conventions used across all national agencies and local government units. ↩
5. Executive Order No. 2, s. 2016 (Operationalizing the Right of the People to Information and the Freedom of Information Program). ↩
6. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (Memorandum Conventions: One Memo, One Subject Rule). ↩
7. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (Memorandum Conventions: Numbered Paragraphs). ↩
8. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (Action Phrases and Routing Conventions). ↩
9. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018 (prescribing posting and publication requirements for government positions). ↩

10. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (Distinction Between "Submitted" and "Transmitted"). ↩
11. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region* (2026), ch. 4 (Government Writing Voice: Academic vs. Government Writing). ↩
12. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 12, s. 2005 (discouraging the use of "the undersigned" in official government correspondence). ↩
13. CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018 (Revised Rules on Appointment, including HRMPSB composition and Qualification Standards). ↩
14. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 4 (Memorandum Conventions — subject line specificity, one-memo-one-subject rule, numbered paragraphs, and action statement placement). ↩
15. *Id.* (distinguishing transmittal memoranda from regular memoranda based on the relative importance of attachments). ↩
16. *Id.* (Endorsement Chain — each endorsement adds a layer to the document's institutional journey and serves as a traceable record). ↩
17. Office of the President, Executive Order No. 2, s. 2016 (Operationalizing the Freedom of Information Program), *supra* note 5; *see also* Rep. Act No. 10173, the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (governing the handling of personal information in government communications). ↩
18. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 4 (Email Conventions — CC practices, response protocols, and professional tone requirements in government correspondence). ↩
19. *Id.* (Meeting Minutes Format and Conventions — capturing decisions and action items, not verbatim transcripts). ↩
20. *Id.* (Meeting Minutes Rules — 48-hour distribution requirement, action items table as the most important element, presiding officer sign-off). ↩
21. *Id.* (Official Letter Format — distinguishing letters from memos by audience, header format, salutation, and tone). ↩
22. *Id.* (Routing Phrases — "respectfully submitted" for original work vs. "respectfully transmitted" for forwarded documents). ↩
23. *See* Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 4 (Government Writing Voice — contrasting academic and government writing conventions); *see also* CSC MC No. 12, s. 2005, *supra* note 12 (discouraging "the undersigned"). ↩
24. Mambayao, *supra* note 1, at ch. 4 (Voice Principles — directness, specificity, conciseness, structure, and courtesy in BARMM government writing). ↩
25. *Id.* (Government Writing Quick Reference Card — document types and action phrases consolidated for desk reference). ↩
26. *Id.* at ch. 1 (the CSW doctrine — written output as the primary measure of professional competence in government). ↩

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Chapter 14: The Bangsamoro Government Employee Journey

Your career is a journey with defined stages. Know what is coming at each one.

You have applied, interviewed, and received your appointment letter. Now what?

This chapter maps the **complete employee lifecycle** from application to retirement, based on BAA 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code).[1] Think of it as a roadmap – you are at the starting point, and this chapter shows you every stage ahead so you can prepare, not just react.

Every Bangsamoro government employee – whether you work in the Parliament, a ministry, an office, or an LGU – follows this journey. The milestones are the same. The timeline varies based on your performance, the availability of vacancies, and the choices you make along the way.

14.1 The Journey Map

Here is your career from beginning to end, in one view:

```
APPLY --> HIRE --> ONBOARD --> PROBATION --> PERFORM --> DEVELOP -->
PROMOTE --> LEAD --> TRANSITION
```

Stage	Duration	What Happens	Key Milestone
Apply	1-3 months	Job search, PDS submission, interview, Comparative Assessment	Appointment letter
Onboard	Days 1-30	Oath of office, ID processing,	Completed orientation checklist

Stage	Duration	What Happens	Key Milestone
		orientation, office tour, first assignments	
Probation	Months 1-6	Learning the job, first CSW assignments, supervisor check-ins	Probationary evaluation PASSED
Perform	Years 1-3	IPCR targets, regular CSW output, SPMS ratings, training	First "Very Satisfactory" or higher rating
Develop	Years 2-5	Functional training, CSW mastery, lateral assignments, graduate studies	Competency proficiency across core areas
Promote	Year 3+	Next-in-rank competition, competitive selection, salary grade advancement	First promotion
Lead	Year 5+	Supervisory role, team management, system design, mentoring	First supervisory appointment
Transition	Varies	Transfer, secondment, retirement, resignation, or new career	Graceful exit with knowledge transfer

Not everyone follows this timeline exactly. Some people reach the "Lead" stage in 5 years. Some take 15. The stages are the same – the speed depends on you, on vacancies, and on opportunity.

What matters is that you **know where you are** at every stage, and you know **what comes next**.

14.2 Onboarding: Your First 30 Days

Your first 30 days set the tone for your entire career. This is when your supervisor, your colleagues, and your office leadership form their first impression of you. Make it count.

Day 1: The Administrative Foundation

Your first day is mostly paperwork – but every step matters.

- **Report to HR.** You will process your appointment documents, take your oath of office, and receive your government ID. Bring all original documents (diploma, TOR, CSC eligibility certificate, birth certificate, NBI clearance). HR will need certified true copies.
- **Oath of office.** This is administered by the appointing authority or an authorized officer. It is a brief ceremony, but it is legally significant. From the moment you take the oath, you are bound by RA 6713 (Code of Conduct),[2] BAA 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code),[3] and all applicable laws governing public officials and employees.
- **Government ID and system access.** You will be enrolled in biometric attendance (or receive a Daily Time Record form), issued your government email, and given access to office systems. Some offices use Google Workspace. Others use Microsoft. Learn whichever your office uses.
- **Benefits enrollment.** HR will process your enrollment in GSIS (Government Service Insurance System),[4] PhilHealth,[5] and Pag-IBIG Fund.[6] These are mandatory deductions from your salary – but they provide retirement benefits, health insurance, and housing loan access.

Days 1-3: Know Your Office

- **Meet your immediate supervisor.** This is the most important relationship in your first year. Ask about their expectations, communication preferences, and how they want you to report progress. Some supervisors want daily email updates. Others prefer weekly face-to-face check-ins. Ask – do not guess.
- **Receive your position description.** This document defines your official duties and responsibilities. Read it carefully. If anything is unclear, ask your supervisor to explain. Your **IPCR** (Individual Performance Commitment and Review) will be based on this.[7]
- **Get your office tour.** Learn where the conference room is, where the prayer room is, where the filing room is, where the comfort room is. Small details, but they matter when you need to find a document at 4:30 PM.

- **Meet your team.** Introduce yourself to every colleague in your division. Learn their names, their positions, and what they do. In Bangsamoro culture, relationships are foundational – take time to build them.

Week 1: Understand the System

- **Read the Manual of Procedures (MOP)** – if your office has one. Not all offices do. If there is no MOP, ask your supervisor how key processes work: How does a memo get approved? How are documents filed? What is the routing for outgoing correspondence?
- **Study the organizational chart.** Know where your division sits in the office structure. Know who your Division Chief is, who the Director is, who the Minister or head of office is. Understand the chain of command.
- **Learn the filing system.** Every office has one – some digital, some paper-based, some both. Learn it immediately. You will be filing and retrieving documents from Day 1.
- **Attend your first staff meeting.** Listen more than you speak. Take notes. Observe how people interact, who leads the discussion, and what the current priorities are. You will learn more about your office from one staff meeting than from reading 10 documents.

Week 1-2: Your First Supervisor Check-In

Your supervisor will schedule a check-in – or you should request one. This is your opportunity to:

- **Clarify expectations.** What does your supervisor expect you to produce in your first month? What does "good work" look like in this office?
- **Receive your first assignments.** These will likely be small: drafting a memo, organizing a file, preparing data for a report. Treat them as seriously as you would a major project. Your supervisor is testing your reliability and attention to detail.
- **Ask about communication preferences.** How should you submit work – email, printed copy, shared drive? When should you escalate problems versus solving them yourself? How does your supervisor prefer to be addressed?

Week 2-4: Your First CSW Assignment

Within your first month, you should complete at least one substantive **Complete Staff Work** assignment using the ADDRESS IT methodology (see Chapter 10). This is your proof of concept – your demonstration that you can produce decision-ready work.

Your supervisor will evaluate not just the content but the process:

- Did you understand the assignment correctly? (Step 1: Analyze Context)
- Did you research adequately? (Step 3: Research)
- Did you present options, not just information? (Step 4: Explore)
- Is the output complete – no loose ends, no missing attachments? (Step 5: Submit)

By Day 30: Your Checklist

By the end of your first month, you should be able to answer "yes" to all of these:

- ☐ I know my office's mandate under BAA 13[8]
- ☐ I have read my position description and understand my duties
- ☐ I know my supervisor's expectations and communication preferences
- ☐ I know the approval workflow for documents in my office
- ☐ I have submitted at least one completed staff work assignment
- ☐ I am enrolled in GSIS, PhilHealth, and Pag-IBIG
- ☐ I have my government ID and system access
- ☐ I know my colleagues' names and what they do
- ☐ I know where the MOP is (or I know there is none)
- ☐ I have attended at least one staff meeting

If you cannot check all of these, you are behind. Ask your supervisor for help catching up.

14.3 Probation: Months 1-6

The first six months of your appointment are a **probationary period**. This is when your supervisor formally evaluates whether you can do the job.

What Is Being Evaluated

Your probationary evaluation measures two things:

1. **Results** – Are you completing assignments on time? Is your work accurate? Does your CSW meet the standard? Are you meeting the targets in your position description?

2. **Behaviors** – Are you reliable? Do you follow the chain of command? Do you accept feedback constructively? Do you work well with your team? Do you observe the 12 Pillars of Moral Governance[9] in your daily conduct?

The Probationary Evaluation

At the end of your probationary period, your supervisor submits a formal evaluation to HR. The evaluation states whether you have performed **satisfactorily** or **unsatisfactorily**.

- **Satisfactory**: You pass probation. Your appointment is confirmed. You are now a regular employee with full security of tenure (if you hold a permanent appointment).
- **Unsatisfactory**: Your appointment may be terminated. BAA 17[10] and CSC rules allow for termination of probationary employees who fail to meet performance standards. This is rare – but it happens.

How to Succeed During Probation

Ask questions early. In your first month, asking questions shows initiative. By month three, not knowing basic processes signals that you are not learning. Front-load your questions.

Seek feedback proactively. Do not wait for your supervisor to tell you what you did wrong. After completing an assignment, ask: "Is this the level of detail you expect?" or "How can I improve this for next time?"

Document your work. Keep a log of every assignment you complete, every training you attend, and every positive feedback you receive. This becomes evidence during your evaluation.

Produce quality CSW from Day 1. Your supervisor is looking for the answer to one question: "Can this person produce work that I do not need to redo?" Every memo, every spreadsheet, every briefer you submit is your answer.

Be on time. Every day. Attendance matters. Chronic tardiness during probation is one of the most common reasons for a negative evaluation. Government tracks attendance through biometrics or DTR – there is no hiding it.

The Most Common Reasons Probation Fails

Reason	What It Looks Like	How to Avoid It
Poor attendance	Frequent absences, chronic tardiness	Set an alarm. Arrive 15 minutes early. File leave properly.
Incomplete work	Memos with missing attachments, data with errors	Use a checklist before submitting anything. Double-check numbers.
Inability to follow instructions	Producing different output than what was assigned	Repeat back the assignment in your own words before starting.
Poor attitude toward feedback	Becoming defensive or argumentative when corrected	Thank your supervisor for feedback. Fix the issue. Move on.
Not learning office systems	Still not knowing the filing system in month 3	Take notes. Create your own reference sheet. Ask colleagues.

14.4 Civil Service Systems You Must Know

Every BARMM civil servant interacts with these systems. Learn them in your first month – they will govern your career for as long as you serve.

SPMS: Strategic Performance Management System

The **SPMS** is the official CSC performance management framework used across all government agencies, including BARMM.[11] It connects your individual work to your office's targets and to the Bangsamoro Development Plan.

IPCR (Individual Performance Commitment and Review) – This is YOUR performance contract. At the beginning of each rating period, you and your supervisor agree on specific targets. At the end, you are evaluated against those targets.

OPCR (Office Performance Commitment and Review) – This is your office's performance contract. Your office commits to specific outputs and outcomes for the year. Your IPCR targets should support the OPCR.

The annual cycle:

Month	Activity	Your Role
January	Target-setting	Meet with your supervisor. Set IPCR targets for the year. Align with OPCR.
July	Mid-year review	Submit mid-year accomplishment report. Discuss progress with your supervisor. Adjust targets if needed.
December	Year-end evaluation	Submit accomplishment report. Your supervisor rates your performance.

The 5-point rating scale:

Rating	Score	What It Means	Consequence
Outstanding	5	Exceeded all targets significantly	Priority for promotion, training, awards
Very Satisfactory	4	Met or exceeded most targets	Eligible for PBB, strong promotion candidate
Satisfactory	3	Met basic targets	Eligible for PBB, meets minimum requirement
Unsatisfactory	2	Failed to meet some targets	Not eligible for PBB. Performance improvement plan.
Poor	1	Failed to meet most targets	Grounds for non-renewal, demotion, or dismissal

Your SPMS rating determines: - **PBB eligibility** – you need at least "Satisfactory" AND your office must meet its OPCR - **Promotion ranking** – higher ratings give you an edge in the Comparative Assessment - **Training priority** – Outstanding performers get first pick of training opportunities - **Step increment** – satisfactory performance is required for your periodic salary increase

SALN: Statement of Assets, Liabilities, and Net Worth

SALN is a constitutional requirement.[12] Every government official and employee must file one annually. The deadline is **April 30**.

- **Your first SALN**: Filed within 30 days of your appointment
- **Annual SALN**: Filed every year covering assets as of December 31 of the previous year
- **Last SALN**: Filed within 30 days of separation from service

What to declare: all real property, personal property over PHP 50,000, liabilities, business interests, financial connections, and relatives in government within the 4th degree of consanguinity or affinity. See Chapter 16 for a complete SALN walkthrough.

Failure to file is grounds for dismissal. This is not optional.

Leave Management

Permanent employees earn: - **15 days vacation leave** per year (earned monthly at 1.25 days)[13] - **15 days sick leave** per year (earned monthly at 1.25 days)[14] - **Maternity leave**: 105 days (RA 11210, Expanded Maternity Leave Act)[15] - **Paternity leave**: 7 days - **Solo parent leave**: 7 days - **VAWC leave**: 10 days (for victims of violence against women and children) - **Special privilege leave**: 3 days per year - **Study leave**: up to 6 months after 7 years of service (with supervisor endorsement) - **Force leave**: 5 days of your VL are mandatory (you must use them)

How to file leave: 1. Fill out the CSC Leave Application Form (CS Form 6) 2. Indicate the type of leave, dates, and reason 3. Submit to your supervisor for recommendation 4. HR processes the approval 5. For VL: file at least 5 days in advance. For SL: file within 5 days of return with medical certificate if applicable

COS and JO employees do NOT receive leave benefits. This is one of the strongest reasons to pursue a permanent appointment.

PDS: Personal Data Sheet

Keep your **CS Form 212** updated. You will need it for every promotion, transfer, and appointment. When you complete a training, earn a degree, or change your personal information, update your PDS and submit the revised version to HR.

PRAISE and PBB

PRAISE (Program on Awards and Incentives for Service Excellence) is the government's recognition framework.[16] Your office should have a PRAISE committee that identifies and recognizes outstanding performance monthly, quarterly, and annually.

PBB (Performance-Based Bonus) is an annual cash bonus. To qualify: - Your office must meet its OPCR targets (at least "Satisfactory") - You must individually meet your IPCR targets (at least "Satisfactory") - Amount varies by performance tier: typically PHP 10,000-35,000

If your office fails its OPCR, no one in the office receives PBB – even if your individual performance was Outstanding. This creates shared accountability.

Step Increment

Your salary increases within your current Salary Grade through **step increments**. Each SG has 8 steps. You move to the next step every **3 years** of continuous satisfactory service.[17] This is an automatic salary increase – no competition required – as long as your SPMS ratings are satisfactory.

Government Benefits

Upon appointment, you are automatically enrolled in:

System	What It Provides	Your Contribution
GSIS	Retirement pension, life insurance, disability benefits, salary loans	Monthly premium deducted from salary
PhilHealth	Health insurance coverage	Monthly premium deducted from salary
Pag-IBIG	Housing loan, savings program, calamity loan	Monthly contribution deducted from salary

These deductions reduce your take-home pay but provide long-term security that private sector employment rarely matches.

14.5 Cultural Navigation

Working in the Bangsamoro government is not just about mastering systems and procedures. It is about navigating a **cultural environment** that may be different from what you experienced in school or in other workplaces.

Prayer Times and Prayer Rooms

Every BARMM office provides a **prayer space**. The five daily prayers (Fajr, Dhuhr, Asr, Maghrib, and Isha) are observed. During work hours, Dhuhr and Asr are the most relevant. Staff will briefly leave their desks to pray. This is normal, expected, and protected.

If you are Muslim: Coordinate with your supervisor so work continuity is maintained during prayer times. Most offices have informal rotating arrangements.

If you are not Muslim: Maintain quiet and respect during prayer times. Do not schedule urgent meetings during these periods. You will not be required to pray – but you are expected to create space for those who do.

Ramadan

Ramadan transforms the workplace. For approximately 30 days each year:

- **Adjusted work hours.** Many BARMM offices shift to earlier schedules (e.g., 7:30 AM - 3:30 PM) to accommodate fasting employees.
- **Energy levels change.** Fasting colleagues may have less physical energy, especially in the afternoon. Be considerate in scheduling demanding tasks.
- **Iftar (breaking of fast).** Some offices organize collective iftar gatherings. Participating – even if you are not fasting – is a meaningful gesture of solidarity.
- **Heightened spiritual observance.** The office atmosphere becomes more reflective. Respect this tone.

For non-fasting staff: Avoid eating conspicuously in front of fasting colleagues. Use the pantry or cafeteria. This is not a rule – it is respect.

Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha

These are the two major Islamic holidays. BARMM offices close on these days. Learn the appropriate greeting: **"Eid Mubarak"** (Blessed Eid). For non-Muslim staff, saying "Eid Mubarak" to your colleagues is appreciated and appropriate.

Bangsamoro Hospitality and Workplace Culture

- **Food sharing** is common. When a colleague shares food, accepting is a sign of respect.
- **Respect for elders** is deeply valued. Address senior colleagues with appropriate honorifics. "Sir" and "Ma'am" are baseline; "Ama" (father/elder) and "Ina" (mother/elder) are used in some groups.
- **Clan and family networks** are real. Your colleague's cousin may work in another ministry. Treat every professional interaction with integrity because reputation travels through networks.
- **Pakikisama** (getting along) and **hiya** (social propriety) operate here as they do elsewhere in the Philippines, with the added dimension of Islamic and Bangsamoro cultural values.

Working Across Ethnolinguistic Groups

BARMM has **13 ethnolinguistic groups**: Meranaw, Maguindanaon, Tausug, Sama, Yakan, Iranun, Kalibugan (from Zamboanga Peninsula), Palawanon, Molbog, Jama Mapun, Badjao (Sama Dilaut), Sangil, and Teduray. Plus settler communities (Visayan, Ilocano, Tagalog) and indigenous peoples.

Your office may include colleagues from several of these groups. Here is how to navigate:

- **Do not assume all Bangsamoro are the same.** A Tausug colleague and a Meranaw colleague may have very different customs, languages, and perspectives.
- **Learn basic greetings** in your colleagues' languages. Even "Salamat" (thank you) in Meranaw or Maguindanaon signals respect.
- **Ask about customs you do not understand.** Genuine curiosity is always appreciated. Assumptions are not.
- **Language in meetings**: Official business is conducted in English and Filipino. But informal conversations often happen in local languages. If you feel excluded, politely ask colleagues to include you. Most will.

"I Am Not Muslim" – Your Place in a Muslim-Majority Workplace

If you are not Muslim and you work in BARMM government, here is what you need to know:

- **You are welcome.** The BOL guarantees the rights of all communities in the Bangsamoro, including settler communities (Article IX, Section 15)[18] and indigenous peoples (Article IX, Section 3).[19] The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance include **inclusivity** as a core value.
- **You will not be required to practice Islam.** No one will ask you to pray, fast, or wear Islamic clothing.
- **You will be expected to respect Islamic governance values.** Amanah (trustworthiness), adl (justice), shura (consultation), rahmah (compassion), and sidq (truthfulness) are universal values. Respecting them does not require changing your faith.
- **The greeting "Assalamu Alaikum"** means "peace be upon you." It is appropriate for anyone to use. The response is "Wa Alaikum Assalam" (and upon you, peace). Using it signals respect and cultural awareness.
- **Non-Muslim staff serve in every part of BARMM government** – including the Parliament Secretariat, ministries, commissions, and LGUs. Your competence, not your faith, determines your career.

14.6 Ten Mistakes New Staff Make (And How to Avoid Them)

Every mistake on this list has been made by real government employees in their first year. Learn from their experience.

Mistake 1: Not Reading the BOL

You work for the only autonomous region in the Philippines – a government created by Republic Act 11054 (the Bangsamoro Organic Law).[20] If you have not read at least the key provisions of the BOL, you do not fully understand the institution you serve. Read Articles IV-V (powers), Article VII (the Parliament), Article IX (basic rights), Article X (justice system), and Article XII (fiscal autonomy).

Mistake 2: Assuming National Government Rules Apply

BARMM has its own **Civil Service Code** (BAA 17),[21] its own **Administrative Code** (BAA 13),[22] its own **Budget System Act** (BAA 84),[23] its own **Education Code** (BAA 18),[24] and its own **Local Governance Code** (BAA 49).[25] These may differ from national rules. When in doubt, check the BAA – not the national law.

Mistake 3: Not Learning the Approval Workflow

Every document in government follows a routing chain. A memo does not go directly from your desk to the Minister. It goes through your supervisor, your Division Chief, possibly a Director, and then to the head of office. Learn this chain on Day 1. Skipping it – even once – erodes trust.

Mistake 4: Waiting to Be Told What to Do

Government rewards initiative. If you see a problem, propose a solution. If you finish your assignment early, ask for the next one. If you notice a process that could be improved, write a brief memo suggesting improvements. Your supervisor will notice the difference between a staff member who waits and one who acts.

Mistake 5: Submitting Incomplete CSW

The "Completed" in Complete Staff Work means **completed**. No missing attachments. No placeholder data. No sections marked "TBD." No forwarding a problem without a recommendation. Before you submit any work, ask yourself: "If my supervisor signs this right now, will there be any unanswered question?" If the answer is yes, the work is not complete.

Mistake 6: Not Knowing Your Supervisor's Communication Style

Some supervisors want detailed daily updates by email. Others want a weekly verbal report. Some prefer printed documents. Others work entirely through shared drives. Some like formal "Sir/Ma'am" address. Others prefer first names. **Ask your supervisor directly** in your first week. Getting this wrong creates friction that has nothing to do with the quality of your work.

Mistake 7: Avoiding the Cultural Context

You are in the Bangsamoro. Learn the greetings. Learn the prayer times. Learn the cultural calendar. Attend the iftar. Say "Eid Mubarak" on Eid. If you treat the cultural context as something to endure rather than something to embrace, you will always be an outsider – regardless of how technically competent you are.

Mistake 8: Skipping Training Opportunities

Every training you attend is recorded and counts toward your competency profile for promotion. Training accounts for **15% of the Comparative Assessment** score when you compete for your next position.[26] Accept every training offered in your first year. Attend free CSC webinars. Complete online courses. Build your training hours aggressively.

Mistake 9: Not Connecting Your Work to BDP Goals

Your IPCR should reference the **Bangsamoro Development Plan**. When you write a project proposal, cite which BDP goal it supports. When you draft a briefer, note the relevant BDP chapter. When you present to your team, connect your division's output to the BDP framework. This demonstrates strategic awareness – a competency that separates staff who get promoted from staff who get passed over.

Mistake 10: Thinking This Is Just a Job

You are not working for a regular bureaucracy. You are implementing the **Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro** – a peace agreement that ended decades of armed conflict. Every program you run, every policy you draft, every barangay you serve is a **peace dividend**. The transition period is when credibility is built or lost. If the government delivers, trust deepens. If it fails, the peace process is undermined. Your daily work is the frontline of this test.

Treat it accordingly.

Actionable Tool: "First 30 Days Planner"

Use this planner to track your onboarding progress. Review it weekly with your supervisor.

Week	Tasks	Status
Day 1	Oath of office, HR processing, government ID, system access	☐ Done
Day 1-3	Meet supervisor, receive position description, office tour	☐ Done
Week 1	Read MOP, study org chart, learn filing system, attend first staff meeting	☐ Done
Week 1-2	First supervisor check-in: expectations, assignments, communication style	☐ Done
Week 2	Enroll in GSIS, PhilHealth, Pag-IBIG (confirm with HR)	☐ Done
Week 2-3	Complete first CSW assignment using ADDRESS IT	☐ Done
Week 3	File first SALN (within 30 days of appointment)	☐ Done
Week 3-4	Attend government orientation seminar (if scheduled)	☐ Done
Day 30	Complete the "By Day 30" checklist in Section 14.2	☐ Done

Supervisor review date: ___

Notes from supervisor: _____

Next chapter: Chapter 15 – Career Growth and Development

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1. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code). ↩
2. Rep. Act No. 6713 (Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees), sec. 4. ↩
3. BAA No. 17, sec. 2. ↩
4. Rep. Act No. 8291 (GSIS Act of 1997). ↩
5. Rep. Act No. 7875, as amended by Rep. Act No. 11223 (Universal Health Care Act). ↩
6. Rep. Act No. 9679 (Home Development Mutual Fund Law of 2009). ↩
7. Civil Service Commission, Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS) Guidelines, CSC MC No. 6, s. 2012. ↩
8. BAA No. 13 (Bangsamoro Administrative Code). ↩
9. Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4 (Moral Governance). ↩
10. BAA No. 17, sec. 27 (Probationary Period). ↩
11. Civil Service Commission, Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS) Guidelines, CSC MC No. 6, s. 2012. ↩
12. Const. art. XI, sec. 17. ↩
13. Civil Service Commission, Omnibus Rules on Leave, Rule XVI, sec. 1. ↩
14. Civil Service Commission, Omnibus Rules on Leave, Rule XVI, sec. 1. ↩
15. Rep. Act No. 11210 (Expanded Maternity Leave Act), sec. 3. ↩
16. Civil Service Commission, PRAISE Guidelines, CSC MC No. 1, s. 2001. ↩
17. Civil Service Commission, Rules on Step Increment, CSC MC No. 1, s. 1997. ↩
18. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 15, art. IX. ↩
19. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 3, art. IX. ↩
20. Rep. Act No. 11054 (Bangsamoro Organic Law). ↩
21. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code). ↩
22. BAA No. 13 (Bangsamoro Administrative Code). ↩
23. BAA No. 84 (Budget System Act). ↩
24. BAA No. 18 (Bangsamoro Education Code). ↩
25. BAA No. 49 (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code). ↩
26. Civil Service Commission, Omnibus Rules on Appointments and Other Human Resource Actions (ORAOHRA), Rule VII. ↩

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Chapter 15: Career Growth and Development

Government is one of the few employers in the Philippines where your promotion path is legally defined, your salary increases are guaranteed by law, and your training is a right – not a privilege. But you have to know the system to use it.

Your first day is behind you. Your probation is complete. You are producing quality work and your supervisor trusts you with real assignments. Now the question changes from "Can I do this job?" to "Where does this job take me?"

This chapter answers that question. It covers how promotion works, what you will earn at each level, the competency frameworks that shape your development, the training available to you, how to move laterally across offices, and the path from staff member to supervisor to director.

15.1 How Promotion Works – The Mechanics

Promotion in BARMM government is **not automatic**. You do not get promoted just because you have been in your position for a certain number of years. Promotion requires three things: a **vacancy**, you meeting the **Qualification Standards (QS)**, and you competing successfully through the **HRMPSB process**.

The Promotion Process (Step by Step)

Step 1: A vacancy opens. Someone resigns, retires, gets promoted, transfers, or a new position is created through the plantilla. Without a vacancy, there is no promotion – regardless of how qualified you are.

Step 2: The vacancy is posted. The HR office posts the position for a minimum of **10 calendar days** (CSC rule),[3] both internally and externally. This means external applicants can also compete for the position – including people from other offices and from outside government.

Step 3: "Next-in-rank" gets priority. Employees one level below the vacant position receive **priority consideration** in the evaluation.[4] But "next-in-rank" is a preference, not a guarantee. The HRMPSB evaluates ALL qualified applicants – internal and external.

Step 4: Comparative Assessment. The same 5 criteria used in hiring apply to promotion:

Criteria	Weight	What Is Evaluated
Education	25%	Degree relevance, graduate units, honors
Experience	25%	Years and relevance of work experience
Training	15%	Relevant seminars, workshops, certifications
Eligibility	10%	Type and level of CS eligibility
Interview	25%	Competency-Based Interview performance

Step 5: HRMPSB recommendation. The board ranks candidates and submits the top 3-5 to the appointing authority (Minister, Secretary General, Director).

Step 6: Appointment. The appointing authority selects from the shortlist. The selected candidate receives a new appointment letter with the higher salary grade.

Realistic Promotion Timelines

From	To	Typical Timeline	What You Need	Common Blocker
SG 11	SG 13	2-3 years	SPMS rating of VS or higher, basic training hours	No vacancy in your office
SG 13	SG 15	2-3 years	Accumulated experience, intermediate training	CSC eligibility (if you do not have it yet)
SG 15	SG 18	3-5 years	Specialized training,	

From	To	Typical Timeline	What You Need	Common Blocker
			demonstrated CSW proficiency	Competition from lateral entrants
SG 18	SG 22	4-6 years	Supervisory training, leadership competencies	Fewer positions – the pyramid narrows
SG 22	SG 24	3-5 years	Division Chief readiness, management experience	Very competitive – may require transfer
SG 24	SG 27	5-10 years	Director-level competencies, strategic track record	Often requires transfer to a different MOA

The Reality Check

Promotion speed depends on two factors you cannot fully control:

1. **Whether vacancies exist in your office.** In a small office with 10 staff and no turnover, you might wait 5 years for a promotion. In a rapidly growing ministry with many new positions being created, you might get promoted in 18 months.
2. **Whether you have competitors.** A next-in-rank position with no other qualified applicants is almost certain. The same position with 5 strong applicants is a genuine competition.

Choose your office strategically (see Chapter 6). An office that is growing, has frequent turnover, or is creating new positions offers faster promotion than a stable office with low turnover.

15.2 Salary Grade Progression

Your salary is determined by two factors: your **Salary Grade (SG)** set by the Salary Standardization Law (SSL)[1] and your **Step** within that grade. Each SG has 8 steps. You advance to the next step every **3 years** of continuous satisfactory service.[2]

Salary Grade Table

SG	Position Level	Monthly Base (Step 1, approx.)	Monthly Base (Step 8, approx.)	Annual Base (Step 1, approx.)
8	Entry clerk/ aide	PHP 20,000	PHP 22,500	PHP 240,000
11	Entry professional (fresh graduate)	PHP 27,000	PHP 31,000	PHP 324,000
13	Junior professional	PHP 30,500	PHP 35,000	PHP 366,000
15	Mid-junior professional	PHP 38,000	PHP 43,000	PHP 456,000
18	Senior professional / Section Chief	PHP 46,000	PHP 53,000	PHP 552,000
20	Senior specialist	PHP 55,000	PHP 63,000	PHP 660,000
22	Supervising / Department Head (LGU)	PHP 65,000	PHP 75,000	PHP 780,000
24	Division Chief	PHP 85,000	PHP 97,000	PHP 1,020,000
25	Assistant Director	PHP 95,000	PHP 109,000	PHP 1,140,000
27	Director III	PHP 130,000	PHP 149,000	PHP 1,560,000
28	Director IV	PHP 140,000	PHP 160,000	PHP 1,680,000
30	Undersecretary	PHP 145,000	PHP 170,000	PHP 1,740,000
31	Minister / Secretary General	PHP 155,000	PHP 180,000	PHP 1,860,000

Note: These are approximate figures based on recent SSL tranches.[5] Actual amounts change with each tranche update.

Additional Compensation

On top of your base salary, you receive:

Allowance/Bonus	Amount	Frequency
PERA (Personnel Economic Relief Allowance)	PHP 2,000/month	Monthly
ACA (Additional Compensation Allowance)	Varies	Monthly
COLA (Cost of Living Allowance)	Integrated into base pay in recent tranches	–
Year-end bonus (13th month)	1 month salary	December
Cash gift	PHP 5,000	December
PBB (Performance-Based Bonus)	PHP 10,000-35,000 (varies by tier)	Annual
Step increment	Automatic salary increase within your SG	Every 3 years
Loyalty award	Cash award	Every 5 years (10th, 15th, 20th year, etc.)

Fresh Graduate Salary Reality

At **SG 11 (Step 1)**, you earn approximately **PHP 27,000/month base** plus allowances. After deductions for GSIS, PhilHealth, and Pag-IBIG, your take-home is approximately **PHP 25,000-28,000/month**.

This is lower than many private sector entry positions. But government provides:

- **Job security** – plantilla positions are permanent. You cannot be fired without cause and due process.[6]
- **Comprehensive health insurance** – PhilHealth plus GSIS sickness benefits
- **Retirement pension** – GSIS provides a monthly pension for life after retirement (private sector 401k/SSS does not match this)

- **Housing loan access** – Pag-IBIG housing loan at below-market interest rates
- **Leave benefits** – 30 days annually (VL + SL), not counting special leaves
- **PBB and 13th month** – guaranteed annual bonuses
- **Career path** – legally defined promotion structure from SG 11 to SG 31

The total compensation package – salary plus benefits plus pension – becomes increasingly competitive with private sector as you advance beyond SG 18.

15.3 The Three Competency Frameworks

Your career development is guided by **competency frameworks** – structured descriptions of the knowledge, skills, and attitudes required at each level. BARMM uses three interconnected frameworks. Knowing which one applies to you, and where you stand on each competency, is essential for career planning.

Framework 1: Parliament Staff Competencies (25 Competencies)[7]

Who it applies to: All staff working in an MP's office or the Parliament Secretariat.

Structure: Three tiers with 25 total competencies: - **Core competencies** (5) – for ALL Parliament staff: Critical/Creative/Strategic Thinking, Effective Communication, Synergistic Collaboration, Complete Staff Work, Public Service and Cultural Competence - **Leadership competencies** (5) – for supervisors and senior staff - **Functional competencies** (15) – 5 per role type: - **PAO** (Political Affairs Officer): Stakeholder engagement and constituency building, representation, advocacy and lobbying, project and events management, monitoring and evaluation - **LSO** (Legislative Staff Officer): Investigation and research, policy making and analysis, legal/legislative competence, attention to details and quality, oversight skills - **PIMAO** (Public Information and Media Affairs Officer): Strategic communications, documentation, social media management, print and digital media, media handling

Assessment scale: 4 levels – Needs Improvement, Developing, Proficient, Exemplary

Your target as entry staff: Reach "Developing" in all Core competencies within Year 1. Reach "Proficient" by Year 3.

Framework 2: ACSCCRaPATFEE (12 Competencies)[8]

Who it applies to: Any BARMM government worker who produces Complete Staff Work – which means everyone.

The 12 competencies:

#	Competency	What It Means in Practice
1	**Analytical and Critical Thinking**	Examining issues from multiple angles before recommending action
2	**Creativity and Innovation**	Generating new approaches to persistent problems
3	**Strategic Thinking**	Connecting your daily work to BDP goals and the broader mission
4	**Communication**	Writing clear memos, briefers, and reports; presenting ideas effectively
5	**Collaboration and Teamwork**	Working across divisions and ministries to produce coordinated outputs
6	**Research and Analysis**	Gathering data, reviewing literature, validating sources
7	**Problem-Solving and Decision Making**	Identifying the root cause and recommending actionable solutions
8	**Attention to Details and Quality**	Producing error-free work that meets professional standards
9	**Time and Attention Management**	Meeting deadlines while managing competing priorities
10	**Flexibility and Adaptability**	Adjusting to new assignments, changing priorities, and ambiguity
11		

#	Competency	What It Means in Practice
	Emotional Intelligence and Accountability	Managing your reactions, taking responsibility for your work
12	**Ethics and Integrity**	Practicing amanah, adl, and the 12 Pillars in every decision

Assessment scale: 5 levels – Limited, Developing, Proficient, Advanced, Expert

Your target as entry staff: Reach "Developing" across all 12 within Year 1. Reach "Proficient" in at least 6 by Year 3.

How it connects to CSW: Each competency maps to specific ADDRESS IT steps. Analytical Thinking maps to Step 1 (Analyze Context) and Step 3 (Research). Communication maps to Step 5 (Submit). Problem-Solving maps to Step 4 (Explore Options).

Framework 3: 12 Supervisory Competencies[9]

Who it applies to: Supervisors and Division Chiefs. You will encounter this framework when you reach SG 18-22 and take on direct reports.

The 12 competencies:

1. **Foundations of Supervision** – Understanding your role as a supervisor (you are no longer the doer; you are the enabler)
2. **Assessing Performance, Potential, and Readiness** – Using the PPR framework to evaluate staff
3. **Giving Effective Feedback** – Using the SBI model (Situation-Behavior-Impact)
4. **Coaching for Performance** – Developing staff through the 5-element coaching cycle
5. **Setting Goals and Expectations** – Collaborative goal-setting using the 5-step protocol
6. **Conducting Effective Check-Ins** – Monthly structured conversations with direct reports
7. **Managing Underperformance** – Addressing performance gaps with progressive interventions
8. **Developing Talent** – Identifying high-potential staff and creating stretch assignments

9. **Leading Teams** – Building cohesive, high-performing teams
10. **Managing Change** – Guiding staff through organizational transitions
11. **Delegation and Empowerment** – Assigning work with authority, not just tasks
12. **Building Accountability Culture** – Creating an environment where people own their results

When you need it: When you are promoted to a position with direct reports (typically SG 18+). A mandatory **Supervisory Development Program** must be completed before or within 6 months of your first supervisory appointment.[10]

15.4 Training Catalog – What Is Available and How to Access It

Training is both a right and a career investment. Every training hour is recorded and counts toward the **Training** component (15%) of the Comparative Assessment when you compete for promotion.

Available Training Programs

Training	Mandatory?	Provider	How to Request	Frequency
Government Orientation	Yes (new employees)	CSC / HR office	Automatic upon appointment	Once
Values Orientation Workshop	Yes (all staff)	CSC	Through HR office	Once
CSW Training (ADDRESS IT)	Recommended for all	Internal trainers / DAB	Request through supervisor	Annually
SPMS Orientation	Yes (all staff)	HR office	Automatic	Annual
Records Management	Recommended (admin staff)	CSC / National Archives	Through HR office	As scheduled

Training	Mandatory?	Provider	How to Request	Frequency
Basic Supervisory Course	Yes (new supervisors)	CSC / DAB	Through HR office	Before or within 6 months of appointment
Supervisory Development Program	Recommended (supervisors)	Internal trainers / DAB	Request through supervisor	As scheduled
Financial Management	Recommended (budget/ finance)	MFBM / COA	Through HR office	Quarterly
Procurement Training	Required (BAC members)	GPPB / procurement office	Through BAC chair	As needed
Legislative Process Training	Recommended (Parliament staff)	Parliament Secretariat	Through committee director	Semi-annually
IT Skills	Optional (all staff)	BICTO / DAB	Request through supervisor	Quarterly
Leadership and Management	Optional (SG 18+)	CSC / DAB / external providers	Through HR office	Annually
Graduate Studies	Optional (scholarship/ leave)	Universities / CHED / DAB	Apply through HR with supervisor endorsement	Annual cycle

How to Request Training

1. **Check your IPCR.** Training should align with your performance targets and development needs. A training request that connects to your IPCR is more likely to be approved.
2. **Discuss with your supervisor during a check-in.** Get their endorsement before submitting any request.
3. **Submit a request memo to HR through your supervisor.** Specify: the training name, dates, provider, cost (if any), and how it connects to your work and IPCR targets.

4. **HR evaluates** against the office's Training and Development Plan and budget availability.
5. **If approved**, you receive a **training order** – the official authorization to attend.

Building Your Training Hours

In your first year, take **every training offered to you**. Here is why:

- Each training hour is recorded in your personal file
- Training = 15% of the Comparative Assessment for promotion
- Free government webinars and CSC online courses count
- Certificates of completion are accepted as evidence

Sources of free training hours: - CSC Learning and Development Portal (online courses) - BARMM ministry webinars and orientations - DAB (Development Academy of the Bangsamoro) programs - Development partner workshops (UNDP, JICA, AusAID) - Professional association events

Build your training hours as aggressively as you build your work experience. Both matter for promotion.

15.5 Scholarship and Graduate Study Programs

A **master's degree** is not required for entry-level positions. But as you advance, especially toward Division Chief (SG 22-24), the QS increasingly requires "master's degree" or "completion of academic requirements for a master's degree." Plan for this early.

Available Programs

Program	Who Qualifies	What It Covers	Return Service
CSC Scholarship	Permanent employees, 2+ years service, VS+ rating	Tuition and allowance for graduate studies in public admin, development management	2 years per year of scholarship
CHED Scholarship			Varies

Program	Who Qualifies	What It Covers	Return Service
	BARMM residents, may include employees	Tuition for graduate and post-graduate programs	
DAB Programs	BARMM government employees	Short courses, executive development, specialized training	None (in-service)
Foreign Scholarships (JICA, AusAID, KOICA)	Government employees nominated by ministry	Full scholarship for master's abroad	2-3 years per year of scholarship
Study Leave (CSC)	Permanent employees, 7+ years service	Leave with pay for up to 6 months for bar/board review or graduate studies	Complete studies within approved period
No-Cost Study (self-funded)	Any permanent employee	Permission to attend classes outside work hours – no financial support	None

How to Position Yourself for Scholarships

- **Maintain consistent SPMS ratings** of Very Satisfactory (4) or Outstanding (5). Scholarship programs require performance evidence.
- **Choose a graduate program aligned with your office's mandate and the BDP.** A master's in public administration, development management, or your technical field will serve you best.
- **Build a relationship with your supervisor.** They must endorse your application. A supervisor who trusts your work and sees your potential will write a strong endorsement.
- **Apply early.** Deadlines are strict and slots are limited. Missing a deadline by one day means waiting another year.
- **Understand the return service obligation.** If you receive a government scholarship and resign before completing your return service, you must reimburse the full cost. Calculate this before accepting.

15.6 Lateral Movement, Detailing, and Secondment

Not all career growth is upward. Sometimes the best move is **sideways**.

Types of Lateral Movement

Movement	What It Is	Duration	Your Salary	When to Use It
Transfer	Permanent move to another office	Permanent	Adjusts to new position's SG	When you want to change tracks or offices permanently
Detailing	Temporary assignment to another office	30-90 days (extendable)	Stays with original office	When you want to explore a different office before committing
Secondment	Extended assignment to another entity	6-12 months	Paid by original or receiving office	For inter-agency projects or professional development
Reassignment	Movement within the same office to a different unit	Indefinite	Same	When your office restructures or you need a different assignment

Why Lateral Moves Are Underrated

A lateral move is an investment, not a detour. Consider:

- A 2-year detailing to **BPDA** teaches you planning and M&E skills that make you a stronger candidate for Division Chief when you return to your ministry.
- A secondment to the **Parliament** teaches you the legislative process in a way that no training course can match. When you return to your ministry, you understand how laws are made – and you can shape them.

- A transfer from an **LGU** to a **ministry** after 3 years of frontline experience gives you both the community perspective and the institutional platform to advance.

Common Lateral Movement Patterns

From	To	What You Gain
LGU (3 years frontline)	Ministry (same sector)	Institutional platform, broader scope, higher SG ceiling
Ministry (technical)	Parliament (committee)	Legislative process knowledge, policy analysis skills
Office/Agency (planning)	Ministry (operations)	Implementation experience, sector depth
Parliament (legislation)	BPDA or commission	Strategic perspective, cross-sector coordination
Any track	Foreign scholarship (1-2 years)	International exposure, advanced degree, expanded network

How to Arrange a Lateral Move

1. **Identify the target office and position.** Check whether a vacancy exists or is expected.
2. **Discuss with your current supervisor.** Getting their support – or at least their non-objection – is critical.
3. **Contact the receiving office's HR.** Express interest and inquire about openings.
4. **For transfer**: Apply through the regular HRMPSB process at the receiving office.
5. **For detailing/secondment**: Your current head of office and the receiving head must both approve. Formalize through a memorandum of agreement.

15.7 The Path from Staff to Supervisor to Director

The career journey in government has distinct **transitions** – moments when the nature of your work fundamentally changes. Understanding these transitions in advance helps you prepare for them.

Career Level Progression

Level	SG Range	Your Role	Competency Focus	The Key Transition
Staff	11-15	Individual contributor. You produce CSW, memos, reports, data.	ACSCCRaPATFEE at Developing-Proficient. Technical knowledge of your sector.	Learning to produce quality work **independently**.
Senior Staff	18-20	Advanced individual contributor. You handle complex assignments and begin mentoring junior staff.	ACSCCRaPATFEE at Proficient-Advanced. Beginning to coach others.	Shift from "doing the work" to "ensuring quality of work."
Supervisor	22-24	Division Chief or Section Head. You manage a team of 3-15 staff.	12 Supervisory Competencies activated.	The hardest transition: from "best doer" to "best enabler." You are now accountable for OTHER people's output, not just your own.
Director	25-28	Bureau, Department, or Service Head. You manage multiple divisions and shape	Strategic thinking, stakeholder management, resource allocation,	From managing people to **managing systems**. You think in years, not weeks.

Level	SG Range	Your Role	Competency Focus	The Key Transition
		organizational direction.	policy influence.	
Executive	29-31	Minister, Secretary General, Undersecretary. You set organizational direction and represent the entity externally.	Political acumen, intergovernmental relations, public accountability, vision-setting.	From managing systems to **shaping the institution**. You are accountable to the Chief Minister, the Parliament, and the Bangsamoro people.

What Each Transition Feels Like

Staff to Senior Staff: "I used to ask for permission. Now people ask me for guidance."

You have mastered the technical work. Junior staff come to you with questions. Your supervisor assigns you the complex cases because you are reliable. The danger at this stage is becoming comfortable – doing excellent work at SG 18 forever without pushing toward leadership.

Senior Staff to Supervisor: "I used to be the best writer in my team. Now I review other people's writing – and it is harder than writing myself."

This is the most difficult transition in government. As a supervisor, you **stop doing most of the technical work** and start enabling others to do it. Your value is no longer in the quality of your memos. It is in the quality of your team's memos. You must learn to give feedback (SBI model), coach underperformers, set goals collaboratively, and run effective check-ins. Many excellent individual contributors struggle with this transition because they cannot stop doing the work themselves.

Supervisor to Director: "I used to manage a team. Now I manage teams of teams, and I see problems I never noticed when I was closer to the work."

At the Director level, you manage multiple divisions, each led by a Division Chief. You allocate resources, set strategy, negotiate with other offices, and represent your bureau in senior meetings. You no longer read every memo – your Division Chiefs do that. You see the big picture and make decisions that affect dozens of staff and thousands of beneficiaries.

Preparing for Each Transition

Current Level	What to Do Now to Prepare for the Next Level
Staff (SG 11-15)	Master CSW. Build competencies. Accumulate training hours. Maintain VS+ SPMS ratings.
Senior Staff (SG 18-20)	Start mentoring junior staff. Volunteer to coordinate team tasks. Complete supervisory training.
Supervisor (SG 22-24)	Develop strategic thinking. Build cross-office relationships. Seek Director-level assignments. Study resource allocation and policy influence.
Director (SG 25-28)	Build intergovernmental relations. Develop public communication skills. Understand political dynamics. Position yourself for executive leadership.

15.8 Actionable Tool: "Career Development Plan" Worksheet

Complete this worksheet annually – ideally during your IPCR target-setting conversation with your supervisor. Review it during each mid-year check-in.

Section	Your Entry
Current position	[Title, SG, Office]
Years in current position	[Number]
Current SPMS rating	[Outstanding / VS / Satisfactory]
Target next position	[Title, SG – be specific]

Section	Your Entry
Target timeline	[In how many years?]

Qualification Standards Gap Analysis

QS Component	Required for Next Position	I Currently Have	Gap
Education	[e.g., Master's degree]	[e.g., Bachelor's degree]	[e.g., Need to complete MA]
Experience	[e.g., 4 years relevant]	[e.g., 2 years]	[e.g., 2 more years needed]
Training	[e.g., 40 hours supervisory]	[e.g., 16 hours]	[e.g., 24 hours needed]
Eligibility	[e.g., CSC Professional]	[e.g., CSC Professional]	[None]

Competency Development Plan

Competency	Current Level	Target Level	How I Will Develop It
1. _____	_____	_____	_____
2. _____	_____	_____	_____
3. _____	_____	_____	_____

Training Plan for This Year

#	Training Name	Provider	Target Date	How It Connects to My IPCR
1				
2				

#	Training Name	Provider	Target Date	How It Connects to My IPCR
3				
4				
5				

Lateral Move Consideration

Question	Your Answer
Is there an office I want to explore through detailing or secondment?	
What skills would that lateral move give me?	
When would I pursue it?	

Graduate Study Plan

Question	Your Answer
What program am I considering?	
Which university?	
When will I apply?	
How will I fund it? (scholarship, self-funded, study leave)	

90-Day Action Items

#	Specific Action	Deadline	Status
1			☐
2			☐

#	Specific Action	Deadline	Status
3			☐

Supervisor's endorsement: __ *Date:* __

Next chapter: Chapter 16 – The Bangsamoro Public Servant

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1. Rep. Act No. 11466 (Salary Standardization Law V), sec. 2. ↩
2. Civil Service Commission, Rules on Step Increment, CSC MC No. 1, s. 1997. ↩
3. Civil Service Commission, Omnibus Rules on Appointments and Other Human Resource Actions (ORAOHRA), Rule VII, sec. 6. ↩
4. Civil Service Commission, ORAOHRA, Rule VII, sec. 12 (Next-in-Rank Principle). ↩
5. Rep. Act No. 11466 (Salary Standardization Law V). ↩
6. Const. art. IX-B, sec. 2(3); BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code). ↩
7. BTA Parliament Staff Competency Framework (25 Competencies), adopted by the Parliament Secretariat. ↩
8. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Complete Staff Work and Supervisory Development Guidebook* (2026), ch. 11 (AC-SCCRaPATFEE Competency Framework). ↩
9. Mambayao, Saidamen R., *Supervision and Supervisory Development Guidebook* (2026), ch. 3. ↩
10. Civil Service Commission, CSC MC No. 22, s. 2017 (Mandatory Training for Supervisors). ↩
11. Civil Service Commission, ORAOHRA, Rule VIII (Transfer, Detailing, Secondment, and Reassignment). ↩
12. Civil Service Commission, Omnibus Rules on Leave, Rule VI (Study Leave). ↩

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Chapter 16: The Bangsamoro Public Servant

This chapter is about who you become, not what you do. Government work will test your values – not your skills. You will be offered shortcuts, pressured to bend rules, and tempted to treat public resources as personal benefits. This chapter gives you the legal framework, the ethical compass, and the practical knowledge to stay clean.

Everything you have learned in this guidebook so far – how to apply, how to interview, how to write memos, how to get promoted – is about competence. This chapter is about **character**.

Competence gets you hired. Character keeps you trustworthy. In the Bangsamoro government, both are required. The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance are not motivational posters in a conference room. They are cited in performance evaluations, referenced in legislative proceedings, and expected in daily conduct. RA 6713 (Code of Conduct for Public Officials and Employees)[1] is not a guideline – it is a **law**, with real penalties for violations.

This chapter teaches you the ethical architecture of Bangsamoro public service: the moral governance framework, Islamic leadership principles, the legal requirements you must follow, and the practical situations where your values will be tested.

16.1 The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance – In Daily Practice

The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance are the ethical foundation of the 2nd Bangsamoro Development Plan (BDP 2023-2028).[2] They are drawn from Islamic governance principles, Philippine public service values, and the Bangsamoro people's aspirations for a government that is different from what came before.

Here is what each pillar looks like in your daily work – not as an abstract principle but as a concrete practice:

Pillar 1: Integrity

Principle: Avoid conflicts of interest. Those in positions of public trust should not bind themselves in any manner – financially or otherwise – that could influence their official duties.

In practice: You do not process your cousin's job application. You do not approve your friend's disbursement voucher. You do not evaluate a procurement bid from a company your family member owns. When a relationship could influence a decision, you **declare it in writing** and recuse yourself.

Pillar 2: Accountability

Principle: Public office holders should be open and transparent about all decisions and actions. They must answer to the people and to authority.

In practice: When your Division Chief asks why a project is delayed, you give the real reason – not an excuse. When you make a mistake, you own it and fix it. You keep records of your decisions so they can be reviewed. You do not say "that was not my responsibility" when the failure is traceable to your desk.

Pillar 3: Transparency and Honesty

Principle: Holders of public offices must declare private interests related to their public duties and resolve conflicts in a way that protects the public interest. All public transactions should be made public.

In practice: If your family owns property affected by a government project, you declare it in writing and recuse yourself from related decisions. You do not hide information that the public has a right to know. Your SALN is filed accurately and on time.

Pillar 4: Sense of Patriotism

Principle: Government officials should invest heavily in their way of life, achievements, rich history, and love for country. The reputation and integrity of the place must be maintained and protected.

In practice: You speak positively about BARMM to outsiders. You correct misinformation about the Bangsamoro. You take pride in your region's achievements – its legislative output, its development gains, its cultural heritage. You do not undermine the government you serve, even in casual conversation.

Pillar 5: Striving for Excellence

Principle: To achieve excellence, public servants should uphold the legitimacy of all their actions. They should strive to deliver the highest quality in everything they do, prioritizing process over results for the good of all.

In practice: Your CSW is decision-ready. Your data is accurate. Your memo has no typos. You do not submit "good enough" work when excellent work is possible. You take the extra hour to proofread, verify your sources, and format properly. Excellence is not perfection – it is the consistent refusal to be mediocre.

Pillar 6: Cultural Understanding and Tolerance

Principle: Public officials should gain understanding and awareness of socioeconomic differences between societies. They should invest in how provincial elements add variety to the entire Bangsamoro.

In practice: You learn basic greetings in your colleagues' languages. You do not assume all Bangsamoro are the same. You respect Teduray customs as much as Meranaw customs. You acknowledge that the Bangsamoro is diverse – 13 ethnolinguistic groups, each with its own traditions, languages, and perspectives.

Pillar 7: Unwavering Loyalty to God

Principle: Unwavering devotion to God is one characteristic of an effective public servant. Public officials are required to follow rules and regulations set by authorities.

In practice: You view your government service as **amanah** (trust) – a responsibility you will be accountable for, not just to your supervisor but to God. This pillar elevates public service beyond a contractual obligation. It makes your work a form of devotion. For non-Muslim staff, the principle translates to a sense of higher purpose in public service – serving the people is a calling, not just a career.

Pillar 8: Justice

Principle: A public servant should serve the public without prejudice. Equity should triumph without regard for oneself, family members, companions, or political alliances.

In practice: The beneficiary list includes ALL qualified families – not just those from your clan or barangay. The job applicant is scored on qualifications – not on who recommended them. You do not play favorites. **Adl** (justice) is not selective generosity. It is consistent fairness.

Pillar 9: Inclusivity

Principle: A good public servant fosters an inclusive environment that makes communities more welcoming and free from discrimination based on religion, ethnicity, or culture.

In practice: You advocate for persons with disabilities in program design (RA 10524 requires 1% reservation in government positions).[15] You ensure women are represented in consultations. You include Other Bangsamoro Communities (OBCs) and indigenous peoples in service delivery. You design programs that reach island communities and geographically isolated barangays – not just the provincial capital.

Pillar 10: Objectivity

Principle: Holders of public office should make only merit-based decisions when conducting public business, such as appointments, contracts, and recommendations. They should decide solely in the public interest.

In practice: You score job applicants on their qualifications – not on who recommended them. You evaluate proposals on their merit – not on the proponent's connections. You recommend the best option for the public – not the option that is easiest or that benefits someone you know.

Pillar 11: Dialogue and Meaningful Engagement

Principle: Public servants should ask the opinion of the community through dialogue to specify what needs to be addressed and to achieve meaningful engagement and positive change.

In practice: Before finalizing the barangay project list, you consult the community. You hold public hearings on proposed legislation. You listen to dissenting views instead of dismissing them. You practice **shura** (consultation) – the Islamic principle of collective decision-making – as a governance method, not a formality.

Pillar 12: Balance Between Practical Life and the Moral Side

Principle: In carrying out government duties, public servants must balance practical demands and moral or ethical values. They must not deviate from the moral aspect of their duties, especially in the public interest.

In practice: You pursue efficiency but not at the cost of fairness. You meet deadlines but not by cutting ethical corners. You balance getting the budget released on time with ensuring every disbursement is properly documented. When practical pressure and moral principles conflict, the moral principle wins.

16.2 Islamic Leadership Principles – For All Staff

BARMM governance is rooted in Islamic values that apply to all public servants, regardless of personal faith. These are not religious requirements – they are **governance principles** expressed in Islamic terms.

The Five Core Principles

Arabic Term	English	What It Means in Government Practice
Amanah	Trustworthiness	You are entrusted with public resources, public information, and public authority. Amanah means treating these as sacred trusts, not personal assets. Every peso you manage, every document you handle, every decision you influence is amanah. Betraying amanah – misusing funds, leaking confidential information, abusing your position – is the gravest failure in Bangsamoro governance.
Adl	Justice	Serving all people fairly – across clans, tribes, religions, and political affiliations. A Tausug applicant and a Meranaw applicant receive the same standard of service. A Christian community in Cotabato City and a Muslim community in Lanao del Sur receive the same quality of government output. Adl does not mean treating everyone identically – it means treating everyone equitably, with attention to those who need the most.

Arabic Term	English	What It Means in Government Practice
Shura	Consultation	Deciding together rather than alone. Before recommending a policy, consult those affected. Before approving a program, involve the community. The BTA Parliament itself is a shura – collective deliberation on behalf of the people. In your daily work, shura means asking your team, your stakeholders, and your communities before you act.
Rahmah	Compassion / Mercy	Government exists to ease suffering, not to create bureaucratic obstacles. When a displaced family needs assistance, process their request with compassion – not bureaucratic indifference. When a citizen makes a mistake on a form, help them correct it – do not send them away. Rahmah does not mean ignoring rules. It means applying rules with a human heart.
Sidq	Truthfulness	Report accurate data. Do not inflate accomplishment numbers. Do not hide problems. If a program is failing, say so – so it can be fixed. If you made an error, admit it – so it can be corrected. Sidq is the enemy of the “everything is fine” culture that destroyed ARMM’s credibility. BARMM must be different.

For Non-Muslim Staff

These principles are universal governance values. Trustworthiness, justice, consultation, compassion, and truthfulness are not exclusive to any faith. You are not required to practice Islam. You are expected to practice these values.

Every ethical system – Islamic, Christian, secular humanist, indigenous – recognizes these as foundational to good governance. The Bangsamoro government uses Islamic terminology because the Bangsamoro identity is rooted in Islamic civilization. But the principles themselves belong to everyone who serves.

16.3 The 8 Norms of RA 6713

Republic Act 6713 – the **Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees**[3] – is the national law governing the behavior of ALL government workers, including Bangsamoro public servants. Violation of RA 6713 can result in suspension, dismissal, or criminal prosecution.

Here are the 8 norms, explained for fresh graduates with real-world violation examples:

#	Norm	What It Means	Violation Example
1	**Commitment to public interest**[4]	Your decisions prioritize the public – not your personal, family, or political interest	Approving a project that benefits your barangay instead of the most underserved community
2	**Professionalism**	Perform duties with the highest degree of excellence, intelligence, and skill	Submitting CSW full of errors because you rushed; skipping training because you think you already know enough
3	**Justness and sincerity**	Do not discriminate. Comply with applicable laws.	Giving preferential treatment to an applicant because they belong to your clan

#	Norm	What It Means	Violation Example
4	**Political neutrality**	Provide service regardless of party affiliation. Government resources are not campaign tools.	Using your government vehicle, staff, or office to campaign for a political candidate
5	**Responsiveness to the public**	Extend prompt, courteous, and adequate service	Making a citizen wait 3 hours for a document that takes 5 minutes because you are on your phone
6	**Nationalism and patriotism**	Be loyal to the Republic and to the Bangsamoro region. Promote locally produced goods.	Publicly undermining the legitimacy of the Bangsamoro government or the peace process
7	**Commitment to democracy**	Maintain transparency. Participate in democratic processes.	Concealing public documents from FOI (Freedom of Information) requests without legal basis
8	**Simple living**	Lead modest lives appropriate to your position and income	Driving a luxury vehicle and wearing expensive watches on an SG 11 salary. COA and the Ombudsman will notice.

RA 6713 and the 12 Pillars – How They Overlap

RA 6713[5] provides the **legal minimum**. The 12 Pillars of Moral Governance provide the **ethical aspiration**. Both apply to you simultaneously. Where they overlap – integrity, accountability, justice, public interest – the standards reinforce each other. Where the 12 Pillars go beyond RA 6713 – loyalty to God, cultural understanding, balance between practical and moral – they reflect the Bangsamoro-specific dimension of public service.

16.4 SALN – Complete Walkthrough

The **Statement of Assets, Liabilities, and Net Worth (SALN)** is a constitutional requirement (Article XI, Section 17 of the 1987 Constitution).[6] Every government official and employee must file one annually. Failure to file is grounds for dismissal.

What You Must Declare

Category	What to Include	Examples
Real Property	All land, houses, buildings you own (sole or co-owned)	Your family's house and lot in Cotabato City (if you are co-owner); agricultural land in Lanao del Sur
Personal Property	Vehicles, jewelry, cash, bank deposits, investments worth PHP 50,000+	Your motorcycle, savings account balance, mutual fund investments
Liabilities	All outstanding debts	Housing loan (Pag-IBIG), car loan, personal loan, credit card balance
Net Worth	Assets minus liabilities	Calculated automatically
Business Interests	Any business you own or have financial interest in	Sari-sari store, online business, shares in a corporation, partnership
Relatives in Government	Relatives within the 4th degree of consanguinity or affinity who are in government	Your brother in MFBM, your sister-in-law in MBHTE
Financial Connections	Any financial connection with anyone doing business with the government	Your cousin supplies IT equipment to your office – DECLARE THIS

SALN Timeline and Deadlines

Event	Deadline
First SALN	Within 30 days of your appointment

Event	Deadline
Annual SALN	**April 30** of each year (covering assets as of December 31 of the previous year)
Last SALN	Within 30 days of separation from service
Where to submit	Your office's HR unit, which forwards to the CSC or the Ombudsman

Penalties for SALN Violations

Violation	Penalty
Failure to file	Suspension (first offense), Dismissal (second offense)
Late filing	Reprimand (first offense), Suspension (repeated)
Misdeclaration (understating assets)	Dismissal + criminal prosecution under RA 3019 (Anti-Graft and Corrupt Practices Act)[7]
Failure to disclose business interests or relatives	Suspension to Dismissal depending on gravity
Unexplained wealth (assets significantly exceed known income)	Investigation by Ombudsman, potential forfeiture of assets, criminal charges

SALN Filing Checklist

- ☐ All real property listed (land, house, building – include market value and acquisition cost)
- ☐ All personal property over PHP 50,000 listed (vehicle, jewelry, bank deposits, investments)
- ☐ All liabilities listed (loans, credit cards, personal debts)
- ☐ Net worth calculated correctly (total assets minus total liabilities)
- ☐ Business interests and financial connections disclosed
- ☐ Relatives in government within 4th degree listed
- ☐ Signed and dated
- ☐ Filed with HR before **April 30** deadline

- ☐ Copy retained for personal records

Fresh graduate tip: Your first SALN will be simple – you probably have few assets and no liabilities. File it anyway, on time, completely. Build the habit now. As your career progresses and your assets grow, the habit of accurate SALN filing will protect you from accusations of unexplained wealth.

16.5 Anti-Graft: RA 3019 – Practical Scenarios

Republic Act 3019 – the **Anti-Graft and Corrupt Practices Act**[8] – defines corrupt acts by public officials. As a fresh graduate, you may think corruption involves millions of pesos and headlines. It starts much smaller. Here are scenarios you may encounter in your first year:

Scenario 1: Gifts and the Nominal Value Rule

A contractor whose proposal you are evaluating brings you a box of pastries and a gift card worth PHP 300. Can you accept?

Answer: CSC rules allow you to accept gifts of **nominal value** (generally interpreted as not exceeding PHP 500 per occasion from a single source). The pastries are likely acceptable. But a gift card can be considered a cash equivalent – more problematic. **Best practice**: Politely decline gifts from anyone with pending business before your office. If you must accept (cultural obligation), declare it to your supervisor in writing.

The bright line: Gifts exceeding PHP 500 from persons with pending business with your office must be refused. No exceptions.

Scenario 2: "Facilitation Fee"

A citizen asks you to expedite their permit application and offers you PHP 2,000 "for coffee." Can you accept?

Answer: Absolutely not. This is bribery. Even if you call it a "facilitation fee," "processing fee," or "token of appreciation," accepting money to expedite a public service is a criminal offense under RA 3019, Section 3(b)[9] – persuading, inducing, or influencing another public officer to perform an act constituting a violation of rules. Report the attempt to your supervisor.

Scenario 3: Using Government Resources for Personal Use

It is Friday afternoon. You use the office printer to print 50 copies of your sister's wedding invitation. Is this a problem?

Answer: Yes. RA 3019, Section 3(e)[10] prohibits using government property for private purposes. This includes the printer, the vehicle, the internet connection, the office supplies, and your work hours. It seems trivial, but COA flags these patterns and repeated violations build a case. Use your own printer. Use your own paper.

Scenario 4: "Ghost Employees"

Your supervisor asks you to process the payroll for a staff member you have never seen come to work. What do you do?

Answer: This is potentially a "ghost employee" – one of the most common forms of government fraud. You have a legal obligation NOT to process the payroll if you have reason to believe the employee is not reporting to work. Document your concern in writing and report it to HR or the Internal Audit unit (BIAB). RA 3019, Section 3(e)[11] covers causing injury to the government through manifest partiality, evident bad faith, or gross inexcusable negligence.

Scenario 5: Conflict of Interest in Procurement

Your office is procuring laptops. Your brother-in-law owns a computer shop that is one of the bidders. Can you sit on the BAC (Bids and Awards Committee)?

Answer: No. You must disclose the relationship to the BAC and recuse yourself from the evaluation for this specific procurement. Failure to disclose is a violation of RA 6713 (Norm 3: justness and sincerity)[12] and potentially RA 3019.[13] The procurement must be decided by people with no personal interest in the outcome.

Scenario 6: Pressure from a Superior

A senior official instructs you to approve a disbursement voucher that you believe has incomplete supporting documents. What do you do?

Answer: Do not sign. Every signature on a government document carries legal liability. If the disbursement is later disallowed by COA, the persons who authorized, approved, and certified the transaction – including you – must refund the amount from personal funds. Politely explain your concern in writing: "Respectfully, I am unable to certify this voucher because the following supporting documents are missing: [list]. I recommend that these be completed before processing." Keep a copy.

16.6 COA Audit Basics – How to Stay Compliant

The **Commission on Audit (COA)** is the independent body that audits all government transactions. COA auditors can examine any document, interview any employee, and **disallow** any expenditure that violates rules.

What Triggers a COA Audit Observation

Trigger	What It Means	How to Avoid
Missing supporting documents	Disbursement voucher has no receipts, no approved request, no BAC resolution	Never process a disbursement without COMPLETE supporting documents
Unauthorized expenditure	Spending money for a purpose not in the approved budget	Always check your office's budget allocation before proposing expenditures
Unliquidated cash advances	You received cash for an activity and have not submitted liquidation	Liquidate ALL cash advances within 30 days (or the period specified in COA rules)
Splitting of contracts	Breaking a large procurement into smaller ones to avoid public bidding thresholds	Follow RA 9184 (Government Procurement Reform Act)[14] thresholds strictly
Non-compliance with procurement rules	Direct contracting when public bidding is required; incomplete PhilGEPS posting	Always coordinate with the BAC and Procurement Office
Overpayment	Paying more than the contract amount or paying for unfinished work	Verify deliverables before signing the Inspection and Acceptance Report

COA Disallowance – Personal Liability

If COA disallows an expenditure, the persons who **authorized, approved, and certified** the transaction must refund the amount **from personal funds**. This is not theoretical. Government employees have been required to repay amounts ranging from thousands to millions of pesos.

This is why **every signature you put on a government document matters**. Do not sign anything you have not reviewed. Do not certify anything you have not verified. Do not approve anything that lacks complete documentation.

The Four Questions

When in doubt about any financial transaction, ask:

1. **Is there a budget for this?** Check the approved appropriation.
2. **Is the procurement process correct?** Ask the BAC.
3. **Are all supporting documents complete?** Use the documentary requirements checklist.
4. **Who will sign and certify?** Each signature carries legal liability.

If you cannot answer "yes" to all four, do not proceed until you can.

16.7 Conflict of Interest – Practical Rules

Conflicts of interest are common in a region with strong clan and family networks. The issue is not that they exist – it is whether you manage them properly.

Situation	What You Must Do
Your relative applies for a position in your office	Disclose the relationship to HR/HRMPSB in writing. Recuse yourself from the selection process.
Your family member's company bids on your office's procurement	Disclose to the BAC. Recuse yourself from evaluation.
You are assigned to review a project in your home municipality where your family has political influence	Disclose to your supervisor. Request reassignment or establish documented safeguards.
You hold a financial interest (stocks, partnership) in a company that does business with BARMM	Declare in your SALN. If the business relates to your office's functions, divest or recuse.
You are offered a consulting engagement by an NGO on a topic related to your government work	Check CSC rules on outside employment. Get written permission from your head of office

Situation	What You Must Do
	before accepting. Government work comes first.
A subordinate gives you a gift on your birthday	Politely accept if it is of nominal value (under PHP 500). Declare it if it is substantial. Never let gifts create an expectation of favorable treatment.

The principle: When in doubt, **disclose and recuse**. It is always safer to declare a potential conflict than to be discovered managing one.

16.8 Whistleblower Protection

If you witness corruption, fraud, or illegal activity in your office, you have the right AND the obligation to report it.

Where to Report

Channel	What to Report	Confidentiality
Immediate supervisor	First resort for most concerns (unless your supervisor is involved)	Internal – may or may not be confidential
Internal Audit unit (BIAB)	Financial irregularities, misuse of funds, ghost employees	Confidential by policy
Civil Service Commission (CSC)	Personnel violations, nepotism, illegal appointments	Formal complaint – documented
Office of the Ombudsman	Graft, corruption, unexplained wealth, misconduct	Protected under RA 6770 (Ombudsman Act)[16]
Commission on Audit (COA)	Financial irregularities, unauthorized expenditures	Audit findings are official records
		Protected

Channel	What to Report	Confidentiality
Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission (BHRC)	Rights violations by government officials	

Legal Protections

- **RA 6981** (Witness Protection, Security, and Benefit Act)[17] provides protection for witnesses against government officials
- **CSC rules** prohibit retaliation against employees who file complaints in good faith
- **The Ombudsman** can issue protective orders for complainants facing harassment

The Reality

Whistleblowing in government – especially in a region with strong clan and political networks – is difficult. But the legal protections exist. If you choose to report:

- **Document everything.** Keep written records of what you witnessed, when, and where.
- **File through official channels.** A formal complaint has legal weight. A conversation does not.
- **Keep copies.** Do not rely on the receiving office to maintain your records.
- **If you fear retaliation**, the Ombudsman is the most independent channel. File directly.

The courage to report wrongdoing is rare and valuable. The Bangsamoro government cannot build the trust of its people if corruption goes unreported.

16.9 Serving Diverse Communities – The 13 Ethnolinguistic Groups

As a Bangsamoro public servant, you serve ALL Bangsamoro people – not just your own group.

Group	Primary Location	Language	Key Context
Meranaw	Lanao del Sur, Marawi City	Meranaw	Largest group in BARMM; strong

Group	Primary Location	Language	Key Context
			tradition of education and commerce
Maguindanaon	Maguindanao del Norte, Maguindanao del Sur	Maguindanaon	Agricultural heartland; largest land area
Tausug	Sulu (now Region IX), diaspora across BARMM	Tausug (Bahasa Sug)	Maritime culture; strong warrior tradition. Note: Sulu excluded from BARMM territory per SC ruling in *Province of Sulu v. Medialdea*[27] (finalized Nov 2024), but Tausug communities live throughout the region and BTA appointments from Sulu remain valid under the doctrine of operative fact
Sama	Tawi-Tawi, Basilan, diaspora	Sinama	Seafaring people; multiple sub-groups (Sama Dilaut, Sama Bangingi)
Yakan	Basilan	Yakan	Weaving tradition; agricultural
Iranun	Maguindanao, Lanao	Iranun	Historically maritime traders
Kalibugan	Zamboanga Peninsula	Kalibugan	Mixed ancestry; distinct cultural identity
Palawanon	Special Geographic Area (63 barangays)	Palawanon	From the SGA communities
Molbog	Special Geographic Area	Molbog	Small community in the SGA

Group	Primary Location	Language	Key Context
Jama Mapun	Tawi-Tawi (Cagayan de Sulu)	Jama Mapun	Island community
Badjao / Sama Dilaut	Tawi-Tawi, Basilan, diaspora	Sinama	Sea-based communities; among the most marginalized
Sangil	Sarangani, General Santos	Sangil	Part of Other Bangsamoro Communities (OBCs)
Teduray	Maguindanao	Teduray	Indigenous People (IP); distinct from Islamized Bangsamoro groups

Plus: Settler communities (Visayan, Ilocano, Tagalog – particularly in Cotabato City and North Cotabato), Other Bangsamoro Communities in other parts of Mindanao and Metro Manila, and indigenous peoples protected under MIPA (Ministry of Indigenous Peoples' Affairs) and BOL Article IX, Section 3.[18]

What This Means for Your Work

Your government serves **all of them**. Here is what that looks like in practice:

- **Program design must be inclusive.** A livelihood program that only reaches mainland communities misses island-based Sama and Badjao families. A scholarship program that requires internet applications excludes youth in geographically isolated barangays.
- **Service delivery must be equitable.** BOL Article IX, Section 15[19] protects settler communities. Indigenous peoples' rights are protected under Article IX, Section 3.[20] These are not aspirational – they are legal requirements.
- **Communication must respect linguistic diversity.** Official documents are in English and Filipino. But community consultations may need to be conducted in Meranaw, Maguindanaon, Tausug, Sinama, or Yakan to be effective.
- **Cultural sensitivity is professional competence.** Understanding that a Teduray community has different governance traditions than a Meranaw community is not optional knowledge – it is essential for any public servant who delivers services across BARMM.

16.10 The Peace Process and Your Role

Every day you work in BARMM government, you are implementing the **Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB)** – signed March 27, 2014, between the Government of the Republic of the Philippines (GRP) and the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF). The BOL (RA 11054)[21] is the legislative product of that agreement.

You may not think about this daily. But it is the context for everything:

- When you process a BANGON livelihood grant, you are delivering a **peace dividend**
- When you draft a legislative briefer, you are exercising the Bangsamoro's right to **self-governance**
- When you audit a project, you are ensuring **public trust** in the new government
- When you serve a community in Tawi-Tawi or Basilan, you are proving that the autonomous government **works**

The transition period is when credibility is built or lost. If the government delivers services, builds infrastructure, educates children, and improves livelihoods, the people's trust deepens. If it fails – if money is wasted, if services do not reach communities, if corruption persists – skeptics who opposed autonomy will say they were right.

Your daily work is the frontline of this test.

The first elected Bangsamoro government will inherit the systems you build, the records you maintain, the policies you draft, and the reputation you establish during the transition. Make that inheritance worth receiving.

16.11 Actionable Tool: "Ethics Decision Tree"

When faced with an ethical dilemma at work, follow this decision tree:

```
START: Someone asks you to do something that feels wrong.
   |
   v
1. Is it legal? (Check RA 6713,[^22] RA 3019,[^23] BAA 17,[^24] COA rules)
   --> NO --> Refuse. Document. Report if needed.
   --> YES --> Continue to 2.
   --> NOT SURE --> Ask your supervisor or legal office BEFORE acting.
   |
   v
2. Does it comply with government rules? (CSC, COA, procurement, HR)
   --> NO --> Refuse. Cite the specific rule.
   --> YES --> Continue to 3.
   |
   v
3. Would you be comfortable if this appeared in the newspaper?
   --> NO --> Do not do it. Even if technically legal, reputational damage m
atters.
   --> YES --> Continue to 4.
   |
   v
4. Does it align with the 12 Pillars of Moral Governance?
   --> NO --> Reconsider. Discuss with your supervisor.
   --> YES --> Proceed with documentation.
   |
   v
5. ALWAYS: Document your decision in writing. Keep copies.
   If someone pressures you, write a memo to your supervisor:
   "For the record, I was asked to [action] by [person].
   I believe this [complies with / violates] [specific rule].
   I have [proceeded / declined]. Please advise."
```

When Pressure Comes from Above

The hardest ethical moments are not when a stranger offers you a bribe. They are when a senior official – someone who controls your career – asks you to cut a corner, approve a questionable transaction, or look the other way.

In those moments, remember:

1. **Your signature carries personal liability.** If COA disallows the transaction, you – not the official who pressured you – will repay from personal funds.
2. **Document in writing.** A verbal instruction that leads to a violation has no paper trail. A written memo creates accountability.

3. **The Ombudsman exists for this.** RA 6770 (Ombudsman Act)[25] and RA 6981 (Witness Protection Act)[26] provide legal protection for public servants who report irregularities.
4. **Your career survives integrity.** It rarely survives a criminal case.

Next chapter: Chapter 17 – Frequently Asked Questions

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1. Rep. Act No. 6713 (Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees). ↩
2. Bangsamoro Development Plan 2023-2028, ch. 4 (Moral Governance). ↩
3. Rep. Act No. 6713, sec. 4 (Norms of Conduct of Public Officials and Employees). ↩
4. Rep. Act No. 6713, sec. 4(a). ↩
5. Rep. Act No. 6713, secs. 4, 7-8. ↩
6. Const. art. XI, sec. 17. ↩
7. Rep. Act No. 3019 (Anti-Graft and Corrupt Practices Act), sec. 7. ↩
8. Rep. Act No. 3019, sec. 3. ↩
9. Rep. Act No. 3019, sec. 3(b). ↩
10. Rep. Act No. 3019, sec. 3(e). ↩
11. Rep. Act No. 3019, sec. 3(e). ↩
12. Rep. Act No. 6713, sec. 4(c). ↩
13. Rep. Act No. 3019, sec. 3(a). ↩
14. Rep. Act No. 9184 (Government Procurement Reform Act), sec. 54. ↩
15. Rep. Act No. 10524 (Expanded Positions for Persons with Disability Act), sec. 5. ↩
16. Rep. Act No. 6770 (The Ombudsman Act of 1989), sec. 13. ↩
17. Rep. Act No. 6981 (Witness Protection, Security, and Benefit Act), sec. 3. ↩
18. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 3, art. IX. ↩
19. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 15, art. IX. ↩
20. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 3, art. IX. ↩
21. Rep. Act No. 11054 (Bangsamoro Organic Law). ↩
22. Rep. Act No. 6713 (Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees). ↩

23. Rep. Act No. 3019 (Anti-Graft and Corrupt Practices Act). ↩
24. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code). ↩
25. Rep. Act No. 6770 (The Ombudsman Act of 1989). ↩
26. Rep. Act No. 6981 (Witness Protection, Security, and Benefit Act). ↩
27. Province of Sulu v. Medialdea, G.R. Nos. 242255, 243246, 243693 (Sept. 9, 2024). ↩

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Chapter 17: Frequently Asked Questions

These are the questions we hear most – from fresh graduates at career fairs, university talks, and social media. If your question is not here, contact the CSC BARMM regional office or the HR unit of the office you are interested in.

This chapter answers 33 frequently asked questions, organized into five categories. Each answer is substantive – not a one-liner but a complete explanation that gives you enough information to act.

17.1 Application and Hiring (Q1-Q8)

Q1: Do I need Civil Service eligibility to work in BARMM government?

For **permanent plantilla positions**, yes. You need either **CSC Professional** (Career Service Professional exam) or **CSC Sub-Professional** eligibility, depending on the position level. Professional eligibility is required for positions at SG 11 and above. Sub-Professional eligibility covers positions at SG 10 and below.

However, there are entry points that do NOT require CSC eligibility:

- **Contract of Service (COS)** – project-based employment, renewable, no eligibility required. This is the most common entry point for fresh graduates without eligibility.
- **Job Order (JO)** – task-based, daily or hourly rate, no benefits, no eligibility required. Common for IT support, event logistics, and administrative tasks.
- **Consultant / Resource Person** – requires specialized expertise but not CSC eligibility. Fresh graduates with strong thesis work or technical skills may qualify for short-term engagements.
- **Internship / OJT** – no eligibility required. Good for exposure and building your network.

If you are a board or bar passer (lawyer, CPA, engineer, doctor, nurse, teacher, or any RA 1080 profession),[1] you automatically have **CSC Professional eligibility**. You do not need to take the CSC exam separately.

Strategy for fresh graduates: Start with a COS position to gain experience while preparing for the CSC Professional exam. Many permanent employees started exactly this way.

Q2: Where do I find job openings?

The official channels where government vacancies must be posted:

1. **CSC Job Portal** (csc.gov.ph/career) – filter by Region: BARMM. Create an account and set email alerts for your target positions and salary grades.
2. **BARMM Official Gazette** – BAA 17[2] requires all vacancies to be published here. Check regularly.
3. **Bangsamoro Parliament website** – for legislative staff positions, committee support, and secretariat openings.
4. **Individual ministry and office websites** – most ministries also post on their official Facebook pages, often before the gazette.

Informal channels that are equally important:

1. **Social media** – BARMM ministry Facebook pages, government career groups, Bangsamoro professional communities on Facebook and Telegram.
2. **University alumni networks** – your professors and alumni may have connections to specific ministries.
3. **Walk-in inquiries** – visiting HR offices directly with your PDS and cover letter is acceptable and sometimes effective in BARMM.
4. **Professional networks** – attending BARMM events, government forums, and civil society activities.

Vacancies must be posted for a **minimum of 10 calendar days** (CSC rule).[3] Check the posting date and closing date carefully – late submissions are disqualified without exception.

Q3: What documents do I need to apply?

Your complete application package includes:

1. **Application letter / Cover letter** – addressed to the head of office or HRMPSB Chair
2. **Personal Data Sheet (CS Form 212)** – the government's standard CV format (revised 2017, 4 pages)

3. **Work Experience Sheet (CS Form 212 Attachment)** – only if you have prior employment
4. **Transcript of Records (TOR)** – certified true copy from your university
5. **Diploma** – certified true copy
6. **CSC Eligibility proof** – Certificate of Eligibility, PRC Board Certificate, or Bar Certificate
7. **Training certificates** – seminars, workshops, online courses (Coursera and edX count)
8. **NBI Clearance** – current, not expired
9. **Barangay Clearance** – from your place of residence
10. **Community Tax Certificate (Cedula)** – current year
11. **2×2 and passport-size photos** – white background, recent
12. **Birth Certificate (PSA-authenticated)** – for appointment processing

Fresh graduate tip: Prepare all 12 items before you start applying. Having a ready package lets you respond to postings within days, not weeks. Keep 5 sets of photocopies ready.

See Chapter 8, Section 8.3 for the complete annotated checklist.

Q4: How long does the hiring process take?

From posting to appointment, expect **2-4 months**. Here is the typical breakdown:

Stage	Duration
Vacancy posting period	10 calendar days minimum
HRMPSB screening of applications	2-4 weeks after posting closes
Interview scheduling and conduct	1-2 weeks after screening
HRMPSB deliberation and recommendation	1-2 weeks after interviews
Appointing authority decision	1-4 weeks
Appointment letter issuance	1-2 weeks

Some offices are faster (6-8 weeks total). Others take longer (up to 4-5 months), especially if the appointing authority is managing many concurrent appointments.

You can follow up with the HR office after 30 days from your interview. A polite inquiry – "May I ask about the status of the selection for [Position Title]?" – is professional and acceptable. Do not follow up weekly.

Q5: I graduated with a general degree (BS Public Administration, AB Political Science, BS Management). What positions can I apply for?

General degrees qualify you for a wide range of entry-level positions:

- **Administrative Officer III** (SG 14) – budget, procurement, HR processing
- **Planning Officer II** (SG 13) – program planning and coordination
- **Legislative Staff Officer I** (SG 11) – entry-level committee staff in Parliament
- **Project Development Officer I** (SG 11) – project design and management in agencies
- **Management and Audit Analyst I** (SG 11) – organizational review, audit support
- **Administrative Aide VI** (SG 6) – if you do not yet have professional eligibility

Your general degree becomes a competitive advantage when paired with CSC eligibility and relevant volunteer, intern, or COS experience. Many Division Chiefs and Directors started with general degrees and built specialization through on-the-job learning and graduate studies.

Q6: Can I apply to multiple positions at the same time?

Yes – and you should. There is no CSC rule limiting the number of simultaneous applications. Apply to every position you qualify for across multiple offices. Here is why:

- Government hiring takes 2-4 months. If you apply to only one position and do not get it, you have lost months.
- Each application is evaluated independently. Applying to one office does not affect your chances at another.
- You learn from each application. Your second cover letter will be better than your first. Your third interview will be stronger than your second.

Track your applications systematically using a spreadsheet: Position Title, Office, SG, Posting Date, Closing Date, Documents Submitted, Status, Follow-up Date. See Chapter 7 for the Job Search Tracker template.

Q7: I do not have work experience. Can I still get hired?

Yes. Entry-level positions (SG 11-15) typically require a bachelor's degree and CSC eligibility but **minimal or no experience**. The Qualification Standards for most SG 11 positions list "none required" for experience.

In the Comparative Assessment, experience accounts for 25% of the total score. But the other 75% is:

Criteria	Weight	Your Control
Education	25%	High – your degree, honors, graduate units
Training	15%	Buildable – attend free seminars, webinars, online courses NOW
Eligibility	10%	Binary – pass the CSC exam or use RA 1080
Interview	25%	High – preparation makes the difference (see Chapter 9)

A well-prepared fresh graduate with strong interview performance, relevant training hours, and a good degree can score higher than a less-prepared candidate with 3 years of experience.

How to build experience without a job: OJT in government offices, volunteer work in LGUs, mosque or church community programs, CSO project assistance, student organization leadership – all count as "relevant experience" on your PDS when documented properly with certificates.

Q8: What is a "next-in-rank" position and does it affect me as an external applicant?

"Next-in-rank" means employees **one level below** a vacant position receive **priority consideration** in the evaluation. For example, if an SG 15 position opens, employees currently at SG 13 in the same office are considered "next-in-rank."

However, next-in-rank is a **preference, not a guarantee**. The HRMPSB evaluates ALL qualified applicants – internal and external – using the same Comparative Assessment criteria. External applicants can and do get hired even when internal next-in-rank candidates exist, as long as they score higher.

Do not be discouraged from applying because you think insiders have an automatic advantage. Prepare thoroughly. If you outscore the internal candidates, you get the position.

17.2 Salary and Benefits (Q9-Q13)

Q9: How much will I earn as an entry-level government employee?

Entry-level professional positions start at **SG 11**, which pays approximately **PHP 27,000/month base** (Step 1). With allowances (PERA at PHP 2,000/month, ACA), your total gross compensation is approximately **PHP 29,000-31,000/month**.

After mandatory deductions (GSIS premium, PhilHealth premium, Pag-IBIG contribution), your take-home pay is approximately **PHP 25,000-28,000/month**.

Additional annual income includes: - 13th month pay (1 month salary): ~PHP 27,000 - Cash gift (December): PHP 5,000 - Performance-Based Bonus: PHP 10,000-35,000 (if you and your office meet targets) - Clothing/uniform allowance: PHP 6,000/year

Total annual compensation at SG 11 (Step 1): approximately **PHP 370,000-400,000** including bonuses and allowances.

See Chapter 15 for the full salary grade table from SG 8 to SG 31.

Q10: Is government pay lower than private sector?

For entry-level positions, **yes** – government base pay is typically 15-30% lower than comparable private sector roles in Manila. A fresh graduate accountant may earn PHP 25,000-30,000 in government versus PHP 30,000-40,000 in a private firm.

However, the **total compensation package** is competitive when you factor in:

Benefit	Government	Private Sector (typical)
Job security		At-will employment in many companies

Benefit	Government	Private Sector (typical)
	Permanent appointment – cannot be fired without cause and due process	
Health insurance	PhilHealth + GSIS sickness benefits	PhilHealth + HMO (if offered)
Retirement pension	GSIS monthly pension for life	SSS + voluntary savings (no guaranteed pension)
Housing loan	Pag-IBIG at below-market rates	Market-rate bank loans
Leave	30 days (15 VL + 15 SL) + special leaves	15-20 days typical
Maternity leave	105 days (RA 11210)	105 days (same law)
13th month + cash gift	Guaranteed	13th month guaranteed; bonus varies
PBB	PHP 10,000-35,000 based on performance	Performance bonus varies widely

The total package – especially the GSIS pension, job security, and leave benefits – becomes **increasingly competitive** as you advance beyond SG 18. At Division Chief level (SG 24, ~PHP 85,000/month base), government compensation with benefits often exceeds comparable private sector positions outside Manila.

Q11: When do I get a raise?

Three mechanisms:

1. Step increment – An automatic salary increase within your current SG every **3 years** of continuous satisfactory service. Each SG has 8 steps. You start at Step 1 and advance to Step 2 after 3 years, Step 3 after 6 years, and so on. No competition required – just satisfactory SPMS ratings and continuous service.

2. Promotion – Competitive selection to a higher-SG position. This requires a vacancy, meeting the QS, and scoring well in the Comparative Assessment. See Chapter 15 for promotion timelines.

3. SSL tranche adjustment – Periodic government-wide salary increases mandated by Congress through the Salary Standardization Law.[6] When a new SSL tranche is enacted, everyone's base pay increases. You do not need to apply for this – it happens automatically.

Important: You do NOT receive an annual raise just for showing up. Step increments require **satisfactory SPMS ratings**. If your IPCR rating is "Unsatisfactory" or "Poor," your step increment may be delayed.

Q12: What are my leave benefits?

Permanent employees receive:

Leave Type	Days per Year	Notes
Vacation Leave (VL)	15	Earned monthly at 1.25 days. Must use at least 5 days (force leave).
Sick Leave (SL)	15	Earned monthly at 1.25 days. Medical certificate required for 5+ consecutive days.
Maternity Leave	105 days	RA 11210 (Expanded Maternity Leave Act).[4] Additional 15 days for solo mothers.
Paternity Leave	7 days	For married male employees, for the first 4 deliveries.
Solo Parent Leave	7 days	RA 8972 (Solo Parents' Welfare Act).[5] Must have Solo Parent ID.
VAWC Leave	10 days	For victims of violence against women and children.
Special Privilege Leave	3 days	For personal milestones, family events, etc.
Study Leave	Up to 6 months	After 7 years of service. For bar/board review or graduate studies. With pay.
Rehabilitation Privilege	Varies	

Leave Type	Days per Year	Notes
		For employees recovering from wounds or illness incurred in the line of duty.

Unused leave credits accumulate and can be: - **Monetized** – converted to cash when you have 15+ days VL balance (terminal leave monetization upon retirement or resignation) - **Carried over** – unused days roll over to the next year

COS and JO employees do NOT receive leave benefits. This is a major reason to pursue a permanent appointment.

Q13: What is the Performance-Based Bonus (PBB) and how do I qualify?

The **PBB** is an annual cash bonus for government employees whose office AND individual performance meet targets. It is not automatic – it must be earned.

How PBB works:

1. Your office must achieve at least **"Satisfactory"** on the OPCR (Office Performance Commitment and Review)
2. You must individually achieve at least **"Satisfactory"** on your IPCR
3. If both conditions are met, you receive PBB

PBB tiers (amounts are approximate and vary by year):

Tier	Office OPCR Rating	Individual IPCR Rating	Typical Amount
Best	Top 10% of offices	Outstanding (5)	PHP 30,000-35,000
Better	Top 25% of offices	Very Satisfactory (4)	PHP 20,000-25,000
Good	Top 50% of offices	Satisfactory (3)	PHP 10,000-15,000

Critical rule: If your office fails its OPCR – even if your individual performance was Outstanding – **no one in the office receives PBB**. This creates shared accountability. Your colleagues' performance affects your bonus, and yours affects theirs.

17.3 Work Culture (Q14-Q19)

Q14: What are government working hours?

Standard hours: 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM, Monday to Friday, with 1 hour lunch break (12:00 noon to 1:00 PM). Total: 8 hours per day, 40 hours per week.

Flexible arrangements: Some offices offer alternative schedules (e.g., 7:00 AM to 4:00 PM, or 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM). Check with your specific office's HR.

During Ramadan: BARMM offices typically adjust hours to accommodate fasting employees. Common Ramadan schedules: 7:30 AM to 3:30 PM. The Chief Minister issues an executive directive each Ramadan specifying the adjusted hours.

Attendance tracking: Most offices use biometric systems (fingerprint or facial recognition). Some still use Daily Time Records (DTR). Tardiness and undertime are tracked and may affect your SPMS rating, PBB eligibility, and leave credits.

Overtime: Government overtime is not like private sector overtime. You generally cannot earn overtime pay unless there is a specific authority (approved overtime authorization). Most government employees work beyond 5:00 PM without additional compensation – especially during budget season, session periods, and deadline-driven projects.

Q15: What is the dress code?

Regular days (Monday-Thursday): - **Men**: Long-sleeved polo or barong, slacks, closed shoes. No jeans, no sneakers, no sandals. - **Women**: Modest professional attire. Many BARMM offices observe Islamic dress norms – avoid sleeveless tops, wear knee-length or longer skirts/pants. Hijab is common but not required.

Fridays: Most offices observe "wash day" or "casual Friday." Casual but still professional. Jeans may be acceptable; check your office's specific policy.

Uniform days: Some offices have designated uniform days (e.g., office polo shirt on Wednesdays). Your office will issue uniforms or a clothing allowance (PHP 6,000/year).

General rule: When in doubt, **overdress** rather than underdress, especially in your first month. Observe what your colleagues and supervisor wear, then match that standard.

Q16: Is there a prayer room in government offices?

Yes. All BARMM government offices are required to provide prayer spaces. The five daily prayers (Fajr, Dhuhr, Asr, Maghrib, Isha) are observed by Muslim staff. During work hours, Dhuhr and Asr are the most relevant.

You will **not be penalized** for performing prayers during work hours. This is a protected practice. However, coordinate with your supervisor so that work continuity is maintained – for example, by staggering prayer breaks within your team so that at least one person is always available.

During Ramadan, the entire office culture adjusts. Expect lighter work schedules, collective iftar (breaking of fast) gatherings, and heightened spiritual observance. Many offices provide iftar meals. Participating – even if you are not fasting – is a meaningful gesture of workplace solidarity.

Q17: I am not Muslim. Will I be required to participate in Islamic practices?

No. You will NOT be required to pray, fast, wear Islamic clothing, or perform any Islamic religious obligation.

You WILL be expected to:

- **Respect prayer times** – maintain quiet during prayers, avoid scheduling urgent meetings during prayer breaks
- **Be considerate during Ramadan** – avoid eating conspicuously in front of fasting colleagues. Use the pantry or cafeteria.
- **Use the greeting "Assalamu Alaikum"** if you are comfortable. It means "peace be upon you" and is appropriate for anyone to say, regardless of faith. If you prefer, "Good morning" or "Good afternoon" is always acceptable.
- **Respect the 12 Pillars of Moral Governance** – these are governance values (integrity, justice, accountability, inclusivity), not religious obligations.

BARMM values **inclusivity** (Pillar 9). The BOL explicitly guarantees the rights of non-Moro and non-Muslim communities. Non-Muslim staff serve across all ministries and offices, including the Parliament Secretariat. You are welcome.

Q18: What languages will I need?

Government business is conducted primarily in two languages:

- **English** – for official documents (memos, briefers, policy recommendations, reports, correspondence with national agencies and development partners)
- **Filipino** – for meetings, informal communication, presentations, and community consultations

Knowledge of a **Bangsamoro language** (Meranaw, Maguindanaon, Tausug/Bahasa Sug, Sinama, Yakan) is a **significant advantage** – especially for: - Field work and community engagement - LGU-level positions - Health, education, and social service delivery - Building trust with communities who may not be fluent in Filipino

However, proficiency in a Bangsamoro language is **NOT required** for most positions. If you only speak English and Filipino, you can fully function in the central offices in Cotabato City.

Arabic is used in formal Islamic contexts (opening prayers at meetings, Quranic references in speeches, Shari'ah court proceedings) but is not required for daily government work. The Bangsamoro Darul-Ifta' and Shari'ah courts are exceptions – those offices require Arabic proficiency.

Q19: How hierarchical is BARMM government?

Very. The approval chain is strict, and hierarchy is deeply embedded in both government culture and Bangsamoro culture.

What hierarchy looks like in practice:

- You do not send a memo directly to the Minister. It goes through your supervisor, your Division Chief, the Director, and then to the Minister's office.
- You do not go over your supervisor's head – even if you think your supervisor is wrong. Raise your concern with your supervisor first. If unresolved, escalate through the chain of command.
- You address senior officials with appropriate honorifics: "Sir/Ma'am" for supervisors, "Director" for Directors, "Honorable" for Members of Parliament and the Chief Minister.
- In meetings, seniority determines speaking order. Junior staff typically speak last (or not at all, unless asked).

For fresh graduates: This level of hierarchy may feel unfamiliar if you come from a flat university culture or private sector startup. Observe and follow the protocol. Earn trust through consistent quality work before you offer unsolicited opinions to senior leadership. Your ideas are valued – but timing and channel matter as much as content.

17.4 Career Development (Q20-Q23)

Q20: How fast can I get promoted?

Realistically:

Promotion	Typical Timeline	Conditions
SG 11 to SG 13	2-3 years	Vacancy exists, SPMS rating VS+, basic training hours
SG 13 to SG 15	2-3 years	Accumulated experience, intermediate training, CSC eligibility
SG 15 to SG 18	3-5 years	Specialized training, demonstrated CSW proficiency
SG 18 to SG 22	4-6 years	Supervisory training, leadership competencies
SG 22 to SG 24	3-5 years	Management experience, possibly master's degree

Total timeline from entry (SG 11) to Division Chief (SG 24): approximately **10-15 years** with consistent performance and available vacancies.

Some people reach SG 24 in 8 years (in growing offices with frequent turnover). Others take 20 years (in stable offices with few vacancies). The two biggest factors are **vacancy availability** and **your SPMS ratings**.

How to accelerate: Maintain Outstanding or Very Satisfactory ratings. Accumulate training hours aggressively. Consider transferring to offices with more growth opportunities. Pursue a master's degree early.

Q21: Can I transfer between ministries?

Yes. Government employees can transfer between ministries, offices, and agencies. Here is how:

Requirements: - A vacant position in the receiving office that you qualify for - You meet the Qualification Standards for that position - Clearance from your current office (no pending accountabilities, cases, or obligations) - Approval from both the releasing and receiving offices

Process: 1. Identify the vacancy and confirm you meet the QS 2. Apply through the receiving office's regular HRMPSB process 3. If selected, your current office processes your release 4. You report to the new office with a new appointment letter

Your salary: You keep your salary grade or receive a higher one if the new position is at a higher SG. You do not lose your accrued leave credits.

Timeline: 1-3 months from application to transfer. Some offices process faster.

Alternatives to permanent transfer: - **Detailing** (30-90 days): temporary assignment to explore a different office - **Secondment** (6-12 months): extended assignment for specific projects or development

See Chapter 15, Section 15.6 for the complete guide on lateral movement.

Q22: Is a master's degree necessary for promotion?

Not always – but increasingly important at higher levels.

Position Level	Master's Degree Requirement
SG 11-15 (Staff)	Not required
SG 18-20 (Senior Staff)	"Preferred" or "completion of academic requirements for a master's degree" in some QS
SG 22-24 (Division Chief)	Often required: "master's degree" or "18 units toward a master's degree"
SG 25-28 (Director)	Almost always required

Strategy: If you plan a long government career, pursue a master's degree within your first **5 years** of service. Do not wait until you need it for a specific vacancy – by then, it takes 2 more years to complete, and the vacancy may be filled.

Programs available: CSC scholarship (for permanent employees with 2+ years service), CHED scholarship, DAB programs, foreign scholarships (JICA, AusAID, KOICA), study leave (after 7 years of service), and self-funded no-cost study (attend classes outside work hours with office permission).

See Chapter 15, Section 15.5 for the complete scholarship and graduate study guide.

Q23: What training will I receive?

Mandatory training (automatically provided): - Government Orientation – within your first months - Values Orientation Workshop – CSC requirement - SPMS Orientation – annual, for all staff

Recommended training (available upon request): - CSW Training (ADDRESS IT methodology) – the core skill for all government workers - Records Management – for admin staff - Financial Management – for budget and finance staff - Procurement Training – required for BAC members - Legislative Process Training – for Parliament staff

Advanced training (as you progress): - Basic Supervisory Course – mandatory within 6 months of first supervisory appointment - Supervisory Development Program – recommended for all supervisors - Leadership and Management – for SG 18+ staff

How to access training: Discuss with your supervisor during check-ins. Submit a training request memo through your supervisor to HR. Each training hour is recorded in your personal file and counts toward the Training component (15%) of the Comparative Assessment for promotion.

Fresh graduate tip: Take EVERY training offered in your first year. Also attend free CSC online courses, BARMM ministry webinars, and development partner workshops. All count toward your training profile.

17.5 BARMM-Specific and Identity FAQs (Q24-Q33)

Q24: I am not Muslim – can I still work in BARMM government?

Absolutely yes.

BARMM is an autonomous government for the Bangsamoro **region** – it is not an Islamic theocracy. The BOL explicitly protects the rights of all communities:

- **Article IX, Section 3** guarantees the rights of indigenous peoples within BARMM territory[7]
- **Article IX, Section 15** protects the rights of settler communities[8]

Non-Muslim staff serve in **every ministry, commission, and office** – including the Parliament Secretariat. There is no position in BARMM government that requires you to be Muslim (with the specific exception of Shari'ah court judges, who must have Islamic law qualifications).

You will be expected to **respect** Islamic governance values (amanah, adl, shura, rahmah, sidq) – but these are universal principles of good governance, not religious requirements. Trustworthiness, justice, consultation, compassion, and truthfulness belong to every ethical tradition.

Your **competence**, not your faith, determines your career.

Q25: I am not Bangsamoro – I am from Manila, the Visayas, or Luzon. Will I fit in?

Yes – if you approach the work with humility, respect, and genuine commitment to the Bangsamoro people's development.

BARMM actively welcomes Filipino professionals from other regions, especially in technical fields where local talent supply may be limited: engineering, IT, health, finance, agriculture, environmental science.

What matters is your **attitude**:

- **Learn the culture.** Read about Bangsamoro history. Understand the peace process. Know what the BOL means.
- **Respect the traditions.** Use "Assalamu Alaikum." Observe prayer time etiquette. Participate in office cultural events.
- **Study the legal framework.** BARMM has its own laws (BAA 13,[9] BAA 17,[10] BAA 49,[11] BAA 84[12]). Do not assume national government rules apply.
- **Show humility.** You are here to serve – not to "fix" the Bangsamoro. Your outsider perspective is valuable, but offer it respectfully.
- **Build relationships.** Learn a few Bangsamoro phrases. Accept food when offered. Ask colleagues about their traditions.

Several senior government officials and technical staff in BARMM are from outside the region. They succeeded because they demonstrated commitment and earned trust through quality work and cultural respect.

Q26: What happens when the BTA transition ends and elections happen?

The BTA (Bangsamoro Transition Authority) is a **transitional body** created to set up the permanent government. When elections happen:

Parliament staff (Secretariat and committee positions): The 77+ appointed BTA Members of Parliament will be replaced by elected MPs. But the Parliament itself continues. If you work in the Secretariat or a standing committee, your position is **not tied to a specific MP's appointment**. Career staff continue serving the institution.

Ministry positions (permanent plantilla): Permanent appointments are **NOT affected** by elections. Ministers may change (they are appointed by the Chief Minister), but career staff remain. Your job is protected by BAA 17's security of tenure provisions.[13]

Coterminous positions: If your appointment is coterminous with the appointing authority's term, your position **ends when they leave**. Plan for this – apply for plantilla positions before the transition.

COS and JO positions: These are project-based and have no security of tenure regardless of elections. Your contract determines your end date.

The bottom line: If you have a **permanent appointment**, the transition to an elected government does NOT threaten your job. The government continues. The mandate continues. The systems you built during the transition become the foundation the elected government inherits. That is the legacy of transition-era public servants.

Q27: I am from a clan or family with political affiliations. Will that help or hurt me?

This is an honest question that deserves an honest answer.

Legally: BAA 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code)[14] mandates **merit and fitness** as the basis for all appointments. The HRMPSB process, the Comparative Assessment, and CSC oversight are designed to prevent pure patronage hiring. Nepotism (appointing relatives within the 4th degree) is prohibited.

Practically: Connections help you **hear about openings** and get your application noticed. In a region with strong clan and political networks, this is reality. A referral from a respected figure can help your resume reach the HRMPSB's desk rather than getting buried in a pile.

But: Connections alone do not get you hired if you cannot pass the QS and score well in the Comparative Assessment. A well-connected applicant who performs poorly in the interview will be ranked below a stranger who performs well. The panel scores are documented and subject to CSC review.

What you should do:

- Use your network to learn about opportunities. This is legitimate and normal.
- Never assume you will be hired on connections alone. Prepare as if you have no connections.
- Build competence that speaks for itself. The best protection against political volatility is being so good at your job that every supervisor wants to keep you, regardless of who is in power.
- When you are the one hiring (eventually), uphold the merit principle. Do not perpetuate the system you may have benefited from entering.

Q28: I am interested in Shari'ah law. Are there positions for that?

Yes. The BOL (Article X)[15] establishes the **Bangsamoro justice system**, including Shari'ah courts with jurisdiction over cases involving Muslims in the Bangsamoro territory.

Available positions:

Position Type	Requirements	Where
Shari'ah Judge	Law degree with Shari'ah law specialization, Philippine Bar membership	Shari'ah District Courts, Shari'ah Circuit Courts
Court Clerk / Court Staff	Relevant education, CSC eligibility	Shari'ah courts
Shari'ah Lawyer	Law degree, Bar membership, Shari'ah law training	Legal offices, ministry legal divisions
Islamic Scholar / Researcher	Islamic studies degree, Arabic proficiency	Bangsamoro Darul-Ifta' (BDI)
Grand Mufti's Office Staff	Islamic studies background, Arabic proficiency	BDI under Grand Mufti Sheikh Abdulrauf Guialani

If you have a law degree with Islamic law concentration, or a degree in Islamic studies or Arabic, explore both the **Shari'ah courts** and the **Bangsamoro Darul-Ifta'** (headed by Executive Director Sheikh Marhan Borhan). These are specialized positions where demand for qualified candidates often exceeds supply.

Q29: Is it safe to work in BARMM?

Safety varies by location, and it has improved significantly since the peace process began.

Cotabato City (the seat of government): Generally safe for government workers. The city has a diverse population (Muslim, Christian, indigenous), a functioning local government, and active commerce. Standard urban precautions apply.

Provincial capitals (Marawi, Lamitan, Bongao, Buluan [Maguindanao del Sur]): Generally safe during daylight hours. Some areas have specific security considerations that your office will brief you on.

Remote and island municipalities: Some areas – particularly conflict-affected barangays, geographically isolated areas, and communities near peace process cantonment zones – have additional security considerations. Your office will provide: - Security orientation and protocols - Travel advisory updates - Coordination with security forces when necessary

The broader picture: The peace process has significantly improved the security situation compared to the pre-BOL era. Government workers typically face more risk from **natural disasters** (flooding in Maguindanao, earthquakes, typhoons) than from armed conflict.

If you are assigned to a challenging area, negotiate **hardship allowance** and **transportation support**. And know that the government workers in these areas are often the most impactful and the most valued.

Q30: Can I work from home? Is there a remote work policy?

During the COVID-19 pandemic, BARMM offices adopted alternative work arrangements (AWA) including work-from-home. Post-pandemic, policies vary by office.

Current situation (as of 2026): - **Most offices have returned to full on-site work.** Government work relies heavily on physical documents, in-person coordination, and biometric attendance tracking. - **Some offices allow flexible arrangements**: skeleton workforce during holidays, compressed workweek for specific projects, occasional WFH for documentation tasks. - **IT-intensive offices** (BICTO, some planning units) may have more flexible policies.

For entry-level staff: Expect to report **on-site daily** for at least your first year. Here is why this matters: - You need face-to-face interaction to learn office culture - Your supervisor needs to observe your work to evaluate you during probation - Relationship-building – essential in Bangsamoro workplace culture – happens in person - Training and mentoring are most effective when delivered directly

Remote work becomes more feasible as you advance and establish trust, but do not enter government expecting a WFH arrangement.

Q31: I am a person with a disability. Can I work in BARMM government?

Yes. Republic Act 10524 (Expanded Positions for Persons with Disability Act)[16] requires government agencies to reserve **at least 1% of positions** for persons with disabilities. BARMM offices are subject to this requirement.

Your disability **does not disqualify you** from any position as long as you meet the Qualification Standards. Reasonable accommodation must be provided: - Accessible workplace facilities - Assistive technology where needed - Modified work arrangements if appropriate

If you experience **discrimination** during the application process, you have legal recourse: - File a complaint with the **CSC** (for hiring process violations) - Contact the **National Council on Disability Affairs (NCDA)** - Report to the **Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission (BHRC)**

PWD applicants are evaluated through the same Comparative Assessment as all other applicants. Your competence determines your score.

Q32: I am a woman. Are there gender-specific programs or barriers?

There are **no legal barriers** to women in any BARMM government position. Women hold leadership positions across the government, including: - **Minister of Social Services and Development** (MSSD) - **Deputy Speakers** of the BTA Parliament - **Committee Chairs** in the Parliament - **Chairperson of the Bangsamoro Women Commission** (BWC, Hadja Bainon G. Karon)

Gender-specific protections and programs:

Protection/Program	Legal Basis	What It Provides
Maternity leave	RA 11210 (Expanded Maternity Leave Act)[17]	**105 days** paid leave (additional 15 days for solo mothers)

Protection/Program	Legal Basis	What It Provides
VAWC leave	RA 9262[18]	10 days paid leave for victims of violence against women and children
Solo parent leave	RA 8972[19]	7 days paid leave for solo parents
Bangsamoro Women Commission	BAA 8[20]	Promotes gender equality across BARMM
GAD budget	GAD Planning and Budgeting Guidelines	Each office allocates resources for gender-responsive programming
Anti-sexual harassment	RA 7877[21]	Protection from sexual harassment in the workplace

The reality: Women in BARMM government face the same challenges women face in Philippine government generally – balancing family responsibilities with career demands, navigating male-dominated leadership structures, and ensuring their contributions are recognized. The legal framework is strong. Implementation varies by office and by leadership.

Q33: What if I get assigned to a remote or island municipality?

Some positions – especially in MOH (Health), MBHTE (Education), MAFAR (Agriculture), and MILG (Interior and Local Government) – require deployment to **geographically isolated and disadvantaged areas (GIDAs)**.

This means: - **Island municipalities** in Tawi-Tawi or Basilan, reachable only by boat - **Interior barangays** in Lanao del Sur, hours from the provincial capital - **Conflict-affected communities** in Maguindanao del Norte and Maguindanao del Sur

The Challenges

Challenge	What to Expect
Connectivity	Limited or no internet. Cellular signal may be weak.
Transportation	

Challenge	What to Expect
	Boats, motorcycles, and long travel times. Some areas are accessible only during dry season.
Living conditions	Basic housing. Limited commercial options.
Isolation	Distance from family, friends, and urban amenities.
Security	Some areas have specific security concerns. Your office will brief you.

The Advantages

Advantage	What It Means
Maximum impact	You will have the most direct impact of anyone in government. The teacher in a remote island school changes more lives than the planner in Cotabato City.
Rapid skill development	You learn resourcefulness, independence, and problem-solving that urban staff never develop.
Service record value	GIDA assignments are **valued in your service record** for future promotions. They demonstrate commitment and resilience.
Community relationships	In remote areas, you are not a bureaucrat behind a desk. You are a person the community knows by name. Those relationships are professionally and personally rewarding.
Sense of purpose	When you see the waterless barangay get a water system because of your project proposal, or the child graduate because your school had a teacher – that is the reason the government exists.

What to Negotiate

If you are assigned to a remote area, discuss these with your supervisor and HR:

- **Hardship allowance** – additional compensation for GIDA deployment
- **Transportation support** – travel allowance or official vehicle access
- **Communication support** – satellite phone or internet stipend if needed
- **Rotation schedule** – periodic return to the provincial or regional office
- **Housing** – government quarters or housing allowance

A GIDA assignment is not a punishment. It is an opportunity to prove – to your office, to the community, and to yourself – that you are the kind of public servant the Bangsamoro government was created to produce.

Next: Glossary of Terms

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1. Rep. Act No. 1080, as amended (Civil Service Eligibility of Licensed Professionals). ↩
2. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code). ↩
3. Civil Service Commission, Omnibus Rules on Appointments and Other Human Resource Actions (ORAOHRA), Rule VII, sec. 6. ↩
4. Rep. Act No. 11210 (Expanded Maternity Leave Act), sec. 3. ↩
5. Rep. Act No. 8972 (Solo Parents' Welfare Act), sec. 8. ↩
6. Rep. Act No. 11466 (Salary Standardization Law V). ↩
7. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 3, art. IX. ↩
8. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 15, art. IX. ↩
9. BAA No. 13 (Bangsamoro Administrative Code). ↩
10. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code). ↩
11. BAA No. 49 (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code). ↩
12. BAA No. 84 (Budget System Act). ↩
13. BAA No. 17, sec. 27 (Security of Tenure). ↩
14. BAA No. 17, sec. 5 (Merit and Fitness Principle). ↩

15. Rep. Act No. 11054, art. X (Justice System). ↩
16. Rep. Act No. 10524 (Expanded Positions for Persons with Disability Act), sec. 5. ↩
17. Rep. Act No. 11210 (Expanded Maternity Leave Act), sec. 3. ↩
18. Rep. Act No. 9262 (Anti-Violence Against Women and Their Children Act), sec. 43. ↩
19. Rep. Act No. 8972 (Solo Parents' Welfare Act), sec. 8. ↩
20. BAA No. 8 (Bangsamoro Women Commission Act). ↩
21. Rep. Act No. 7877 (Anti-Sexual Harassment Act of 1995). ↩

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Glossary of Terms

This glossary defines the acronyms, legal terms, institutional terms, Islamic governance terms, and process terms used throughout this guidebook. Terms are listed alphabetically. Bold terms within definitions indicate cross-references to other glossary entries.

A

ACA (Additional Compensation Allowance) – A monthly allowance paid to government employees on top of their base salary. Amount varies by position and budget allocation.

ACSCCRaPATFEE – The 12-competency framework for Complete Staff Work: Analytical and Critical Thinking, Creativity and Innovation, Strategic Thinking, Communication, Collaboration and Teamwork, Research and Analysis, Problem-Solving and Decision Making, Attention to Details and Quality, Time and Attention Management, Flexibility and Adaptability, Emotional Intelligence and Accountability, Ethics and Integrity. Applies to all BARMM government workers who produce **CSW**.

ADDRESS IT – The 7-step **CSW** methodology: **A**nalyze the Context, **D**efine and **D**eliberate, **R**esearch, **E**xplore Options, **S**ubmit, **S**ustain, **I**terate and Improve. The standard process for producing decision-ready staff work in BARMM government.

Adl – Arabic term meaning justice. One of the five core Islamic leadership principles applied in BARMM governance. Requires serving all people fairly, regardless of clan, tribe, religion, or political affiliation.

Amanah – Arabic term meaning trustworthiness. The most fundamental Islamic governance value in BARMM. Treats public resources, information, and authority as sacred trusts that must not be misused.

Appointing Authority – The official who has the power to issue appointments. In ministries, this is the Minister. In the Parliament, this is the Secretary General (for secretariat staff) or the Speaker. In LGUs, this is the local chief executive.

ARTA (Anti-Red Tape Authority) – The national agency that monitors government compliance with service delivery standards. All government offices must have a **Citizen's Charter** specifying processing times and requirements for each service.

AWA (Alternative Work Arrangement) – Flexible work arrangements in government, including work-from-home, compressed workweek, and skeleton workforce. Policies vary by office.

B

BAA (Bangsamoro Autonomy Act) – A law enacted by the **BTA** Parliament.[1] BAAs are the Bangsamoro equivalent of national Republic Acts. Examples: BAA 13 (Administrative Code), BAA 17 (Civil Service Code), BAA 84 (Budget System Act).

BAC (Bids and Awards Committee) – The committee in each government office responsible for procurement. Governed by RA 9184 (Government Procurement Reform Act).[2] BAC members must undergo procurement training.

BARMM (Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao) – The autonomous political entity in Mindanao created by the **BOL** (RA 11054) and ratified through a plebiscite in 2019. Comprises 5 provinces (Lanao del Sur, Maguindanao del Norte, Maguindanao del Sur, Basilan, Tawi-Tawi), Cotabato City, and 63 barangays in North Cotabato organized into 8 SGA municipalities.

BBOI (Bangsamoro Board of Investments) – The agency responsible for investment promotion and incentives in BARMM.

BDP (Bangsamoro Development Plan) – The government's medium-term development roadmap. The current plan is the 2nd BDP (2023-2028), which has 6 development goals, 8 strategies, and the 12 Pillars of Moral Governance.

BHRC (Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission) – Created by BAA 4. Investigates human rights violations within BARMM territory.

BIAB (Bangsamoro Internal Auditing Body) – The internal audit unit that monitors financial compliance within BARMM government offices.

BICTO (Bangsamoro Information and Communications Technology Office) – The agency responsible for IT infrastructure, digital government, and technology services in BARMM.

BOL (Bangsamoro Organic Law) – Republic Act 11054,[3] the law that created BARMM. Ratified through a plebiscite on January 21, 2019 (mainland) and February 6, 2019 (island provinces). Establishes BARMM's powers, government structure, fiscal autonomy, and justice system.

BPDA (Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority) – The agency responsible for development planning, monitoring and evaluation, and coordination of the **BDP** implementation.

BTA (Bangsamoro Transition Authority) – The transitional government of BARMM, serving until regular elections are held. The BTA exercises both legislative (Parliament) and executive (Chief Minister and Cabinet) functions. Currently has 77 Members of Parliament.

BWC (Bangsamoro Women Commission) – Created by BAA 8. Promotes gender equality and women's empowerment across BARMM.

BYC (Bangsamoro Youth Commission) – Created by BAA 10. Promotes youth development and participation in governance.

C

CAB (Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro) – The peace agreement signed on March 27, 2014, between the Government of the Republic of the Philippines and the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF). The **BOL** is the legislative product of the CAB.

CBI (Competency-Based Interview) – A structured interview format used in government hiring and promotion. Questions are designed to assess specific competencies through the **STAR** method. The interview component is 25% of the **Comparative Assessment**.

Citizen's Charter – A document required by **ARTA** that specifies the services each government office provides, including steps, processing time, fees, and requirements. Must be publicly posted.

COA (Commission on Audit) – The independent constitutional body that audits all government revenue, expenditures, and transactions. COA can **disallow** expenditures, requiring the responsible officials to refund from personal funds.

COLA (Cost of Living Allowance) – An allowance for government employees, now integrated into base pay under recent **SSL** tranches.

Comparative Assessment – The scoring system used by the **HRMPSB** to evaluate applicants for government positions. Five criteria: Education (25%), Experience (25%), Training (15%), Eligibility (10%), Interview (25%).

COS (Contract of Service) – A project-based employment arrangement in government. No CSC eligibility required. Renewable. No security of tenure. Limited benefits (no GSIS, no leave credits). Common entry point for fresh graduates.

Coterminous – An appointment type that ends when the appointing authority's term ends. Common for staff of elected officials, political appointees, and special assistants.

CSC (Civil Service Commission) – The national constitutional body that administers the Philippine civil service, including examinations, qualification standards, personnel rules, and discipline.[4] CSC oversight applies to BARMM through BAA 17.[5]

CSW (Complete Staff Work) – The doctrine that staff work should be so complete that the decision-maker only needs to approve or disapprove. In BARMM, CSW follows the **ADDRESS IT** methodology.

D

DAB (Development Academy of the Bangsamoro) – The government training institution for BARMM employees. Provides short courses, executive development programs, and specialized training.

Detailing – Temporary assignment of a government employee to another office for 30-90 days (extendable). The employee remains on the payroll of the original office.

DTR (Daily Time Record) – The form used to track daily attendance in government offices. Being replaced by biometric systems in many offices.

E

Eid al-Adha – The Festival of Sacrifice. One of the two major Islamic holidays observed as a national holiday in the Philippines and as an official holiday in BARMM.

Eid al-Fitr – The Festival of Breaking the Fast, celebrated at the end of Ramadan. An official holiday in BARMM.

F

FOI (Freedom of Information) – The policy requiring government agencies to disclose public documents upon request, subject to exceptions for national security and personal privacy.

Force Leave – The mandatory use of 5 days of vacation leave per year. Government employees must take these days off; they cannot be accumulated or monetized.

G

GAD (Gender and Development) – A government requirement that each office allocates budget and programs for gender-responsive initiatives. Guided by the GAD Planning and Budgeting Guidelines.

GIDA (Geographically Isolated and Disadvantaged Area) – Remote, hard-to-reach areas with limited access to basic services. Includes island municipalities in Tawi-Tawi and Basilan, interior barangays in Lanao del Sur, and conflict-affected communities.

GSIS (Government Service Insurance System) – The social insurance institution for government employees. Provides retirement pension, life insurance, disability benefits, and salary loan programs. Contributions are mandatory and deducted from salary.

H

HRMPSB (Human Resource Merit Promotion and Selection Board) – The board in each government office responsible for evaluating applicants and recommending selections for appointment or promotion. Uses the **Comparative Assessment** criteria.

I

IPCR (Individual Performance Commitment and Review) – Your individual performance contract under the **SPMS**. Sets specific targets at the beginning of the rating period and evaluates accomplishments at the end. Your IPCR rating determines PBB eligibility, promotion ranking, and training priority.

J

JO (Job Order) – A task-based employment arrangement in government. Hourly or daily rate. No benefits (no GSIS, PhilHealth, leave, PBB). No security of tenure. Used for short-term administrative, IT, and event support tasks.

K

Kalibugan – One of the 13 Bangsamoro ethnolinguistic groups. Located primarily in the Zamboanga Peninsula. Characterized by mixed ancestry and distinct cultural identity.

L

LGU (Local Government Unit) – Provincial, municipal, and barangay governments. In BARMM, LGUs are governed by **BAA 49** (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code).[6]

LSO (Legislative Staff Officer) – A staff position in the Parliament assigned to support committee work: research, policy analysis, legislative drafting, and briefer preparation.

M

MAFAR (Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries, and Agrarian Reform) – The BARMM ministry responsible for agricultural development, fisheries, and land reform.

MBHTE (Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education) – The BARMM ministry responsible for education at all levels. Governed by **BAA 18** (Education Code).

MENRE (Ministry of Environment, Natural Resources, and Energy) – The BARMM ministry responsible for environmental protection, natural resource management, and energy development.

MFBM (Ministry of Finance, and Budget and Management) – The BARMM ministry responsible for fiscal management, budget preparation and execution, and financial management. Governed by **BAA 84** (Budget System Act).

MILG (Ministry of the Interior and Local Government) – The BARMM ministry responsible for LGU coordination, local governance, and disaster risk reduction.

MIPA (Ministry of Indigenous Peoples' Affairs) – The BARMM ministry responsible for indigenous peoples' rights, culture preservation, and ancestral domain management. Established by **BAA 64**.

MOH (Ministry of Health) – The BARMM ministry responsible for health service delivery.

MOLE (Ministry of Labor and Employment) – The BARMM ministry responsible for labor relations, employment, and labor standards. Governed by **BAA 82** (Labor Code).

MOP (Manual of Procedures) – A document that describes the step-by-step processes for each function of a government office. Not all offices have one; new staff may be tasked to create one.

MPOS (Ministry of Public Order and Safety) – The BARMM ministry responsible for law enforcement and public safety.

MPW (Ministry of Public Works) – The BARMM ministry responsible for infrastructure development.

MSSD (Ministry of Social Services and Development) – The BARMM ministry responsible for social welfare and social protection programs.

MOST (Ministry of Science and Technology) – The BARMM ministry responsible for science, technology, and innovation.

MOTC (Ministry of Transportation and Communications) – The BARMM ministry responsible for transportation networks and communications infrastructure.

MTIT (Ministry of Trade, Investments, and Tourism) – The BARMM ministry responsible for trade promotion, investment facilitation, and tourism development.

N

Next-in-Rank – The principle that employees one level below a vacant position receive priority consideration for promotion. A preference, not a guarantee. The **HRMPSB** evaluates all qualified applicants.

O

OBC (Other Bangsamoro Communities) – Bangsamoro communities living outside the BARMM territory, particularly in other parts of Mindanao and Metro Manila. Protected under the **BOL** and served by the OOBC.

ORAOHRA (Omnibus Rules on Appointments and Other Human Resource Actions) – The CSC rules governing the appointment, promotion, transfer, detailing, secondment, and reassignment of government employees. Specifies the **Comparative Assessment** criteria, **HRMPSB** process, next-in-rank principle, and vacancy posting requirements. The primary CSC regulatory framework for HR actions in government.

OOBC (Office for Other Bangsamoro Communities) – The office responsible for serving Bangsamoro communities outside BARMM territory.

OPCR (Office Performance Commitment and Review) – The office-level performance contract under the **SPMS**. Your office commits to specific outputs and outcomes. OPCR achievement determines whether the office qualifies for **PBB**.

P

Pag-IBIG (Home Development Mutual Fund) – The government fund that provides housing loans, savings programs, and calamity loans. Contributions are mandatory for all government employees.

PAO (Political Affairs Officer) – A staff position in Parliament assigned to an MP's office, handling constituency concerns, stakeholder engagement, and representation.

PBB (Performance-Based Bonus) – An annual cash bonus for government employees. Requires both the office (**OPCR**) and the individual (**IPCR**) to meet performance targets. Typical amount: PHP 10,000-35,000 depending on performance tier.

PDS (Personal Data Sheet / CS Form 212) – The government's standard CV format. Required for all applications, promotions, and transfers. Must be kept updated throughout your career.

PERA (Personnel Economic Relief Allowance) – A monthly allowance of PHP 2,000 paid to all government employees.

PhilGEPS (Philippine Government Electronic Procurement System) – The online platform where government procurement opportunities are posted. Required for all procurement above certain thresholds.

PhilHealth – The national health insurance corporation. Government employees are automatically enrolled. Monthly premiums are deducted from salary.

PIMAO (Public Information and Media Affairs Officer) – A staff position in Parliament assigned to an MP's office, handling strategic communications, social media, media relations, and documentation.

Plantilla – The list of authorized positions in a government office, including the position title, salary grade, and whether the position is filled or vacant. A "plantilla position" is a permanent position with security of tenure.

PPR (Performance-Potential-Readiness) – A 3-step assessment framework used by supervisors to evaluate staff. Performance = current role effectiveness. Potential = capacity for a larger role. Readiness = skills for a specific new assignment.

PRAISE (Program on Awards and Incentives for Service Excellence) – The government recognition framework. Each office has a PRAISE committee that identifies and recognizes outstanding performance.

Q

QS (Qualification Standards) – The minimum requirements for a government position: Education, Experience, Training, and Eligibility. Set by the CSC and specified in each vacancy posting.

R

RA 3019 – The Anti-Graft and Corrupt Practices Act.[7] Defines corrupt acts by public officials and prescribes penalties including imprisonment and perpetual disqualification from public office.

RA 6713 – The Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees.[8] Establishes the **8 norms of conduct** and requirements including **SALN** filing.

RA 6770 – The Ombudsman Act.[9] Establishes the Office of the Ombudsman and its powers to investigate and prosecute government officials for graft, corruption, and misconduct.

RA 6981 – The Witness Protection, Security, and Benefit Act.[10] Provides protection for witnesses, including government employees who report corruption.

RA 9184 – The Government Procurement Reform Act.[11] Governs all government procurement, including bidding thresholds, procedures, and the **BAC**.

RA 10524 – The Expanded Positions for Persons with Disability Act.[12] Requires government agencies to reserve at least **1% of positions** for persons with disabilities.

RA 11054 – See **BOL**.

RA 11210 – The Expanded Maternity Leave Act.[13] Provides **105 days** of paid maternity leave for all female workers in government and private sector, with an additional 15 days for solo mothers.

Rahmah – Arabic term meaning compassion or mercy. One of the five core Islamic leadership principles. In governance, it means applying rules with a human heart and prioritizing the relief of suffering.

RRACCS (Revised Rules on Administrative Cases in the Civil Service) – The CSC rules governing disciplinary proceedings for government employees. Specifies grounds for disciplinary action, due process requirements, and penalties.

S

SALN (Statement of Assets, Liabilities, and Net Worth) – A constitutional requirement[14] for all government officials and employees to annually declare their assets, liabilities, net worth, business interests, financial connections, and relatives in government. Deadline: **April 30** of each year. Failure to file is grounds for dismissal.

SBI (Situation-Behavior-Impact) – A feedback model used by supervisors. Describes the Situation (context), the Behavior (what was observed), and the Impact (the effect of the behavior).

Secondment – Extended assignment of a government employee to another government entity for 6-12 months. Used for inter-agency projects and professional development.

SGA (Special Geographic Area) – The 63 barangays in North Cotabato that voted to join BARMM in the 2019 plebiscite, organized into 8 municipalities (established through BAAs 41-48).

Shura – Arabic term meaning consultation. One of the five core Islamic leadership principles. In governance, it means collective deliberation and decision-making, exemplified by the Parliament itself.

Sidq – Arabic term meaning truthfulness. One of the five core Islamic leadership principles. In governance, it requires accurate reporting, honest communication, and refusal to hide problems.

SPMS (Strategic Performance Management System) – The CSC's official performance management framework. Includes **IPCR** (individual) and **OPCR** (office) performance contracts. Uses a **5-point rating scale**: Poor (1), Unsatisfactory (2), Satisfactory (3), Very Satisfactory (4), Outstanding (5).

SSL (Salary Standardization Law) – The national law that sets salary grades and compensation for all government positions.[15] Updated periodically through "tranches" that adjust salary levels.

STAR Method – The structured format for answering **CBI** questions: **S**ituation (context), **T**ask (your responsibility), **A**ction (what you did), **R**esult (the outcome). Essential for government interviews.

Step Increment – An automatic salary increase within your current **SG** every **3 years** of continuous satisfactory service. Each SG has 8 steps.

T

Tausug (Bahasa Sug) – The language of the Tausug people. Also known as Bahasa Sug. The Tausug are one of the 13 Bangsamoro ethnolinguistic groups, historically centered in Sulu.

Transfer – Permanent movement of a government employee from one office to another. Requires a vacancy, meeting the **QS**, and clearance from the releasing office.

Transmittal Memorandum – A cover memo that accompanies a **CSW** output (briefer, policy recommendation, project proposal) as it moves from the staff member's desk to the decision-maker. Distinct from a regular memorandum.

V

VL (Vacation Leave) – 15 days per year for permanent government employees, earned monthly at 1.25 days. At least 5 days must be used as **force leave**.

W

Wali – The ceremonial head of the Bangsamoro government. Currently Sheikh Muslim M. Guiamaden.

End of Glossary

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1. Rep. Act No. 11054, sec. 2, art. VII (Legislative Power of the Bangsamoro Parliament). ↩
2. Rep. Act No. 9184 (Government Procurement Reform Act). ↩
3. Rep. Act No. 11054 (Bangsamoro Organic Law). ↩
4. Const. art. IX-B, sec. 3. ↩
5. BAA No. 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code). ↩
6. BAA No. 49 (Bangsamoro Local Governance Code). ↩

7. Rep. Act No. 3019, sec. 3. ↩
8. Rep. Act No. 6713, secs. 4, 7-8. ↩
9. Rep. Act No. 6770 (The Ombudsman Act of 1989). ↩
10. Rep. Act No. 6981 (Witness Protection, Security, and Benefit Act). ↩
11. Rep. Act No. 9184, secs. 10, 21. ↩
12. Rep. Act No. 10524, sec. 5. ↩
13. Rep. Act No. 11210, sec. 3. ↩
14. Const. art. XI, sec. 17. ↩
15. Rep. Act No. 11466 (Salary Standardization Law V). ↩

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